

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas

II.

(Grundideernes Logik, translated from the Danish)

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Corrigenda.

[[VI]]

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- p. 79, l. 15 from top: udvikes, read: udvikles.
— 125, — 4 from top: en, read: er.
— 130, — 11 from bottom: des, read: das.
— 139, — 7 from bottom: I den, read: 3) I den.
— 194, — 12 from bottom: høist, read: høiest.
— 195, — 6 from bottom: belyste, read: belyse.
— 305, — 2 from bottom: De, read: Det.
— 315, — 10 from bottom: Syllogistisk, read: 1) Syllogistik.
— 282, — 7 from bottom: καλοκαγάρθια, read: καλοκάγαθία.
— 398, — 10 from bottom: realiset, read: realiseret.
— 400, — 10 from top: blot Række, read: Række blot.

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Corrigenda to The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas I.

- p. 327, l. 14 from bottom: frembringes, read: forbruges.
— 328, — 14 from top: (H O), read: (H₂ O).
— 328, — 8 from bottom: denne Kjendsgjærning, read: dette som Kjendsgjærning.
— 239, — 17 from top: dannede, read: dannende.

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[Introduction]

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas is an attempt in pure philosophy, an attempt at a [[VII]] pronounced theism, a scientific protest against all theology.

Pure philosophy. The task is to free thinking from extraneous representations, fancies and sense-images, so that it may be put in a position to develop concepts and, in the development of the concepts, to cognize and hold fast the necessary forms of the Idea. When, however, it is said, according to a usage once accepted, that in logic it is thinking alone as thinking that accomplishes everything, then here as in so many other cases it holds that: *a potiori fit denominatio*. So-called pure thinking is, when taken by itself, an abstraction which, despite speculative sorceries with pure being, would not be able to stir from the spot without the help of intuition. It is for that reason a misunderstanding when “pure philosophy” is to be restricted to a simple grinding out of the old tune on being and thinking and thinking and being. Many and heterogeneous phenomena of spirit may be introduced into pure philosophy, and examples chosen from the most diverse spheres of life and of science alike; what everything essentially depends on in this respect is an observance of the following three fundamental demands: 1) The abstraction must be carried through, so that the concept together with its consequences can become sufficiently clear and transparent [[VIII]] at every stage of development; 2) The critique of the phenomena of spirit in question and the working-out of the examples chosen must be so laid out that only the logical, and what serves in a peculiar degree to render ontological problems and their solution distinct, comes into consideration; 3) The development must advance in essential continuity, so that what follows can be seen, step by step, to proceed with logical necessity from what precedes it: only in a continuous stream can the Idea be present

everywhere in the movement.

Pronounced theism. Although a logic of the fundamental ideas can in no section coincide immediately with the philosophy of religion, it is nevertheless quite necessary that it — unless it should be able to help itself with an atheistic principle — must develop the logical form of the idea of God as well as of the idea of the world, must logically determine the relation between these ideas and thus furnish the foundation for a corresponding philosophy of religion. The impossibility of giving either a logic of the Idea or a logic of the ideas without at the same time indicating the fundamental features of a philosophical world-view must surely be evident to anyone who has any concept of the matter. But by what, then, is such a philosophical world-view actually determined? Psychologically seen, it might almost look as if the philosophizer had a personal view ready in advance, and then, instead of adjusting his philosophical world-view to the logic, on the contrary accommodated the logic to his personal view. In this way an atheist would lay out an atheistic, a pantheist a pantheistic, a deist a deistic, and a theist a theistic logic.

That the personal view of the philosophizer must in fact become a factor in the peculiar manner in which he apprehends and determines the logical essentiality of the Idea cannot be denied; but philosophy would not be a science if it were not able to procure for itself a quite exact and incontrovertible standard by which the greater or lesser scientific validity of the heterogeneous, mutually conflicting logical systems can be judged. In the testing of a logical system everything depends chiefly on investigating how its principle, beginning and method are originally determined. If the given system really deserves the name of a system, then a glance at the plan as a whole, together with a thorough acquaintance with the beginning and the first sections, will ordinarily be sufficient to decide to which world-view such a system must necessarily lead. Those who know the Hegelian philosophy, e.g., will be able to see already from the first part of the Logic, from the first sections of the first division on being, and especially from the beginning with pure being, that the world-view answering to such a logic must necessarily become a logical pantheism, a panlogism, which only by mystifications of “the concept,” the pure concept, the logical Proteus of the immanent method, will be able to give itself a theistic tinge.

That The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas, in the two attempts now before us, is and must be theism, unambiguous theism, in plan, principle and method, can likewise be seen from the beginning itself and the first sections. If it is true that philosophy cannot begin with a unity of thinking and being unless it expressly begins with knowledge; if it is true that the principle of knowledge must absolutely coincide with the principle of subjectivity; if it is true that subjectivity must be principle, not merely for itself, but for all objectivity, and can be the former only by virtue of absolute knowledge, the latter by virtue of absolute power, and both by virtue of that unity-in-opposition of knowledge and power which alone gives absolute truth: then it will already from this be clear that the logical determination of the fundamental relation between the [X] idea of God and the idea of the world must become theistic.

Scientific protest against all theology. That an atheistic philosophy protests against all theology is in order. “But,” one might say, “how is it possible that a philosophy which announces itself as an attempt at a pronounced theism, which acknowledges the idea of God and consequently, from its standpoint, must set about developing the concept of God, can present itself as a scientific protest, not merely against theology in one determinate form, but unconditionally against all theology? A scientific development of the concept of God must, after all, always coincide with an objective doctrine of God. Since now any doctrine whatever of God — one need only recall the old orthodox fourfold division: *theologia accipitur sensu quadruplici: generalissime pro quavis de Deo doctrina, generaliter pro theologia vera, specialiter pro theologia revelata, specialissime pro doctrina de Deo uno et trino* — must be called theology, the question is: how is it possible that a philosophy should be able to set up a doctrine of God which yet, in order not to be theology, dare not be any doctrine of God?”

In answering this question we prefer to begin with a reduction of the fourfold form of theology, comprehending the first two definitions under the designation: natural theology (*theologia naturalis*), the last two under the category: revealed theology (*theologia revelata*).

That natural theology, which is originally an abstraction from a positive church doctrine, must be very different from true philosophy is easy to see. Natural theology, namely, begins in its own theological fashion with an immediate representation of

God. In such an immediate representation God himself is then apprehended as a supramundane objective being with certain determinate properties. The task is: to prove [XI] that such a supramundane objective being with such properties really exists, that this being really created the world, and so forth. With such an immediate representation of God, a representation that makes God into an object outward to contemplation, philosophy, if it is truly to be science, cannot possibly begin. Instead of getting involved with immediate representations of God and bungling with argumentative proofs of God's existence, philosophy begins by presupposing what is not something beyond or absent, but something essentially present for common knowledge, namely existence itself with its infinitely rich content. This content of knowledge is then determined, according to its content-rich unity with itself, as the Absolute, and the task becomes to develop and clarify the forms of knowledge adequate to the absolute content of being.

This task is scientific, for such forms can be developed, revised and corrected with an exactness which in dialectic is not inferior to what is exact in mathematics. For the development of the forms the method is so laid out that the content streams in of itself, as though under a pressure-head of the Idea: if only the form is true, then every doubt about the reality of the content is thereby at once removed. As the perfect form for the absolute content the concept of God is then developed; in the unity of the developed concept with its content the idea of God is cognized; in the idea of God, God is cognized; but this cognition is not theological.

As for revealed theology next, the ecclesiastically positive theology, in particular "speculative dogmatics," the author of the present writing has already expressed his view so often and so unreservedly that he can here restrict himself to a stereotyped repetition of what he, in order to concentrate attention on the first thing needful, must regard as decisive points.

[XII] The first thing, then, is to indicate what is theological in theology by a conceptual determination whose validity every expert must concede. We hold fast to the following criterion: "What is theological in theology is recognized by this, that the cause from which all effects in the realm of nature as in that of spirit are derived and explained, partly mediately, partly immediately, is sought not in the nature of things or the

essence of reason, but in the absolute will, in the Almighty who creates out of nothing. But even the purest, most acute and most consistent application of such a principle (occasionalism, Malebranche) makes science unscientific.”

In consequence of the conceptual determination set up, the second thing is how the account between theology and philosophy is to be settled. For philosophy’s part we choose the following settlement: In the Middle Ages it was theology that attacked philosophy, because philosophy was not believing enough; in our own day it is conversely philosophy that attacks theology, because theology is not scientific enough. It is then necessary in this respect that a sharp distinction be made between scientific in the wider and in the narrower sense. “Scientific in the wider sense is everything that becomes an object of science’s treatment: what is scientific lies in the treatment; scientific in the narrower sense, on the other hand, is only that whose validity science discerns, whose truth it can judge, test and acknowledge.”

By exploiting the ambiguity that lies in the category “scientific,” the doctrine of faith sometimes succeeds in giving itself the appearance of science; it is then the task of the theory of science to point out the most important sophisms belonging here.

First sophism. “If faith is not to rest on subjective notions and be abandoned to the whims of individuals, it must be possible to show expressly what one is to believe: faith must have its object. To investigate the objects of faith thoroughly is to investigate them scientifically. The doctrine of faith rests on such an investigation; thus the doctrine of faith is a science.” [XIII]

This sophism gives the matter the appearance that the objects of faith are secured by science because they are tested in science. The matter stands the other way about. The objects of faith dissolve into vapor as soon as science is given leave to apply its critique. It is just as impossible for a scientific critique to acknowledge the gospel of the Risen One as it is impossible for science to acknowledge the myth of Hercules. To acknowledge a miracle by virtue of scientific critique is a contradiction, since the possibility of a miracle makes scientific critique impossible: where the wonder speaks, the understanding must be silent; where the miracle begins, science must end.

Second sophism. “Every distinctive science must necessarily have its presuppositions. Just as logic presupposes and justifies the validity of thinking, and aesthetics

the validity of the beautiful, so must the doctrine of faith for its part presuppose and justify the validity of faith and of faith's content. Whoever proves that the doctrine of faith is not a science because it has its peculiar presuppositions proves at the same time that there is no science at all; but here it holds that: *qui nimium probat, nihil probat*. Thus the doctrine of faith is a science."

This sophism dazzles by the ambiguity that lies in bringing a presupposition along with one. What makes the doctrine of faith unscientific is by no means the circumstance that it brings presuppositions along, but precisely the circumstance that the presuppositions it brings along conflict with science. It presupposes the miracle, it presupposes the absolute validity of subjectivity and of subjective assurance; with [XIV] these presuppositions it has, so to speak, thrown itself upon science and broken the scientific standard. If the consequences are to be scientific, the presuppositions must be so too; on unscientific ground no scientific edifice can be raised: a science of nature is possible, but a science of miracles is impossible.

Third sophism. "The supernatural presuppositions of the doctrine of faith have, each for itself, validity no doubt only for the believer; but among these propositions themselves there is a logical and to that extent objective connection. Since the connection is objective, and the propositions of faith find precisely their true interpretation and deeper grounding in this connection, the grounding is itself objective, and the doctrine of faith thus, by virtue of this grounding, a science."

What is dazzling in this sophism rests on this, that a logical connection becomes without further ado an objective connection, and this in turn an objective grounding. "All men are triangles; Cajus is a man, thus Cajus is a triangle. In every triangle the sum of the angles is equal to two right angles. Cajus is a triangle, thus the sum of the angles in Cajus is equal to two right angles." Among these propositions there is here undeniably a logical connection; but is there on that account an objective scientific grounding? From the standpoint of life there may be an eternity-difference between the holy and the profane, the evangelical and the mythological; but when once science cannot judge this holy, cannot master this evangelical, the difference is, in science's eyes, as though it were not at all. — Since the propositions of faith are, each for itself, unconditionally subjective, they are in science just as arbitrary as the most fantastical

fancies. If, then, there is a scientific grounding of doctrines of faith, there is also a scientific grounding of doctrines of myth, a scientific grounding of nonsense.

Fourth sophism. “The spirit in the doctrine of faith, ‘the Holy Spirit,’ is not merely [XV] in the subjective sense a spirit of faith; in the objective sense it is the absolute spirit of truth, the spirit that ‘searches the deep things of God’ and ‘guides us into all truth.’ If it now stands firm that every science presupposes a truth; if it stands firm that the lower truths must always seek their final explanation in a highest truth, then it also stands firm that the spirit which guides us into all truth must be the spirit which guides us into all science; the doctrine of faith is thus not merely a science, but the highest science, that in which all other science is explained.”

What is dazzling in this sophism rests on a double subreption. It is assumed that the spirit which runs through the theologians’ objective doctrine of faith really is “the Holy Spirit”; this assumption is false. Every church communion has, as is well known, a doctrine of faith of its own; the one doctrine of faith stands in conflict with the other; the adherents of the one contradict and condemn the adherents of the other. If the doctrine of faith were essentially a work of “the Holy Spirit,” then “the Holy Spirit” would have to be at variance with itself; but a spirit that is at variance with itself cannot be the spirit of truth. It is assumed that “the Holy Spirit” must in its principle be a scientific spirit. This assumption is false. If “the Holy Spirit” were a spirit of science, then Christ’s and the apostles’ cognition of the eternal truth would have had to be the highest scientific cognition; then Christ and his apostles, in other words, would have had to be the greatest men of science on earth. If the spirit of faith were in truth a spirit of science, then it would surely have to go forward with theology, inasmuch as on the whole it goes forward with scientific rigor. But how does it go? Scientific rigor advances, but theology goes backward.

Now that the chief points to which a scientific protest against all theology can [XVI] on the whole be referred have thus been set up, the third thing is to get these points *either scientifically acknowledged or scientifically refuted.*

Those who now suppose that they have “the testimony of the Spirit” for theology’s really being a science will find in the propositions set up a convenient and, as we hope, a welcome occasion to raise theology’s repute and let its light shine, in that they

illuminate point for point the errors and misunderstandings of which the author of the present writing, be it in the criterion set up or in the sophisms pointed out, may demonstrably have made himself guilty. What matters, be it noted, is to demonstrate *determinate* errors in the *determinate* propositions; for on vulgar evasive remarks, improvised views, alterations or rehashings of old and long since refuted ways of seeing, and the like, the undersigned will not reflect.

March 11, 1866.

R. Nielsen.

B. Logical Functions.

[1] It is an old objection that philosophy hangs upon words, that its explanations are explanations of words, its controversies disputes about words, its wisdom verbiage. This objection is not wholly without ground when one one-sidedly fixes one's attention upon the shadow-sides, upon the barren subtleties, the tasteless aberrations into empty word-cleverness, over which a Johan of Salisbury¹, an Erasmus of Rotterdam, a Baco of Verulam and among us a Holberg have, each in his own age, held proceedings against the clients of speculative knowledge. The objection becomes groundless and empty, on the other hand, when, in blind zeal for the real, one disparages the ideal and imagines that the understanding sees the thing best of all when it overlooks the word. That philosophy cannot possibly enter into such a way of regarding the matter goes without saying. Philosophy is the science of the word in a peculiar sense; it must necessarily hold to the word, so surely as it means to hold to thought and to hold fast the concept.

Or how should it indeed be possible to separate concepts from the corresponding words, developments of the concept from explanations of words? The concept being and the word being, the concept nothing and the word nothing, the concept something and the word something are surely so inseparable that one cannot alter the word without changing the concept, cannot give up the word without giving up the concept.

¹*Nihil est odibilis subtilitate, ubi nihil aliud est quam subtilitas.*

Just as a soul cannot be without a body, so neither can the concept, as the concept [2] determinate in itself, be without a determining word. It is to that extent quite significant that logic has its name from Logos, and that Logos is both word and thought; for if thought were not, then there would be no word, but if the word were not, then neither would there be any determinate thought.

What holds in this respect of philosophy holds in a corresponding way of the special science. It is unthinkable that any real science should really find itself able to cognize the thing otherwise than by means of the word, to set up concepts that did not rest upon words, to give us explanations of the matter that were not at the same time explanations of words. In every science a difference must necessarily be made between a doctrine of things and the things themselves; it is the doctrine of things, not the things themselves, that constitutes the content of the real science. If science could make the doctrine of things one with the things, then one would surely have to find again, e.g., the actual starry heaven in astronomy, the plant world in botany, the animal world in zoology, etc.; but since it is not the object, but the doctrine of the object, that science offers us, it follows of itself that the doctrine must hold to the word. Even in mathematics, where the exact designations do in so many ways take the place of the word, the word is necessary in order to raise the designations to determinations of concepts.

If it is explanations of words when the logician develops the difference between something and other, because the concept can contain nothing other than what lies in the word, then it is an explanation of words also when the mathematician makes a difference between angle and arc, the astronomer between parallax and aberration, the botanist between leaf and branch, the zoologist between paw and hoof; for arc, parallax, branch, hoof are words just as much as something and other. What is to be thought precisely by such words as paw and hoof must, even if we had paws and hoofs in a thousand, indeed ten thousand specimens before us, be explained by other [3] words just as necessarily as it must be explained by other words what lies logically in the words something and other.

That disputes about words are no more to be avoided in the real science can then be illustrated by countless examples; we choose an example from botany. *Taxus baccata*

(the yew tree) plainly has its epithet from the fact that its fruit has been taken for a berry (*bacca*). Now is it really a berry, or are we to use another designation? Such a question cannot be dismissed with a remark such as this, that it surely does not turn upon a name, a word, but upon the matter; for an explanation of the matter is here impossible without a corresponding explanation of words. — That the alleged fruit has a likeness to a berry, is fleshy, rounded, colored and is the result of a flower, is not to be denied; but the alleged fruit is nonetheless no fruit. A fruit is the ovary developed after fertilization; but here there is no ovary. If there is no ovary here, then neither is there any fruit here; if there is no fruit here, then neither is there any berry here, for a berry is a fruit. Is the so-called berry then perhaps an open carpel, such a one as is generally found among the naked-seeded plants? Neither is this assumption tenable. A carpel must necessarily be a leaf of its own kind (*folium sui generis*). But what we have to do with here is no leaf; it is a placenta, a funicle, hence an axis with a development quite analogous to that in the fig, the rose, etc. One sees from this how the dispute about the alleged berry becomes a dispute about words; for berry is a word, fruit is a word, ovary, carpel, placenta, etc., are nothing but words. The dispute about the thing thus becomes a dispute about words; without such a dispute about words a scientific development of the concept would be impossible.

“But,” it is said, “there is nonetheless, as regards dispute about words, an essential difference between the special sciences and philosophy. No doubt every special science [4] must express its concepts in words, but the concepts expressed in words become, as the above example also sufficiently shows, tested and secured by indisputable facts to such a degree that in consequence it is not the concept that must conform to the word, but on the contrary the word that must conform to the concept. In philosophy, on the other hand, attention is so one-sidedly directed upon thought, and through thought upon the word, that the thing becomes dependent upon thought and thought upon the word.” The opposition between philosophy and real science would then, from the standpoint hereby indicated, be apprehended thus: in philosophy it is the word that determines the thing, in the real science it is conversely the thing that determines the word. But how groundless this view is will be shown in what follows.

That things are determined by things through the mediation of words gives an

explanation of the matter; that words are determined by words through the mediation of things, an explanation of words. It is now to be investigated how far one is able in a finite manner to hold the explanation of the matter outside the explanation of words and yet satisfy the demand of the concept. As regards the word, philology is that one of the special sciences which stands nearest to philosophy; we choose, then, an example from philology. "For the consideration of that series of designations of *the relations in the sentence*, those which concern the relations in intuition of the individual substantival representations," says Madvig², "it is of the most decisive importance to make one's own and to hold fast the cognition that the grammatical designations have nothing whatever to do with the things' own real relations, but solely with those relations in intuition in which they are either referred to one another in contentless generality or show themselves as members in a determinate single image of action or state, from which the relation receives content. The master's relation to the slave [5] is, according to its content, apprehended no less as the opposite of the slave's to the master, because I designate the connection in which the representations *master* and *slave* enter for intuition, when the one is determined by its relation to the other, by one and the same case from both sides: *the master's slave* and *the slave's master*. In grammar the slave is, if one will, just as much the master's owner as the master the slave's; that is to say, grammar has nothing whatever to do with the relation of ownership, which is a real relation, and *possessive form* is quite as incorrect a name as the old Latin case-names, which are fetched from real relations; it brings, like those, one of the countless shapes before the mind which in intuition is subsumed under the relation of connection, and thereby it calls forth, indirectly and unconsciously, this true representation of the form's significance: belonging-together." — With regard to certain German philologists' speculatively confused apprehensions of the significance of case, in particular of the genitive as the case which "designates something (the representation whose name stands in the genitive) as "Ursprung oder Bedingung des Werdens eines Andern" ", there is added in a note: "Who does not now see, when he is reminded of it, that we are here in the midst of real relations and in the very crudest

²Om de grammatikalske Betegnelser Tilblivelse og Væsen, 1ste Stykke. Indbydelsesskrift til Kjøbenhavns Universitets Fest i Anledning af Hans Majestæt Kongens Fødselsdag den 6 October 1856. p. 20–22.

confusion? In “des Vaters Sohn” the father is no doubt Ursprung und Bedingung des Werdens des Sohnes, but in “des Sohnes Vater” is the son also Ursprung des Vaters? Perhaps the author would be shrewd enough to answer that the son is Bedingung des Werdens des Vaters, because the latter is father only through him. He would then merely confound the coming-to-be of an essence and that of a name. But how would he get free, e.g., of “des Vaters Hand.” In such obscurity one tumbles about, and by such stuff many let themselves be impressed, because there is once for all confusion in this domain and because one lacks the force of abstraction to grasp the matter as it is.”

- [6] It is a strong light that with these few but clarifying words falls upon the opposition between grammar and logic. That the grammatical designations have nothing whatever to do with the real relations of things means, then, in other words, that they have nothing to do with the real concepts of things. Explanation of words and explanation of the matter in this way step quite visibly apart from one another. Insofar as, in the talk of the master and the slave, the grammatical is here looked to, the slave is undeniably just as much the master’s owner as the master the slave’s; and why should he not be so as well? they both belong, after all, to the same part of speech, are both of equal rank, for the slave is surely a substantive just as much as the master. It is otherwise when in the talk the matter is expressly aimed at. In reality the master A is now an actual individual, the slave B likewise; but between the two individuals the real relation of master and slave is altogether contingent. For A as master could just as well be thought to have another slave, and B in the capacity of slave to have another master; indeed, so far as the immediate fact is concerned, it could just as well have been B who was master, and A slave, as the reverse. There is then, as is seen from this, neither in the pure explanation of words nor in the immediate explanation of the matter any question of comprehending proper. From the grammatical standpoint of the explanation of words the concept is lacking, because here every regard to the real relations of things is lacking; combinations such as “the slave’s master,” “the coat’s servant,” “the moon’s trousers” give in that respect equally good sense. From the immediately real standpoint of the explanation of the matter the concept is lacking, because the real relation in its pure facticity lacks what is necessary to the concept, the universally valid: now “A is master and B slave,” no! “now it is B who is master,

and A who is slave.” As the mere individual the slave is no concept, nor as the mere substantive either; if a trace of concept is to show itself here, the thing and the word, the individual and the substantive, must enter into process with one another.

The development of the concept demands a reciprocal determination of the explanation of words and the explanation of the matter, an objective reflection in which the thing determines the word, and the word in turn the thing: the thing is antilogical, only the word is logical. Insofar as the thing determines the word, the slave is dependent upon the master, not conversely; but insofar as the word determines the thing, the master as master is himself essentially dependent upon the slave. Insofar as the thing determines the word, the father is “Ursprung und Bedingung des Werdens des Sohnes,” not conversely; insofar, on the other hand, as the word determines the thing, the son is likewise essentially “Ursprung des Vaters.” What actuality parcels out, essence retains in reflected unity; in order to cognize the essential unity of the opposed determinations, the relation of actuality must continually be turned around. That the relation is turned around signifies, in the logical sense, by no means that the coming-to-be of an essence is merely exchanged for the coming-to-be of a name; it means on the contrary that the intuition of an actual is exchanged for the insight into an essential. It is by the effect that the cause not merely gets the name of, but essentially is, cause; it is by the slave that the master not merely gets the name of, but essentially is, master; it is by the son that the father not merely gets the name of, but essentially is, father.

In the reflection of the reversed relations dialectic is seen. Dialectic is essentially explanation of words, a mark of character that is strikingly designated by the Schleiermacherian expression that dialectic is an “art of language.” But the external, finite separation of explanation of words and explanation of the matter brings about confusion in science. In the feeling that dialectic is explanation of words, and, by the reversal of the relations, even a teasing explanation of words, one lumps it without more ado together with wordplay, word-splitting, etc. One speaks of the essential and means the actual; when dialectic then, in order to make the essential recognizable, turns the relation of actuality around, the verbally acute man can of course see in the word nothing other than the bare word, and thus protests, without knowing it, against the essential, and then the dialectician is at once to be a word-splitter. [8]

A mitigated form of the same misunderstanding makes itself known in this, that one does indeed concede a dialectic of the formal and a priori concepts, but not of the real, the empirical ones. "A priori concepts, such as: something and other, essence and seeming, ground and consequence and the like, can easily be brought forth from one another by the application of contradiction. He who posits the ground already tacitly understands the consequence; the ground is thus at bottom both itself and the consequence; but when the ground first becomes a ground proper on the ground of the consequence, then the ground is surely consequence, and the consequence ground. The same thing is not merely ground in one respect and consequence in another, but the two respects at the same time coincide in one respect: to dialecticize the concepts out of one another is, if I may use this expression, the same as to dialecticize *diversi respectus* into one another. As regards the a posteriori concepts, the concepts of experience, on the other hand, it is impossible to dialecticize existence out of the concept; or who would indeed attempt to dialecticize the actual horse out of the horse's concept, or the actual snail out of the snail's concept? But if it is impossible to dialecticize the existent out of its concept, then it is presumably for the same reason also impossible to dialecticize the one concept of existence out of the other, the concept of horse, e.g., out of the concept of fly, and this in turn out of the concept of snail. In the world of experience *diversi respectus* fall outside one another, and where *diversi respectus* fall outside one another, dialectic plays a very subordinate role."³

[9] The whole misunderstanding is removed when it is seen that a real concept can be formed and developed only on the condition that determinations of the antilogically actual and the logically essential articulate one another. The existing acid, e.g., is no doubt in actuality independent and to that extent indifferent toward the existing base. To want to maintain, from the standpoint of actuality, that it is the acid that makes the base a base, and conversely, just as in the relation of causality it is the cause that makes the effect an effect, and conversely; that the acid is thus itself base, and the base acid, just as the cause is itself effect, and the effect cause, is unreasonable and meaningless: in the antilogically actual *diversi respectus* fall outside one another. But that in the essential sense, hence when the concept is to come along as concept, it

³Forelæsning over "Phil. Propæd." Universitetsaar 1860–61 p. 25.

must absolutely be the acid that makes the base a base, and conversely, is not merely incontrovertible in reflection, but is even indicated in the phenomenon of actuality by this, that the same substance can in one combination play the role of the acid, in another that of the base: in silicate of alumina the alumina is base, but in aluminate of magnesia it is acid; the acid as silicic acid thus makes the alumina a base, while the base magnesia makes the alumina an acid. Instead of reproaching philosophy with its dialectical explanations of words, one ought, for the benefit of science, at length to learn to see that the dialectical explanations of words are necessary for the all-sided development of the real concepts.

If in truth so finite a separation could be made between the word and the thing that the thing let itself be apprehended as the purely objective, the word as the purely subjective, dialectic would undeniably lose its higher validity; but what indeed is a word's essential significance, if it is not its objectivity, and what sort of thing is it whose objectivity does not let itself be apprehended and determined by a corresponding word? There may indeed be something subjective in usage, and to that extent it rests with ourselves what significance we will attach to a determinate word in a determinate connection. But in all usage there is also something objective; once a word has received a determinate significance, then the significance must be respected. New words can be formed, but not arbitrarily: the reciprocal action between the popular language [10] and scientific language has therefore also long since been acknowledged.⁴ The thing is indeed independent of the word insofar as the word is an arbitrary designation; but a thing so objective that no word corresponded to its objectivity is unthinkable. The objective would then in this way transform itself into an unnameable, an in itself indeterminable, a something that nevertheless was not something, since something is after all a designation, and the unnameable falls outside every designation.

In order that the word shall be able to be determined by the thing, the thing must

⁴*Ce sont les opinions du peuple et le point de vûe sous lequel il envisage les objets, qui donnent la forme au Langage. A mesure que le savoir et la politesse se répandent dans une nation, et à proportion de la durée de leur regne ils portent leurs influences dans la Langue. C'est qu' alors le peuple s'approprie plusieurs expressions que les savans ont inventées; comme ceux-ci adoptent souvent à leur tour, des expressions populaires.*

De l'influence des opinions sur le langage. Par Mr. J. D. Michaëlis. Traduit de l'Allemand. à Breme. MDCCLXII. p. 9.

in turn be determined by the word; in order that the word's essence can be objective in the thing, the thing's essence must be subjective in the word. The thing and the word are thus in essence one and yet actually different: this is the meaning of dialectic.

Just as the word, dialectically regarded, is one with and yet different from the thing, so it is also one with and different from thought. If the word is posited against the thing, then the thing becomes the objective, the word the subjective; if the word is posited against thought, then the word becomes the objective, thought the subjective. Immediately thought and thing can never be united; only with the word does explanation come, and with explanation an understanding. As a general doctrine of the Logos, a doctrine of the pure Logos, logic is a doctrine of thought only insofar as [11] it is at the same time a doctrine of the word in its essential unity with thought. Yet here, as everywhere, the essential unity is of course grounded upon difference and opposition; the doctrine of the word's unity with thought is precisely a doctrine of the opposition of word and thought. If it is misleading to want to hold thought fast in finite separation from the word, then it is no less misleading to want to identify the word outright with thought. The latter error characterizes speculation, which overlooks the word's immediacy and lays one-sided weight upon the fact that Logos is essentially thought.

That logic, the rational doctrine of the Logos, must from first to last use the word is then a matter of course; but it is one thing to use the word, another to reflect upon the word's use. This reflection presents itself precisely in the present connection, where the task is to develop the logical functions. If we abstract from what is peculiar in the relation between thought, word and thing, then it becomes impossible to subject the logical functions to any special treatment. One must then either presuppose the word's unity with thought and reflect upon subjectivity, or conversely the word's unity with the thing and reflect upon objectivity. In the first case the functions are so entirely absorbed into the universal that a special development of their own inner peculiarity and mutual relation becomes impossible. In the latter case the objective differences become so obtrusive that it cannot be the logical functions themselves, the subjective acts, but the logic of the functions, a system of objective determinations of relation, that comes to development. We have indeed in the doctrine of *reflecting subjectivity*

treated a plurality of peculiar forms of reflection: reflection of the understanding, essence-reflection, actuality-reflection with corresponding subdivisions; but these reflections, although from one side they must be apprehended as logical functions, are nevertheless in another respect so entirely fused with the objective as well as the subjective formations of the content that they cannot possibly come forward in their difference from the content itself. This difference, on the other hand, announces itself [12] immediately when reflection is directed upon the word and the word's relation to thought and to the thing.

In the unity-in-difference of the word and thought there is seen a unity-in-difference of reflection and judgment: the reflecting one judges, the judging one reflects; but reflecting and judging are not on that account the same. That reflection, which always hovers between opposed determinations and has its rest in this hovering, must also rest in a hovering between the subjective and the objective, and to that extent be just as ready to give the determination of form an objective as a subjective stamp, is a matter of course. In the mirroring of the members, in the transparency of the moments, reflection is objective; but judgment cannot be objective in this way. In judgment as judgment the judging subjectivity posits an express unity-in-difference of objective and subjective, in that the object of the judgment is indeed objective, but the judgment-act subjective; the unity-in-difference is determined by the word: in the judgment's subject there is seen the unity of the word and the thing, in the predicate the unity of the word and thought, in the copula the unity of thing and thought by means of the word. Only by reflecting upon judgment as judgment can thought reflect upon what is peculiar in its own many-sided activity; but the development of what is peculiar in thought's formal activity coincides precisely with a development of the logical functions. The fundamental function is judgment as judgment: all determinate and determining thinking is essentially a judging; this judging expresses itself not merely in individual judgments, but in combinations of judgments, not merely in determinations of the judgment's formal, but also of its real validity. Judgment passes over with inner necessity into syllogism, syllogism into proof. What is general in the general fundamental function then articulates itself into three distinct fundamental functions: to *judge*, to *syllogize*, to *prove*.

- [13] In each of these distinct fundamental functions the unity-in-opposition of the subjective and the objective is easy to point out; for the unity-in-opposition is determined by the word.

“Formal logic” takes the matter subjectively; it is right insofar as the functions judging, syllogizing and proving must necessarily be subjective, absolutely subjective activities. But formal logic is wrong insofar as it apprehends the subjective in so one-sided and undialectical a separation from the objective that the empty forms of thought are set up as though they were indifferent toward the content. That such an abstraction can be carried through only by the aid of the word is comprehensible; but in treating thinking as a psychologically conditioned activity of spirit, formal logic at the same time apprehends the word as a merely psychological product, a designation impotent in itself, which falls outside the thing’s essence. By such a separation of the thing and the word and, what coincides with this, of the thing and thought, logic becomes idea-less. It is precisely the questionable thing about formal logic that, under the pretense of developing the “nature and essence” of thinking, it in reality carries it no further than to a development of the “nature and essence” of trivial abstractions, insipid remarks and endless ratiocinations.

- “Speculative logic” takes the matter objectively, indeed so objectively that the objective judgment must judge itself, the objective syllogism syllogize itself, and the objective proof of the method end at last by proving itself. Speculative logic has the immortal merit of having dissolved the finite thoughts in the idea’s inner infinity and of having put into force the demand for a judging, syllogizing and proving that oversteps the narrow boundary of the psychological conditions. But when objectivity absorbs the subjective to such a degree that thought becomes word and the word thing, then subjectivity reacts and in turn dissolves the objective to such a degree that the thing becomes word and the word thought. Only a clarification of thought,
- [14] word and thing in their original unity and opposition will be able to remove the mystification in which speculative logic has wanted to drown the dualism of the in itself subjective and the in itself objective; but such a clarification must then rest upon a special development of the logical functions.

The difference between thing and thought transforms itself in the logical judgment

into a difference between subject and predicate. The subject is the singular, the singular in its immediacy, the object of the judgment, i.e. of the judgment-act, hence the thing; the predicate, the universal, namely the universal in reflection, is on the contrary thought, hence the subjective. In the immediate judgment thought now becomes so united with the thing that it looks as though the thing were thought, and thought thing; this comes of thought and the thing being united in the word. In judgments such as: this is a rose, this rose is red, — the word rose as predicate is surely an expression for the concept, hence for thought, whereas as subject it is a designation of the object, hence of the thing. But according to the meaning the predicate rose must be just as objective as the subject this, and the predicate red just as objective as the subject rose; for the copula *is* holds to objectivity.

It is thus not a part of the judgment, but the whole judgment, that states the objective; but precisely for the same reason it is also not a part of the judgment, but the whole judgment, that rests upon the judging subjectivity. The judging subjectivity determines the object as subject, in order that this subject may through its predicate become objectively determined, i.e. determined in the quality of object. The judgment-act is, seen from this side, an objectification-act. The whole judgment is objective, for the judging subjectivity is determined by the object, and expresses the determinateness categorically, in that it makes the object of the judgment the subject of the inhering predicate. The whole judgment is subjective, for the judging subjectivity must itself determine its object. The thing as thing is in its objective immediacy just as little a subject as the property existing in the thing is in its immediacy predicate: only in [15] objectification does the existing thing become subject by means of the word; only through the word decisive for objectification can the existing property be transformed into predicate, into the universal under which the subject can be subsumed.

Insofar as the judgment, the whole judgment, is by its nature subjective, there is here, then, in the finite sense a possibility that the judging subjectivity, hovering above its object, may in an arbitrary manner connect subject with predicate: here, then, doubt about the judgment's validity can arise. If the doubt is to be removed, the validity must be grounded; this grounding has in turn a subjective and an objective side.

If the grounding is taken from the subjective side, the connection between subject and predicate must rest upon a development of thought, and the development of thought upon the formal connection of the factors in question. For full illumination of this connection it is required that subject and predicate step forth as opposing extremes; between the extremes a middle term is inserted which is so two-sided that it can show itself in one judgment united with the subject, in another with the predicate: as a judgment derived from the judgments thus formed, the validity of the disputed judgment is formally grounded; the grounding is a syllogism-act, and the judgment thereby grounded a syllogism. That the syllogism-act is a logical function, an act of thinking that rests just as originally upon the word as the immediate judgment does, is then a matter that goes without saying. If, as the Hegelians maintain, there could be objective syllogisms, syllogisms which, without any co-operation of a thinking, judging, syllogizing subjectivity, went on in the objective essence of objective reason: then the thoughts in objective reason would surely become judgments that could judge themselves; the self-thinking thoughts, the self-judging judgments, would then [16] have to transform themselves into thinking and judging subjectivities: what a swarm of subjectivities in the objective essence of objective reason!

If we take the matter from the objective side, the validity of the judgment must be made good mediately by immediate demonstration. Under the immediate demonstration the judging subjectivity, and thereby the act of judgment, the judging function, becomes determined by the object of the judgment: the judgment is objective. With this objectivity the judgments in which each of the syllogism's extremes is connected with the middle term now come forward separately, one after the other, now coordinate, now in a relation of dependence; yet always in such a way that the syllogism resulting therefrom is determined as an objectively valid judgment. By this mode of syllogizing the immediate is parceled out into separate members; the demonstration is immediate: the immediate demonstration, mediate nevertheless through its articulations, is the original mark of the proof-function. Since the proof-function is, however, subjective as a function of judgment and syllogism, the mediate cannot remain as a parceling out and piecing together of the immediate, but must dissolve itself in reflection. The mediate is here the objective by means of the immediate; objectivity is recognizable

precisely by that alternation of mediate and immediate to which the demonstration corresponds. Reflection is the subjective; reflection transforms the immediate members of mediacy into reflexes in the movement of thought, into a totality of transparent moments determinative for insight; by this transformation the demonstration becomes grounding; in the reflected unity of grounding and demonstration we have the proof.

If we bring the three logical functions together under one point of view, it is clear that they designate a progressive objectification. In the judgment the subjective alternates immediately with the objective; in the syllogism the objective becomes a moment for a formal development of the subjective; in the proof the subjective becomes a moment for a development of what in knowledge is objective; this doubling [17] is for each function conditioned by the word. That actual determinations of objectivity can be reflected in subjective forms is due to the word as a word of *knowledge*; that subjective determinations of form can pass over into content of actual existence is due to the word as a word of *power*; only through the opposition between the word in knowledge and the word in power, and through this opposition's content-rich unity in the word of truth, do the logical functions allow themselves to be developed and determined many-sidedly.

Since the judgment as judgment expressly shows how thought forms itself by shaping its ideal material in the word, we shall in what follows treat the functions of judgment under the designation: *formal functions*; since, further, the syllogism according to its concept adds no new or peculiar determinations to the judgment in its singularity, but precisely indicates the manner in which the one judgment partly presupposes, partly entails and confirms the other, we apprehend the functions of the syllogism as a whole as *modal functions*. The peculiar element that the proof as proof introduces into the form of the syllogism, namely the real moment, the objective reflex of the word, then leads finally to insight into the articulated reciprocal determination of the matter and of its exposition; the manner in which the one-sided, in the conduct of the proof, is resolved into the many-sided, the incomplete supplemented, what is defective in the grounding integrated, thus serves to show *the reality of the modal functions*.

a) *Functions of the Judgment: Formal Functions.*

Just as thought is a function of the act of thinking, and conversely, so the judgment is a function of the act of judgment: the act of thinking from which the determinate thought results is originally determined by the resulting thought, and likewise the judgment determined by the act of judgment is determinative for the act of judgment itself. For finite thinking and finite judging there must of course be finite points of departure, finitely determined presuppositions; but the finite acts of thinking and of [18] judgment are only conditioned expressions of the essential judging that is identical with self-objectification, of the universal thinking that is identical with the being of subjectivity. For essential judging, for infinite thinking, there is just as little a first fixed point of departure as there is for absolute knowledge or for ontological subjectivity.

If one separates the individual acts of thought from the principle of thinking, the particular acts of judgment from the “power of judgment” that expresses itself in all judgments, then one must either live on in sheer immediacy, and to that extent in relative thoughtlessness, or in the end run up against a great problem, the problem that so characteristically torments the Licentiate in a Student’s Adventures: “You see, my friend! A movement presupposes a direction. The understanding cannot advance without moving in a certain line, but before it follows this line it must surely have thought that line beforehand. Thus one has always already thought every thought before one thinks it. Every thought that seems to be the work of a minute thus presupposes a whole eternity. It could almost drive me mad. How, then, can any thought be born, since it must always have existed before it comes into existence”.⁵

The infinite thought is made finite by the material of finitude over which it thinks. It is not enough, however, that thought in the finite has something to think about; it must at the same time have something to think by, something to think in: that in which and by which thinking takes place is language. Only when language transforms the immediate images of sense-perception into representations does it become possible for reflection to transform the representations into thoughts; only by such a transformation can thinking become attentive to itself and to its functions. The word, which [19] by transforming image into representation serves to determine thought, then serves, by converting representation into image, to determine the object of thought as well.

⁵Efterladte Skrifter af Paul M. Møller. First volume. Third edition. p. 120.

In the proposition: this is a tree, the word does not primarily awaken a representation of itself as word, but a representation of the existing tree, and thus of the object.

Insofar as the judgment as judgment is now apprehended from the subjective side, the word stands in the service of thought and is from this standpoint to be apprehended as a word of knowledge; the subjective essentiality of the judgment is form: all functions belonging under the form of the judgment are *functions of the word of knowledge*. Insofar as the judgment is considered from the objective side, that is, in relation to the object, the word stands in the service of the object. But that the word stands in the service of the object presupposes precisely that the object likewise stands in the service of the word; the word is in this phase a word of power: all functions objectively corresponding to the relation of judgment and object are *functions of the word of power*. A complete development of the content of knowledge and of power in the word of truth cannot, however, be given in the form of the judgment; as a particular fundamental function the judgment still has its syllogism outside itself. The development of the judgment must then end with a determination of its subjective validity, a preliminary syllogism which precisely introduces the syllogism itself, in that it leads us to insight into *the modality of the functions*.

α) The Form of the Judgment: Functions of the Word of Knowledge.

Both that about which judgment is passed and that in which and by which judgment is passed are words; words are judged about by means of words; here thought goes into one with language. The question how far animals have a power of judgment and a “natural logic” is most closely connected with the question how far they have a language properly so called. What is at issue is a determination of the relation between animal sense-consciousness and human self-consciousness. If the difference between the animal’s and the human being’s consciousness is only a difference of degree, then [20] the difference between the animal’s and the human being’s “natural logic”, between the animal’s and the human being’s language, is also only a difference of degree. Those who, trusting in the perfectibility of animals, take pains to develop the animal’s natural capacity for thought must then at the same time take pains to develop and perfect the animal’s natural language. If the latter succeeds only in a very restricted sense, then the former endeavor too will yield but little. The animal’s language has

sound enough, but no words; from the most expressive sound in which the animal utters its momentary condition to the logical word, human in the proper sense, there is the same distance as from animal sense-consciousness to human self-consciousness. For a closer understanding of the relation between thought and language there serves a special development of the formal functions as *language-forming*, *thought-forming* and *idea-forming functions*.

αα) Language-forming Functions. What is language? The ideal corporeality of thought, the medium for the self-revelation of subjectivity, the inner essential other in which the light of spirit can refract its rays. As the first immediate revelation of thought, language is indeed a system of signs, but not of arbitrary signs; here it is impossible to begin with a specially conscious separation, determined by agreement, of the sign itself and the thing signified. If the formation of language were to begin with arbitrary designations, then thought would have to exist, prior to every such designation, as the determinate thought, for only the thought determinate in itself can arbitrarily choose its sign; but how should thought determine itself prior to language, when language is word, and the word itself is thought's first immediate determinateness. In order to form language, thought must act; in order to act, it must be; to that extent the activity of thought certainly precedes language: language is a [21] function of thought. But thought can determine only insofar as it is itself determined; in order to act determiningly upon language, the active thought must be determined by language: thought is in this sense a function of language. As a function of language, while language is a function of thought, thought is a function of a function of itself: by this circuit infinity is designated.

Yet we must not forget that the identity of thought and word thus emphasized has, from the standpoint of philology, and not without a hint of self-conscious philosophical assurance, been rather sharply rejected. "It is sometimes put forward," says Madvig,⁶ "as a deeper conception of language, that it exists not for the sake of communication but for the sake of thought itself, and that man does not think except in and with language. What is true in this is that no human being develops in isolation, but in a community of representations with others prepared through the existing language,

⁶Indbydelsesskrift til Københavns Universitets Fest i Anledning af Hans Majestæt Kongens Fødselsdag, den 18de September 1842. Om Sprogets Væsen, Udvikling og Liv. p. 5-6.

from which it follows that the word, the mark of community, is inseparably bound up with the shared representations, accompanies them as already given, and preserves them precisely in *this* form and articulation; whereby it must indeed be noted that even for the living representation the familiar word can sometimes fail. The new representations which the individual forms and sets apart he will then strive to give the same validity and place in the series, and yet this striving first emerges, in the attempt at (oral or written) communication, as a search for a new word ... Even the writing down of a new word as a reminder of the representation for oneself *at another time* has entirely the form of communication. Language loses nothing of its essential character as a means of communication because it also becomes a means for a surer and easier mastery of the representations made common and objectified through communication. The general feeling that accompanies thinking, that representations [22] can be uttered in language and one's own representations precisely in one's own language, is by no means a thinking in and by the word; for the word is sounding. (All speaking with oneself in actual words is a consequence of the drive to communicate, or a kind of test of one's own sureness in the series of representations, or of the latter's capacity to be uttered in the words one possesses)".

Two concessions are to be made here at once: 1) "that no human being develops in isolation", and 2) that language is a "means of communication"; but the assertion that language is not to be "for the sake of thought itself", that "the general feeling that accompanies thinking, that representations can be uttered in language", is by no means "a thinking in and by the word", is to such a degree arbitrary and at variance with sound psychology that we do not see how so distinguished a man as the author of the program cited could have advanced such an assertion. When the question is how far thinking does or does not take place in and by the word, one must here expressly look to articulated thinking, the thinking that develops itself in distinct thoughts. How, then, does one go about apprehending a thought distinctly and determinately without apprehending it in and by the word? One need only reflect on the first necessary separation between image, representation and thought! An image (the image of an animal, a human being, a cloud etc.) consciousness can hold fast without the help of the word, precisely because the image is an immediate imitation of the object; but

image is one thing, representation another. The images in the circle of consciousness can be distinguished and recognized in the same immediate way as the objects in the surrounding world, but the representations cannot. Precisely as the pictorial is dissolved, the representations must, in order not to run together, be made recognizable by signs, non-pictorial signs, that is to say by words. “Thus the word is a *sign* for a representation that *could* have received another sign, just as this sound *could* also [23] have become a sign for another representation”.⁷ That the word as sign is itself non-pictorial, that sound-symbolism receives its significance precisely from the fact that the word is and is to be a “sign without imitation”, on this the author of the program has also expressed himself clearly enough, in agreement with Hegel.

What now follows from this? Indeed, from this it follows incontestably that the mutual separation and connection of the representations—the non-pictorial representations that pass over into thoughts—is so originally conditioned by the word that the one who represents and thinks needs the word just as surely in order to understand himself as in order to make himself intelligible to others. It is thus the making distinct of representations and thoughts within the circle of consciousness, not their communication, on which the emphasis falls. The hint with which the author of the program accompanies his assertion that thinking stands in a contingent relation to language, since “the feeling that representations can be uttered in language and one’s own representations precisely in one’s own language” is by no means “a thinking in and by the word”, is most singular; for it runs to this, that “the word is sounding”. How loudly, then, must the word sound in order to be a word? If it is the sensuous in the sound that makes the word a word, then the word uttered in a stentorian voice must thus be a word in a higher sense than the word that is whispered. With such a conception it does indeed agree that the loud-sounding word is a more powerful “means of communication” than the faint-sounding one; but where now is the boundary? If the word that is whispered is still a word, though a faint word, how faint may a whisper then be without the word disappearing? “All speaking with oneself” must, according to the view put forward, either be audible, which among educated people is readily taken for a sign that the speaker is growing somewhat childish, or else a very

⁷Anførte Program 1842. p. 11.

soft whisper. To speak with oneself is thus to whisper to oneself: where there is no [24]
whispering there are no words, where there are no words there is no language, where
there is no language there is no speaking.

But what are we now to say of the one who sits quite silent and reads in a book? Does such a reader perhaps sit and whisper, or, if he does not whisper, does not use his voice but only his eyes, what then is it properly that he reads? Words it naturally cannot be; if, be it noted, it is to be understood literally that “the word is sounding”, that it is the sensuous sound that makes the word a word.

The view set forth in the program is the more singular in that the Programmatarius himself in the preface (p. 4) has laid especial weight on “Hegel’s remarks on language, weighty in all their brevity (Encyclopædie, 2te Ausgabe, § 459),” and has accorded them an express recognition. With this recognition, however, there must be something peculiar; either the recognition cannot apply to the whole of § 459, or else the philologist cannot quite have understood the philosopher. For so far is Hegel, in the paragraph cited, from having entered into the view that the word, in order to be a word, must be sounding, that on the contrary he will have the sound regarded as something inessential to the word. Indeed, he goes so far in this respect that in the very paragraph so commended he even sets written language higher than spoken language. “Die Buchstabenschrift”, says Hegel, “ist an und für sich die intelligenterere; in ihr ist das *Wort*, die der Intelligenz eigenthümliche würdigste Art der Aeüßerung ihrer Vorstellungen, zum Bewußtseyn gebracht, zum Gegenstande der Reflexion gemacht” ... What Hegel is driving at with this utterance is not difficult to discover: he wishes, namely, to make the outward-directed use of language as a “means of communication” the inessential, and the inward-directed application, by which thought is articulated, the essential. “Die erlangte Gewohnheit”, he continues, “tilgt auch später die Eigenthümlichkeit der Buchstabenschrift, im Interesse des Sehens als ein Umweg durch die Hörbarkeit zu [25]
den Vorstellungen zu erscheinen, und macht sie für uns zur Hieroglyphenschrift, so daß wir beim Gebrauche derselben die Vermittlung der Töne nicht im Bewußtseyn vor uns zu haben bedürfen; Leute dagegen, die eine geringe Gewohnheit des Lesens haben, sprechen das Gelesene laut vor, um es in seinem Tönen zu verstehen”.

All this now belongs, as was said, to “Hegel’s remarks on language, weighty in all

their brevity (Encyclopædie § 459)”; but that these remarks contain the most decisive protest against the point of view assigned by the Programmatarius to the significance of language as a mere “means of communication” is certain. When, then, right at the beginning of the program it is said: “It is sometimes put forward as a deeper conception of language, that it exists not for the sake of communication but for the sake of thought itself, and that man does not think except in and with language,” the attentive reader asks: what scientific phenomena may these be that are here aimed at? To judge by the immediate impression, one would suppose that they were only some obscure minds, fermenting mystics of little rank, to whose view no further regard could on the whole be paid. To such a conception one is led partly by the cursoriness of the expression: “it is sometimes put forward”, partly by the circumstance that the whole view is dismissed with a couple of remarks without further investigation or grounding. Yet one sees (p. 6) that it is not merely visionaries like (p. 8) a Schmidthenner or a K. F. Becker, but even a Wilhelm Humboldt, who holds to the original unity of word and thought. Even if it must now be granted that Humboldt, despite his great services to linguistic research, can in his “care for the dignity of language” here and there be so unclear that for that reason he does not properly offer firm points of purchase for a motivated criticism, this can nevertheless, as far as the fundamental question is concerned, in no way hold of Hegel.

[26] Among the thinkers who expressly conceive language in such a way “that it exists not for the sake of communication but for the sake of thought itself,” Hegel, whose “weighty remarks on language” the Programmatarius himself has acknowledged in his preface, stands in the first rank. The words become, according to Hegel,⁸ “zu einem vom Gedanken belebten Daseyn. Dies Daseyn ist unseren Gedanken absolut nothwendig. Wir wissen von unseren Gedanken nur dann, — haben nur dann bestimmte, wirkliche Gedanken, wenn wir ihnen die Form der *Gegenständlichkeit*, des *Unterschiedenseyns* von unserer *Innerlichkeit*, — also die Gestalt der *Aeußerlichkeit* geben, — und zwar einer *solchen* Aeußerlichkeit, die zugleich das Gepräge der höchsten *Innerlichkeit* trägt. Ein so innerliches Aeußerliches ist allein der *articulirte Ton*, das *Wort*. Ohne Worte denken zu wollen, — wie *Mesmer* einmal versucht hat, — erscheint daher als eine Unvernunft,

⁸Encyclopædie. Berlin 1845, § 462, p. 349.

die jenen Mann, seiner Versicherung nach, beinahe zum Wahnsinn geführt hätte. Es ist aber auch lächerlich, das Gebundenseyn des Gedankens an das Wort für einen Mangel des Ersteren und für ein Unglück anzusehen; denn, obgleich man gewöhnlich meint, das *Unaussprechliche* sey gerade das Vortrefflichste, so hat diese von der Eitelkeit gehegte Meinung doch gar keinen Grund, da das Unaussprechliche in Wahrheit nur etwas Trübes, Gährendes ist, das erst, wenn es zu Worte zu kommen vermag, Klarheit gewinnt”.⁹

To explain the origin of language is in other words to explain the origin of self-consciousness, of human subjectivity. The fundamental function is an ideal objectification. Only through the objectification of another can consciousness objectify itself for itself, can it raise itself from sense-consciousness to self-consciousness. That the animal’s consciousness is only a sense-consciousness presupposes that animal subjectivity is unable to raise itself above a merely sensuous objectification, an objectification in which the ideal itself bears the stamp of sensuous immediacy. This is seen from the fact that the animal can indeed express itself by a sound corresponding to the sense-impression, but that a whole system of animal modifications of sound would nevertheless not constitute a language, since the animally sensuous sound cannot become a word. In order that the sound may become a word, it must “*be torn loose from that*” — sense-consciousness’s — “*immediacy and be set free by the human being who is not animally engrossed, but representing*”;¹⁰ thus: in order that the sound may become a word, the representation of the object must be separated from the mere sense-image, the representation of the sensation from the mere sensation, the inner objectification from the outer. That the inner, ideal objectification is conditioned by a reciprocal action among those who speak, and that language to that extent forms

⁹In his work *De l’origine du langage*. Paris 1858. *Préface*. p. 56 E. Renan has defended the original significance of the word for the determination of thought against H. Ritter. *M. Ritter n’attribue au langage qu’un seul rôle, celui de communiquer la pensée; il méconnaît une autre fonction non moins importante de la parole, qui est de servir de formule et de limite à la pensée*.

¹⁰Madvig. *Indbydelsesskrift til Kjøbenhavns Universitetsfest 1842*. p. 10. The liberation of the sign from the first, so to speak immediate, immediacy is emphasized in this work in the most emphatic way, e.g. p. 11, where it is said: “Many shrink from recognizing in the word a mere *sign* without a real impress of the essence and character of the representation; they will not, as they say, let language sink down into this bare and abstract shape from sensuous, picturesque fullness and color”. To which the author remarks, “that the specific articulations of sound that constitute the word have no necessary relation to the particular constitution of the representation”.

itself as a means of communication, shows only that psychological subjectivity is from the beginning sensuously turned outward, and is bent inward toward self-reflection and ideal objectification only by influences coming from without, and notably from
 [28] other subjectivities. But from this it by no means follows that the language forming itself in the course of communication should have significance merely as a means of communication; no, from this it follows precisely that communication, essentially regarded, is the condition and presupposition for the development of the inward-turned consciousness, a development in the course of which the means of communication is to be apprehended as a means of objectification.

If communication, and not the inner, ideal objectification, were the main thing in the formation of language, then the speaker would have to be supposed capable of clarifying his representations and thoughts in another way and by other means for himself than for others, namely for himself without language, for others by the help of language; but this is demonstrably not the case. Of him who communicates his thoughts to another in an unclear and bungled language one of two things holds: either the thoughts in his consciousness have an unclear and bungled form, or, if they are clear and determinate, he thinks them in one language and utters them in another. The language in which the speaker thinks the thoughts is then for him the essential and superior one; that in which he communicates them, the inessential and subordinate one. The speaker cannot objectify his representations for others without at the same time having to objectify them for himself; but he can well objectify them for himself without objectifying them for others: language can thus be a means of objectification without being a means of communication, but not conversely.

The manner in which speech is determined coincides in principle with the manner in which thought is determined. One speaks in propositions because one thinks in propositions; the sounding word in speech and the soundless word in thought are essentially the same word. If the word "lightning", when it sounds, can count as a spoken proposition "it lightens", then the same word must also, without sounding, be able to count as a thought-proposition. The subjectivity that speaks to another about the phenomenon in question in the word "lightning" will, when no one is present,
 [29] speak to itself, objectify for itself the same phenomenon by the same word; only with

this difference, that whereas thought in the sounding word is a speaking, speech in the soundless word is a thinking. Restricted to the soundless word *lightning* alone, the thought-proposition is indeed without articulation, the subject goes into one with the predicate, the substantive with the verb; nonetheless the difference between subject and predicate, substantive and verb is in an unconscious way understood. The same holds when the word sounds as a spoken proposition; without an involuntary separation of something about which one speaks and that which is said of it, a separation which the word does not indeed designate but occasions, there would here be no proposition,¹¹ and if there were here no proposition, then no speech either.

As the unity-in-difference of speech and thinking the proposition is a product [30] of ideal objectification, and the ideality of the objectification is recognizable by the fact that what is objectified undergoes a transformation. In propositions such as: the horse runs, the tree grows green, it is not the sensuous objects, the horse and the tree, by themselves, nor yet the universal categories, running and growing green, by themselves, that are objectified; in the objectification determined by the proposition the horse is the running thing, and the running thing a horse. The complete proposition

¹¹“That language begins with the proposition is entirely true in the sense that this is the task set, toward which everything aims and strives: for man wants to speak, not to name isolated representations; it is further true that single words in the beginning involved propositions, in that it was presupposed that the speaker wanted to say something, not purposelessly to throw out a name. But when in the most recent time this has been presented as if language had really begun its formation with the *whole* proposition, there lies in this the strangest confusion ... The proposition is whole only when it contains its constituents posited in their singularity and thereupon comprehended together. If one will now let language begin with such a proposition, then one assumes that at the first attempt two separate words came forward, were understood and held fast, and of these the one as a sign for a concrete subject-representation (object), and that at the next attempt, the next proposition, this repeats itself. From here one then turns to the notion of propositions in which the constituents lay enveloped but were afterward separated out, as from a root-tuber, that is, to non-propositions, a monstrosity that could neither be uttered nor understood nor be thought. For all speech and all understanding proceed from the fact that the sound which one cannot resolve into separately significant constituents is a sign for a single representation, and out of this undivided mass no process can bring forth separate, entirely different words, or out of many such propositions always the same word for the same representation; if, on the contrary, there are separately significant sounds in it, then they are there as words prior to the proposition, or we fall back into the absurdity indicated above.” Madvig. *Anførte Program*. p. 27–28. Renan, however, does not yet seem to have become attentive to this certainly very important point, but lets the matter rest with rather general reflections, such as: *Dans nos langues modernes, le sujet, le verbe, ainsi que plusieurs des relations de temps, de modes et de voix, sont exprimés par des mots isolés et indépendants. Dans les langues anciennes, au contraire, ces idées sont le plus souvent accumulées dans un mot unique et exprimées par une flexion. De l’origine du langage*. p. 154.

has its separate constituents, but consists itself in their being comprehended together into unity. The fundamental function of objectification is thus conditioned by two separate functions: determination of the members of the proposition and indication of the manner in which the members are connected. In the determination of the members of the proposition what essentially matters is word-formation; in the indication of the mode of connection, form-formation. The language-forming functions we *therefore* apprehend in this respect from two points of view, namely as *word-forming* and *form-forming*, yet in such a way that the one of these activities incessantly presupposes the other.

Word-forming Functions. In order to explain the origin of the multiplicity of differences of sound that a language requires for the designation of the manifold phenomena of existence, one has laid weight especially upon the natural man's keen sense for sensuous differences and his great gifts for imitation. The word-forming function thus came, on this way of viewing the matter, originally to rest upon an imitation, especially of sound-phenomena, so that the onomatopoetic words had to become the proper root-words (*τὰ γὰρ ὀνόματα μιμητικά ἐστὶ*. Aristotle). But however great a role involuntary imitation may have played in the incipient formation of words, we must nevertheless grant those philologists to be right who reduce both the onomatopoetic words and the interjections to subordinate moments.¹² It is not [32] imitation, it is on the contrary that designation by which the sense-image becomes representation, a designation by which every imitation falls away, that makes the

^{12a}In any case the word here too first becomes a word by laying aside this immediacy, precisely that of designating what sounds so. From this only that determinate and limited exception is to be made which rests upon the relation of the linguistic means itself to a peculiar side of sensuous nature, the sounding in it. The apprehension of the sound-representation itself in its individual shapes (not as a general category) uttered itself naturally through the sounds that were the content and object of the representation, and thus arose the *onomatopoetic* words. They are so far from belonging to the kernel and foundation of language that, because they remain standing in that immediate relation, they are in a manner spurious words, often subjected, even in the otherwise developed and consolidated language, to playful alterations and formations". Madvig, *Anførte Program* p. 16. But the interjections and the onomatopoetic imitations would indeed be excellent words, if language were a mere means of communication. Among the more recent philosophers Renan in particular has spoken for sound-imitation. *La langue des premiers hommes ne fut donc, en quelque sorte, que l'écho de la nature dans la conscience humaine ... La rupture, par exemple, pouvait-elle s'exprimer d'une manière plus pittoresque que par la racine ῥαγ (ῥήγνυμι, ῥήσσω, ῥώξ); sanscrit: rug; celto-breton: rogan; ou par sa forme latine frac; allemand: brechen? Frem, strep, strid, ne sont-ils pas également la peinture naturelle du bruit dans ses diverses nuances?* Anf. Skr. p. 136–37.

sound into a word; instead of being merely *imitative* the word-forming function is actually *determining*.

That the word-forming function is actually determining must not be understood as though the self-active subjectivity added something of its own in the sense that it immediately brought forth ideal designations for the ideal, peculiar words for relations, names for pure categories and the like. Such an assumption is directly at variance with the nature of the matter. It is true that it is not the sensuous in the sound that makes the word a word; but for its first immediate determinateness the word cannot dispense with an element of sensuous punctuality. "That all formation of language proceeds from the designation of sensuous representations is not merely the result to which all investigations into the connection of the significations of words lead, even in the most developed languages, nor yet a mere conjecture grounded upon a presupposition about the development of the first language-forming men and the limits of their circles of representation, but a proposition that follows directly from the nature of language and its necessary manner of coming to be. The confirmation of the community of representations by the help of their sensuously present object was the starting-point of that whole fundamental agreement in which language has its root".¹³ The word-forming function is thus, in designations for the general, not an independently creating but an explaining, idealizing activity. [33]

The fact that every word in language has originally had a sensuous signification has naturally been misunderstood by the sensualists to such a degree that they have taken subjectivity's a priori self-activity for an empty fancy. But subjectivity's self-activity in the formation of language is recognizable precisely by the manner in which the outward is converted into its corresponding inward, the sensuous into its non-sensuous, the individual into its universal. Subjectivity does not come to itself abstractly by itself; it must begin with its other, but in the apprehension of its other,

¹³Madvig. Anførte Program. p. 18. How consistently the author holds fast to and carries through this way of viewing the matter is seen among other things from the following statement (Program 1856 p. 11). "When Humboldt somewhere, struggling with himself, declares that he nevertheless does not see why there cannot be original words for relations just as well as for representations, he forgets that the presupposition of the word is the representation (and originally the representation of what is sensuously demonstrable) ... originally, and in accordance with the first presupposition by which sound is made into word, everything that emerges in language becomes, by its emergence, a norm of representation or a pronominal pointing-out of representation."

the objective, it shows precisely its originally subjective essence. Thus neither can thinking begin with an abstract determining of itself; it must begin with its other, its real negation, the sensuous. So long as the words still have only sensuous signification, thinking is lost in sense-perception; but the very fact that the sound is stamped into word and thereby into category proves that thinking has thought with it even in its other. Only in the degree that the apprehension of the relations in the outward is articulated by language does a corresponding articulation of the inward take place. Why the speaker does not originally choose words of his own for the designation of the inward and the ideal is, insofar as language is apprehended as a means of communication, clear from what has preceded; but why does the thinker not now choose peculiar signs, independent of everything sensuous, abstractly ideal private signs, in order to designate the thoughts for himself? Answer: because it is impossible. What indeed should such abstractly ideal private signs be? Representations of his own!

[34] but then these representations, as was shown above, would themselves have to have their signs. Intuitions of his own! but what is a peculiar intuition without a peculiar image, without the semblance of something sensuous. It is thus not merely for the sake of communication, but for the sake of thinking and of the thoughts themselves, that words for the sensuous receive a transferred signification and are employed for the designation of the non-sensuous.¹⁴

¹⁴ *Ceux qui ont tiré le langage exclusivement de la sensation se sont trompés, aussi bien que ceux qui ont assigné aux idées une origine purement matérielle ... Le transport ou la métaphore a été de la sorte le grand procédé de la formation du langage. Une analogie en a entraîné une autre, et ainsi le sens des mots a voyagé de la manière en apparence la plus capricieuse; souvent même la signification primitive a disparu, et n'a laissé subsister que les acceptions dérivées, .. Le verbe être, dont M. Cousin disait hardiment en 1829: "Je ne connais aucune langue où le mot français être soit exprimé par un correspondant qui représente une idée sensible"; le verbe être, dis je, dans presque toutes les langues, se tire d'une idée sensible. L'opinion des philologues qui assignent pour sens premier au verbe hébreu haia ou hawa (être), celui de respirer, et cherchent dans ce mot des traces d'onomatopée, n'est pas dénuée de vraisemblance. En arabe et en éthiopien, le verbe kâna, qui joue le même rôle, signifie primitivement se tenir debout (exstare). Koum (stare) en hébreu passe aussi dans ses dérivés au sens d'être (substantia). Quant aux langues indo-européennes, elles ont composé leur verbe substantif avec trois verbes différents: 1) as (sanscr. asmi, équi, eîqi, sum); 2) bhû (φύω, fui, allem. bin, persan bouden); 3) sthâ (stare, persan hestem), devenu partie du verbe être, au moins comme auxiliaire, dans les langues modernes de l'Inde et dans les langues romanes (stato, été). De ces trois verbes, le troisième est notoirement un verbe physique et signifie se tenir debout. Le deuxième a eu très-vraisemblablement le sens primitif de souffler. Quant au premier, il paraît se rattacher au pronom de la troisième personne; mais ce pronom lui-même, quelque abstrait qu'il soit, semble se rapporter à un sens primitivement concret. Renan. Anf. Skr. p. 122–130.*

Form-forming Functions. How intimately the determination of matter and of form [35] belong together in language is seen from the formation of words. Already the first articulation of the sound, by which it becomes the designation of a determinate corresponding representation, presupposes form-activity. Since it can moreover be a question how far the separate sound-elements out of which a proposition is formed are, in their merely elementary difference, to be apprehended as original “words” or rather as “roots,” out of which words in the proper sense can be formed, it is seen from this that the words belonging to determinate classes in the Indo-European languages must have undergone a twofold forming.¹⁵

Straightforwardly and directly the form-forming function has not begun by dis- [36] tinguishing substantives, adjectives, verbs, etc.; but already in the formation of the proposition, in which each of the roots received its function, such a distinction was originally presupposed. “When it has repeatedly been disputed whether the substantive or the verb was the older in language, there usually showed itself in the whole dispute a certain lack of clarity in the representations. In and for itself the verbal root was just as much a substantive as the name for any other representation, and so likewise the original adjectival roots; but since in incipient language one did not hold fast the activity or the quality as abstract representations and speak of them, the roots did not come to be employed as substantives, but became at once verbs or adjectives, in that they were used assertively; for this is the verb, the name of activity set as predicate ... In considering the setting of the root as verb to a subject-substantive (when this had

¹⁵Die Sätze der sanskritischen Sprachen bestehen aus Wörtern; in diesen sind die Wurzeln aufgehoben oder enthalten, etwa in der Weise, wie ein chemisches Element (z. B. Sauerstoff) in einem chemisch zusammengesetzten Körper (z. B. Wasser), und die Wörter sind die Glieder des Satzes. Nirgends, auch im Englischen nicht, treten Wurzeln, als solche, in der Rede auf. Denn es liegt im Wesen und im Begriff der Wurzel, etwas Vereinzelt zu sein; in der Rede aber hat alles Zusammenhang. Die Wurzel ist also allemal nur ein abstractes Product der Analyse. Sie kann zwar unter Umständen lautlich unverändert und ohne Zusatz Glied der Rede werden, und im Chinesischen tritt allerdings die Wurzel in ihrer vollen Nacktheit in die Rede, dann genügt es aber schon, daß sie mit andern Gliedern des Satzes, wenn diese auch selbst wiederum bloß nackte Wurzeln sind, zusammengesprochen werden, um ihr abstractes Wesen als Wurzel abzulegen und lebendiges Element der Rede zu werden. Durch das Zusammenfassen zweier oder mehrerer Wurzeln in einem bestimmten Verhältnisse hört die Wurzel auf eine solche zu sein. Es ist also ungenau, zu sagen, der chinesische Satz bestehe aus Wurzeln; denn in den Satz aufgenommen verschwindet das Wesen der Wurzel. In Bezug auf letztere unterscheiden sich also das Chinesische und die sanskritischen Sprachen dadurch von einander, daß in diesen die Wurzel im Worte, in jenem aber erst im Satze aufgeht. H. Steinthal. Charakteristik der hauptsächlichsten Typen des Sprachbaues. Berlin 1860. p. 112.

been formed) one must first come to clarity about the so-called *copula* between subject and predicate ... This *copula* lies, as the act by which the representations are referred to one another, behind language and is the presupposition of speech; in language itself it neither is nor can be directly expressed otherwise than by the connection of speech. Every sign would itself require a new sign in order that it should be referred; least of all is the commonest predicate, *is*, a sign for the *copula*".¹⁶

[37] Straightforwardly thought and word can never become commensurable; their unity is a unity-in-difference. The determinate thought, indwelling in its determinate expression, is always reflected in a thinking that hovers above it, and only in this reflection can it first properly be grasped. Let the signification of a word be ever so determinate through usage, it will nevertheless always be altered according to the connection in which the word occurs, and the same holds of the proposition. What then cannot be attained directly must be attained indirectly; but in order that the attainment may take place, there must occur articulations of the indirect by the direct, and conversely; it is by these articulations that the form-giving activities are especially to be known. Everywhere that the thought-forms did not crystallize in a system of unfinished designations, the satisfaction of the first elementary demands had, on account of the disproportion, the far too great gulf between the direct and the indirect, involuntarily to call forth new demands, the satisfaction of these again new ones, and so forth. "The task of language, to present for apprehension and reproduction those connections of single representations into intuitions in which the thinking being moves, did not find its full solution in that which constitutes the first result of the language-forming activity, the words that designate the representations according to their content or point them out according to their relation (the naming and the pronominal words), since the intuiting consciousness contains more than is expressed by these words and by their apprehension according to that fundamental presupposition of speech, requiring no further indication, of the predicative connection into an assertion, and connects more representations in one intuition than could, on that presupposition alone, be apprehended in their connection. To effect the apprehension of that which is thus more in the intuiting consciousness, the grammatical designations

¹⁶Madvig. Anf. Program 1842. p. 29–30.

serve (word-order, auxiliary words, inflection of the naming words)".¹⁷

But precisely by reflecting on the relation between the direct and the indirect in "the grammatical designations" and noting "the motives", as the acute philologist himself accurately states them,¹⁸ we obtain point for point the proof that language is inseparable from thinking, and that the development of language must for that very reason — not for the sake of communication — coincide with the self-development of thinking subjectivity. "The *motives* which either require or can occasion grammatical [38] designations may, according to the nature of the form of intuition, be referred to determinate principal classes, in that they either (A) concern *the extent of the single representation and the form* under which it is, in a determinate function (as substantive, verb, adjective), taken up into the intuition in relation to the immediate signification of the word (such as designations for the number of the substantives, for their apprehension as individually determinate or indeterminate, for the degrees of the adjectival representation, for the use of the verb in the passive or in a similarly modified signification), or (B) *the relation of the representations in connection* into a whole in the intuition (*relation in the proposition*), which relation is partly (a) predicative or attributive connection (designations at the predicate or the attribute according to its belonging to the subject, *predicative or attributive designations*), partly (b) a relation of determination of the substantival representations to and in the assertion, either as predicated about or as entering in the form of spatial intuition (*special designations of relation*. Cases, prepositions), or finally (C) *the whole position of the intuition for consciousness* with respect to actuality, presentness and connection with other intuitions into a composite intuition (*the relations of the proposition*; designations for mood and tense, conjunctions)".¹⁹

It is again the fundamental relation, the psychological-ontological relation between image, representation and thought, upon which it essentially depends when the question is what can be expressed directly and what indirectly. Just as the representation is the image idealized in the logical sense, so thought in turn is the idealized

¹⁷Madvig. Om de grammatikalske Betegnelser Tilbliven og Væsen, 1ste Stykke. Universitetsprogram. 6te October 1856. p. 7.

¹⁸Anf. Program p. 7–8.

¹⁹Madvig. Anf. Program 1856. p. 8.

representation. The less ideality a representation has, the more direct the presentation can be; conversely, the more abstractly ideal the representation is, the more indirectly is it from the beginning contained in the direct presentation of the concrete. “He who [39] speaks of *men* has not a special abstract representation of plurality, but he has, and demands to have apprehended, the representation *man* under the form of plurality; he who will speak of a horse’s running as past has not before consciousness an abstract representation of pastness, nor would he, if he had it, speak of it as he speaks of the horse and the running; by *naming* pastness he would confuse the whole meaning; he who says: “The man lies in the house,” has not a representation of *being* in brought into prominence in consciousness, nor will he set it beside the representation of man and of lying as a third; but both have the feeling of a beholding of the named representations under a peculiar form, the form which, when it is held fast by abstraction and made an object of discussion, will require a name such as *pastness* or *being* in, and likewise a demand that the hearer shall reproduce and behold the named representations (in the first case: “The horse ran”, the whole assertion) under the same form”.²⁰ — He who speaks of *men* thus makes, be it consciously or unconsciously, a difference between what is to be represented and what is to be thought. The shape *man* is to be represented, *the plurality* is to be thought: in that the representation *man* is apprehended “under the form of *plurality*”, the direct becomes determined by the indirect, i.e. the representation determines the thought and the thought the representation; the reciprocal determination of both is given in and by language, and cannot be given by any other means. Should anyone attempt to specify another means, the result is one of two: either the means is inadequate, and then it has failed, or adequate, and then it is a language. What is expressed indirectly in speech is just as much indirect for the speaker himself as for the hearer.

If one attempts to place the separation between thought and word in this, that the one speaker can have a more developed consciousness than the other, although [40] they both say the same thing, and thus, as regards the communication, stand on the same level: then this attempt too will be wrecked on the cliffs of philology. Let two communicate in the same proposition: “The horse ran”; let the one have “an abstract

²⁰Madvig. Anf. Program 1856 p. 11.

representation of pastness,” the other not: is it hereby made good that language as a means of communication stands in a contingent relation to thought? By no means. In the first place we have the philologist’s express declaration that he who, in uttering the proposition “The horse ran,” had an abstract representation of pastness would nevertheless not mix it into the speech, in order not to confuse the meaning. But if he confuses the meaning by mixing in the irrelevant representation, then he confuses it not merely for the hearer but just as much for himself. Next, and this must be emphatically brought out, no one can have an abstract representation of pastness and hold it fast in an abstraction without his having, precisely for the sake of the abstraction, a corresponding word. Pastness is an ideal representation; its essence is negative; it cannot be intuited, it can only be thought, and the thought is determined by the imageless sign, by the word.

What we are to see in this connection is that language originally “exists for the sake of thought itself,” and “that man does not think except in and with language”. Whichever of the motives adduced for grammatical designations we consider, we nevertheless arrive at the result that thought is determined by the language which it itself determines, that thought is, by means of language, a function of a function of itself.

If we look to designations for “the extent of the single representation and its form,” thus to motive (A), why then is there not in language, beside the name for the single representation itself, a name for its extent and a separate name for its form? The determinations extent and form are, it is said, not to be represented directly but indirectly, that is to say, they are not to be represented but thought. Nevertheless such determinations cannot begin in the language-forming consciousness as clear [41] thoughts; they must on the contrary begin as obscure intimations. How, then, are the obscure intimations raised up into the light of consciousness? By this, that as fleeting representations (in this case accessory representations of a determinate extent, a determinate form) they attach themselves to a representation of an object; this attachment is possible only by the word. It is not man as individual but man as word to which an article can be added; it is not the individual man but the word man that by a vowel-change passes over into the plural; but once the individual is exchanged for

the word, the obscure intimation of *determinate* or *indeterminate*, of *single* or *several* is involuntarily there in the accessory representations. Now in that these accessory representations accompanying the word of the principal representation are noticed as essential, they must as indirect representations be determined either in a direct or in an indirect manner. Only when the designation by language has secured the indirect representations do they become an object for abstraction and, through abstraction, for the determining thinking. Without language there would be no consciousness of a difference between a determinate and an indeterminate individual, between singular and plural, between active and passive; without language there would for thought be neither determinateness nor indeterminateness, since thought for its determinateness just as surely presupposes the word as the word for its determinateness presupposes thought.

If we cast a glance at motive (B), surely no one will deny that the difference between the subject and its predicate, between the substantive and its attribute, is a concept-difference, thus a thought-difference. Without such a difference the corresponding thought would not be, but without a corresponding language the difference itself would not be. The thing, antilogical as thing, is neither subject nor predicate, neither substantive nor attribute; only in language is there subject and predicate, only in language is there substantive and attribute, only in language can there be thinking.

[42] As regards finally motive (C), where is it then possible to think “a position of the intuition for consciousness,” an intuition composed of intuitions, thus an intuition of intuitions, without words, without language? A position of the intuition for consciousness is indeed something quite other than a position of the object for consciousness. An intuition of an intuition, a representation of a representation, is not like an image of an image, a sight of a sight, in sensuous immediacy; here there is a doubling that rests upon the transformation of accessory representations into negative determinations of form, determinations of the image-like by the imageless, of the imageless by the image-like, reflection-determinations of word by proposition and of proposition by word, of principal clause by subordinate clause, etc. “In the power with which the single members of the thought press forward simultaneously there lies an incitement to extend the connection of propositions by attaching several subordinate

clauses to the same principal clause, and subordinate clauses to subordinate clauses, an incitement that becomes the stronger, the richer the thought-content, the livelier and more comprehensive the communication, the greater the need becomes for a sharp delimitation of the single thought by accessory determinations”.²¹ — He who recognizes this and still assumes that determinate thoughts can be thought without words, without propositions, consequently without any regard to the difference between principal clauses and subordinate clauses, must really, if his assumption is to count for more than an empty assertion, undertake to show us philologically how a subjectivity sets about thinking either a thought without a proposition, or a proposition without words, or a proposition in words without language.

ββ) Thought-forming Functions. In that thought works upon its means of objectification, it essentially works upon itself; the thought-forming functions cannot then be kept in a rubric of their own over against the language-forming ones. But thought is different from the word as that which is designated is different from the designation; the task of developing a system of designations is thus different from the task of [43] forming out and clarifying throughout the content reflected in the designations: with respect to the first task the functions are language-forming, with respect to the latter thought-forming. It is of great significance for psychology and logic that philology in our time has reached the turning-point at which it is able, with full consciousness, to treat the language-forming functions by themselves, without the admixture of irrelevant speculations.

“The question *what* and *how much* of thought and representation lies in the grammatical designations of language”, says Madvig,²² “and how it lies therein, by what path it is attached thereto, forces itself forward as so important for the scientific presentation of grammatical concepts, and its decision is so essential a presupposition for the validity of considerations and judgments upon the grammatical excellences and defects of languages, upon the relation of their grammatical structure to the life of spirit, that one should expect that for the sake of both these regards eager work had been done to clear it up, that at the least one had sought to state it and to answer it quite determinately”. That the task really admits of being stated and

²¹Madvig. Program 1856. p. 39.

²²Program 1856. p. 9.

answered determinately the author of the Program of 1856 has shown by specifying and determining the motives. But since language “exists for the sake of thought itself”, since man “does not think except in and with language”, the language-forming functions must just as surely reflect themselves in the thought-forming ones as these in the former. Here there can be no doubt *that* it happens; but the question is *how* it happens.

It is, or has at least formerly been, a fairly widespread opinion that the ancient classical languages, Greek and Latin, especially Latin, are distinguished by strict logic, and that the strict logic displays itself in their grammar. But how much lack of clarity can mix itself into such assessments philology itself can best of all make good.²³

- [44] “Language”, says Madvig, “has not merely a grammatical *form*, but it has also within the limits of this form a standpoint, a *condition*, a raw unworked existence and a higher development, an acquired stylistic capacity, and herein lies both a *testimony*
- [45] that there has been more or less working in and with the language, that there has been spiritual movement among the people, and an *aptitude* for future work. Here, not in the fundamental form, not even in the directions and the position that have been

^{23a} Sometimes one is referred to the fine nuances and turns of phrase of which every language has its own, and which, as has been developed above, testify more to naive receptivity than to consistent logic; but more commonly appeal is made to the strict consistency with which the parts of the proposition are joined together in exact agreement with and dependence upon one another, the predicate conforming to the subject in person, number, gender, the substantives ordered in their determinate cases, etc.; in other words, it seems to be apprehended as especially logical that language observes its own rules and employs its means of designation each according to its signification, as if the simpler languages did not do quite the same within the domain of their system” ... “To this representation of the greater logicity of the ancient languages there attached itself next an obscure transference to the languages of other qualities which one, each according to his own judgment, found in the ancient peoples and in their literatures, partly because one wished to prove from the languages’ own grammatical constitution what can be proved only from the great historical conditions of culture, namely that a knowledge of the ancient languages is of the greatest and most widespread importance for education, or because one sought recommendations generally for the study of language that one pursued. While Latin retained the reputation for a peculiar logical determinateness, other predicates were sought for Greek. It is possible that a comparison of the two classical languages with one another in a purely grammatical respect — which, moreover, when the moments are to be rightly and unmixedly weighed, is extremely difficult — will show in Greek some preponderance in receptivity to the influence of accessory motives (perturbations) upon the principal analogy (see the preface to the German edition of my Greek Syntax. p. XI); very great it will hardly be, and an inference from it to the whole people’s spiritual disposition will be the more uncertain, in that not all the particular influences lying in the conditions of development can be taken into account”. Madvig. Om de grammatikalske Betegnelser Tilblivelse og Væsen. Andet og sidste Stykke. Universitetsprogram 1857. p. 83–86.

given to single members of the fundamental form in the course of the development, but in its full and flexible development, flexible not merely in a single direction, lies the grammatical excellence of a language ... But whereas it can be discerned from Greek grammar, especially the syntax, that the Greeks had and cultivated a detailed communication in speech and writing, that the members of the people, at the least many of them, were able to move in large and composite groups of representations, and whereas it can be seen from metrics, as a part of grammar, that they had a poetry clothed in sensuously beautiful and manifold rhythmical forms, there can be drawn from the grammatical structure of the language no further inference whatever either to the fullness of content of the communication cultivated in the language or to that direction of thinking (e.g. toward the ideal or the material, etc.) which has made itself felt therein. Here there enters, as the far richer, far more determinate linguistic testimony as to what has taken place among the people, if one will, as to its view of the world (that is to say, as to the concepts and representations that have *at all* been in movement and have come forth among the people), the stock of words and the stock of significations in the words. It is here that one notices that not merely discussions such as those Demosthenes conducted, but also such as those at the head of which Plato and Aristotle stood, have taken place among the Greeks, that all the regions of the life of spirit have been traversed by them. The lexical, the stuff-like, the material in languages, as it is sometimes called, contains the only image, determinate to a certain degree, of the people's *direction of spirit*".²⁴ But however clear, definite and [46] striking this statement may seem at first glance, there is nevertheless here one point, and that a principal point, which awakens misgivings. It shall be willingly conceded that "from the grammatical structure of a language no further inference whatever can be drawn either to the fullness of content of the communication carried on in the language or to that direction of thinking which has made itself felt therein"; but — we must ask — is it after all admissible to make such a separation of the grammatical and the lexical, when what is in question is the relation of the development of language to the life of spirit? It is surely just as impossible to read off the definite image of a people's spiritual direction from the lexicon of a language as from its grammar. In

²⁴Madvig. Program 1857. p. 88–89.

both, the lexical as well as the grammatical, when each of these principal sides is considered by itself, one sees only a multitude of conditions, but not their application. Only in the application, in the definite presentation of a spiritual content, does it show itself what a language is capable of in a spiritual respect. In the presentation the grammatical works point for point together with the lexical; it is in this articulating co-operation that the reciprocal action of language-forming and thought-forming functions is properly to be recognized.

That it is not only the lexical, but also the grammatical, which in every language acts upon the movement of thought, is especially striking in those cases where one thinks in one language and communicates in another; but it can moreover be shown literally by experiments with translations, particularly of logical writings. Let one but try to translate Hegel's *Logic* into French, and one will convince oneself that changes in the lexical also bring with them changes in the grammatical, that the paraphrases thereby occasioned cause alterations in the thought, inasmuch as they cause changes in the mode of presentation, and that the alterations of thought answering to the altered presentation contain logical deviations which for the sake of the principal [47] thought must incessantly be corrected. One will further convince oneself that the difference which, in respect of the train of thought, is a consequence of the diversity of languages is of a quite different nature from that which is a consequence of what is peculiar to authors who think in the same language. One will finally convince oneself that different grammatical turns of phrase can give the same meaning without on that account giving, in the logical sense, exactly the same thought: the German *ist gewesen* and the Danish *har været* give the same meaning, but not the same thought. "On the whole", says Heiberg,²⁵ "one will perceive that the language in which one philosophizes cannot be without influence upon the philosophizing itself. For language consists of the, so to speak, embodied categories, so that grammar must be regarded as a collection of illustrative figures to logic. Hence Hegel too has categories at which he would not have arrived by thinking in a foreign language, and of which some have no counterpart in Danish either".

There is in the formation and development of languages a difference which can by

²⁵ *Perseus*. Journal for den speculative Idee. Nr. 2. 1838. p. 44–45.

no means be derived from definite stages of culture, as little as from the contingency of a first more or less fortunate grasp of the matter, but which points to what is peculiar in the nature of a people. Let one imagine the Hebrew language cultivated as much as one will, it will nevertheless never acquire the logical stamp that the Greek has. Hebrew thinking is essentially psychological. The Hebrew's thinking is in a special sense a speaking with himself; he thinks with the *heart*.²⁶ Not only the Jewish people's cultural history, but the original character of the language too bears the stamp of the [48] fact that this people's highest thinking was, and was to be, not a philosophical, but a religious thinking. It is otherwise with the Greek language; for the Greek knows that he thinks with the *head*.²⁷ Long, long before there could here be any question of a philosophizing thinking that was to work upon language, language itself was peculiarly prepared for philosophical development.

A language's logical endowment is then not to be recognized simply from the fact that in all immediacy it furnishes means for a development of thought, for that every language does to a certain degree; but expressly from the fact that in the course of its development it conditions and furthers a thinking about thinking, a judging about the judgment, that it, in other words, is fitted to express pure forms of thought by definite shadings in definite transitions. Here, then, is an essential difference between psychologically naive thinking and logical thinking that is conscious of itself. In both there is a distinguishing and a discerning, in both a separating and a connecting of representations; but psychological thinking, which discerns and distinguishes immediately, involuntarily mixes the contingent with the necessary, the special with the universal, the image with the concept; logical thinking, which is attentive to itself, is on the other hand sure of the abstraction and exercises a constant self-criticism.

²⁶ Prenons pour exemple l'hébreu, qui nous représente un état fort ancien du langage. On sent que le phénomène qui a servi d'occasion à la création des radicaux de cette langue, et en général des langues sémitiques, a été presque toujours physique. "Je conviens, dit Herder, que le penseur abstrait ne doit pas trouver la langue hébraïque très parfaite; mais sa forme agissante en fait l'instrument le plus favorable au poète. Tout en elle nous crie: Je vis, je me meus, j'agis! je n'ai pas été créée par le penseur abstrait, par le philosophe profond, mais par les sens, par les passions! Renan. *Anførte Skr.* p. 124.

²⁷ The Greek knows too what it means that language exists "for the sake of thought itself, and that man does not think except in and with language": Οὐκοῦν διάνοια μὲν καὶ λόγος ταῦτόν· πλὴν ὁ μὲν ἐντὸς τῆς ψυχῆς πρὸς αὐτὴν διάλογος ἄνευ φωνῆς γιγνόμενος τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἡμῖν ἐπωνομάσθη, διάνοια; . . . Τὸ δὲ γ' ἀπ' ἐκείνης ῥεῦμα διὰ τοῦ στόματος ἰὸν μετὰ φθόγγου κέκληται λόγος. Plato. *Sophist.* 263 E. Cf. *Theæt.* 189. E.

[49] The purest understanding of its own formal activity that thought can attain it obtains through a consideration of the forms of language in which it becomes transparent to itself. When formal logic makes a difference between “judging” and “non-judging” propositions, this distinction can in a way be acknowledged, insofar as the emphasis falls exclusively upon the form. But now the obscurity shows itself precisely in this, that logic, before one rightly knows of it, mixes the logically universal with the logically individual, the abstractly objective with the abstractly subjective, the form of the judgment in language with the act of judgment in the judging subjectivity: this yields a great confusion.

Propositions such as: “it is raining”, “he is sneezing”, “someone is ringing”, are, so it is said, “not properly judging;” “they are merely narrating, reporting, stating, without there being any question of an assuming of one thing about another.” If one looks at the purely formal, then this must be conceded, for the form is immediate and gives no clear mirroring of the logical function; but when it is then added that such propositions “will be able to transform themselves into properly judging ones as soon as a question arises about the correctness of the utterance or of the statement”, then the confusion is in full swing. Insofar as the proposition: someone is ringing, gives occasion for doubt, investigation and discussion, what is looked at here is solely the content, not the form. One demands of the proposition a guarantee that the speaker really does think something in what he says; but such a guarantee the proposition, as logical judgment, cannot possibly give so long as the judging subjectivity is seen in psychological arbitrariness. A proposition such as: God is love, can be uttered by a parrot just as fleetingly and thoughtlessly as the proposition: someone is ringing. If one now, as regards the latter proposition, demands a closer determination: *it is so, it really is so*, that someone is ringing, then one must, as regards the former proposition, [50] likewise add the assurance: *it is so, it really is so*, that God is love. But such assurances can in their turn be made in a thoughtless manner; one must thus assure oneself of the thought in the given assurances by new assurances: it is in truth so, that it really is so, that it is so, etc.

The confusion which formal logic brings about in that it, not content with the objective logical form of the judgment, strays over into the abstractly subjective and

would have in the utterance itself a separate confirmation that the speaker really does think something in what he says, that same confusion has then also, though in a reversed manner and on an opposite ground, forced its way into speculative logic. The judgments in Hegel are, namely, as we have seen, so objective that out of sheer objectivity they are on the point of judging themselves and making themselves subjective; it cannot then be otherwise than that the judgments which are objective in “Subjectivity” must develop and advance together with the concept that is objective in its subjectivity, whose content is one with the form. Since Hegel now, as regards the judgments and their division, has retained the forms of formal logic and set himself the task of saturating the empty forms with immanent content, we meet in him too the misunderstanding that the form, instead of having its logical content in a reflection of pure determinations of form, must fill itself with a content captured from a richer development of categories already traversed;²⁸ as though it did not follow of itself

²⁸— “Wenn Beispiele von Prädikaten der Reflexions-Urtheile gegeben werden sollen, so müssen sie von anderer Art seyn, als für Urtheile des Daseyns. Im Reflexions-Urtheil ist eigentlich erst ein *bestimmter Inhalt*, d. h. ein Inhalt überhaupt vorhanden; denn er ist die in die Identität reflektirte Formbestimmung, als von der Form, insofern sie unterschiedene Bestimmtheit ist, — wie sie es noch als Urtheil ist, unterschieden. Im Urtheil des Daseyns ist der Inhalt nur ein unmittelbarer, oder abstracter, unbestimmter. — Als Beispiele von Reflexions-Urtheilen können daher dienen: Der Mensch ist *sterblich*, die Dinge sind *vergänglich*, dieß Ding ist *nützlich*, *schädlich*; *Härte*, *Elasticität* der Körper, die *Glückseligkeit* u. s. f. sind solche eigenthümliche Prädikate.” Hegel. Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. p. 92. — Further, p. 101–102, where the discussion is of “Das Urtheil der Nothwendigkeit”, it reads: *Das kategorische Urtheil* hat nun eine solche Allgemeinheit zum Prädikate, an dem das Subjekt seine *immanente* Natur hat. Es ist aber selbst das erste oder *unmittelbare* Urtheil der Nothwendigkeit; daher die Bestimmtheit des Subjekts, wodurch es gegen die Gattung oder Art ein Besonderes oder Einzelnes ist, insofern der Unmittelbarkeit äußerlicher Existenz angehört. ... Was daran *nothwendig* ist, ist die *substantielle Identität* des Subjekts und Prädikats, gegen welche das Eigene, wodurch sich jenes von diesem unterscheidet, nur als ein unwesentliches Gesetzseyn, — oder auch nur ein Namen ist; das Subjekt ist in seinem Prädikate in sein An- und Fürsichseyn reflektirt. — Ein solches Prädikat sollte mit den Prädikaten der bisherigen Urtheile nicht zusammengestellt werden, wenn z. B. die Urtheile:

die Rose ist roth,
die Rose ist eine Pflanze,
oder: dieser Ring ist gelb,
er ist Gold,

in Eine Klasse zusammengeworfen, und eine so äußerliche Eigenschaft, wie die Farbe einer Blume als ein gleiches Prädikat mit ihrer vegetabilischen Natur genommen wird, so wird ein Unterschied übersehen, der dem gemeinsten Auffassen auffallen muß.” — But that the logical form of the judgment, when what is at stake is the pure immanent development of form, has nothing to do with the otherwise varied content of cognition, is easy to see. A judgment such as: man is mortal, is in a formal respect just as much an assertoric, categorical and positive judgment as it is a “judgment of reflection”; indeed,

[51] that all forms of logical judgments must at once be capable of application in the development of the system's very first and poorest categories.

[52] The confusion that has thus crept into logic's determination of the peculiarity of the several judgments in respect of form brings with it in its turn another and corresponding confusion when the question is of the divisions of the judgments.

In its "Survey of the modes of division of judgments and judgments" formal logic proceeds roughly as though what were at stake were an arrangement of furniture, a distribution of kindling wood, a classification of shoes and boots, and the like. Formal logic leaps from one ground of division to another, enumerating now more, now fewer, without the one being in any way developed out of the other.

Thus the judgments can be divided with respect to their matter into mathematical, physical, astronomical, astrological, necromantic, chiromantic, etc. etc. judgments.

Next the judgments can be divided with respect to the real nexus between subject and predicate into "not properly judging" and "properly judging propositions". The "not properly judging propositions" can in their turn be divided into the "merely propounding" and the "tautological". The "merely propounding propositions" can in their turn be divided into the "merely narrating," the "merely describing" and the "merely concept-propounding." But the "merely propounding propositions" can in their turn be divided into those in which there lies no "aggregate of judgments," and those in which there lies an "aggregate of judgments without its coming forward as judging". As regards the "tautological propositions", these can according to circumstances be divided into the "wholly vacuous" and the "not wholly vacuous". The latter can in their turn be divided into those that serve "to close the matter", and those that are "merely concept-propounding", etc. Further, the "tautological propositions" can be divided into the "directly and the indirectly tautological", and these again be divided, etc. If now the "not properly judging propositions" can bear so many divisions, subdivisions and subdivisions of subdivisions, what must the "properly judging" ones not be able to bear?

[53]

which judgment is not, according to its form, a judgment of reflection? The positive judgment is positive only in reflection of the negative, the singular only in reflection of the particular, the categorical only in reflection of the hypothetical, etc.

Furthermore the judgments can be divided with respect to the logical nexus between subject and predicate, and under this respect again with respect to quality, quantity, etc. Finally these divisions can “in general be divided” into those which at bottom do not concern logic, namely the material ones, and those which do concern logic. The divisions that concern logic can in their turn be divided into “the logical” ones and then into “certain divisions which are a consequence of the fact that two or more judgments can stand in different relations to one another,” divisions which in the last resort then also belong among the logical ones. Etc. etc. — “Thus”, says Heiberg, “one is astonished to see twenty to thirty species of judgments set up, each distinguished by its own baroque name. Since furthermore the division of these species proceeds according to different principles of division, every species of a given division can combine successively with all the other species of the other divisions, whereby there arises a host of distinctions which are wholly vacuous, inasmuch as in the judgment there lies no principle for this multiplicity.”²⁹

That formal logic, with its hotchpotch of sections, rubrics and divisions, has had a repellent effect upon so clear and logical a head as Heiberg is intelligible; it awakens more attention when we see him turn even against Hegel’s own attempt at an immanent deduction. “Hegel, who gave scholastic logic its death-blow, has” — says Heiberg “by wishing to deduce the different species of judgments as different stages of development through which the judgment becomes a syllogism, nonetheless bestowed upon them an attention and allotted to them an importance which they are far from deserving.”

But here Heiberg cuts the knot instead of untying it. In order to be rid of formalism he demands that logic shall not enter at all upon any closer determination [54] of the mutual difference of the judgments, but go from the fixing of the concept of the judgment straight over to the syllogism, so that the further development of the judgment coincides with a development of the syllogism. Hereby he overlooks that the logical development of the different forms within the form of the judgment is an essential development of form; were one in logic to skip over essential developments of form in order to avoid formalism, it would presumably end with one’s skipping

²⁹Den speculative Logik § 144 Anm. 3.

over the whole of logic at last.

“Every judgment” — it reads³⁰ — “is positive, for whether the universal under which the singular is subsumed be determined positively or negatively, the subsumption itself is always a positive act.” This must be conceded; but in the concession there is then also seen at once the demand for an essential development of form. For if reflection be made here upon the act of judgment, hence upon what is subjective in the function, it shows itself that the positive act of subsumption is essentially three posittings: the positing of the subject, the positing of the predicate, the positing of the unity of subject and predicate. We may now readily begin with the presupposition that here there is essentially only one single logical judgment; but since the form of thought always alters with the form of language, and no single form is absolutely adequate, it is seen that the one judgment must necessarily develop into a plurality of judgments, inasmuch as the one form develops into a plurality of forms. If we reflect upon the positing of the unity of subject and predicate, hence upon the *copula*, then it may indeed be conceded that the difference between subject and predicate is “a difference of reflection in which the one is only what the other is”; but the difference of reflection is for all that none the less an essential difference: the one is nevertheless not what the other is. To be sure the judgment says that the subject is what the predicate [55] is, that the subject is its predicate; but the judgment also says that the subject is not predicate, the predicate not subject. If now the being of subject and of predicate is posited immediately as one and the same being, the judgment is positive, and the positive judgment determined by the form: S is P. If conversely the being of subject and of predicate is posited as a being at variance with itself, differentiated in itself, then the subject is not what the predicate is; the judgment is thus negative, and the negative judgment determined by the form: S is not P. Immediately, and according to the content of cognition, the positive judgment can indeed be set up independently over against the negative: to that extent there are here two different judgments. It is then upon this difference too that logic reflects when it divides the judgments according to their *quality*: into *positive*, *negative* and *infinite*. But, essentially regarded, there is here only one judgment. The positive judgment acquires logical significance only

³⁰Den speculative Logik § 144. Anm. 3.

in reflection of the negative, just as conversely the negative judgment must become infinite and in its infinity meaningless if it cannot reflect itself in its corresponding positive one. How the language-forming functions prepare the thought-forming ones is then seen in this connection from the fact that there is a linguistic expression for a subject's being or not-being of its predicate.³¹

If we reflect in particular upon the *positing of the subject*, then it may indeed be conceded that the positive in the act of judgment is essentially determined by the negative, and conversely; but the unity of the two-sided determinateness first acquires its punctual significance when it is expressly posited in the form of the judgment. This [56] S is P; this judgment is, immediately regarded, positive; but the negative transforms itself into a limit and shines through when weight is laid upon the fact that for the time being it is only *this, and no more* S of which P is asserted. Just as now the positive judgment: this S (at least) is P, rests upon the possibility that there are S which are not P, so conversely the negative judgment, that there are S which are not P, rests upon the possibility that some, indeed several, and ever more S may be P. Insofar as it is still uncertain how many S are P, it is just as possible that they all are so as that none is so. It is then evident from this that formal logic's division of the judgments according to *quantity*: into *singular*: this S is P, *particular*: some S are P, and *general*: all S are P, has essential validity in respect of the form, but becomes misleading when weight is laid upon the immediate independence of the several judgments. It is the same, essentially the selfsame logical judgment which in quantity *distributes* the negative and the positive, and which in quality lets the positive exclude the negative, and conversely.

If we reflect in particular upon the *positing of the predicate*, then it may readily be conceded that the unity of the two-sided determinateness, of the negative by the positive, is decisive for the judgment in every form; but then it also essentially depends upon how far the form itself indicates the act of thinking by which the unity

³¹That the copula "is" is not found in the Hebrew and Aramaic languages has been especially brought forward in the history of the religious controversies with respect to the sacramental words: *hu dami, hu gufi* [this is my blood, this is my body]. A language can have the abstract copula without therefore having an abstractum answering to the category *being* (thus, e.g., the French *être* is not being, but substance), but a language that does not have the abstract copula will hardly furnish adequate expressions for categories such as being and not-being.

is posited. That the unity of subject and predicate is a unity-in-difference means then, in other words, that the predicate as predicate *belongs to* the subject insofar as it both is in the subject and *comes to* the subject. That the predicate belongs to the subject means, then, that the predicate-determination is the subject's own original determination; here, therefore, nothing is posited in the predicate that is not already in the subject; the predicate-determination is a subject-determination transparent in the form: *the judgment is analytic*. But that the predicate essentially belongs to the

[57] subject presupposes then also that in the predication it is really brought together with the subject; by the act of predication, therefore, a new determination is brought to the subject itself: *the judgment is*, in other words, *synthetic*. From the standpoint of finitude it does indeed look as though the analytic judgment were complete by itself over against the synthetic, and conversely. But this is in the logical sense a pure illusion, and formal logic must bear the blame for the fact that this illusion, so pernicious for science, constantly receives new nourishment. How should it be possible, when we look expressly at the concept, to find a judgment so analytic that there were not to be found in it a moment of synthesis. Let the predicate be in the subject itself as much as one will; the subject cannot possibly be subject except in formal opposition to its predicate: by the form of the judgment the formal independence of the predicate is irrefutably asserted. Conversely the subject may, according to its immediate reality, have whatever independence it will — in opposition to its predicate it has, in virtue of the form determined by the act of predication, only formal independence. If now on the one side it is not possible to conceive a judgment so analytic that it should contain nothing synthetic, so on the other side it is just as little possible to conceive a judgment so synthetic that it were not at the same time analytic. A judgment so synthetic that the analytic were wholly excluded would have to be a judgment in which subject and predicate came forward each by itself with such immediate independence that their union were to be regarded as wholly contingent; but such a judgment is in its essence meaningless. The subject in the judgment is subject only by reflecting its predicate, just as the predicate is predicate only by reflecting its subject. What the predicate asserts, the subject must be, were it only for a single moment; but what the subject as subject itself is cannot possibly be indifferent to its being: the synthetic judgment is

essentially analytic, because the analytic judgment is essentially synthetic.³² [58]

The positive judgment is thus in its concept analytic-synthetic just as well as the negative, the singular analytic-synthetic just as well as the general. In the logical sense it is so far from being the case that the analytic and the synthetic should here be something by themselves over against the positive, the negative, the singular, the particular and the general, that on the contrary they ground the unity-in-difference of the positive and the negative, the singular and the particular, etc. Herein lies then also the ground why the difference between the analytic and the synthetic judgment has not, as the difference between the positive and the negative, the particular and the general judgment has, any direct expression in language.

Since it nonetheless makes an essential difference whether it is the synthetic or the analytic side of the judgment that hovers before the one who judges in the moment of thought, there is already hereby awakened an expectation that language must surely have, if not a direct, then at any rate an indirect expression for the distinction between the merely synthetic, the analytic and the analytic-synthetic.

How this expression must be constituted can, although formal logic does not let us surmise the least of it, hardly be difficult to find out. It is then in the first place manifest that the immediately synthetic is directly determined by the immediately given, S is really P (the wall is really red; his eyes are really blue): *the judgment is assertoric*. But how now are the analysis and the consciousness of the abstractly analytic to [59] be expressed? Naturally in a negative and indirect manner. When the predicate, immediately regarded, belongs to the subject only because in actuality it is found united with it, there lies in this that the opposite might be the case, namely that the union did not take place; the subject then hovers between being and not being the determinate predicate: S is perhaps P, perhaps not: *the judgment is problematic*. But when the judgment is problematic, the question involuntarily forces itself forward: which predicate must the subject in question then, according to its concept, incontestably have? In order to decide what in this is necessary and what contingent, the analysis must be undertaken. And with what then does the analysis end? Not with simply

³²It was by a true flash of genius that Kant became aware that a priori judgments too can be synthetic; but he stopped half-way. That synthetic judgments are *a priori* possible rests precisely upon this, that what is synthetic in the judgment is *a priori* one with what is analytic.

discarding the contingent and retaining the abstractly necessary (for such an attempt betrays but little power of judgment), but with taking up the contingent as a moment in the concretely necessary: S is necessarily P; here is the unity of the synthetic and the analytic: *the judgment is apodictic*.

Formal logic divides the judgments with respect to *the real nexus* between subject and predicate into *analytic* and *synthetic*, and with respect to *modality* into *assertoric*, *problematic* and *apodictic*; but it lets each of the divisions stand as a rubric by itself, without any suggestion that the one should in any way concern the other. It is this parcelling out, this half thoughtless but nevertheless “thoughtful” rubrication, that does such irreparable harm. By overlooking the connection between the two modes of division one naturally overlooks the connection between the formal function and the form of the judgment. The same judgment which for the one presents itself as assertoric presents itself then for the other as problematic, for the third as apodictic, etc. If on the other hand one perceives the connection between the formal function and the form, then one perceives also the connection between the different modes of division. The assertoric judgment is in its concept assertoric precisely because [60] it as immediately positive is immediately synthetic. In the analytic judgment the predicate is taken up into its subject, in the problematic it loosens itself from its subject; but the one of these extremes presupposes the other. If the analysis is to begin, immediate certainty must be at an end: the problematic judgment answers to a judging consciousness which by the immediately synthetic is driven towards the analytic. Finally, the apodictic judgment is not apodictic because it occurs to a thoughtless man to use the form: S is necessarily P, where he had better use the form: S is perhaps P; the form: S is necessarily P, expressly presupposes that the judgment rests upon an exhaustive analysis answering to the synthesis. In the apodictic judgment the assertoric in the synthesis has become problematic, and this problematic, by reason of the analysis, again assertoric, and thereby more than assertoric.

If we reflect finally upon *the posited unity of all three posittings*, hence upon the equilibrium between the logical independence of subject and of predicate, then we come to the most concrete completion of form that thought, by the help of language, is able to give to the logical judgment.

The positive judgment is in its full determinateness *categorical*; the categorically positive judgment cannot be immediately opposed to the negative, for the positive has taken up the negative into itself as a moment. The categorical judgment expresses the unity of the singular and the general, which among other things comes to light from the fact that the plural characteristic of the general judgment (All men are mortal) is transformed into an essential singular, significative for the universal judgment (Man is, as such, mortal). That the categorical judgment is also determined as analytic-synthetic is seen from the developed conceptual relation of subject and predicate; for the subject is here posited in unity with its predicate, as the singular (the existing) in unity with the universal (the concept). The categorical judgment cannot, then, as assertoric have the problematic outside itself; the existent cannot, after all, fall out of [61] its category: the categorical judgment is essentially apodictic.

But just because the categorical judgment has all the judgment's fundamental determinations in it, it can have no special language-form: in its expression it is straightforwardly the judgment as judgment. Its peculiarity first develops, and becomes recognizable in language, when its own inner oppositions are asked after. S is (categorically) P; the singular (S) is subsumed under its universal (P); one and the same concept (P) comprehends a multiplicity of particular S, namely $S_1, S_2, S_3, \dots$. Thus: S_1 is P, S_2 is P, S_3 is P. etc. But categorically the converse holds as well, namely that many universal determinations are found united in one and the same existing singular, that, in other words, the predicate inheres in its subject. This then gives us the following series: S is P_1 , S is P_2 , S is $P_3 \dots$. From this it is seen that the predicate in the categorical judgment can be partly one-sided, as a property of the thing, partly all-sided, as the totality-concept that exists in the subject, the species that is realized in the individual.

If the fundamental relation between subject and predicate, that which exists and the category, has been brought to consciousness, then it has at the same time been brought to consciousness that the categorical judgment cannot possibly be seen in its significance without a series of categorically connected judgments forming itself. If now, e.g., S is (categorically) P, what then? Well, then s must (categorically) be p; or still more abstractly and more formally: if S is subject, then P must be predicate; thus we have the *hypothetical* judgment. In the hypothetical judgment the categorical

is doubled; at first glance it looks as though there were two independent judgments here, one in the antecedent: if S is P, and one in the consequent: then s is p; but [62] the unity consists categorically in the dependencerelation given between the two propositions, the condition and the conditioned.³³ That the hypothetical judgment

³³For the distinction of the categorical and the hypothetical judgment Kant brings out that the former is determined by the categories substance and inherence, the latter by the categories cause and effect. To this Trendelenburg remarks (*Logische Untersuchungen*. Zweiter Band. Berlin 1840. p. 178.) that these concepts form no opposition. "Die Substanz ist in der Eigenschaft causal. Die Eigenschaft ist die an das Ding gebundene Thätigkeit. Die strengste Form der Inhärenz ist das Verhältniß der im Ganzen inwohnenden Theile. Da aber das Ganze die Theile trägt und zu dem macht, was sie sind, so schlägt auch hier die Inhärenz in die Causalität über." But what does this prove? Nothing other than that with respect to the same object one can apply now the categories substance and inherence, now the categories cause and effect. What was to be proved here is that, when the categories cause and effect form the ground, one applies the categorical form just as fittingly as the hypothetical; but from proving that one will surely refrain. In defense of Kant's conception Apelt (*Die Theorie der Induction*. Leipzig 1854. p. 9.) declares it a downright impossibility to transform the one of the two kinds of judgment into the other. "Was man von der *Verwandlung* kategorischer und hypothetischer Urtheile sowie kategorischer und hypothetischer Schlüsse in einander gesagt hat, ist eine logische Fabel. Denn jede solche angebliche Verwandlung besteht nur in einer Veränderung des *grammatischen Ausdrucks*, aber nie in einer wirklichen Veränderung *der logischen Form*." This too is a great misunderstanding; for with the change in the grammatical there enters precisely an alteration in the logical. Trendelenburg has then also (*Anf. Skr.* S. 179.) shown by examples how a categorical judgment allows itself to be transformed into a hypothetical: "Wenn ein hypothetisches Urtheil verschiedene Gegenstände zusammenbringt, so sind sie immer unter einem höhern Begriff eins, da sie als Bedingung und Bedingtes, als Grund und Folge eins gesetzt werden. Vermöge dieser in einer Thätigkeit oder einer Eigenschaft ruhenden Einheit kann es geschehen, daß auch in diesem Falle das hypothetische Urtheil ein fast gleichbedeutendes kategorisches neben sich hat. Man vergleiche z. B. die Urtheile: Wenn Bernstein gerieben wird, so entwickelt sich Electricität. Der geriebene Bernstein entwickelt Electricität. Ferner: Wenn ein Kegel durch eine Ebene geschnitten wird, so entstehen regelmäßige Curven. Der Schnitt durch einen Kegel erzeugt regelmäßige Curven".

Thus: from the one side one seeks to level out the difference between the categorical and the hypothetical judgment, because one sees that different categories can be applied to the same object, and does not notice that the judgment's form alters with the altered categories; from the other side one wants to raise a partition wall between the categorical and the hypothetical judgment, because there admittedly is a difference between the logical and the grammatical, and does not notice that the logical, in accordance with the reciprocal determination of the language-forming and thought-forming functions, is altered by the grammatical. A third standpoint is represented by Ulrici (*Compendium der Logik*. Leipzig 1860. p. 177–178.): "Hypothetische Urtheile giebt es in Wahrheit gar nicht. Denn daß sie auf dem Verhältniß der Ursache und Wirkung beruhen, ist (z. B. von dem Urtheil: wenn dieß Mineral ein Metall ist, so ist es schmelzbar) nicht nachweisbar und würde keinen Unterschied begründen. Und ihre anderweitige Verschiedenheit von den kategorischen ist entweder nur eine rein äußerliche des sprachlichen Ausdrucks, oder beruht bloß auf einer rein subjectiven Beziehung des Urtheilenden zu dem Gegenstande (Inhalt) des Urtheils, — ist also ohne alle logische Bedeutung." The judging consciousness's subjective relation to the judgment and to the judgment's object is thus — "ohne alle logische Bedeutung?"

To extricate oneself from these quackeries there is only one way out: to hold fast the judgment's

can designate something uncertain, something still undecided, in likeness with the problematic, must be granted; but the emphasis by no means falls on the uncertainty, [63] on the contrary! it falls categorically on the decisive determinateness with which the antecedent entails the consequent: if S is P, then (categorically) s is p, or if s is not p, then (categorically) S is not P.

Inasmuch as every existing thing expresses its category, things exist in categorical connection. The categorical connection is contingent-necessary, contingent with re- [64] spect to the immediacy of the existent members, necessary with respect to their mutual dependence. The contingent-necessary connection of things is expressly brought to consciousness in the hypothetical judgment; but the hypothetical judgment is in this respect only a one-sided development of the categorical. The hypothetical judgment has its point of support in the presupposition that the singular is subsumed without the universal,³⁴ that it is thus the singular things in their relations and reciprocal conditionedness on which, in the totality-development, everything essentially depends: the totality-unity is as yet only a connection-unity. But with this the categorical judgment is by no means exhausted.

According to the categorical judgment the thing can first fully correspond to its category, and the category to the thing, when both, each in its own form, express the same totality of categorical determinations. But when the predicate has the same totality as the subject, only with this difference, that the predicate-determinations are essential and logical, the subject-determinations existential and antilogical, then the relation can of course be reversed: the subject, that which exists, then becomes predicate, and the predicate, the concept of that which exists, subject. The concept, the essence totalized in itself, is actualized in a multiplicity of existences; these existences now constitute the members of the predicate, while the unity of the concept furnishes the subject. Thus there arises, when we look to the essence of the subject, the conjunctive judgment: S is (in its essence) both P₁ and P₂ and P₃, and, when we look to the existing members of the predicate, the *categorically-disjunctive* judgment³⁵:

form in its unity with the abstract logical content and to take note of the unity-in-difference of word and thought.

³⁴If we disregard the deduction and mix in representations of one real content or another, totality-predicates can naturally also come forward as subjects: if the plant is a rose, then the fruit etc.

³⁵That the disjunctive judgment can moreover also have that which exists as subject and predicate

[65] S is (in its existence) either P_1 or P_2 or P_3 Since now each P is in its totality a realized S, each existing member is not only a relative totality for itself, but at the same time a moment in the comprehensive totality that penetrates all the members. The penetrating totality-unity is a fundamental unity; by the reciprocal determination of the hypothetical, the conjunctive and the disjunctive judgment the form is brought to consciousness, the categorical form, which serves to express that the connection of the members, which exclude yet condition one another, essentially rests upon a fundamental unity.³⁶

[66] When formal logic inculcates the necessity of going through the formal element in thinking in a thorough and penetrating manner, we must grant that it is right. The doctrine of the judgment's modes of division ought in that respect just as little to deter us as the doctrine of the judgments' "subalternation", "equipollence", "opposition", "conversion", "contraposition" etc., because it is not "spirited and attractive", if only it were scientifically fruitful. But here is precisely the great misunderstanding of which the defenders of formal logic make themselves guilty. It is not the thoroughness and the acuteness, but the barren, unfruitful element in the treatment of the logical forms, that is here opposed. Instead of pointing out a principle that itself sets thought

in one-sided categories (the thing is either black or white or red) is in this connection, where what is at issue is the deduction, without significance.

³⁶Alle disjunctiven Urtheile (die auf dem Verhältniß der Wechselwirkung oder des Ganzen und Theils beruhen sollen, was wiederum nicht einmal richtig ist) sind ebenfalls *nur* sprachlich von den s. g. positiven (kategorischen) unterschieden, und lassen sich daher unbeschadet ihres Sinnes in kategorische umwandeln: Das Urtheil z. B.: Cajus ist entweder gesund oder krank, ist nur sprachliche Abkürzung für: Es ist unmöglich, daß Cajus zugleich gesund und krank sey, oder: Es ist nothwendig, daß er entweder krank oder gesund ist. Und das Urtheil: Die Kegelschnitte sind entweder Kreise oder Ellipsen oder Parabeln oder Hyperbeln, läßt sich auch so ausdrücken: die Kegelschnitte sind theils Kreise, theils Ellipsen oder: Die Kegelschnitte können nur die Form von Kreisen, Ellipsen etc. haben, nur diese Formen sind möglich. Ulrici. Anf. Skr. p. 178. What is true in this reduction is that the judgment's particular forms are modifications of one and the same fundamental form; but what is untrue is that the particular forms should on that ground have no logical significance. How arbitrary the reduction is strikes the eye when the judgment: Cajus is either healthy or sick, is supposed to be a "sprachliche Abkürzung" for: it is impossible that Cajus can at one and the same time be both healthy and sick. It would really be interesting to see a little proof that the judgment in the latter form is more logical than in the former. Why can Cajus not at one and the same time be both healthy and sick? Because a decisive either-or is presupposed here: either healthy or sick; if doubt is raised about this presupposition, doubt is at the same time raised about the judgment: it is impossible that Cajus can at one and the same time be both healthy and sick. The logical in the latter judgment can thus just as well be said to rest upon the logic in the former as conversely.

in movement, and in the movement of thought lets the one determination of form, in a given connection, develop out of the other, school-logic on the contrary aims at depositing and setting up results of thought that merely are, with disregard of every consideration of principle and movement. The frozen waves in a brook still always bear traces of movement, namely of an arrested movement; but formal logic's distinctions and rubrics bear no trace of movement; its propositions are like finished figures, strokes and crosses, whose number and order must be impressed on the memory.

Herein lies a great misdirection. It does indeed seem as though the many abstractions, arrangements of concepts, exact definitions etc. must serve precisely to develop the understanding, to exercise acuteness and, as Herbart expresses it, to "accustom us to sustained attention to the natural course of thinking"; but these advantages are of a very ambiguous kind. What help is it that the understanding is developed, when it is developed in a skewed direction, in that it is developed so as to separate what is [67] thought from thinking, the logical forms from their corresponding functions.

It is not a schema of the judgment's divisions finished once and for all, but a development and motivation of the difference of form under which the judgment comes forward by turns, that opens to us an insight into the logical judgment-functions. Least of all can scholastic formalism "accustom us to sustained attention to the natural course of thinking"; it is on the contrary the unnatural course of thinking upon which formalism fixes attention. For what can be more unnatural than to conjure the living forms into a crystallized being? what indeed can be more unnatural and more pedantic than the manner in which formal logic by its distinctions sets abstractum against abstractum, without an inkling that living thought at every moment demands the sublation of the abstraction just as necessarily as the abstraction itself? If it really were thought's natural, not its unnatural course to which scholastic logic with its barbarous mnemonic verses directed attention, then in scientific presentations, especially in every philosophical treatise, one would surely see the fruits of logic's teachings; but the author who should seriously set about letting logic's teachings shine through a logical treatment of a concrete subject — in him thought would come to run about as

natural a course as in a Magister Stygotius or an Else David Skolemesters³⁷.

- [68] To thought's natural course it belongs that the language-forming and the thought-forming functions enter into living reciprocal action; only thus can the representation pass over into concept, and the pictorial be illuminated by the non-pictorial. Logic's significance is that thought catches sight of itself, that the abstraction is carried through. First a judgment is passed on the object, and the judgment's form is deposited
- [69] in language; the thought-forming function is latent in the language-forming.³⁸ In the judgment's linguistic form thought then sees its own trace, an imprint of its invisible essence, and now begins with a judgment upon the judgment: the language-forming function introduces the thought-forming. Once thought has, by its own turns of language, become attentive to the abstract and has won certainty in abstraction, then it is so far from being the case that fuller, more figurative expressions should weaken

³⁷One can become pedantic just as well by chasing after the abstractly logical with a petty, unfruitful acuteness, and arbitrarily fixing a schema for what is "in his own imagining" philosophically stringent, as by visibly overexerting oneself to express everything quite ceremonially, figuratively, ingeniously and ornately. If it is comic when a Stygotius as a suitor corrects his expression "draws my heart's iron" to "thrusts my heart's iron", then it is also comic when a Stygotius as a logician grows shy of a categorical judgment and imagines that a tautology lurks in it; exhortations such as: "Gold is — if I may permit myself an implicitly tautological proposition — for when we look at the manner in which the concept metal has formed itself, and at what is in general understood by metal, we shall not be able to call the proposition 'Gold is a metal' anything but an implicitly tautological proposition, since it at *bottom* or, what would I say, *in general*, says neither anything other nor anything more than that gold is such a thing as gold, silver, copper etc. — a metal", would be style for a Stygotius.

Editors of formal logic (for a long straw that is threshed over again only because it has been threshed so often can hardly be used for productive authorship) not seldom make themselves guilty of the comic contradiction that, whereas in the so-called principle of identity, where the tautology is conspicuous, they cannot discover the tautological, but for the sake of "certainty" and "truth", "determination", "statuation", "whatness", "unanimity" and "concordance" alone rejoice over "the deeper logical element" that lies in logic's highest proposition, that A is what A is, they on the other hand get scruples when they are to recognize it as a judgment that gold is a metal, for it might after all possibly be a tautology. It naturally does not occur to that pusillanimous acuteness to think the matter through and let the decision of the case turn upon a dialectic; for then it would soon become clear. If the following judgments: gold is a metal, silver is a metal, copper is a metal, are implicitly tautological, what follows from this? Then it follows from this that gold is silver, and that silver is copper, a consequence whose absurdity is just as evident to the natural understanding as its necessity.

³⁸The language-forming functions are recognized, namely, so far as style is concerned, not immediately by the fact that either new words or new grammatical turns are formed here, but by the fact that the given means of language are used in a peculiar manner. To every peculiar turn of language there corresponds a peculiar turn of thought. He who says: "all metal is fusible" speaks a different language and thinks the thought otherwise than he who says: "if this is a metal, then it is fusible"; and the latter in turn speaks a different language and thinks the thought otherwise than he who says: "if this mass does not allow itself to be melted, it cannot possibly be metal".

the light-effect of ideality, that reflection, reflection carried through, on the contrary has a satisfaction in striking into the way of intuition and transforming the pictorial into a clear form, transparent in its color, for the non-pictorial.³⁹

The logical expression too can have its essential beauty. A presentation that in each [70] and every respect should satisfy logic's aesthetic demand is certainly a great rarity, since it presupposes a peculiar, happy union of reflection and imagination; but that logic, strict logic, makes aesthetic demands is certain: the aesthetic is here grounded in the living thinking's appropriation of everything that stirs in the life of consciousness; it is this aesthetic that inspires thought, gives the shadings their play of color and makes productivity recognizable by the attractive harmony of language-forming and thought-forming functions.

γγ) Idea-forming Functions. Between subjectivity and the actual world of objects the chasm is so deep that it opens anew every time reflection dreams of having got it filled. *The Logic of Functions* ended with a concretion of the teleological unity of the ideal system and the real system, namely as a syllogism-unity of nature and spirit, a development in which the dualism of the objective and the subjective provisionally found its explanation. From several sides it has then also been shown in advance how the antilogical, by the mediation of sense-perception, allowed itself to be transposed into the logical; how the same content could assume a different form, the same form

³⁹It is wonderful how intuition and thought, the pictorial and the non-pictorial, can by the word's sorcery be interwoven with one another, so that thought's clarity and the image's boldness stand in direct proportion. The reciprocal action of language-forming and thought-forming functions is then aesthetic. — "My sorrow, that is my knight's castle, which like an eagle's nest lies high up on the mountains' peak among the clouds; no one can storm it. From it I fly down into actuality and seize my prey; but I do not remain down there, my prey I bring home, and this prey is an image that I weave into the tapestries of my castle. Then I live as one deceased. Everything that has been lived through I dip down into the baptism of forgetfulness unto the eternity of recollection. Everything finite and contingent is forgotten and effaced. Then I sit like an old, gray-haired man, deep in thought, and explain the images in a soft voice, almost whispering, and at my side sits a child and listens, although it remembers everything before I tell it." Victor Eremita. Enten-Eller. Kjøbenhavn 1849. p. 21. — What are we now to judge, from logic's standpoint, of such a presentation? If there are here only images without thoughts, then the whole is presumably an insipid fabrication, and we must, with Master Mannegrimm, ask for "one more lie". If, on the contrary, there are here just as many, indeed still more thoughts than images, if the colorful image-propositions are essentially clear thought-propositions, should the thoughts then perhaps gain by being stripped of the rich garb and presented in their logical nakedness? But if this last is neither desirable nor in a stricter sense possible, then we have here an example of the aesthetic reciprocal action of language-forming and thought-forming functions.

[71] a different content etc. But beneath all these turns, transpositions and explanations there is understood a something which, just because it was in immediate application, could not at once become the object of special reflection, namely the word.

What then is the word? That the word is not without further ado the same as language is clear from our foregoing; for there are indeed languages without free-standing words, and the language that has specially formed words has, after all, many and different words. The category: *word* therefore stands in this respect partly lower, partly higher than the category: *language*. Lower! for just as letters are elements in syllables, syllables elements in words, so the single word is in turn an element in the proposition, and the proposition an element in language. But as an element of the proposition the word is not yet essentially word; a language proper cannot do without propositions, but a proposition can transform roots into words: that there can be language without words is then true insofar as propositions can be formed without words. Higher! for the word is the expression of thought. Insofar as the proposition yields a meaning, and the meaning a thought, the proposition is essentially a word. "There is a word, an old word, which says" etc. That the proposition is, according to its meaning and by virtue of the thought, word, means then, in other words, that the word as word in a deeper sense is higher than the proposition. From this standpoint there can then be no language without words; it would have to be a language without propositions, a pure animal language, or a language of propositions without meaning, a meaningless language.

If now the word in a deeper sense stands higher than the proposition, then it also stands higher than language. If we take words as elements of propositions, that is, finitely and in the plural, then one may certainly say that it is language which, by a peculiar development, makes its elements into words; but if we take the word as word in the absolute sense, that is, in the singular, then we must say that it is the word that

[72] is the original, language the derived; that it is the word which makes language into language. How unreasonable it is to want to make language the absolutely original — which is nevertheless what those do who with F. Schlegel trace the origin of languages back to a supernatural act, a miracle — can already be felt when one, instead of the Johannine: "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the

Word was God”, attempts to put: In the beginning was Language, and Language was with God, and Language was God.

If it is now not language as finite language, but the word in the absolute sense, that is the original, then it is seen from this that what in the finite and relative sense is accomplished by language must in the absolute and original sense be ascribed to the word.

What then does speaking subjectivity properly owe to language? The answer sounds from the foregoing: an objectification-doubling, whereby the opposition between the inner and the outer world is essentially articulated! Certainly the shapes of the surrounding world would be able to mirror themselves in consciousness even without the mediation of language — we see it, after all, in the animals; — but this mirroring would then have to proceed: partly in such a way that every image, even if only for a moment, remained standing in antilogical outline, relating itself to the object as the copy to its original; partly in such a way that the images dissolved into representations as clouds into mists, the flow of the representations proceeding on the one side with spiritually determined natural necessity, and on the other side losing itself and vanishing in empty, hovering reflections. Only by the help of language does it become possible for consciousness to articulate the objective content of existence in subjective form and, conversely, to give the content of subjectivity objective form; only by the help of language can the same content enter into a double form, and the same form into a double content; only through language does it become possible to form the idea, the absolute content.

What in the relative sense is accomplished by language must, as has been said, in the absolute sense be referred back to the word: the relation between the content and language presupposes a fundamental relation between the idea and the word. Since the idea’s absolute content is at once both subjective and objective, the idea-forming functions are to be determined specifically by the unity-in-difference of the subjective and the objective. Insofar as this unity shows itself as a *magical* unity of idea and word, the idea-forming functions are *mythical*; insofar as the word’s unity with the idea has a *fantastic* stamp, they are *gnostic*; if the unity is posited in the *essence of the Godhead*, they become *theosophical*. [73]

Mythical Functions. It is the unity-in-difference of the objective and the subjective in the word on which the emphasis falls. Essentially, with this unity-in-difference, everything depends on the content. If the content is finite, and the separation between subjective and objective unclear, then we have before us a consciousness fermenting and groping among sensations and obscure representations, a stage of consciousness corresponding to that of the child in its early years: this standpoint cannot come into consideration here. If the content is finite, and the separation between subjective and objective clear, then we have the critically understanding stage of consciousness. At this stage the word is one thing and the thing another, the representation one thing and actuality another, and language then mediates in a finite manner between the factors in this parceling out: this standpoint likewise cannot come into consideration. What is decisive for the idea-forming functions is that the content of consciousness must be absolute.

Since now an absolute content cannot possibly move through subjectivity without reflecting itself in relative oppositions, it is further seen that the consciousness which is to objectify the idea for itself in and by the word, and therein to cognize the absolute, must already beforehand have reached the point at which it can in the finite sense distinguish the things of the surrounding world, and on the whole make a difference between actuality and sense-deception, between what is outward and what is merely inward. The psychological subjectivity which, after having attained, within narrow [74] limits, a clear understanding of existence in the finite, is seized and moved by the idea in so immediate a manner that finitude's oppositions of dream and actuality, of inward and outward disappear, in order to repeat themselves in higher forms corresponding, by virtue of the word, to the absolute, is *mythical*.

The distinguishing mark of the mythical is, in principle, by no means obscurity about the outwardly finite; it is not sensuousness's misty images, but the idea's lightning-flash, not the understanding's night, but reason's daybreak, that lends the content of consciousness its wonderful mythical colors. How peculiar the blending of colors is strikes the eye when one really tries to characterize mythology and the mythical standpoint. "For mythology", says Heiberg, "there is no other, all-embracing point of view than the poetic. Mythology is poetry, and purely original folk-poetry".

Later on this folk-poetry is then at the same time apprehended as a kind of speculative philosophy. "Every mythology", it is said, "begins with cosmogony; for philosophizing humanity's first endeavor is to explain the wonder of existence. The first question is: how has the world come into being? What was there before all this came into being? Or what was there when as yet there was nothing? The understanding can so little answer these questions that it must even declare them foolish and self-contradictory. But imagination hovers boldly out over the beginning of things, without fearing to lose itself in nothing. It peoples the void, it lets light arise out of darkness, existence out of non-existence"⁴⁰ etc.

That mythology is at once both poetry and philosophy means then, in other words, that it is at bottom neither poetry nor philosophy; not poetry, because it is philosophy; not philosophy, because it is poetry. The closer determination is seen from the functions. The poetic is here not apprehended as poetry. Poetry presupposes [75] a separation of illusion and actuality bearing upon the absolute content, a separation that expressly sets illusion above actuality, because it sets the idea above finitude; but with so reflected a separation the myth as myth cannot possibly subsist: the mythical figures maintain themselves, by the idea's magic, at the stage of a higher actuality; here at this stage there is not even an inkling of illusion. Just as little is the philosophical in myth-formation apprehended as philosophy. What kind of philosophy would that be, which began with an express discord between understanding and imagination, and which on account of this discord gave up the understanding and let imagination rule? Instead of beginning with a dualism of imagination and understanding, myth-formation on the contrary begins with an imagination impregnated by understanding and reason; one may say with full right of the mythical idea-movement that thought fantasizes because *imagination thinks*.

When, then, the imagination impregnated by understanding and reason "hovers boldly out over the beginning of things, without fearing to lose itself in nothing", what steers its flight, what is it that preserves it from plunging into the void's abyss? Essentially it is *the idea*; immediately seen, it is *the word*. The abyss of the beginning is equally deep, whether we begin with *Chaos* or with *Ginungagap*; it is in both infinitely

⁴⁰J. L. Heibergs nordiske Mythologie. Paa Dansk udgivet af Chr. Winther. Kbhvn. 1864. p. 4 og p. 24.

deep; but in the infinite deep the idea is wedded to the word.

If we begin with Chaos, then it is naturally not the empty appellation on which weight is laid here, for the appellations can vary. But the synonymous appellations all bear upon the same fundamental word. That Chaos as a fundamental word is a revelation of the idea, posited and moved by the idea's power, can easily be shown. Chaos is in the mythical sense neither an abstract logical concept nor an expression [76] for a state of physical confusion, but a totality-unity held fast in the word, a subjective-objective First which in pictorial and yet non-pictorial form renders intuitable what cannot be intuited, namely the origin of things, the idea of all actual beginning, or the actual beginning's idea.

That chaos as concept is not in the form of the concept, but in the form of a non-pictorial image, follows expressly from intuition's unity with the word. What is there in chaos? Nothing, and yet everything! This self-contradiction of thought, with the consequences springing from it, is not apprehended in the form of a thought, but is seen in an image, a mighty thought-image formed by the word. In that thought, by help of the word, lets the imagination play over nothing and everything, the imagination thinks essentially of everything and yet intuits in chaos nothing, the empty; it thinks essentially of nothing, and yet intuits in chaos everything, namely the seeds of everything (*non bene junctarum discordia semina rerum*). The content, the content void of content in chaos, is essentially subjective by means of the word: a product of imagining thinking, of thinking imagination; but it is at the same time intuited objectively, strikes the intuiting consciousness with the power of objectivity in the word, and takes on the shape of physically immediate reality.

But that chaos in an objective sense nevertheless does not have physically immediate reality is precisely a consequence of the non-pictorial in the image, of intuition's mythical unity with the word. In an objective, physical significance chaos would have to be the actual dissolution in which all-existence would have to find itself when all forms were disordered and the swarm of atoms in lawless confusion. For an understanding, critical consciousness of such a chaos the word has lost its magical force. The word chaos is in this case only a name; chaos, on the other hand, as an outward actual state is the thing, and the thing, not the word, is what matters. Separated from

the imagination that rests upon the word, the understanding will then on its own account investigate the actual chaos, the outward actual beginning of things. But this enterprise of the understanding will totally miscarry. As an actual state chaos is [77] utterly unactual; there is actually no existence that can begin with an actual chaos; what the understanding is to get out of such a chaos it must in actuality itself smuggle into it: it is an idle play, the understanding plays with itself and with the actual.

In the mythical chaos objectivity is subjective; the objective content is by the word transposed into subjective form. How different the mythical chaos is from the outward physical one is then also recognizable from the figures that proceed out of chaos. "First is chaos, next the wide earth, dark Tartarus — and Eros, the fairest among the immortal gods." He who sees the old gods step forth out of chaos cannot be in doubt about what sort of being chaos is. In that one here begins with chaos, a run-up is here in a manner taken toward an objective presentation of the world's coming to be, of the formation of things, of the finite realities; but the view turns about. Cosmogony swings over and becomes theogony; chaos becomes a divinity, the divinity from whose womb the particular gods are born. This regression of the cosmogonic into the theogonic is in a high degree characteristic of myth-formation. In order that the world may come to be, the gods must first come to be; in order that the finite realities may in actuality come to be, the real ideas must first come to be: the finite becoming of the real ideas reflects in itself the eternal being of the fundamental ideas.

Chaos is thus in its ideality eternal, in its immediate reality temporal, divinity in being, nature-ground in becoming, totality in original unity, the ground of totalities in original plurality; in chaos the relative is absolute, the absolute relative; in the chaos-word motion is rest and rest again motion, fullness emptiness, and emptiness fullness, the inward an outward, and this outward again an inward: in chaos the idea is word, and the word idea.

It is then not a contingency, but an essential necessity, that the oldest gods issue out [78] of chaos. In logical form the necessity is recognizable by this, that plurality proceeds out of unity, since unity itself is originally plurality, that the particular in the totality proceeds out of the universal, since the universal is originally a totality of particulars. But in the logical form the content lacks immediate reality; reality, the mythical reality,

comes with the word, for the word determined by the idea determines the idea.

Such figures as Gaea, Tartarus, Erebus, Nyx and Eros are in their originality more than empty personifications. “Figures of the figureless”, “elementary forms of the first One, in themselves formless” — such famished abstractions fall just as far below the idea as below actuality. No, by the magic of the idea in the mythical word the oldest gods are, despite what in form is unformed, typical figures full of reality, each divinity a totality in itself, a being of its own, a determinate physiognomy. It is the idea that in particular totality-unities penetrates, moves and determines the word; but it is in the immediate sense the word, the particular fundamental word, that in its unity takes up, determines and gathers the manifold of the ideal and real, non-pictorial and pictorial moments that make up the idea’s absolute content.

The goddess Gaea, who receives her name after the earth, takes up by this name all the earth’s reality into herself, becomes by this name a divinity with immeasurable capacities, mighty forces and great possibilities; but that the goddess has received her name after the actual earth says at the same time that it is the actual earth that has received its name after the goddess. The earth-goddess and the actual earth have not merely one name, but they are one being, designated by one word: they are one in the word, since they are one in the idea. That the actual earth is a goddess shows us in a strikingly forcible manner what it means that the idea’s objective, real content is — by [79] means of the word — transposed into subjective, ideal form; that the goddess, with all the traits of elementary subjectivity, is the earth itself, the actual earth, renders intuitable on the other side what the word is capable of where it is a question of translating a subjective content — for the goddess’s being is in its ideality a subjective being — into immediate, objective form.

Not merely a positive magnitude like the earth, but even such negative forms of sense as darkness and night, such essentialities as Tartarus, Erebus and Nyx, absorb the idea’s reality through the word, are individualized in the word and become living figures by means of the word. Breathed through and moved by the idea, the word has not merely the peculiar power that, as the highest and deepest of language, it is able to gather the relativity-determinations, which in the propositions of speech are piecemeal presented, described and developed, into pregnant unity-expressions; but as

a member in the proposition, as an element in language, the word has at the same time that suppleness, flexibility, mobility and relativity, that in the most diverse connections it can be now for sense, now for thought, now figurative, now literal, can unite what it has itself separated, separate what it has itself united, can, member by member and point by point, illuminate the real by the ideal, the pictorial by the non-pictorial, the immediate by the reflected. Once the word has become a god, and the god a word, then it stands in the power of subjectivity to let this god of the word appear in the most adventurous situations, undergo the most remarkable transformations, show itself from the most diverse sides, thinking, desiring, acting, suffering.

The mythical word, which transforms the particular ideas into god-figures, at the same time transforms the ideal movements into actual events; this transformation is decisively characteristic with respect to the mythical essence of the idea-forming functions. In that the ideas' strife with material actuality, and through actuality's elementary oppositions their mutual strife with one another, is transformed into a [80] history of the gods' battles, the magical unity of idea and actuality is upon the ways of the word brought to that turning point at which the mythical identity of the ideal and the real swings over into dualism, and the illusion shows itself.

The colossal audacity with which the thinking imagination, impregnated by the idea, defies probability at the sight of working gods is an eloquent testimony to the word's power in the objectified events. The age of the gods, the distant past, is the golden age of the ideas, of the ideal causes; the present with its facts is the age of actuality, of the conditions and of the material causes: can the two ages indeed become one age? In the mirror of the word, i.e. of narration, of recollection, the past does indeed reflect itself in the present as the great fundamental ideas in the actual results of development; but actuality with its thing-causes reacts with the power of the present against those ideal presuppositions; the consequence is a discord between the thing and the word, a discord between the objective and the subjective, a discord between content and form, imagination and thought, a discord that awakens criticism, sublates the standpoint and sets the idea-forming functions new and higher tasks.

Gnostic Functions. In principle mythology is different from poetry; for the myth, which has magical objectivity, is without illusion, whereas poetry as poetry essentially

presupposes consciousness of illusion. Since consciousness, however, can advance continuously from dim intimation to clear cognition, can as in a waking dream be at one and the same time in the power of illusion and have a knowledge of the illusion: it is intelligible enough that mythology has been able to pass over just as imperceptibly into folk poetry as folk poetry in turn into art poetry. But for that [81] reason the separation of illusion and actuality nonetheless remains just as decisive for the stage of consciousness with which poetry begins.

In proportion as the mythical content is transfigured in the forms of poetry, the understanding, which sees the illusion, will tear itself loose from the imagination, make front against the actual and strive to orient itself in the world of things. But the world of things is sensuous, finite, material and to that extent idea-less. Separated from the imagination, the understanding is at the same time separated from the idea. But the idea-forsaken understanding has an essential need of ideality; the understanding is in principle rational: here philosophy begins. Poetry with its idea-filled illusions and philosophy with its formal concepts now form extremes with the sensuously concrete world between them. In order to vindicate the idea, the ideal powers, poetry and philosophy, work each from its own side at dissolving, transforming and transfiguring the outwardly actual; but actuality is strong, and the battle hard. For reinforcement in the hard battle, reflection, enfeebled among universal concepts, then feels a need to fill the empty forms with intuitable content by renewing the old covenant between intuition and thinking, reflection and imagination; on these terms the idea-forming functions become *gnostic*.

It is gnosticism's essence, and not a determinate historical figure of gnosticism, that we here have in view; only insofar can regard be had to the historical phenomenon as this phenomenon is in a peculiar sense fitted to make the essence manifest. The re-established union of understanding and imagination is recognizable by the word, the word recognizable by the categories that bear the intuition. Here one does not essentially begin with chaos. Chaos is platonically reduced to pure emptiness, an expression for the essential nothingness of the sensuous; thus chaos is nothingness, negative being, *Kenoma*. That the material and sensuous in all-existence is reduced to *Kenoma* is in gnosticism an indication that the beginning, the real beginning of

development, cannot be sought in the physically objective, in sensuous reality, but [82] must be sought in the essentially subjective, in overreaching ideality. In categorical opposition to *Kenoma*, the objectively sensuous empty, there stands then *Pleroma*, the realm of ideas, the region of power and of fullness.

Insofar as gnostic thinking gives itself over to intuitions of the imagination, Pleroma is an objective thought-image in likeness to the mythical chaos; but a closer consideration of this thought-image soon shows us that in Pleroma we have to do with a realm of subjectivity, of spirituality and inwardness. Pleroma's original unity is in *the Depth* and *the Silence* (βυθός and σιγή). In and for itself the depth can now indeed designate something objective just as well as something subjective; but already *the Silence*, not the stillness, lets us surmise that the depth is in subjectivity. The surmise becomes certainty when the opposition's first abstract form is more closely determined by a following, more concrete opposition, the opposition between *the Primal Father* and *the Thought* (προπάτωρ and ἔννοια). If we cast besides a glance at the ever increasing concretions in which the original opposition repeats itself by degrees, the opposition of *Reason* and *Truth* (νοῦς and ἀλήθεια), *the Word* and *Life*, etc., then we recognize in Pleroma a realm of subjectivities and of ontologically subjective content.

How peculiar the fusion of image and concept is in the gnostic Pleroma strikes the eye when we note the immediacy in which the word-meaning of the categories set up, indeed even the gender of the words, is apprehended and employed. That the categories: the Depth and the Silence, the Primal Father and the Thought, Reason and Truth, etc., are hypostatized essentialities, logical personifications, can be seen from a translation too; but the linguistic contingencies which the imagining thinking has employed in these personifications are discovered only by a glance at the original text. The designations of the pleromatic hypostases are namely chosen in such a way that the one is always a masculine word, the other correspondingly a feminine [83] word: βυθός, προπάτωρ, νοῦς, λόγος ... are masculine words, whereas σιγή, ἔννοια, ἀλήθεια, ζωή ... are feminine words.

By this division, a fundamental division which in its kind corresponds to Hegel's objective judgment (das Urtheil, derived from urtheilen), a certain equilibrium between reflection and imagination is brought about. Reflection demands that Pleroma's funda-

mental division shall in all repetitions yield oppositions of totality-concepts. This is in a certain manner attained by the categories indicated; λόγος, νοῦς, ἔννοια, ἀλήθεια are true totality-categories. Likewise there is here, by the categorical oppositions, designated a progression from the abstract toward the concrete, from the universal through the particular toward the individual; for it must be conceded that βυθὸς and σιγὴ are more abstract than νοῦς and ἀλήθεια, these in turn more abstract than ἄνθρωπος and ἐκκλησία. Indeed, so ingeniously is the series laid out that reflection can even, if it be demanded, give a logical account of the progress. The more abstract doublings form, namely, the foundation for the more concrete; these are, to speak in Hegel's language, mediations of the former. Thus λόγος and ζωή are evidently mediations of νοῦς and ἀλήθεια, since νοῦς by means of ἀλήθεια becomes λόγος, ἀλήθεια must by means of νοῦς naturally become ζωή, etc.

But if reflection is satisfied in a spirited manner, the imagination is no less so: ingenuity and spiritedness are in general essential marks of all gnosticism, the more recent as well as the older. That the imagination has had its share in the spirited choice of categories of opposition is seen from the manner in which the chosen masculine and feminine words support the personification. According to the personification, every categorical pair is a married pair, husband and wife: deified forms, and yet not mythical gods!

[84] The difference between the mythical and the gnostic is now striking; what a distance between a pleromatic hypostasis with its abstract-metaphysical habitus, in its ideality ingeniously measured out by reflection, and one of mythology's gods or goddesses, which individualizes itself in the finite, plays with the contingent and teems with reality! In gnosticism the imagination no longer has thought in its power, and just as little can thought be said to have the imagination in its power. The alliance in which both, imagination and thought, were properly to strengthen each other is conditioned by an accommodation whereby they mutually weaken each other: the imagination becomes thoughtful, and thought fantastical.

That gnostic reflection aims at idea and ideality with a quite other consciousness than the mythical does is a matter of course. The ingenious and spirited is then also seen in the manner in which the particular ideas are represented by the hypostases in

Pleroma. In this respect too the word makes its immediacy felt by the name. Every one of the pleromatic hypostases bears, as is well known, the name of aeon (αἰὼν). What does aeon mean? A world-age and an eternity! thus an eternity enclosed by time, set in the ring of time, an individualized absolute. As an individualized absolute every one of Pleroma's aeons is then a particular totality, a relative Pleroma in itself, in other words: an idea. That the one aeon has the other for its opposition then means that the one idea has the other for its opposition: the particular aeons have each its place in Pleroma, the particular ideas have each its place in the system of the ideas.

It is a distinguishing mark of the gnostic functions that they cannot reconcile the unbounded with the boundary or master concretion. As regards the unbounded and the boundary, gnosticism hovers incessantly between the oriental and the Greek way of viewing. It will in Greek spirit individualize the absolute, and one should then to that extent suppose that the most concrete aeons would have to occupy the highest place in Pleroma; but on the contrary! Gnosticism, with its oriental respect for the [85] unbounded, the infinite, has a decided predilection for the abstract; it is precisely the abstract aeons (βυθὸς and σιγή) that occupy the highest or, if one will, the deepest place, the central place, in the realm of "the fullness". The strife between the bounded and the unbounded, a strife that originally smoulders in the whole of Pleroma, then also comes at last to open breakthrough in the catastrophe with Sophia.

It is an ingenious, profound trait in the Valentinian gnosis that Sophia, the deeply grounding aeon of the aeons, this idea comprehending the ideas, is seized by an irresistible longing to behold the Propator. Instead of an absorption in the concrete, wisdom's feminine, receptive aeon thus chooses a return to the abstract, as to the originally productive; instead of cognizing the indeterminate as negative determinateness in the concrete and thereby determinate idea, Sophia, the bounded, will immediately embrace the boundless one: the guardian of the boundary (ὄρος) is not able to hold her back. Sophia's fall and restoration; matter, which in Kenoma's darkness is formed out of her anguish, her tears and laughter; the birth of the Demiurge (the world-aeon) from the fallen Sophia; the creation of the world by the imprisonment of light in the darkness; the redemption by the return of the soul-light to Pleroma, etc., all this together presents a manifold of ingenious traits, which all show how the imagining

thinking has transformed the movements in the realm of ideas into illusory events.

With the old gnostic systems scientific criticism has long since finished; but gnosticism's marks of recognition: an ambiguous unity of thoughtful imagining and fantastical thinking, ingenious turns and spirited expressions instead of clear concepts and categorically decisive determinations; direction to deeper beholding and dramatizing depiction of supernatural events instead of penetrating investigation of [86] eternal fundamental relations: these and similar peculiarities continue still⁴¹ to draw the logician's attention to the gnostic functions.

Theosophical Functions. In the mythical word it is the imagination that unconditionally has thought in its power; in the gnostic word there is a unity of imagination and thought reflected in approximation; in the theosophical word it is thought that immediately masters the imagination, yet in such a way that, where logical determinations are concerned, it prefers to make use of the imagination. That theosophical thought has the imagination in its power by a magic of the idea appears at once from this, that whereas the mythically absolute is involuntarily parceled out into relative figures, the finitizing relativity is consumed by the theosophically absolute. But when thinking divests the absolute of all relative determinations, the form of course vanishes: the form of the absolute, the absolute form, is formless.

The theosophical is in this respect more nearly akin to the mystical than to the mythical. The mythical too has indeed a strife between the form and the formless; but it is the imagination, not thought, whom the strife most nearly concerns. For theosophy it is expressly not the imagination, but reflection, that is essentially interested in giving form to the formless. The formless has in thought's absolute no immediate, elementary determinate being, such as it has, so far as mythology is concerned, in chaos and the oldest gods. The formless is for the theosophist on the contrary reflected in the negation that has removed the finite. And yet the theosophical consciousness cannot be sated with empty infinity; theosophy's gaze is fixed upon the in-itself absolute, upon God as God, thus upon an affirmative determinateness.

Theosophical reflection is naive; the naivety is recognized by the restless unity [87] of the negative and the affirmative: this reflection of the form in formlessness recalls

⁴¹As e.g. in speculative dogmatics.

mysticism⁴². But theosophy is nevertheless different from pure mysticism in this, that it lays weight upon determinateness and wills an absolute form for the absolute. Thought's absolute is the idea; language's absolute is the word; the task is to find an immediate expression for the absolute ideality, or — in naive reflection — to find the name by which God names himself, the word in which God reveals himself, the language that the Godhead speaks.

But is it now also certain that God himself speaks a language? Is the Godhead not the infinite depth (βυθός)? Must not the depth be grounded in eternal silence (σιγή)? To this the theosophist must answer: "A Godhead without language, a God without a word is a dreaming Godhead, a thoughtless God; for language is thought's revelation, all thinking is essentially a speaking." — But is it possible for a human being to form for himself any concept of the Godhead's language, to think the divine speaking? See, human language has in sound, in the trembling of the air, a sensuous element, an immediate material, which thought can naturally form into words and propositions. But now there is surely no one who can represent to himself that the Godhead's mouth should set either the air or the water or the ether in vibrations, in order in such vibrations to have a sensuous element, an immediate material, in which the divine thought could articulate its first revelation? To this the theosophist must answer: "The divine language-element has its immediacy in the ideal power, but this immediacy is not outwardly sensuous. How far the language-element original in the Godhead's speaking ought most nearly to be compared with something sensuous, with light-phenomena or with sound-phenomena or with both, is not decisive for the ontology of language; but this is decisive, that the language-forming functions must [88] condition the thought-forming — just as originally in the ontological subjectivity as in the psychological; this is decisive, that the language-element in its divine immediacy must bend itself for thought itself into words and propositions and judgments." But how is it possible that the divine language can, in likeness to the human, consist in a system of propositions and judgments, when the Godhead is therein to utter its essence's inwardness, an original unity of knowledge and power? If the word is with God and itself God from the beginning, then this word must surely, in divine unity of

⁴²Mysticism makes the word itself negative. "Gott ist ein lauter Nichts, Ihn rührt kein Nun noch Hier, Je mehr Du nach ihn greifst, Je mehr entwid er Dir." Angelus Silesius.

knowledge and power, be absolutely substantial; but the human word, the impotent word, is without substantiality. To this the theosophist must answer: "The Godhead-word and the divine language are in the idea the same and yet different. In language the manifold is uttered, the relative, the many visions, representations, reflections and judgments; from this side of relativity and manifoldness human language has in formal respect an undeniable likeness to the divine. But what in language is a relative is in the word an absolute. The Godhead-word is the absolute itself. Here is seen the deep chasm between the human word and the divine Logos. In the human word, the content-expression of human thoughts developed by language, the idea can indeed mirror itself; but the mirroring is only formal: the word developed in human language cannot become one substance with the idea. It is otherwise with the almighty Godhead-word: it develops its content in wisdom's language, it unfolds its riches in systems of systems of divine judgments; but while it during the development determines all judgments, moves all propositions, penetrates, fulfills and completes the infinite totality of concepts and form-determinations, it is itself alone the totality's absolute and yet immediate form-unity. With this absolute but immediate form-unity [89] the word is the idea's first revelation, is in absolute substantiality one with the idea, the idea itself: the word is God."

In the above speeches we have let the theosophist utter his guiding thought according to the sense, for the sake of understanding, but not in his own language, thus not in theosophical form. For the elucidation of the theosophical form we cast a glance at Philo.

1) *The Word and God in Ambiguous Unity*. The Philonic principal category is, as is well known, the category Logos; but whether Philo for the rest apprehends Logos as identical with God or as a being different from God, whether this being is to be assumed to be personal or impersonal, about this the interpreters have hitherto not been able to agree⁴³. The theosophical reflection chooses in all naivety different points of departure, without heeding the contradictions that arise when heterogeneous ways of viewing are to be resolved into one another. On the one side Logos is then presented as a being identical with God, as God's thinking (λογισμὸς τοῦ θεοῦ), as

⁴³Cf. G. Steenberg. *Om Synspunktet for Opfattelsen af Philos Gudserkjendelse*. Kjøbenhavn 1849. S. 84–125.

God's word (ῥῆμα), God's oath (ὄρκος), God's law (νόμος), God's covenant (διαθήκη). But just as immediately Logos is set up on the other side as a being for itself, as the bond (δεσμός) that binds together all things (περιέχων τὰ πάντα), which, "in order to hinder everything from going astray, is thought of as stretched out from the one end of the world to the other"; Logos is "the divine wisdom that streams through the world; the world is this wisdom's garment; wisdom itself is ὁ τῆς φύσεως ὀρθὸς λόγος." Although Logos in both these apprehensions is impersonal, yet other points of view again present themselves, from which Logos is expressly seen as a personal being, as a god subordinated to God himself (δεύτερος θεὸς, πρωτόγονος υἱός), etc.

Theosophical reflection is everywhere recognized by this, that thought, that which [90] fundamentally moves, pushes itself in under abstract intuitions, and lets the totality-moments remain standing in immediate independence. Theosophical reflection is in its naivety uncritical; if the naivety now vanishes, while the uncritical use of intellectual intuitions is forced up into a higher science of revelation resting upon faith, then we have dogmatic speculation. In dogmatic speculation Logos is then also, as "the heart of God the Father, at the same time the eternal world-heart through which the divine life streams into the creation. He is ground and source of all reason in the creation", etc. etc.

2) *The Word and God in Ambiguous Opposition.* The theosophical reflection, which posits the unity of God and Logos immediately, posits at the same time the opposition immediately, and sublates again the posited opposition just as immediately; hence that swarm of contradictions which criticism so easily discovers. If these contradictions are to be resolved, then the indeterminate unity must be developed into opposition, in order that the opposition, the totality-division, the idea-filled judgment, may again be resolved into developed unity. It is, be it noted, developments of the concept and not new revelations upon which in this respect what essentially matters depends.

Speculative dogmatics assures us that on the ground of its new revelation it finds itself highly exalted above the old "Alexandrian philosophy of religion". "One has often", it runs, "compared the Logos-doctrine of revelation with the Alexandrian philosophy of religion; indeed the assertion has often been uttered that John must have borrowed his Logos-doctrine from the Jew Philo. But here the most determinate

opposition takes place. For Philo history transforms itself into a world of seeming, the historical facts into an allegory for universal thoughts and ideas. For Philo there is a yawning abyss fixed between ‘word’ and ‘flesh’ (λόγος and σὰρξ); for sensuousness [91] and nature are to him only a prison of the spirit, and only by a mystical rapture away from actuality, only by the mortification of sensuousness can the thinker be united with the divine reason.”

If now in science it were merely a matter of bringing “flesh” into the Word and “word” into the flesh; if the knot were untied as soon as speculation, with pathos, merely went on repeating its λόγος σὰρξ ἐγένετο: then dogmatics would undeniably celebrate a great triumph over the Philonic “philosophy of religion”. But if development of the concept is really required here, it will be easy to show that dogmatics, despite its many triumphant assurances, has not come a hair’s breadth further than Philo.

If “sensuousness” and “nature” are to be able to be taken up as integrating moments in the Logos, the concept of the Logos must originally be so determined that the real is present in the ideal, that, in other words, immediacy breaks through from the beginning. This is now not the case in Philo. The defect in Philo is just this, that the Logos is one-sidedly apprehended as thought (λόγος νοητός), not at the same time as the Word, that Word which in the identity of immediacy is one with thought only insofar as it is thought’s other, opposed to thought. But the same defect repeats itself in speculative dogmatics; here too there is no hint of the ideal reality of the language-element, or any trace of the primitive immediacy of the Word; immediacy comes first when we come to “the flesh”. The defect in Philo is further this, that the ideal world, the original content of the Logos (κόσμος νοητός), lacks essential articulation, because here all consciousness is lacking of the method valid for such an articulation⁴⁴. But the same, the very same lack repeats itself in speculative dogmatics. Here too we peer, in the midst of “playing possibilities”, “plastic prototypes” and [92] “magical actualities”, in vain for an articulating principle; for a reference to “the free, artistic activity of spirit” is naturally idle, so long as one is not, by means of something resembling a concept, in a position to state what is really meant here by the plastic art and the magical arts of spirit. In Philo wisdom (σοφία), the Logos and the powers

⁴⁴Cf. Grundideernes Logik I. p. 178–220.

(δυνάμεις) are separated and mingled with every possible arbitrariness: now Sophia is the source from which the Logos springs, now again the Logos is the source of Sophia. The same, the very same up-there-and-down-here of the representations we find again in speculative dogmatics, when “the magical visions that play before God’s countenance in the inner self-revelation must be thought to determine themselves for God as decrees for the creation” etc. Philo lacks consciousness of the fact that the logical in the ideal system (κόσμος νοητός) lets itself be developed only in the reflection of the antilogical moments of the real system⁴⁵. The weak point in Philo is therefore the obscurity with which he hypostatizes the Logos now as a divine person (δεύτερος θεός), now again as world-essence, the cosmic principle, (ὁ τῆς φύσεως ὀρθὸς λόγος), the reason indwelling in the world, which sows the germs of life (λόγος σπερματικός). But the same, the very same obscurity reigns in speculative dogmatics, and for the same, the very same reason. Without theosophical naïveté dogmatic speculation knows how, in a naïveté of its own, to operate both with “the Logos of the Father” and with “the world-Logos”, and with “the world-germs” (λόγος σπερματικός) and with “the second God” (δεύτερος θεός) and with “the originating ideas” and with other things of the sort.

3) *The Word and God in Developed Unity-in-Opposition*. Logic is not theosophy; but in the theosophical functions there works something rational which logic must strive to clarify. When the form of the judgment is to contain the idea, the absolute content, there shows itself a fundamental division, whereby the one and the same [93] totality of totalities divides itself into two originally opposed forms, the form of selfhood or of subjectivity and the form of otherness or of objectivity. With the form of selfhood the absolute content is reflected into unity, essentiality, inwardness and ground; in this inwardness the depth is the silent thought that breaks the silence. As the infinite subjectivity which in the deep silence lifts the silence and utters its content, the Godhead is not the Word itself, but *the origin of the Word*. With the form of otherness the absolute content is articulated in manifoldness, in difference, thus a totality distinctly marked in its members; the logical element of speech, that is to say, of the revelation of thought, a primitive immediacy in which the judgment separates

⁴⁵Grundideernes Logik I. p. 224–229.

what is united and unites what is separated, is as totalized unity *the Word*. The Word in its immediacy is not the Godhead, but its revelation; not subjectivity itself, but its objectified content. The absolute totality has by the two opposed forms become two opposed totalities: the Godhead and the Word.

But when the form of the judgment is to contain the idea, the absolute content, the fundamental division, whereby the subjective totality resting in selfhood is set over against the objective totality in the immediate-mediate unfolding of otherness, must necessarily have a connecting link, a middle, a unity-in-opposition, in which the extremes meet. By virtue of the totalized unity-in-opposition the Word in its opposition to God is one with God: the Word is God. In its unity with God the Word is the objectified God (ὁ δεύτερος θεός).

As the self objectifying itself God is the origin of the Word; as the objectified self God is identical with the Word. But as the God objectified in himself the Word is not merely one with God, but by reason of the objectification at the same time opposed to God: in its objectified opposition to God the Word is not God, but a world in God, the ideal world (κόσμος νοητός).

[94] But how does it really come about that the same absolute content, this same totality objectified in the Godhead, can become both God himself (πρωτόγονος υἱός, δεύτερος θεός) and a world in God different from God? It lies in the idea of the judgment! Here there is in the objectified totality a decisive tension between selfhood and otherness, reflection and immediacy, the unity of the content and the content of the unity. If the emphasis falls upon selfhood, and upon the content-unity reflected in selfhood, then we have in the objectified totality the objectified Godhead, God himself in his own objectification. If, on the other hand, the emphasis falls upon otherness and upon the development by which the content of the unity is totalized in the immediate-mediate relational determinations of the parts, then we have the objectified totality as a connection-unity articulated in manifoldness and difference, thus a world in ideal determinate being, a world in God, different from God, an ideal world.

But the ideal world, the ideal world-totality, could not possibly form an essential opposition to the Godhead objectified therein, if this ideal world were not originally in totalized opposition to its real world. The ideal and the real world have in reality the

same content, but in ideality, by the difference of form corresponding to the idea of the judgment, to the fundamental division, they have each its own content: in its ideal world the Word is a word of knowledge, but in its real world it is a word of power. Only by unity-in-opposition with the word of power does the word of knowledge, and with it the ideal world, acquire ideal independence.

It has been developed from several sides in the doctrine of subjectivity⁴⁶ that “the acts of thought” in the ideal system cannot possibly coincide with “the acts of nature” in the real system. But in the first treatment of the problem it could not yet be seen in what manner the idea-movement in ontological subjectivity could free itself from [95] the real movement in the outer world of actual objects; now, on the contrary, the problem is solved. If the Word in the articulation of propositions and judgments is a divine language; if the thoughts of the Godhead have inner, ideal existence in the ideal language in which they have their first revelation; if the word in which the infinite wealth of uttered thoughts has totalized unity is the word of the divine knowledge: then it follows from this that the ideal world must have inner independence in a divine thinking and speaking.

The ideal and the real world are, however, not merely in opposition, but — what indeed also lies in the idea of the judgment — at the same time in unity-in-opposition. If the judgment corresponding to the idea demands an opposition of the Word in knowledge and the Word in power, then the idea of the judgment must necessarily also demand a totalized unity of the word of knowledge and the word of power.

β) Judgment and Object: Functions of the Word of Power.

It has been shown from several sides in “the Logic of Subjectivity”⁴⁷ how the same content can, in the form of knowledge and in that of power, in the logical form of the concept and the antilogical form of existence, transform itself and become a double content. This doubling was then reflected through by means of the word, without its yet being possible to reflect upon the word. In the present connection, where reflection is expressly directed upon the word as word, the task returns with heightened emphasis; the task is to show how the concept-content in the word of

⁴⁶Grundideernes Logik I. p. 210 ff.

⁴⁷Grundideernes Logik I. p. 145–166; 201–204; 255–263.

knowledge and the existence-content in the word of power presuppose and determine each other to infinity. Inasmuch as the concept acquires ideal independence in the word of knowledge, while existence steps forth as an object for itself determined by [96] the word of power, they at first glance fall so far apart from one another that it seems as though they were wholly indifferent toward one another. On the one side it indeed looks as though the concept, after it has received ideal determinate being in the word, could be formed, developed and held fast either for itself or in connection with other concepts, without regard to whether there were in existence any object corresponding to this concept or not. On the other side it appears as though the existing objects, subsisting in the word of power, were wholly indifferent, not indeed toward being objectified, but yet toward the peculiar development of the concept to which their objectification may give subjectivity occasion. How, then, do we determine the relation between concept and thing, judgment and object?

Formal logic treats the task in its own way, in that, for orientation in the domain of thinking, it makes a distinction between our concept of the object and the object's concept, but not, on the other hand, between our judgment about the object and the object's judgment; it distinguishes between the object's concept and the object itself, but not between the object's judgment and the object; thus between the concept in the subjective and the concept in the objective sense, but not between the judgment in the subjective and the judgment in the objective sense. We shall now see what value can be attached to these distinctions.

The difference between the concept in the subjective and the concept in the objective sense cannot possibly, when the concept itself is looked at, be any logical difference. Were there any logical difference here, it would have to be conditioned by our subjective concept of the thing containing either more or fewer or at any rate other determinations than the thing's objective concept; but in that case the *subjective* concept would become the same as a *false* concept, which cannot be the meaning. But if the subjective concept has the same logical content as the objective, then the difference falls away: the subjective concept is in its truth objective; our true concept of the thing is the thing's concept.

[97] Just as untenable is the distinction set up between the object's concept and the

object itself. The object's concept, it is said, is the "intellectual" and the "underlying" in the object, that which constitutes the object's "nature and essence." But how is it possible to separate an object's nature and essence from the object itself? What remains of an object when its nature and essence are thought away? If that in the object which does not constitute its nature and essence does not belong to its concept, then it must be something so contingent that it really does not concern the object at all; if, on the other hand, there must necessarily be here, besides that which constitutes the object's nature and essence, yet something else, something which, without concerning its "nature and essence," essentially and necessarily belongs to its existence, then it lies in the object's nature and essence to have something which does not concern its "nature and essence:" what then may that something be?

It is said that the object itself is "the real outward", the sensuous exterior, whereas the concept is "the inner, ideal and underlying". But when "the real outward" constitutes the object itself, the actual object, then "the inner, ideal and underlying" must in actuality fall outside the object⁴⁸. Nor can it help that one would make the inward [98] "the constitutive," the outward "the consecutive"; for in the object as object, and here there is question only of the actual object, the inward is object just as much as the outward: here there is not an object that goes around a concept, not a concept that sits inside an object; here there is, in the object, within and without, only object.

⁴⁸A. Here, then, in one and the same existence there are two existents, namely the existing object and the concept existing in the object? C. No, it cannot be taken that way; it is not the object itself, but its material, that is opposed to the concept. A. Then presumably we get three existents: the existing material, the existing concept, and that existence of the object in which both exist? C. No, neither can one take it that way. A. How then is one to take it? C. The material by itself is not a separate existent, any more than the concept is, but the material and the concept are two sides, namely two existence-sides of the same existing One, the object. A. The existing One is, then, in opposition to and over against the two existence-sides, that which exists in and for itself? C. No, neither can one take it that way, for if we let abstraction take away the two existence-sides, the existing unity will itself become an abstractum, an existence-side that does not exist. A. But how then is one to take it? C. In such a way that the existing unity is seen to exist in the two existence-sides, which then precisely thereby come to exist in inseparable unity A. But what is material in the object is surely something sensuous, which as sensuous cannot be thought, and what is intellectual in the object something non-sensuous, something thinkable, which cannot be sensed? C. Perfectly correct. A. In the existing unity, then, the unthinkable is nevertheless a thinkable, the non-sensuous a sensuous. C. That I do not understand!" A. But you do, on the other hand, no doubt understand that the ideal, the inner and the underlying, which constitutes the object's "nature and essence", is not the real, the outer, the existing, which precisely constitutes the nature and essence of the object, of the actual object! Cf. *Forelæsninger over phil. Propæd.* Universitetsaar 1860-61. p. 26-27.

How obscure the distinction between the object and the concept existing in the object is, is best seen when the relation between concept and judgment is to be more closely determined. One cannot — so we are assured in formal logic — use the word judgment in an objective sense, as one uses the word concept: “one cannot say that in the same manner in which a concept can come to meet us in an object, a judgment too can come to meet us.” And why not? Because one has once for all got it into one’s head that inside the objective object there sits an objectively existing concept. But as soon [99] as one by carrying reflection through has got the better of this fixed idea, and has seen that the concept which “can come to meet us in an object” is precisely our own concept corresponding to the object, one will also at once see that the judgment, the true judgment corresponding to the object, has the same objectivity as the true concept. That no judgment can come to meet us in the object is indeed certain, insofar as there cannot be given a judgment about the object objectively existing in the object; but the same holds of the concept. If the object cannot come forward with a judgment about itself, with a judgment objectively judging itself, then neither can it come forward with a concept of itself, with a concept objectively comprehending itself. If the judgment about the object falls within the judging subjectivity, then the concept of the object, the object’s objective concept, assuredly falls within the comprehending subjectivity as well; if the concept does not lose its objective validity because it must absolutely be comprehended by subjectivity, then neither does the judgment lose its objectivity because it is a subjectivity that judges.

The relation between concept and existence, between judgment and object, is in principle a fundamental relation between word and word, between the word of knowledge and the word of power. The content is the same; but the form is different: in the word of knowledge the content is concept, and the concept is uttered in the judgment; in the word of power the content is existence, and the existent is the object of the judgment. Seen from the side of the concept it is nonetheless the form that becomes the same, while the difference falls in the content; and the same holds when the matter is seen from the standpoint of the object. To be sure, in the concept of the object, if one will, in the object’s concept, a difference must be made between what in the act of comprehending belongs to the concept and what on account of

existence belongs to the object; but so long as the separation of conceptual and object-determinations falls under the concept, the concept of the object-determinations must anew resolve itself into conceptual determinations. The form for both kinds of determination thus becomes the same; the difference falls upon the content: in the totality of the conceptual determinations the content is logical; in the concept of the totality of the object-determinations the content is antilogical. [100]

“But the antilogical content must surely have a corresponding antilogical form; the object-determinations are antilogical in form as well as in content;” so runs the judgment about the object from the standpoint of the object. Since now the judgment about the object cannot be separated from the judgment about the judgment without the separation becoming idle, the judgment runs to the same effect from the standpoint of subjectivity as well. The object-determinations expressed in the judgment will then, for the judging consciousness, set themselves sharply against the universal, will in the object’s name individualize themselves with antilogical punctuality, and the form will thus be antilogical. The form turned toward the logical then now stands for consciousness in a logical mirroring of an antilogical and yet logical content. The doubling of the content shows itself again: in itself, as object-content, the content is antilogical like the form, but in the *logical* mirroring of the *antilogical* form the content is logical.

To determine the relation between judgment and object is by no means the same as to show the identity of judgment and content. The latter task is logical in the sense that it can restrict itself to a development of pure conceptual determinations; the former task, on the other hand, is logical in the sense that the antilogical itself demands a logical explanation. It is the logic of the antilogical forms, one of the most difficult portions in the whole of philosophy, that matters in this connection. If we had to do only with logical forms and corresponding content-determinations, the functions would all without exception be functions of the word of knowledge; the highest would be attained when the form of the judgment was so far developed that the fundamental division corresponded to the idea. The antilogical sting, which, so to speak, palpably affects the content and brings it about that the object of the judgment sets itself sharply [101] against the judgment, without the identity of judgment and content being allowed

to be given up, awakens on the contrary everywhere a knowledge of opposition between power and knowledge, and makes the word of power the foundation of the functions. The functions are logical; the word of power is antilogical; the infinite reciprocal determination of the logical and the antilogical which hereby arises requires an illumination of judgment and object from the standpoint of knowledge, from that of power, and, by unity-in-opposition of knowledge and power, from that of the idea. We designate these standpoints in what follows by: *Knowledge of Judgment and Object*, *Power in Judgment and Object*, *The Idea in Judgment and Object*.

αα) Knowledge of Judgment and Object: Theoretical Functions. In psychological dualism the surrounding world with its objects stands outwardly over against the contemplating, thinking, judging consciousness. That the object in its immediate independence falls outside the judgment; that the judgment concerns only the consciousness of the object, while the object itself is indifferent toward consciousness: this one-sided way of regarding the matter is to such a degree rooted in so-called sound common sense that philosophy must for that very reason find itself called upon from all sides to work against its one-sidedness. No doubt in the immediate sense the actual object falls outside the judging consciousness; but what essentially makes the separation between the object and consciousness is precisely the judgment about consciousness and object. That with respect to the object's independence it depends just as essentially upon the judgment as upon the object, is something that escapes the immediate sense. To the immediate sense the matter appears as though the object came to meet consciousness by itself from without, while yet it is just as originally consciousness that comes to meet the object from within; "sound understanding" overlooks that the object is only outside consciousness because it is judged and by the [102] judgment set to stand over against consciousness. Take away the judgment, that judgment of instinct upon which all separation between the subjective and the objective, the outward and the inward, essentially rests, and the object will instantly coincide with consciousness in such a way that here there is neither object nor consciousness.

If the judging subjectivity posits the separation between itself and the object in the judgment, then it is also seen from this that the distinction between judgment and object must likewise rest upon the judgment. But that the distinction between

judgment and object rests upon the judgment presupposes in turn that the identity of judgment and object rests upon the judgment. That there is here in the judgment a knowledge of the object in its express opposition to the judgment is grounded, then, in there being here in the judgment a knowledge of the object's identity with the judgment: the double knowledge is in the judgment itself one and the same knowledge. In the reflection of this two-sided knowledge, hovering above judgment and object, the functions are *theoretical*.

It is a distinguishing mark of all theory that the object of knowledge determines knowledge, and not conversely; but here there is now a double knowledge, a knowledge of the judgment in its relation to the object, and a knowledge of the object in its relation to the judgment; knowledge has, in other words, a double object: an *ideal* one, namely the judgment as judgment, and a *real*, the object as object. Theory will not arbitrarily alter anything either in the judgment or in the object, but take them in their reciprocity, as they are in themselves. The problem is seen from the following questions: Is it the judgment that essentially determines the object, or the object that determines the judgment, or is there here a reciprocal determination? Does the truth of cognition rest upon the mere likeness between the determinations in the judgment and the object-determinations, or must a transformation take place here in order that the object-determinations may become identical with the knowledge-determinations [103] contained in the judgment?

If theory starts from the presupposition that the determinations in judgment and object are heterogeneous, and that between heterogeneous determinations there can be given only a parallelism on the ground of likeness, not a transition conditioned by transformation, then agreement as mere and bare parallelism steps into the place of identity, and psychological dualism must then seek its principle of cognition in a presupposition standing above consciousness. Thus:

1) *Parallelism of Judgment and Object: Supposing Functions*. The existing object is in its outward immediacy something sensuous, the content of the judgment something thinkable; the sensuous is heterogeneous with the thinkable: it lies near at hand, then, to apprehend the sense-phenomena and the thought-determinations as two series which may indeed yield a parallelism, but no identity.

Thus it is, according to Plato, not the sensuous in things, but the ideas in which the things of sense have come to partake, that let themselves be thought. That judgment and object can agree in true thinking is conditioned by the same ideas which reveal themselves subjectively in thinking revealing themselves objectively in things. Whence, now, does the judging subjectivity know that the ideas reveal themselves objectively in things, or, what is the same, that things partake of the objective ideas? The assumption rests upon a presupposition immediately slipped under by thought itself. How immediate and objective this slipping-under is, is seen from the myth of pre-existence with the corresponding doctrine of recollection (ἀνάμνησις).

What is characteristic of the supposition is the naïveté with which subjective reflection comes objectively by its own assumptions. First it is assumed that thought can think only the ideas, since the ideas alone are beings of thought. By holding fast [104] to this assumption thinking would obviously not get beyond its own subjectivity; the judgment would in other words have only a logical content, not an antilogical object. Since, however, the object in its outer independence obtrudes itself involuntarily, thought is, without rightly knowing of it, moved to lay its subjective content objectively into things and thus to make these partake of the ideas. The ideas are now in things themselves objective, not subjective, since in thinking they are subjective, not objective. The original agreement of subjective and objective, upon which thought builds as upon an objective given, it has subjectively given itself.

The slipped-under foundation of the supposing functions comes forward still more strongly in Cartesius and, after him, in Malebranche and Leibnitz. The presupposition is a separation of the intellectual and the material, determined by a gulf between thinking and extension insurmountable for the relative substances. A direct reciprocal action of the representations in the circle of consciousness with the things in the surrounding world is from this standpoint wholly impossible. As little as a representation or a concept can become an efficient cause of a change in the world of things, just as little can a physical impression bring about the formation either of a corresponding representation or of a concept. That the representations in consciousness and the things in the surrounding world, without thoroughgoing reciprocal action, merely form parallels, is equally decisive for theory, whether with Malebranche we appeal to

an omnipotence working unceasingly through occasional causes, or with Leibnitz to a *harmonia præstabilita*.⁴⁹

Although Cartesius must admit to himself that the essence of a triangle, e.g., is so [105] perfectly determined that the many qualities which can be proved of it depend upon [106] thought in such a way that the thinker must cognize them whether he will or not, he still dare not, when the question is of the truth of the mathematical propositions, rely straightforwardly upon the testimony of thinking, but builds upon the assurance that *God is and does not deceive*. In its relying upon God, thus in being certain, not of itself, but of an other than itself, thought is immediately certain of itself: this is the contradiction. That thought has itself slipped in underneath the Absolute to which it appeals in the last instance is, however, a fact about which the supposing functions

⁴⁹“Material objects”, says Malebranche, “cannot possibly be apprehended by themselves, they are apprehended only by the ideas corresponding to them in the soul. The opinion of the Peripatetics, that the outward objects should send us their images (*des espèces, qui leur ressemblent*), and that these should then through the outer senses be brought to the common sense (*au sens commun*), is unreasonable; these impression-images (*espèces impresses*) would then themselves have to be small bodies, and these bodies, with which space would be filled, would then, by reason of the impenetrability of matter, have to crush and jostle one another, some going to one side, others to another, and so could not make the objects visible.”

The opinion of those who assume that the ideas of objects are created with us, so that God does not need at every moment to awaken them in the soul when we have need of them, Malebranche refutes with the following consideration: “We have, even as regards simple figures, an infinite multitude of ideas: ellipses, triangles, polygons and the like can with respect to proportions of magnitude be imagined in countless ways. It is then highly improbable that God should have created such a swarm of ideas in and with the human spirit. But suppose that we also had such a store of co-created ideas (*un magasin de toutes les idées*), it still remains wholly inexplicable how we come to apply the right idea when the corresponding object shows itself. We see, e.g., the sun. The image which the sun impresses in the brain has no likeness to the idea we form of the sun; nor does the soul notice the very least of the impression which the sun makes either upon the bottom of the eye or in the brain: it is thus impossible to explain how among the countless ideas we come precisely to choose the idea of the sun when we see the sun” ... By these and similar reasonings Malebranche then arrives at the result that spirit can see what it is that is in God which presents “the created things” etc. Cf. Om Theologiens Naturbegreb med særligt Hensyn til Malebranche: *De la recherche de la vérité*. Af R. Nielsen. I Anledning af Reformationsfesten 1855. p. 13–15.

What Malebranche refers to God immediately, Leibnitz refers to God mediately. The presupposition is that the monad of monads has so constituted each single monad that it can as a living mirror (*miroir vivant*) mirror the whole universe. But in this mirroring one must not think of any immediate communication between the monad and the surrounding world. The physical mirror receives from the object itself the light by whose reflection the image is formed; but the metaphysical mirror forms its images out of its inner constitution without immediate influence from without: between these images and the objects of the surrounding world there can therefore be only an agreement secured by parallelism, not a causal relation.

can themselves give no information.

If thinking must seek truth's guarantee outside itself when it occupies itself with its own logical content, how much more then when the talk is of the things existing in the corporeal world. That corporeal things — so Cartesius reasons — can exist follows from this, “that God can create everything that I am thus able to apprehend. But now there is in me a certain passive capacity for sense-perception, or for receiving and cognizing the ideas of sense-things. For this capacity I should have no use if there did not also exist a certain active power, either in myself or in others, to bring forth these ideas. This power cannot, however, be in myself, ... since those ideas are brought forth without my co-operation, often against my will. It must thus be in another substance, in which all that reality is contained objectively (*formaliter*) or in a higher degree (*eminenter*) which is subjectively in the ideas brought forth by it. This [107] substance must either be God, or a created being nobler than the corporeal, in which these ideas are contained in a higher degree, or the corporeal itself, in which they are contained precisely objectively. Since now there is given me no capacity whatever for cognizing that the ideas should be brought to me by God himself, either immediately or through another created being, but on the contrary a great inclination is given me to believe that they are sent out by the corporeal things, I cannot see otherwise than that God would have to be a deceiver if they were not really sent out by the corporeal things: the corporeal things therefore exist.”⁵⁰

On the basis of the supposing functions thing and thought, judgment and object do indeed stand outwardly against each other; the mechanical and physical is heterogeneous with the intellectual and metaphysical, the material with the spiritual: but what is nevertheless the point of the problem, the opposition between the concept and its existence, between the same content in logical and in antilogical form, between the same form with logical and antilogical content, cannot on this standpoint come to clear consciousness all the same. The antithesis of the concept and the object is blunted when the category idea is applied just as immediately to the object as to its concept. The question how the idea is able to come forward in two such dissimilar shapes as a corporeal thing and a representation evaporates when both shapes are

⁵⁰Cf. *Meditatio Sexta*. p. 35; 39–40. (*Opera philos.*)

after all assumed to resemble each other in this, that they are both ideas. To this comes the fact that, in consequence of the ground slipped in underneath, one has at every difficulty omnipotence, thus a word of power, a divine power-language, to refer to in all arbitrariness.

In the supposing functions thought has originally gone out from itself, and yet it supposes itself to be at home with itself; this contradiction must become manifest.

2) *The object determines the judgment: abstracting functions.* If thought goes literally [108] out from itself in order to begin with an other, then the first and nearest thing it encounters is not the Absolute but the relative, not a God but a sensible thing. Insofar as one here begins with the sense-impressions proceeding from the object, one here begins with the existential extreme, the antilogical. The a priori concepts, "the innate ideas," have here vanished; only the immediate forms of existence, the sensible object-determinations, remain. We have then again the sensualist doctrine of experience. That Locke lets the soul begin as a *tabula rasa* acquires in the present connection the significance that he makes the attempt to let all conceptual determinations arise through the transformation of individual object-determinations. It is then not the judgment which by presuppositions *a priori* is to determine the object; it is on the contrary the object which by existence's word of power is to determine the judgment. If we consider the theory somewhat more closely, as it is laid out by Locke and developed by Hume, it is chiefly two factors that play the principal role, namely: *the impression* and *the abstraction*.

By the impression the existing object is supposed to imprint its individual form in the soul in a manner similar to that in which the seal imprints its characters in the wax. If it now remained at mere impressions, there would surely be found as many individual forms in the soul as there are objects the soul has apprehended. The form of the object's image in the soul and the object itself in existence would in this way be the same; but the content would be different, insofar as the object-image in the soul only was and remained an image, a copy of the actual, while actuality itself, the copy's original, would have to be sought in the existing object. But however passive one may wish to make the soul that is subjected to the impressions, the soul is nevertheless

[109] essentially subjectivity, and subjectivity self-activity.⁵¹ Beneath the psychical passivity self-activity comes to view in the transformation the object-form undergoes as it is taken up into the soul: in the object itself the form of existence has the individual stamp of singularity; apprehended by the soul it assumes the stamp of generality; it is a thoroughgoing transformation, and this thoroughgoing transformation is due to abstraction.

Since abstraction does not add anything but on the contrary takes something away, it seems at first glance as though it were the form of existence itself that was preserved pure and unfalsified in the form of consciousness. What is it, then, that falls away through abstraction? The contingent, the merely individual, the changeable, the inessential! And what is it that is expressly held fast through abstraction? The common, the universal, the constant, the essential! But the object-form is in its objective determinateness antilogical, the form of consciousness in subjective mobility essentially logical; through abstraction the miracle must then have taken place that an antilogical form has become logical; thus an *other* form, and yet *the same* form — how is this to be understood?

Abstraction, this receptive, negative function, which was supposed to aim solely at holding fast the object-form as a pure, unadulterated form of existence freed from the contingent, has evidently done something to the form, has, so to speak, on its own account reworked it, has transformed it from an antilogical individual form into a logical universal determination, from a form of existence into a form of the concept. Abstraction is then not so abstractly receptive that it cannot also be productive. Abstraction is a function of a priori selfhood; but the thinking that is lost in abstracting functions does not discover it.

The result of the theory is that both the form of the concept and the form of
[110] existence are dissolved, the judgment is suspended and the object is lost. The concept must necessarily vanish when the universal, that which is necessary in itself, vanishes. Necessity and universal validity are, namely, distinguishing marks of all true conceptual determinations; but the necessary and universally valid does not allow itself to be abstracted from the immediate singularities of facts. Hume does indeed maintain

⁵¹Cf. Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 25.

that categories such as likeness, degree, magnitude, etc., yield immediate certainty through abstraction and the corresponding reproduction; “for when an object is like another, the likeness will at once affect the eye, or rather the mind, and seldom does it require a second examination; in the determination of magnitudes or numbers we can proceed in approximately the same way,” etc. With the categories cause and effect, on the other hand, matters are supposed to stand in quite another way. This is now evidently an error; for if causality does not allow itself to be abstracted from facts, then the same holds of likeness; and if likeness does allow itself to be abstracted, then the same holds of causality.

Why does the causal relation not allow itself to be abstracted from facts? Because this relation as relation cannot become an object of immediate experience, because in other words the relation itself is not a sensible object. But now likeness! is likeness perhaps a sensible object? Hume assumes that the likeness in what is alike immediately affects the eye; that is a childish way of representing the matter. The categories likeness and unlikeness arise only through comparison; but things do not compare themselves with one another: comparison is a function of the judging, abstracting subjectivity. Comparison is a reflection that finds likeness only by presupposing likeness; in order to discover the likeness in the thing, the reflecting subjectivity must itself bring the likeness with it, must proceed from the category of likeness. The same, the selfsame, holds of causality. The difference is only this, that the causality-reflection is involved, while the likeness-reflection falls out as if of itself.

What does it now mean that likeness is abstracted from like objects, unlikeness [111] from unlike? But no! it is in this connection more important to determine what it does not mean. For it by no means means that the sensible thing, besides its other qualities, should also have the quality likeness, and that abstraction could then, by removing the other qualities, retain the likeness. Let two things be alike in color, let them e.g. both be red; there is nevertheless no one who assumes that in the like color there are two sensible qualities, the color and the likeness; the likeness in the color is not sensible in the way the color is. The sensation of color rests upon a sense-impression, but the likeness rests upon a judgment. Abstraction is determined by the judgment; in a judgment such as “this is a color” the color is sensible in the subject, non-sensible

in the predicate, antilogical in the subject, logical in the predicate; only thus can the category in the predicate be an abstraction from the object in the subject.

This Hume and the sensualists have now quite overlooked. From the color on A and the color on B they will without more ado abstract the likeness, just as though abstraction consisted in scraping the likeness off the color, as one can in certain cases scrape the color off the object. Only when abstraction is reflected in the judgment does the illusion disappear: A and B are alike in color; here the determination "color" points back to immediate sense-perception, but the predicate "alike" belongs to reflection.

It is, logically regarded, the axiom of sensualism that the object is to determine the judgment. In this lies the tacit presupposition that the existing object has in and for itself a sensible objective independence, independent of every judgment. But this presupposition too dissolves for the abstracting functions. Already Locke was embarrassed by substance; his incipient doubt was developed in Hume: for Hume there is no substance. "If," he says, "the concept substance is conveyed to us through [112] the senses, then I ask, which sense gives us this concept, and how does it give it to us? Were it received by the eyes, then it would have to be a color; by the ears, then a sound; by the palate, then a taste, — and so with all the remaining senses."

Hume comes consistently to the result that by the concept substance nothing else can be understood than a collection of single qualities (*a collection of particular qualities*), a gathering together of simple concepts which are united by the imagination and designated by a name of their own. "Thus we first discover in gold the yellow color, the weight, the malleability, the fusibility; afterwards we discover that it allows itself to be dissolved in aqua regia; this quality we then connect with the others, and reckon it just as much to the substance as if the concept of it had from the beginning constituted a part of the composite whole." What then is gold? As object-unity gold is a name, an aggregate of heterogeneous qualities which not actuality, not existence itself, but "imagination" has united. By isolating the qualities and apprehending each single quality by itself, abstraction is led to deprive the object of substantiality; but deprived of its substantiality the object is at the same time deprived of its objective independence.

Substance is an imaginary magnitude which, according to Hume, "arises from this,

that one ascribes to the particular qualities an unknown *something* in which they are assumed to inhere.” The word of power that was to secure for the object a factually determinate, substantial objectivity is thus through abstraction transformed into a word of impotence, a name; for substance, this *caput mortuum* of abstraction which remains when all qualities fall away, is only a name: if the object is to determine the judgment in this way, then there is here neither judgment nor object.

3) *The judgment determines the object: determining functions.* By going out from itself and seeking its determinations of content in the existent object, thought has [113] from the ground up disturbed both its own essence and that of the object. In order to remedy this fundamental disturbance, thought turns back from the dissolution of the object to its a priori point of departure. The beginning is made from the subjective extreme, in that the judgment determines the object.

That the judgment determines the object must naturally not be understood as though subjectivity could now judge arbitrarily according to its own fancy, and the object were then without more ado to conform itself to the judgment. The truth is on the contrary that the essence-determinations decisive for the cognition of the object must, in order to be object-determinations, absolutely be conceptual determinations; it is in consequence of this theory that the functions of the judgment show themselves as *determining*.

How impossible it is to assume object-forms that are not originally forms of subjectivity, Kant has sufficiently demonstrated. The one-sided element in Kant lies in this, that by subjectivity he can think only a psychological subjectivity, whereas the task is conversely, in the psychological subjectivity, to think only of the subjectively universally valid, of that which is essential to all subjectivity. When Kant declares the intuitions of space and time to be subjective forms, we grant him his right; but when he thereupon at the same time assumes that these forms cannot be objective because they are subjective; that they are only forms for *our* subjectivity, without its following therefrom that these forms also have validity for a subjectivity of a higher order, if such there be: then we cannot grant him his right.⁵²

The acuteness with which Kant in his “transcendental analytic” derives categories

⁵²Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 77–80.

of the understanding from the judgments has awakened admiration and deserves admiration. It is hereby demonstrated once and for all that no one can judge about the thing's objective being without his, by reflecting upon the judgment, at last
 [114] having to become conscious that objective being is posited by a category lying in the understanding itself. The being object *is*, insofar as subjectivity adjudges being to it. If anyone will hold that the object's objective being is in reality independent of the subjective being in the judgment, let him go back to Hume and take what follows upon it. But when Kant then sees in the distinction of being and non-being decisive for the judgment's quality — "reality and negation" — only a presentation of psychological-subjective forms, forms of the understanding which are so subjective that they cannot possibly fit the thing in itself, then he is in error.

When the thing is judged about as phenomenon: this thing is hard, red, etc., then Kant knows very well that the subjective being in the judgment's copula does no damage to actual existence, but on the contrary determines the phenomenon's objective being. For matters do not stand thus, that the phenomenon, the object of cognition, has a determinate being independent of the judgment and therefore indifferent toward the judgment, and that this object-being is then, when it so happens, apprehended and designated by the judgment's copula. Far from it! The relation is precisely the reverse, that the phenomenon is subjectively judged to be objective: the phenomenon has its objectivity from the judging subjectivity.

Otherwise, when the thing is spoken of, not as an object of cognition, but as "the thing in itself." Here Kant now absolutely insists upon a being so objective that it shall in no way be able to allow itself to be apprehended by any subjective category of the understanding, and thus not by the being corresponding to the judgment's copula either. By this assumption the author of the critique of reason comes into infinite contradiction with himself. When Kant says of the thing in itself that it *is*, he passes a judgment. He may now introduce as many distinctions as he will between reality and being, between objective and subjective, incomprehensible and comprehensible
 [115] being: it still stands fast that the distinctions by which the thing's being is to be placed outside the category of the understanding rest upon nothing but categories of the understanding; further it stands fast that he cannot declare it an impossibility to judge

about what the thing in itself is except precisely thereby, that he judges about what the thing in itself is. If he says: the thing in itself is an X, then by this judgment he has just as surely let a category of the understanding be determining for the thing in itself as, by saying: the thing is hard, he has let it be determining for the thing as phenomenon.

What has here been said of the categories which, according to Kant, lie at the ground of the judgments according to their quality holds also of those which are derived from the division of the judgments according to quantity, namely: *allness*, *plurality*, *unity*; from the division according to relation: *substance* and *inherence*, *cause*, *effect* and *reciprocal action*; and finally according to modality: *possibility*, *actuality* and *necessity*.

If it is once proved that the category of the understanding *being* must be determining for the thing in itself, then the same holds of all the remaining categories. If the thing in itself belongs to a sphere in which the category *being* has validity, then it belongs precisely to a sphere in which the categories *non-being*, *plurality*, *unity*, *cause*, *effect*, etc., have validity. Conversely: if the categories *non-being*, *plurality*, *unity*, *cause*, *effect*, etc., have no validity when the talk is of the thing in itself, then the category *being* has no validity either. One can then just as little say of the thing in itself that it is as that it is not; in setting itself up against the judgment, the thing in itself ceases to be an object.

The Kantian “thing in itself” can be regarded as a peculiar representative of the antilogical, insofar as the antilogical stands against thought and for that reason does not allow itself to be thought. But in Kant the apprehension of the antilogical is nevertheless in a high degree mistaken. In the first place “the thing in itself” is antilogical in the sense that it does not allow itself to be apprehended in any thought- [116] determination whatever, and therefore maintains itself as an X inaccessible to human knowledge. This is now, for the determination of the antilogical, both too much and too little. Too much; for the antilogical does indeed stand against thought, but in such a way that precisely through the opposition it both determines thought and allows itself to be determined by thought. Too little; for “the thing in itself” falls to thought with its determining functions in two quite different ways. For here it is presupposed

that this which is unknown to us, unthinkable for us, can possibly be thought by a divine thinking: the thing in itself is thus not in itself absolutely unthinkable. Here it is further presupposed that the thing in itself can in a certain manner coincide with our forms of cognition and subjective categories of the understanding. For what is it, then, that fills out the forms of cognition and gives experience its determinate content? Evidently “the thing in itself.” But then the phenomenon must, as has been shown in an earlier connection, precisely be an identity of the thing in itself and the forms of cognition; or in the phenomenon the concept and the thing must be identical. — Next, and this is our second principal objection, Kant has missed the antilogical in this, that, with all the fuss he otherwise makes about the separation between thing and concept, he nevertheless in complete indeterminateness lets the thing in experience and the concept in thinking have the same form, only that the concept’s form still lacks the content of experience. Thereby he has overlooked the real problem. If the actual contains in the concept nothing more than the merely possible; if there is here in the concept’s form nothing, nothing at all, that points to a difference between possibility and actuality, then we ask: by what form and in what manner is the determination of the determinate actual to be distinguished from the determination of the many-sidedly determinate possible? Here there must necessarily be a distinguishing mark in the
 [117] form itself; for to add empirical intuition to the pure concept is surely about as difficult as to subtract the sky from the blue sky.

The peculiar manner in which Kant in his critique of reason treats the relation between the formal and the material conditions of experience is well suited to incite metaphysical reflection in a one-sided direction. Everywhere it looks as though there were in the object of experience, besides the form of cognition, an indeterminable something that set barriers to cognition, a foreign element that thought could not get the better of; and yet it is not anything — the resistance yields everywhere before the thought that works its way forward in analysis. Thus attention was now in Fichte directed exclusively upon thought’s overreaching power: thought came to itself and saw in everything only itself. Once reflection had dissolved the thing in itself and, despite actuality’s protest, forced back every representation of the antilogical character of existence, one could no longer repel subjective idealism either by appealing to that

power of immediacy with which the outwardly actual comes forward; the immediate power of the actual was then cognized in its essence not as an antilogical factor, but as a logical power, a pure thought-power: the objective returned, not as the judgment's object, but as the judgment's content, indeed, in Hegel, as the judgment itself.

ββ) Power in judgment and object: practical functions. If the Hegelian development of the concept's power were many-sidedly satisfactory, the opposition of judgment and object would dissolve into an illusion corresponding to the psychological standpoint. Instead of antilogical power-determinations we should then get an existential immediacy; this immediacy, although in the phenomenon it seems to be opposed to the concept, would then essentially be only a moment in the concept itself, since the concept's reality, its logically overreaching power, consists precisely in positing and presupposing the elements through whose mediation it gives its content the form of infinity and reveals the absolute idea. What is one-sided and untenable in this theory [118] has already been pointed out from several sides at earlier stages of the Logic of the Fundamental Ideas.⁵³ Nonetheless the theory returns at every new stage with renewed emphasis, and quite naturally, so surely as the Hegelian philosophy is, in its kind, a consistent conclusion of all preceding systems.

If there is none among the thinkers of the past who can rightly be said to have raised the problem of the antilogical; if Kant is among them all the one who has come nearest to the matter without yet having grasped the matter; if everything that earlier systems have set up under various designations as reality's mark of distinction over against thought is mistaken, partly in such a way that in its absolute unthinkability it must become self-contradictory and meaningless, partly in such a way that as an ambiguous possibility it can belong only to a subordinate sphere and thus be destined to disappear: what wonder then that a logical carrying through of reflection ends by transforming existence into a concept.

Only in the logic of the antilogical forms can panlogism find its essential corrective. Earlier the knowledge-concept has been set over against the power-concept under various lights; the opposition is now heightened by this, that each of the concepts receives its corresponding development in its corresponding word, the concept of

⁵³Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 148–155 and p. 162–168 etc.

knowledge in the word of knowledge, the power-concept in the word of power. If the content of the power-concept could be developed in the word of knowledge, then the opposition of existence and concept would have to dissolve into a seeming; only in the light of representation, thus in the light of untruth, would the existence-determinations appear as antilogical object-determinations; seen in the light of truth they would on the contrary show themselves to be pure conceptual determinations; panlogism would then in principle be completely right.

If panlogism is to be overcome, the power-concept must be developed in the word [119] of power. But where do we now come to? As power is, so must the word be; power is antilogical, the word likewise. As the word is, so must language be; the word is antilogical, language likewise. As language is, so must its propositions, judgments and concepts be; language is antilogical, propositions, judgments and concepts likewise. Antilogical concepts, antilogical propositions, antilogical judgments! and all this is to be treated in a logic, the antilogical thus treated logically: is there not here a web of insoluble contradictions? — Before we enter upon the reality of the matter, we will consider the difficulties from the formal side.

Formal logic makes, as is well known, a finite separation between thought and what is thought, between the concept and what is comprehended, a separation that finds its confirmation in turns of speech such as: to think *of* something, to think *over* something, to form for oneself a concept *about* something and the like. In displeasure at the relation between thought and thing thus made finite, objective logic has in turn from its side held fast the identity of thinking and being as so immanent that what is, by being thought, became thought, and the existent, by being comprehended, became concept. Objective logic does not think of something; it thinks something, and this something is thought itself (ὥστε ταῦτόν νοῦς καὶ νοητόν. Aristoteles.). Objective logic does not form for itself a concept about something, — that would be far beneath its dignity, — but it comprehends something, and the something it comprehends is the concept itself.

Both ways of regarding the matter are, when they are held fast each by itself, equally one-sided and by their one-sidedness equally harmful to true development of the concept. Formal logic's separation of thought and its object is one-sided insofar

as it overlooks the identity; objective logic's identity of thought and what is thought is one-sided insofar as the opposition is overlooked. In order to defend the paradox that thought's object can only be thought itself, objective logic appeals to immanent negation. By its immanent negation thought is able to raise itself above itself and [120] make thought into object; by its immanent negation thought is conversely able to transform the thought object into thought. The object is, in other words, thought's other; but this other is through the immanent negation thought itself: here there is thought of thought of thought in a thinking of a thinking of a thinking, and further one fundamentally does not get.

In order to get beyond this boundless formalism, we must necessarily distinguish between mere formal negation and real negation. So long as thought's other is only thought itself, and all form-determinations to that extent logical, the negation is formal; only when thought's other can no longer be transformed into thought, thus when the antilogical enters, is the negation real. If one will now, in virtue of real negation, declare that other of thought which is not itself thought to be something in itself unthinkable, then one will also easily be able to defend the paradox that thought in actuality thinks the unthinkable. The matter is that this so-called unthinkable is in reality thinkable: thinkable in that it is apprehended by the thinker, unthinkable in that it is not thought and cannot think itself. Upon real negation, upon a thinking of that which is not thought, thus upon a logical determination of the antilogical, rests the reality of all thinking.

That the reality of thinking must coincide with the reality of the matter goes without saying. In the reality of the matter there must here, then — this lies in real negation — be an actual opposition of the concept in the word of knowledge and existence in the word of power; the concept in the word of knowledge is the judgment, existence in the word of power is the object: the actual opposition of concept and existence is an actual opposition of judgment and object. If the actual opposition of judgment and object is now not to sink down into the parceling out of finitude and be fixed in psychological dualism, then to the actual opposition of the word of knowledge and the word of power there must necessarily correspond an actual unity; such an actual unity cannot be merely theoretical; the actual unity is here only insofar [121]

as it is actually brought about; it is brought about only by an actual transition, a transformation: the bringing-about is essentially practical. In order that logic may now be able to give a mirroring, determined by the word of knowledge, of the praxis answering to the word of power, it is necessary to begin with the relation between thought and power.

Theory, pure theory, must content itself with thought-movements; its functions are only thought-acts. By pure thought-acts it is, according to the real negation, impossible to unite knowledge and power. The actual unity which in the infinite has been brought about and is to be brought about presupposes an essential unity which neither can nor is to be brought about, because it eternally is; it is in subjectivity itself, the absolute principle reflected into itself. According to the finite opposition between knowledge and power the thought-act is powerless and the power-act in its immediacy thoughtless; but in virtue of the original unity of power and knowledge the thought-act is a transformed power-act, and thereby itself powerful; the power-act, conversely, a transformed thought-act, and itself thought-fast. Inasmuch as the power-act is converted into thought-act, and the word of knowledge assimilates the power-determinations, the movement goes from the antilogical to the logical, the object-forms become concept-forms, and the judgment logical. Inasmuch as the thought-act conversely passes over into the power-act, and the word of power absorbs the ideality of the conceptual determinations, the movement occurs from the logical to the antilogical, and the judgment itself becomes antilogical. The practical functions are simultaneous in both movements, insofar as the movements form an infinite circuit; the reciprocal determinations of logical and antilogical moments answering to this circuit are explained in a comprehending reflection, which makes the judgment at once logical and yet antilogical.

- [122] 1) *In the logical judgment the object is preformed: anticipating functions.* If the judgment is really to be able to determine the object, knowledge must become one with power; this unity is brought about by a system of anticipating functions. In teleology there is talk often enough of anticipations and preformations, without its becoming clear just on that account how the preforming activity actually proceeds, and how far anticipation is originally a theoretical or a practical function. What relation,

then, obtains here between preformation and anticipation? what must anticipation necessarily presuppose? how does it take place?

Since preformation, as the word runs, aims at giving the object an inner existence preceding the outer, and therewith at once an inner shape preceding the outer, it follows of itself that all preformation must rest upon anticipation; for what is anticipation but a first forming of a form that presupposes itself, a becoming form without actual existence. In preformation it is impossible to point out an immediately first form: for preformation says in its concept that every existing form must result from a preceding form. Could there in actuality be given a first existing form, then the one existing form could go before the other, prepare the other and be relieved by the other without any proper preforming. In preformation, by contrast, the preparing form is so essentially determined by the resulting one that it is at once both its copy and its model, and can be the latter only by being the former. The actual shape is always, if the word may be used, a this-shape, just as the existent is always a this-being. If now it is not a shape in indeterminate generality, but this, just this shape, that is to be preformed, then it must necessarily be presupposed in order to be posited: it must be anticipated. That a shape which is not yet, and consequently has not the determinateness of the existent, should [123] act determiningly upon the initial form by which it is determined — this presupposing, on the part of preformation, of that which is to be posited, is precisely anticipation.

From the infinity reflected in anticipation it shines forth that its being is itself a reflecting, and that this reflecting must necessarily presuppose a reflecting subjectivity. All anticipating functions are subjectivity-functions. But just as selfhood with necessity presupposes otherness, so must subjectivity's anticipating activity necessarily presuppose objectivity. That anticipation is determined by consideration of a coming objectivity is evident; think away what follows, and what goes before ceases to be an antecedent. But not only in a formal, also in a real sense must anticipation presuppose a given existence. What is posited subjectively in anticipation is posited precisely with the express determination that it shall one day become objective. But nothing can become objective save that which in its subjective beginning already has conditions for objectivity. Conditions for objectivity can only that have which is originally determined by objective considerations; but objective considerations, consideration of

the objective, presuppose a world of already existing objects. Divided between the subjective and the objective, or rather in its indivisible unity determined in part by both, anticipation thus falls under the relative concepts: an absolute anticipation is just as impossible as an absolute beginning.

From the relativity of the anticipation-concept it follows that actuality in infinite extent cannot possibly be anticipated at once. Every relative totality, every actual member, must indeed proceed from its possibility; but for that reason the whole of actuality cannot simply have its beginning in a possibility going before all actual things: [124] possibility has actuality not only before it, but also behind it; the actual possibility rests upon actuality. So too with anticipation: it prepares an existent by means of an already existing one. From the relation between the actual and the possible, the objective and the subjective in anticipation, the relation between the theoretical and the practical is seen as well.

Insofar as anticipation proceeds from the objective, the anticipating functions are essentially theoretical. The theoretical is that the judgment is determined by the object, thought by the given, that actuality, the objective, rules. With its gaze upon the objectively actual the anticipating subjectivity recognizes its actual limit, its barrier. Over against the actual objective the abstractly subjective is powerless. Or what should pure subjectivity be in a position to alter in objective actuality? The actual objects would have to be no objects, but mere figments, pure dream-images, if they could without more ado be dissolved and transformed by a purely subjective determining. What holds of the objective members holds of course also of the relations in which the members essentially bring their objectivity to light. Every alteration of the objective must occur upon objective conditions, in consequence of objective presuppositions. The objective must indeed be objectified; but it itself determines the content of its objectification, and thereby proves its reality.

But if subjectivity is really in every respect powerless over against the objective, then anticipation is an impossibility: a unity of knowledge and power is required, a unity which anticipation itself both presupposes and brings about. The anticipating activity is preforming; preformation presupposes precisely in subjectivity an overreaching power over the objective. Without such an overreaching power the subjective

forming would not be determinative for the objective form. As the subjective activity which prepares and shapes a coming actuality, anticipation must thus be an ideal [125] praxis; but from which side, then, can the objective fall liable to determination by the subjective? From that of possibility, of real possibility! For real possibility is at once both objective and subjective.

Insofar as possibility is objective, the objects can in countless ways be reshaped and altered by one another. As existing object, as outer actuality, the object has in itself the possibility, on different conditions, of playing a highly different role. In its immediate actuality the object is of determinate peculiarity, sets itself against subjectivity and asserts its independence; but according to possibility the objective is powerless, according to its possibility the object is stuff-like and indeterminate; to know possibility is to know the side from which objectivity lets itself be attacked subjectively: by its knowledge of objective possibilities the anticipating subjectivity acquires an ideal power over the objects.

How stuff-like objectivity is, is seen from the objective possibilities. Never are so many individual shapes formed that there could not, by reason of the possibilities, be formed more; actuality is never shaped in types so particular that it could not, by reason of the possibilities, be shaped in other types: here there everywhere remains in the objective formations an infinite surplus of possibilities. It is this surplus of possibilities that always stands at subjectivity's disposal; subjectivity judges, and the judging subjectivity knows how to handle possibility, for subjectivity *liberates* possibility. In its objective form possibility is bound, and the bound possibility is abandoned to contingency; only in the subjective form does possibility become free: the liberated possibility has its expression in the judgment.

The actual can as actuality be expressed both in the object and in the judgment about the object; but the possibility latent in the object can be expressed in the form of possibility only insofar as it is expressed in the judgment. To be sure, objective [126] possibility always rests in a corresponding actuality; but in actuality possibility is not; were possibility actually there, it would be precisely an actuality, no possibility. In outer actuality, in the object itself, possibility must content itself with a being without determinate being; in the judging subjectivity, by contrast, possibility acquires ideal

existence, its ideal existence is the judgment itself, the judgment in which it is uttered. Here now is seen anticipation's original unity with the judgment.

In the knowing subjectivity many images may form, also images of things which are not yet; but no image can in its immediacy as image pass for an anticipation. Anticipation expressly demands a knowledge that the given image designates an object not yet existing, an object whose existence is precisely introduced and prepared by the image; but such a knowledge is inseparable from a judgment; for only in a judgment can the relation between the image and the object be expressly determined. That the image of anticipation does not remain standing in pictorial immediacy, but resolves itself into a representation and passes over into the judgment, is seen from this, that the demand indicated by the image, to be actualized as object, is in the judgment expressly posited as a task. It is not the image, but the task, the task determined by the judgment about the image, about which the anticipating functions essentially move. Transformed by the judgment into a task, the anticipation-image is more closely determined by the category's pregnant unity-expression, thus by the word, the practical word of knowledge, which carries the whole task.

[127] With the task in the practical word of knowledge the anticipating functions now work at a closer determination of the possibility of the object in question. In the determination of this possibility the subjective is articulated point by point by objective considerations. The articulation is expressed in the judgment, inasmuch as the judgment in turn expresses a peculiar reciprocal relation of freedom and necessity, arbitrariness and terms. If the task, categorically determined, is to construct, e.g., a clock, then the choice by which it became just this and not another task is doubtless arbitrary; but the terms announce themselves at once when one looks to the solution of the task. The fundamental demand is to bring about a series of isochronous events and to indicate these in numbers. From the task thus posed it is seen that its solution rests upon the terms of actuality, upon the conditions objectivity offers. Nor, then, does the image of the clock stand fast; it is as yet only a possibility, and possibility varies in the alternation. "A clock is (can be) both a sand-clock and a water-clock and a mechanical clock, etc." The conjunctive judgment: *A* is (can be) both *B* and *C* and *D*, sets several possibilities before a choice; the disjunctive judgment: *A* is (must be)

either *B* or *C* or *D*, expressly demands a choice among several possibilities.

Inasmuch as the anticipating subjectivity in the judgment surveys the possibilities offered by objectivity and bethinks itself of a choice, it must likewise see in the judgment how it may best adapt its choice to the conditions of actuality. The judgment now assumes the hypothetical form: if the clock is to be a sand-clock, then ... if *A* is *B*, what then? Then, answers formal logic, *A* is neither *C* nor *D*. This answer is in the present connection idle; the idleness of theoretical formalism is most palpable when the question concerns the solution of a determinate task; the determinate task is essentially practical. Thus: if *A* is (is to be) *B*, what then? then a system of conditions of its own holds, the system *b*; if *A* is (is to be) *C*, then by contrast another system of conditions holds, the system *c*, and so forth.

To the judgment, the decisive judgment which goes through a system of judgments, there answers the anticipated possibility, which with its determinateness consists in a [128] system of possibilities. In order to determine possibility the anticipating subjectivity works with nothing but imaginary elements, but in every one of these imaginary elements a reflex of the real is seen, of the reality in the objective conditions. The objective conditions in their reality are nothing but power-determinations; the subjectivity immersed in anticipation's deliberations has thus, through these deliberations, appropriated to itself a system of reflected power-determinations; with this system of reflected power-determinations possibility is articulated into an inner, imaginary actuality; with the complete development of the inner, imaginary actuality preformation, and with it anticipation, is carried through.

2) *With the antilogical judgment the object is realized: executive functions.* In the task determined by anticipation actuality is posited in advance as concept; by the solution of the task the concept is to be posited as actuality. How a concept is converted into actuality is seen wherever a work of subjectivity is objectively accomplished, wherever a purpose is realized. What is essential in the actualization of the concept is however misunderstood from two equally one-sided standpoints, by everyday consciousness and by the philosophy of the immanent method.

For everyday consciousness it is human manufactures, not natural products, that must serve as examples of the actualization of concepts in material objects, houses,

household utensils, machines and the like. What is orienting in these examples is that they point expressly to an anticipating subjectivity, an actual surrounding world in which the means answering to the purpose must be sought, and an active individuality which by voluntary use of its limbs procures itself tools and by voluntary use of the tool works its material in a manner answering to the task, etc.

[129] By such exemplifications the task now becomes parcelled out to such a degree that one can, so to speak, anatomically separate the individual moments. First the master-workman has the whole concept of the work in question anticipated in the purpose; next, by means of thought's unity with the will, the execution of the plan lying in the purpose becomes actual resolve; in the will's immediate action upon the organs, in the voluntary use of arm and hand, there is finally seen the identity of the ideal with the real, the subjective with the objective, the concept with actuality. Inasmuch as the will is determined by the concept by means of thought, the motion in hand and fingers is in turn determined by the will and, by means of the will, by the concept; every finger-motion now answers to a thought-movement; the concept's ideal power has transformed itself into real power: the transition from concept-form to object-form, from the logical to the antilogical, has begun.

But however illuminating such exemplifications may be in a propaedeutic sense, they are nevertheless insufficient for the logic of the ideas. So long as attention dwells one-sidedly upon the individual master-workman and his work, there will always be a multitude of collateral representations here which can work disturbingly. It constantly looks as though the plan and subjectivity stood in a merely contingent relation; the plan must indeed be in the master-workman's consciousness, but the master-workman's consciousness may very well exist without such a plan. Just as arbitrary and just for that reason contingent is the relation between anticipation and actualization, between plan and execution; the master-workman cannot indeed proceed to execution without a plan, but he may go about with the plan without proceeding to execution. Finally, and this is in the main the most misleading thing, by such examples the point of coincidence of the subjective with the objective in the will's use of the limbs is grasped in so restricted and particular a manner that the

[130] fundamental relation between concept and actuality, between purpose, means and the

attainment of the purpose, the fundamental relation which runs through the whole of existence, is not brought to light: here there is and remains a wide gulf between *manufactures* and *natural products*.

In sharp opposition to the popular exemplifications, Hegel, in his doctrine of the concept's actualization by itself, notably in his doctrine of the purpose, has to such a degree removed all considerations of finitude that the opposition between the subjective and the objective purpose, between the concept in itself and the actual world of objects, falls under the concept's general self-movement. The mystification which has already been pointed out in "*The Logic of Subjectivity*"⁵⁴ can in this connection be illuminated from a new side. — "Die Bewegung des Zwecks" — says Hegel⁵⁵ — "kann ... so ausgedrückt werden, daß sie darauf gehe, seine *Voraussetzung* aufzuheben, das ist die Unmittelbarkeit des Objekts, und es zu *setzen* als durch den Begriff bestimmt. Dieses negative Verhalten gegen das Objekt ist ebenso sehr ein negatives gegen sich selbst, ein Aufheben der Subjektivität des Zwecks. Positiv ist es die Realisation des Zwecks, nämlich die Vereinigung des objektiven Seyns mit demselben, so daß dasselbe, welches als Moment des Zwecks unmittelbar die mit ihm identische Bestimmtheit ist, als *äußerliche* sey, und umgekehrt das Objective als *Voraussetzung* vielmehr als durch Begriff bestimmt, *gesetzt* werde."

According to the Hegelian conception all difference then vanishes between the anticipating subjectivity and the plan, the subjective purpose determined by anticipation. Insofar as the purpose presupposes anticipation, and anticipation subjectivity, the purpose-concept in Hegel is this subjectivity. The concept has, as "the determinate concept," all the requisites it essentially needs. Here there is to that extent a [131] smuggled-in anticipation, but no anticipation-problem. "The movement of the purpose aims at sublating its presupposition, namely the immediacy of the object, so that the object may expressly become determined by the concept;" what does this now mean? The object is as object already concept; inasmuch as the purpose as concept has the immediacy of the object for presupposition, this means, in other words, that the subjective concept reflected into itself has the objective, immediate concept for presupposition. If the emphasis is now laid upon this, that the presupposition of the

⁵⁴Grundideernes Logik I. S. 226.

⁵⁵Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. S. 220.

reflected concept is itself concept, then the whole movement by which the immediacy resulting from the concept is again sublated in its reflected concept is only a repetition of the worn-out story of reflection's conversion into immediacy, and immediacy's into reflection; here, then, there can be no question of the purpose realizing itself, for here there is no reality at all, and of course no realization either. If, by contrast, the emphasis is to fall upon the object's objective immediacy, thus upon reality, then it is asked whence the purpose as concept acquires the independence to step forth in free ideality against a given reality, to intervene in the connection of things and to master the outward objective. The concept as purpose is a subjective thought which abstraction has torn loose from the thinking subjectivity and set up as an essence for itself. The essence thus set up, "the subjective purpose," is a phantom, a powerless shadow, which will surely refrain from realizing itself.

The Hegelian concept, for all its divinity, evidently lacks the essential opposition of ideal existence in the judgment and real existence in the object. The concept's self-realization is a feigned movement, due to abstraction and to abstraction's stepwise sublation. That "the subjective purpose turns itself negatively against the object," that it therewith "turns itself negatively against itself," that it, in other words, "sublates [132] its subjectivity and posits itself negatively as realized purpose," means only that the thinking spectator is, by help of an explicative dialectic, to fix his gaze now upon the one of these moments, now upon the other, now upon both together.

If Hegel with his whole system is not in a position to state the difference between an object's concept and the object itself, between the concept in knowledge and the concept in power, how should he then be in a position to point out a transition from concept to object? Formally there are transitions enough here; but here there is no concept of a real transition. A real transition namely presupposes a real distance; where there is no real distance, neither is there, in the logical sense, any real transition. The transition-illusion, an illusion not unlike that by which one who sails sees the coast move, is maintained chiefly by this, that the concept in the *general* now steps into opposition to, now again melts together with, the concept in the *particular*; but concept is always concept after all: the dialecticizing reflection posits and sublates the separation with equal ease. Once a separation between the objective and the subjective

has here been posited in consequence of the concept in the particular, as is now the case with the objects and “the subjective purpose,” such a separation is again sublated by the concept in all generality. Of the concept in all generality it may doubtless hold that it turns itself negatively against itself in turning itself negatively against the object; for the concept of the objective belongs undeniably just as essentially under the concept in all generality as does the concept of the subjective; but how should such a thing be able to solve a realization-problem, how should it be able to explain to us the transition from “the subjective” to “the realized purpose”?

What we need to have explained in this connection is not a tautology such as this, that the subjective purpose is in its concept subjective and thereby opposed to the object and to the objective; no, what ought to be explained to us is the problem how it [133] actually comes about that the concept, not the subjective-objective concept in logical ambiguity, but the determinate concept, the concept of this particular, determinate purpose, can effect a transition from ideal existence to actual existence, where by the transition there is then thought no logical paraphrase of the subjective by the objective, but an event, a production, in which the concept is seen to determine actuality and itself to become actual. For the answering of questions belonging here the Hegelian logic contains no instruction, not even a hint.

In Hegel the opposition between concept and object, when it is driven to its utmost, cannot reach further than to an opposition of essence and phenomenon, only with the express addition that the totality is completely developed from both sides, indeed has in the course of the development even become two totalities. Since now the totality-unity of the two totalities is posited as the judgment, the logically objective judgment (the fundamental division, “das Urtheil”), one should expect that Hegel would hold fast in the judgment to the opposition between the concept in the form of essence and the concept in the form of phenomenon, and would thus arrive at a cognition of the object; but no! in the judgment reflection is directed upon the filling-out of the copula, thus upon the totalization of the identity in which the separate totalities are sublated. “So ist die Form des Urtheils untergegangen, erstens, weil Subjekt und Prädikat *an sich* derselbe Inhalt sind; aber zweitens, weil das Subjekt durch seine Bestimmtheit über sich hinausweist, und sich auf das Prädikat bezieht, aber ebenso drittens ist *dieß*

Beziehen in das Prädikat übergegangen, macht nur dessen Inhalt aus, und ist so die *gesetzte* Beziehung oder das Urtheil selbst. — So ist die konkrete Identität des Begriffs ... im *Ganzen* hergestellt" ...⁵⁶

[134] With the filled-out copula the judgment now passes over into the syllogism.⁵⁷ If the judgment ended in its immanent development with the two totalities, the subject and the predicate, going together in the totalized unity of the concept, then one would now have to expect that the content-rich totality-unity which, in the course of the syllogism's self-development, is divided and united in three totalities should lead to insight into the opposition between the concept as concept and the concept as object; but no! the syllogism ends thus: "Die ganze Formbestimmung des Begriffs ist in ihrem bestimmten Unterschied und zugleich in der einfachen Identität des Begriffes gesetzt." And now is added: "Dadurch hat sich nun *der Formalismus des Schließens*, hiermit die Subjektivität des Schlusses und des Begriffes überhaupt aufgehoben".⁵⁸

Should anyone hold that here at last a thoroughgoing totality-opposition must show itself, since it is expressly said that the whole form-determination of the concept is posited, not merely in simple identity, but also in determinate difference, then let him note how the chapter on the syllogism ends: "Das Resultat ist ... eine *Unmittelbarkeit*, die durch *Aufheben der Vermittelung* hervorgegangen, ein Seyn, das ebenso sehr identisch mit der Vermittelung und der Begriff ist, der aus und in seinem Andersseyn sich selbst hergestellt hat. Dieß Seyn ist daher eine *Sache, die an und für sich ist* — die *Objektivität*". And what, then, is gained by this? A concept which is itself object, because it is Object, but an Object which is nevertheless not object, because it is concept; thus a concept which is neither concept nor object; an object which is neither object nor concept; a dialectical story which can go on as long as one pleases.

[135] If the object, seen from the side of logic, is to assert its independence against the concept; if the concept, seen from the side of existence, is to assert its independence against the object: then they must both have each its own existence, the concept an ideal existence in a comprehending subjectivity, the object a real existence in actual objectivity. The concept's existence in subjectivity is determined by a word of

⁵⁶Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. S. 117.

⁵⁷Cf. Grundideernes Logik. I. S. 214.

⁵⁸Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. S. 169 & 71.

knowledge; the object's objective existence is determined by a word of power. The concept's realization, the actual transition by which the determinate concept comes to existence as determinate object, occurs through an intellectual-real praxis whose peculiar character must rest upon the executive functions.

The executive functions are themselves determined by a difference-unity of antilogical judgments and antilogical propositions. The antilogical judgment, which has the concept in its subject and existence in its predicate⁵⁹, first acquires its full significance in thought's transition into action, theory's transition into praxis.

From the standpoint of theory the antilogical judgment will look only like an inverted presentation of the logical. For when someone, instead of saying: this is an axle, this is a wheel, this a roller, says: an axle is this, a wheel is this, etc., it certainly sounds inverted enough. It is otherwise when the task is to construct a wheel, a roller and the like. The construction presupposes the concept: the concept is the original, the object the derived. The concept is had in the subject of the judgment; the one who judges knows what a wheel is in its concept, he does not then wish to have the concept determined over again as concept in the predicate, so that the predicate should give him a logically exact definition. Such theoretical formalities are here superfluous. The constructing master-workman will indeed define his concept, but the definition is to be practical, not theoretical: the practical definition is one with a corresponding production, a construction.

It is said in logic that it is not the singular but the particular, not the object itself but its concept, that admits of definition (*species sola definitur, non individuum*); this is, in [136] the theoretical sense, quite correct; the logical judgment cannot define the object. But in practice the matter stands the other way round; here the endeavor aims precisely at defining the concept's reality by producing the object corresponding to the concept: *the produced object is the concept's practical definition*. To such questions as: what is a triangle? a square? a circle? one can answer practically by constructing a triangle, a square, a circle. How far such practical definitions will satisfy theory shall not be investigated here; only this shall be emphasized, that the practical definition is guided and determined by an antilogical judgment.

⁵⁹Grundideernes Logik. I. S. 160–62.

He who answers the question: what is a circle? by constructing a circle, translates the concept of the circle straightway into existence. "A circle is a figure like *this*, is *this figure*"; with such a judgment the construction begins, but such a judgment is antilogical. The logical judgment coincides immediately with its corresponding proposition; in the word of knowledge the proposition is judgment insofar as it is reflected in thought, and the judgment proposition insofar as it is reflected in language: both reflections are theoretically the same reflection. It is otherwise when the question concerns the relation between judgment and proposition in the antilogical; here the identity is practical, and therefore there must here also be a practical difference.

The practical difference is a difference between the thought that guides the action and the action itself. The constructing, and hence acting, subjectivity must *think*; but the thought is practical, its functions executive. The executive functions all aim, from the standpoint of the concept, at showing the possibility of the practical definitions. Here the antilogical judgment divides itself into a multiplicity of particular [137] judgments. The constructing, and hence thinking, subjectivity must *act*. The actual acting, determined by thought, is not itself a thinking, but on the contrary is so opposed to thought that precisely by the opposition it can correspond to thought. The actual action corresponding to thought cannot possibly, since it is not itself thought, coincide with the judgment as judgment; it must necessarily have its expression in an antilogical proposition determined by the judgment. As the antilogical judgment branches out into the multiplicity of particular judgments, so the antilogical proposition branches out, in the execution of the work, into a multiplicity of particular propositions; in the articulated reciprocal determination of antilogical judgments with practical-antilogical propositions is seen the full significance of the logic of the executive functions.

That the object produced in and by the judgment, by the antilogical judgment in its system of corresponding propositions, is now also actually opposed to the judgment, can be seen from the executive functions. In every executive function the judgment decisive for the proposition is an expression of the identity of power and knowledge in the form of knowledge: the power in the judgment is ideal. But in every executive function the proposition determined by the judgment, the action governed by thought, is likewise an expression of the identity of knowledge and power in the form of power;

the power in the action is real: as many actions, so many power-determinations. Since now the unity of the proposition through the judgment gives, point for point, a unity of the power-determination with its corresponding conceptual determination, the totality of the power-determinations in the produced object must in the execution itself necessarily correspond to the totality of the knowledge-determinations in the producing subjectivity. The object in its system of antilogical propositions stands as a word of power over against the system of judgments which, in the practical word of knowledge, has given the concept existence.

If the unity-in-opposition of thinking and acting, of judgment and proposition, is a unity-in-opposition of knowledge and power, then it is seen from this that the producing subjectivity must be at one and the same time both a capable and a knowing [138] subjectivity. If the power is restricted but the knowledge extended, this will be seen in the production; if conversely the power is extended but the knowledge restricted, this will likewise be seen in the production. Here is a turning-point at which the relation between *manufactures* and *natural products* can be more closely illuminated.

All real productions, even the apparently meaningless ones, are determined by concepts and realize concepts. To assume that there could in actuality be productions so confused that they fell outside every thought, every conceptual determination, is just as unreasonable as to assume that in sand, water or air there could be eddies that fell outside all laws. If it is now true that every production rests upon a unity-in-opposition of concept and actuality, and if actuality is the objective and the concept the subjective side of the production, then it is seen from this that production is a two-sided category, and that it makes a great difference whether this category is regarded from a subjective or from an objective standpoint.

“The manufactures, the human productions, are”, it is said, “productions that take place with consciousness, but the natural products are unconscious productions”. Such a separation of manufactures and natural products is misleading, insofar as it gives the appearance that there were here two productions different in principle, subjective and objective, whereas the truth is that every production is in the last instance both subjective and objective.

That the human, conscious productions are subjective is evident; but with all the

arbitrariness that distinguishes them they are nonetheless objectively conditioned. Whoever will abstract from the master builder's subjectivity and during the work fix his attention upon the hand, the tool and the material, will convince himself that what
 [139] is subjective in the production is determined, link for link, objectively. That natural productions are objective is evident; but whoever will attend to what observers say about "natural forms", "natural concepts", "natural thoughts", "natural purposes" etc., will soon see that no thinker can consider the objective side of natural productions without looking about him for the producing subjectivity.

"But", it is said, "natural productions surely take place with objective necessity; how then can a production that occurs so objectively rest upon subjectivity?" We answer: Not upon a finite psychological subjectivity which, with a limited knowledge and a still more limited power, stands in finite opposition to the world of objects; but indeed upon a subjectivity which, with an original unity of knowledge and power, stands in an infinitely articulated fundamental relation to the objectivity in everything objective. If natural productions were to lose their reality because they are produced ideally and in a subjective manner in the concept, then natural objects too would have to lose their reality, because they can be objects only insofar as they are objectified by an infinite subjectivity. Since it is now so far from being the case that objects become less objective by being objectified, that on the contrary they must have their objectivity in the objectification itself: then it will also be possible to understand that natural productions do not lose their objective validity by being produced by a subjectivity that is indwelling in them and yet hovers above them; it is precisely the subjective in the production that grounds the objective.⁶⁰

3) *In the logical-antilogical Judgment the Object is explained: explicative Functions.* It is a peculiar matter with observations of nature; everything that the ingenious observer puts into nature he gets out again, neither more nor less. The well-known dispute between the Hallerian and the Goethean view concerning "the inner of nature"
 [140] science has accordingly not been able to settle hitherto either. Indeed, the natural products in their immediate objectivity have no liberated inwardness, as if there could here be an outer that, like a shell, surrounded and concealed the inner; but

⁶⁰Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 444–456.

the immediacy with which all activity of nature takes place nonetheless gives the production so objective a stamp that the subjective is at one and the same time both missed and presupposed. When the one mass attracts the other, the one stone presses the other, the one substance combines with the other: then there is here, point for point, a determining of other by other, of objective by objective upon objective possibilities, and the same holds when the seed germinates and the organism thrives; – what then is the inner of nature? In its immediate corporeality the organism is an object just as much as the stone; that there is here in the object an opposition of inner and outer must be conceded; but the object's inner is, as we have already seen above, just as much object as the outer. That in nature's outer an inner should everywhere come to meet us is a figure of speech that can be just as ambiguous as when it is asserted, in clumsy immediacy, that "in the object a concept comes to meet us".

It is with the inner of nature as with the natural thoughts; when we look at the outer, then there is an inner; but if we would see the inner itself, then it has vanished. The inner has essentially a reflected, not an immediate being; but nature does not reflect, and in its immediate naturalness cannot have an essential inner. And yet nature has an inner; when Goethe says: "die Natur hat weder Kern noch Schale, Alles ist sie mit einem Male", it sounds striking, but is nonetheless veiled; the poet's clear words stand in great need of an explanation.

That nature is without an inner, without free inwardness, means that it is without subjectivity; that nature has its inwardness, its essential inner, means that it nevertheless has subjectivity; that the inner of nature is obscure, its inwardness a riddle, [141] means that the subjectivity which nature has is a subjectivity that has nature, and hence a subjectivity doubled within itself; a subjectivity that is of course in nature itself, and a subjectivity hovering above nature, a subjectivity in which the producing actions are reflected as determining thoughts.

To the doubled subjectivity of natural productions there corresponds the difference-unity of antilogical judgments and practical-antilogical propositions. Without a system of antilogical judgments the concepts decisive for the productions could not possibly be. The concepts are only in a comprehending, the comprehending only in a comprehending subjectivity. The antilogical judgments are determined in the anticipation by

the logical ones; the reflection of the logical and the antilogical judgments is in the knowing subjectivity that hovers above the productions and reflects itself in everything and everything in itself, in the divine selfhood whose knowledge is power and whose power is knowledge. But without a system of antilogical propositions, of actual power-actions expressly determined by the anticipated concepts of practical knowledge, natural productions could not possibly have the real character of otherness, of actuality, of real existence. Where, then, do we find the original unity of the antilogical propositions with the corresponding judgments? In the essence-unity of the hovering subjectivity with the powerful subjectivity indwelling in the productions; determined still more closely, in this subjectivity's reflected unity with the immediately producing cause, the principle of nature that is present in objective working.

The actual relation between the principle of nature and the infinite subjectivity must in logic be determined by *explicative functions*.

Every natural object is a produced thing. To cognize the produced is to cognize [142] the production; to cognize the production is to repeat it in cognition;⁶¹ to repeat it in cognition is to reflect through the system of antilogical judgments that have guided the producing actions, and to imitate these actions in particular imaginations answering to the demands of the concept. To the system of the actions, of the antilogical propositions, there corresponds the principle of nature. The principle — this holds both of the principle in general and of the particular principles — works but does not think, does the deeds of the concept but does not itself comprehend it; the principle is, as principle of nature, selfhood in the objective form, a disposition of subjectivity, a selfhood working selflessly, the productive unity of the antilogical propositions. To the system of the judgments, of the logical-antilogical judgments, there corresponds selfhood in the form of the self, the reflecting, knowing subjectivity. The knowing subjectivity — this holds both of the powerful subjectivity, infinite in its ontological knowledge, and of the powerless subjectivity, restricted in its psychological knowledge — cannot in its pure knowledge act, for that lies in the nature of knowledge: knowledge is not acting; the knower can in his knowledge only think and judge.

To the pervasive difference between thinking and acting, knowledge and power,

⁶¹Grundideernes Logik I. p. 169–70 ff.

theory and practice, there corresponds, then, a pervasive opposition between the comprehending subjectivity, which thinks the action but does not act, and the working principle, which does the deeds of thought but does not think. A dualism of subjectivity and principle of nature cannot deter the logical inquirer; for such a dualism serves precisely to ground the identity. The identity rests in the power. Insofar as the power is, according to its ideality, originally one with knowledge, it belongs to subjectivity: the ontological subjectivity is, in infinite knowledge, infinitely powerful; insofar as the power is, in its immediate reality, originally opposed to knowledge, it founds otherness, posits objectivity and is identical with the principle.

In subjectivity the objective power is subjective on account of its ideality, its unity [143] with knowledge; in the principle the subjective power is objective on account of its otherness, its reality, its unity with working. Here, then, there are not two powers, an ideal and subjective one alongside a real and objective one; it is one and the same power that in powerful self-opposition is ideal in thinking and judging, real in working and producing.

In its system of antilogical judgments subjectivity thus has ideal power over the principle with all the activities proceeding from it. By virtue of the ideal power every natural action is determined, link for link, by the corresponding judgment. The principle does, in all expressions of power, the deed of thought. In its system of antilogical propositions the principle has the conceptual determinations reflected in the judgment as real motives of power, so that the production satisfies the concept precisely by the object's opposition to the concept.

Every natural production, the organic just as much as the chemical and the mechanical, thus takes place objectively in accordance with the principle that moves in the concept, but is determined subjectively by the concept reflected in subjectivity. The objective in the production is thus not without further ado subjective, but receives its significance through the subjective; the subjective in the production is not itself objective, but receives its significance through the objective. That the objective is punctually explained by the subjective, and this by that, that the objective is objective only by signifying the subjective, and conversely, is a theoretical moment in the practical fundamental relation that gives the explicative functions their peculiar

stamp.

The explicative, i.e. the explaining, appraising, interpreting functions presuppose precisely a dualism of subjective and objective, of inner and outer, concept and object. The object is, as object, not concept, but signifies the concept, and is therefore to be interpreted and understood by means of the concept. The concept is indwelling in the
 [144] production (immanent) and yet hovering above it (transcendent), indwelling as a word of power, hovering above as a word of knowledge; upon the true relation between the indwelling and the hovering concept rests the truth of the interpretation.

In all activity of nature the concept is immanent; but for that reason it still cannot possibly, as concept, coincide with the activity itself. If the concept were so absorbed into the activity that in what is active we got only the activity itself, then the activity would become concept-less, and hence meaningless. In order that the concept indwelling in the activity of nature may be concept, it must necessarily hover above it; in order to move in the real system as a word of power, it must be reflected in the ideal system as a word of knowledge.

There is an essential difference between *being* something and *signifying* something; an object's significance can, insofar as it is arbitrarily attributed to the object, be wholly indifferent to its existence; but an object's significance is, when it corresponds precisely to ground and essence, decisive for the object's being.

The significance that is ascribed to the natural object by the explicative functions is one with the object's own essence. In such judgments as: this is a stone, a plant, an animal, the one judging declares that he recognizes the concept in each of the objects he encounters: the judgments are logical. According to the logical judgment the object is its concept, its significance is stated immediately in the judgment as judgment; here, to that extent, there can be no talk of any difference between signifying and being: what the object is, it signifies, and what it signifies, that it is. It is otherwise when the question concerns the origin of the natural object, when the produced is to be understood from the production. Here the relation reverses itself: instead of beginning with the object and grasping it theoretically in the concept, the judging subjectivity here starts out from the concept and wants to understand practically how
 [145] a given concept has been realized in the determinate object. "The stone is a natural

product like this”; “the plant is a natural product like this”; such antilogical judgments presuppose that the one judging is originally certain of the concept’s objective validity, and the judgment now decides in each individual case how the concept in question has realized itself in the given object. From this standpoint there can here be talk of the object’s representing its concept, signifying the concept, receiving its significance and therewith its interpretation from the concept. “Is this formation a leaf, or is it perhaps a branch?” here is in botany a matter that must be investigated more closely. What now does the botanist do? He sets the concept branch, and the manner in which this concept realizes itself morphologically, sharply over against the concept leaf and the morphological appearance of the leaf-concept, and the judgment then falls that this, e.g., “must be a branch!” Here it is seen expressly that the object signifies its concept, and receives its interpretation and significance from the concept.

The reciprocal determination of judgment and object has shown itself to be both logical and antilogical. In the logical judgment the determination is anticipating, in the antilogical it is realizing, in the logical-antilogical it is explicating. “But” — it will be asked — “how can a judgment at one and the same time be both logical and antilogical? The logical judgment has its form, the antilogical has its; but has logic any form for a judgment that is both logical and antilogical?” We answer: a special form for the logical-antilogical judgment logic assuredly does not have, insofar as by special form one will think exclusively of a special proposition. But no weight is laid here upon the special proposition; the whole weight must fall upon the special thought. The special thought utters itself in all judgments that expressly indicate that the one judging recognizes, in the produced object, the concept of the production. Such judgments announce themselves under very different turns of phrase: “this must be a branch”; “so must a building be”; “this is a poor specimen, an excellent specimen [146] of” “an abnormality of” etc.

If reflection is now directed particularly upon the concept immanent in the production, then other is determined point for point by other, objective by objective upon objective possibilities; through the objective possibilities and their conditioned realization the observer sees a reflected gleam of the thoughts that guide the activity of the principle; the inner is absorbed into the outer, and we must, in the objective

sense, affirm the poet's words: "die Natur hat weder Kern noch Schale". If, on the other hand, reflection is directed upon the difference between the concept and the activity, then human knowledge meets a twofold barrier. In the first place it must acknowledge it to be impossible to pursue the reflection of the immanent natural concept in the transitional forms of transcendence through all intermediate determinations into the infinite depth of the ideal system. In the second place it must acknowledge it to be impossible to reproduce productions that presuppose a creative unity of knowledge and power, of antilogical judgments and practical-antilogical propositions.

How the concept of a triangle guides the construction of a triangle can become clear to us, for we can both think the concept and construct the triangle; but how the concept of the organism can move the organic principle, and the principle moved by the concept the material parts, will, under the present conditions of human cognition, never become transparent: we can see *that*, but not *how*. Whether, then, we consider the concept's immanence or its transcendence, nature has in both respects its mystery, its inner, an inner that loses itself in the unfathomable; with this explanation it sounds, not like a philistine remark, but like a voice from the deep: "Ins Inn're der Natur dringt kein erschaffner Geist".

But although the interpretation of the concept's relation to the object thereby produced must remain imperfect, insofar as the unity of thinking and real producing is [147] imperfect, it nevertheless stands just as firm that the produced object can be explained only by a subjectivity that is able, in a logical system of antilogical judgments, to reproduce the production. The explicative functions have significance not merely for human knowledge, they have absolute significance for the divine: the knowing power that produces the object is eternally one with the powerful knowledge that explains the production and in the produced sees the concept satisfied.⁶²

γγ) *The Idea in Judgment and Object: ideal Power-Functions*. The real world is a world of objects, the ideal a world of thoughts; thought has as thought its expression in the judgment, and therefore the relation between judgment and object is, from the standpoint of totality, decisive for the determination of the relation between the ideal

⁶²It is said in the language of religion: "And God saw everything that he had made, and behold, it was all very good". That the explication must in the logical sense take up determinations of such categories as: appraisal, acknowledgment, recognition, etc., goes without saying.

and the real world. The ideal world has inner existence in the word of knowledge, the real outer existence in the word of power: by the power of the word the dualism is carried through; by the power of the word the dualism must again be sublated. In the sublation of the dualism the Absolute, the idea, is seen again; but the idea, the Absolute, cannot with its deep self-opposition possibly come to revelation in any merely finite and relative form; the Absolute demands an infinite and absolute form; but an infinite and yet absolute form can be given only in the word.

Through the word, the word of omnipotence, the Absolute moves in a double circuit, a subjective and an objective. In the subjective circuit the power is ideal-real; the real world proceeds from the ideal and returns in infinity to it: the Absolute [148] is posited in subjective form, and this Absolute, the Absolute in subjective form, corresponds to the ideality of the power-word. In the objective circuit the power is real-ideal; the ideal world mirrors the real, as the latter encircles itself through subjectivity: the Absolute is posited in objective form, and this Absolute, the Absolute in objective form, corresponds to the reality of the power-word. Such is the self-opposition of the Absolute. The self-opposition of the Absolute then shows itself, according to its actual unity, objectified in a power-language corresponding to the principle of doubling. Thus:

1) *The Ideality of the Power-Word: imperative Functions.* In the course of the development of the relation between judgment and object the power-word has already presented both its ideal and its real side: the development has proceeded in such a way that it runs back into itself from anticipating through executive and explicative functions: it begins and ends with the anticipation. Seen cursorily, it might seem as though the explicative functions placed themselves in direct opposition both to the executive and to the anticipating ones, and in this way formed a final conclusion; but this is not how the matter stands when it is seen in the principle: the explicative functions form, on the contrary, an essential presupposition for the anticipating ones.

That the anticipation is determined by objective considerations, a look at the actual, has been shown above; it is the objective possibilities that are at issue. But the objective possibilities are discovered only by the interpretation of the actual, and hence only by explicative functions. That the explication cannot satisfy the infinite subjectivity by

finite results is then also easy to see. The result satisfying in the finite sense would have to be a determinate object, a completed work, in which the judging subjectivity, explicating the work's significance, could see the concept perfectly realized; but the object, the Object, which here represents the satisfied concept, is in the quality of an
 [149] actual object subject to change; through the change the object adequate to the concept becomes precisely inadequate: the actuality determined by the concept is, so to speak, pregnant with possibilities. If the realization of the new possibilities is now also to satisfy the concept, the comprehending subjectivity must by anticipating functions again determine these possibilities and preform the actuality in which the concept is to be realized. The new actuality is then once more an object adequate to the concept, which by being changed becomes inadequate; the inadequate object then conditions a new anticipation, and so on to infinity.

If the eternal circuit of the anticipations is now intuited in the light of the Absolute, then the whole of actuality, with all the elements belonging to its infinite totality, becomes shone through by ideality, a medium for the idea's self-revelation; every actuality-element is by the anticipation a moment of the idea from the beginning: every link in the whole of actuality, every actual shape has, according to its objective-subjective possibility as idea-moment, originally been anticipated and objectively preformed in the infinite subjectivity. In the eternal circuit of the anticipations the real world is seen to proceed unceasingly from the ideal; the real system is preformed in the ideal system: the Absolute is in its subjective circuit.

The actual productions find themselves, then, in a double system of relations; from the objective side they are subjected to the conditions of finitude and forfeited to relativity; from the subjective side they are announcements of the unconditioned, utterances of the Absolute. Insofar now as a production directly utters the Absolute in the word of power, it shows itself as a primitive natural production; insofar as it belongs, in the circle of its conditions, to relativity and to finite causality, it ranks in a class with ordinary natural products. The primitive natural production is accordingly also called, insofar as emphasis is here laid in a special sense upon the ideality of
 [150] the power-word, a *creation*. Since now religion has in its language impressed upon the category creation a quite peculiar stamp, the question arises in this connection

how the religious significance of the category stands to the scientific one, and what dogmatics, especially the speculative, has done to clarify this relation.

How “revealed religion” expresses itself in the narrative of the creation is well known. Whether we translate the first verse of Genesis by: In the beginning God *created*, or by: In the beginning God *had created* the heaven and the earth, the creation is in both cases conceived as an event, for which reason it is also aptly presented in the form of a narrative: to the category event there corresponds the category narrative. If the religious narrative is now to be transformed into a link in a doctrinal edifice, then the representation uttered in the narrative must, if not exactly changed into concept, yet be fixed by a conceptual determination, in order to be able to be set up as dogma. Thus the doctrine of creation passes from religion through theology over into dogmatics.

If we choose as an example one of the older orthodox definitions of creation: *Actio Dei triuni externa qua is res omnes visibiles ex nihilo, sex dierum spatio, solo liberrimæ voluntatis suæ imperio omnipotenter et sapienter produxit, in nominis sui laudem et hominum utilitatem* (Quenstedt), it is seen from this that dogmatics, as ecclesiastical doctrinal concept, conceives the creation as an event at the beginning of time; to this there then corresponds the creation out of nothing, a creation that is referred exclusively to God’s free, omnipotent will.

Between the fixed creation-dogma of the doctrine of the Church and the rational creation-category of which the doctrine of the idea can avail itself, when it sees in primitive natural productions a determinate utterance of the Absolute, a preformation of the infinite subjectivity, there is a yawning chasm, an engulfing abyss. This abyss, [151] this chasm, speculative dogmatics has nevertheless pretended to be able — of course, to a certain degree — to fill up and level out; we shall now see what “filling” it uses for the filling, and how it sets about levelling the chasm.

According to the doctrine of the Church the creation is a miraculous event, not a fundamental relation; every accessory representation of an eternal creation-relation, a creation from eternity, must be rejected as an intolerable heresy. According to the doctrine of the idea the creation is a fundamental relation, not a miraculous event; every accessory representation of miracle and miraculous event must be rejected as

an imagination.

It is now in characteristic agreement with the ambiguous standpoint of speculative dogmatics — for the standpoint is from first to last an ambiguity — that in all principal points it is moved by heterogeneous considerations, motives that work against one another and end by blunting and neutralizing one another mutually. This is seen especially in the treatment of the creation-dogma. Dogmatic speculation will not break with orthodoxy, will at any price avoid the appearance of heresy; here is the first objective consideration, the ecclesiastical motive. By virtue of the ecclesiastical motive speculation makes a show of being in earnest about the creation as a miraculous event, about the creation out of nothing, about the creation out of unconditioned freedom. “The Mosaic creation-history expresses the fundamental thought of the creation in this, that the world came to be by God’s almighty word. He spoke: “Let there be light”! and there was light. Each of the six days of creation arises only by virtue of the almighty creator-word”. To a certain degree the creation out of nothing is accordingly emphasized in agreement with this as well: “In creating, God calls the non-being into existence. This is the significance of the old doctrine that God created the world out of nothing”.

[152] But, of course, these emphases naturally hold good only to a certain degree. Here there is, besides the objective consideration for the Church, yet another objective consideration, the objective consideration for science. Moved by the scientific motive, speculation turns gently, for the uninitiated almost imperceptibly, away from the ecclesiastical. The creation is now not merely a miraculous event, but a fundamental relation, the relation in which God must originally stand to the world. By virtue of the scientific motive “each of the six days of creation” then becomes “each new epoch in the world-system”. The nothing out of which the world is created is not = 0, against which representation there holds: *ex nihilo nihil fit*; the nothing out of which the world is created is then neither the orthodox nothing, that *nihil negativum, negatio omnis entitatis*, according to which a Hollazius can meet Aristotle with a proposition such as this: *ex nihilo nihil per vires naturæ generatur; at per vim Dei infinitam omnia creata sunt ex nihilo*. Nor can the scientific motive agree well with the orthodox when the talk is of the unconditioned freedom (*solum liberrimæ voluntatis imperium*) with

which God in the ecclesiastical sense has created the world. To be sure God has on the one side created the world with full freedom; but on the other side the world has nevertheless come to be with indefeasible necessity. To be sure it is a love-necessity; but necessity is nevertheless always necessity. "Just because God is love, he *cannot* close himself off as the God "of the ideas", but *must* determine himself, etc. Yes, he must determine himself, for it is "freedom's exceeding riches, which cannot do otherwise than will" ... See, now the result is just as ambiguous as the point of departure.

When the Church now asks after freedom, necessity goes up into "freedom's exceeding riches"; and when science demands necessity, why, then "freedom's exceeding riches, which cannot do otherwise than will" ..., goes under in necessity. "From this standpoint it is evident in what significance we deny, and in what significance we [153] affirm, the proposition: Without the world God is not God".

In what significance do we then deny the proposition? In the ecclesiastical orthodox significance, naturally! for necessity goes under in freedom. In what significance do we affirm the proposition? In the scientific, that is to say: in the speculative scientific significance, naturally! for freedom goes under in necessity. Do we then really deny the proposition? Yes, for the ecclesiastical emphasis falls on freedom. But is it now also certain that we really deny the proposition? No, for the scientific emphasis falls nevertheless on necessity. Thus Yes and No become at last a good theology.

"But", one might object, "Yes and No are in this connection dialectical determinations of one and the same thing; freedom is a dialectical determination of necessity, necessity a dialectical determination in freedom: why should dogmatics not have the same scientific right to avail itself of dialectic as philosophy has"? To this it must be answered that philosophy, as far as dialectic is concerned, is bound to make a distinction between the two-sided and the ambiguous. This distinction can, in the present connection, where everything turns upon determinations of the ideality in the word of power, be made clear by an elucidation of the power-word's *imperative* functions.

In the executive functions there showed itself a practical difference between the determining thought and the actual action determined by thought; the unity corresponding to the difference is to be sought in the practical self-determining, in the

will. But the will's ideal acting upon the bodily real must immediately rest upon a bidding identical with acting. One can paraphrase pure willing in many ways, but the determining that proceeds from the will is essentially commanding and bidding. Insofar as the actual production is conceived as a realized concept, it stands at the
 [154] same time as objective expression for a Become of subjectivity, a sign of the power of ideality. The fact is a factum; every factum presupposes a *fieri*, every *fieri* a *fiat*: in the Absolute's subjective circuit the executive functions go up into the imperative ones.

In consequence of the imperative functions every factum is thus led back to a *fiat*, the objective in the production back to the subjective, the power-word in the object back to the word of knowledge in the judgment; but to refer factum to *fiat*, the objective with its conditions to the subjectivity determining in the concept, is, in other words, to subordinate necessity to freedom, to lead the activity of nature back to creation. The validity of the imperative functions must in this respect be acknowledged by the doctrine of the idea just as much as by the doctrine of faith; but when the acknowledgment is more closely determined, the chasm opens anew, the deep chasm that sets a separation between faith and knowledge.

In the doctrine of faith the divine Become is taken absolutely; the act of creation is unconditionally free, the divine power and will knows nothing, will know nothing, of any impelling necessity whatever. God is God from eternity; but the world is not from eternity; God is God from eternity — without the world. The motive for the creation, possibility for the creation, plan and purpose for the creation, all is gathered in one single moment and concentrated with infinity's energy in one word, one single word, the almighty word: *Become!* With this word time begins, prior to this word is eternity; with this word the world begins, prior to this word is God alone, God without the world.

This absolute conception of the absolute Become on the part of faith the doctrine of the idea is not able to appropriate. That God is God from eternity means, when the doctrine of the idea is to translate it into the concept, that the divine essence, the subjectivity free in its inner infinity, is with necessity. No almighty Become can
 [155] bid the Godhead itself become something; no almighty Become can bid the Godhead itself become nothing. But in the concept as concept selfhood could not possibly be

if otherness, the self's opposite, were not originally; seen in the concept as concept subjectivity, the subjectivity free in its inner infinity, could not be if objectivity, the real objectivity, the object's outwardly actual world, were not actually. The almighty Become that was to call the real objectivity from non-being to being, this same almighty Become would then also have to call the infinite subjectivity from non-being to being; the almighty Become that was to call the outwardly actual world from nothing to something would at the same time have to call the inner, divine essence itself from nothing to something. This almighty Become, unconditioned in its absoluteness, is to science an incomprehensible.

But when science cannot comprehend a coming-to-be out of nothing, how can it then acknowledge the category of creation? Here weight must again be laid upon the imperative functions. What is rational in the creation rests, like what is rational in the ideality of the power-word, the almighty Become, upon the fundamental relation of the subjective and the objective: in this fundamental relation selfhood, the infinite subjectivity that through another relates itself to itself, is eternally the overpowering, that which overreaches in everything. By the power that overreaches into the infinite the subjective determining, the divine Become, acquires original significance for all natural productions; out of this significance there shines forth what is rational in the category of creation. The doctrine of the idea can from this standpoint cognize that the world is created, that it has come to be out of nothing in original opposition to God; but the coming-to-be out of nothing of which the doctrine of the idea speaks is in categorical conflict with the creation out of nothing upon which the doctrine of faith builds.

It has been treated in several places in our foregoing how philosophy has striven with itself in order to bring matter's reality into accord with reason's demand; it has [156] been shown that the solution of the riddle must be sought in the concept of power: the masses with their atoms are facts, punctual manifestations of power's immediacy. Since now power's real immediacy is a moment in power's own reality, and the real power in subjectivity itself identical with the ideal, it is understood from this that the subjectivity which anticipates everything actual and preforms all existent shapes cannot have either eternally independent atoms or material or chaos outside its power,

which overreaches in all things. All determinations of material, all material elements are real negations in the Godhead's ideal power, antilogical moments in the all-capable ideality; everything is formed and produced by power itself, the divine power: outside the divine power there is nothing, nothing at all, out of which something can be formed.

But with such a nothing the doctrine of faith cannot be content. For faith the creation out of nothing means that the whole world at omnipotence's bidding proceeds forth out of nothing; herewith it is presupposed that the world, before the Creator uttered his Become, was nothing, nothing at all, that there goes, as shown above, an eternity before the final creation, and that in that eternity there was no actual world. This religious fundamental thought no doctrine of the idea will be able to raise to scientific concept. Were God to be thought as being an eternity before the world, then the ideal power would indeed have to be an eternity before the real. With the real power, with the real manifestation of the divine power, the world is there instantly; — for what is the world, seen from the standpoint of creation, other than the real manifestation of divine power? — If, then, a whole eternity elapses before the creating Become lets the world come forth, then a whole eternity also elapses before the creating Become gives the ideal power reality. But the ideal power by itself, without the real power, is only half-power, not omnipotence; only the identity of ideal and real power is omnipotence.

[157] Seen from this standpoint the miracle of creation now becomes two miracles, the one, if possible, more wondrous than the other. First it is a miracle that the Creator's absolute Become posits a world in nothing's place, a world where formerly nothing was; this miracle presupposes omnipotence. Next, the coming-to-be of omnipotence is itself a miracle. In order to work the miracle with the world, the Creator must work a miracle with himself, in that he must call the real power from non-being to being; in order to work omnipotence's miracle, the Creator must first by a miracle make himself almighty.

And what then does this prove? it does not prove that religion is in the wrong against science, for religion does not undertake to make the miracle of creation comprehensible; but it proves that every scientific attempt to explain the almighty

Become by ascribing abstractly unconditioned validity to the imperative functions must end in the meaningless.

2) *The Reality of the Power-Word: indicative Functions.* In the system of the imperative functions subjectivity has disposal over the produced at all stages of the production. The production begins with the explication's transition or rather return to anticipation; from both sides the beginning is determined by the determining subjectivity. The beginning production is subjected to the executive functions; the actual actions, the practically antilogical propositions proceed from antilogical judgments, both in their unity from the thinking, acting subjectivity. The result of the completed production, the produced, which according to the appraisal acquires significance in this, that it both satisfies and yet does not satisfy the subjectivity explicating its production, then becomes a moment for new anticipations, new productions, etc., thus constantly subjected to subjectivity. Thus the Absolute has taken up all the elements and conditions of the production as moments in its own subjective circuit: subjectivity's superiority culminates in an all-capable Become.

But that the objective elements of the production are immanent in subjectivity [158] presupposes at the same time that the conceptual determinations, the subjective moments of the production, are immanent in objectivity. The whole circular movement must thus, in order to be seen in its reality, be considered from the objective side. In the anticipating as well as in the explicating functions it is just as much the object that determines the judgment as conversely the judgment that determines the object; but that the object determines the judgment means, in other words, that the objective determines the subjective. The infinite reciprocal determination of objective by subjective, and conversely, must then in the objective sense end with the objective determining itself, through the subjective, point for point, from the production's beginning to its completion. Herewith objectivity is expressly posited as the Absolute's own form, as the idea's immanent form: the Absolute is in its objective circuit, and this is the reality of the power-word.

By the ideality of the power-word the functions become imperative, by the reality of the power-word they become indicative; the task is to show how the indicative relates to the imperative. Everywhere that the objective determines the subjective,

the judgment aims at a straightforward indication of what the objective is; in this indication the indicative is seen. The judgments treated in formal logic are all indicative. That the determination of the indicative nevertheless cannot come forward in the usual logic has its ground in this, that it lacks its opposition, namely the imperative: we shall now see how the imperative fades away and comes to rest in the indicative.

The objective must be objectified, the objective productions preformed; but however great a part subjectivity may have in preformation and execution, its co-operation can nevertheless never go further than to determine the objective rightly objectively. [159] To determine the objective objectively is not to determine it immediately at any point, but to let it determine itself at all points. The objective in the production now comes forward from all sides in such a way that the producing subjectivity seems to vanish altogether. The only thing subjectivity still has to do is to objectify for itself the objective production; but this objectifying is so theoretical, so contemplative, that nothing is altered in what objectively takes place.

The difference between the finite and the infinite subjectivity is decisive on this point too. When the finite, the psychological subjectivity is to act determiningly upon objective productions, one notices at once the separation between the subjectively arbitrary and the objectively necessary; just because the objective sets such immediate barriers to the impotent subjectivity, the latter must in turn just as immediately break through these barriers at single points; here there arises a finite conflict between what the subject wills and what lies immediately in the objective; therefore in all manufactures and art-products the influence of subjectivity is so evident.

It is otherwise with the infinite subjectivity; its acting upon the objective does not take place in a finite manner and is for that reason not immediately recognizable. Although everything is anticipated, preformed and subjectively determined by the mighty Become, although there is not an element in the objective whose being has not been prepared subjectively, yet in actuality it looks as though the objective went by itself. Yes, the objective really does go by itself objectively; here in the appearance there is no delusion, no deception: in all productions the actual determination is a determination of objective by objective upon objective possibilities; subjectivity has only to look on, its functions are indicative.

The indicative in the functions has nevertheless not displaced, but transfigured the imperative: the indicative shows that the development of the objective is objective; [160] but the imperative shows that the objective is objective only by means of subjectivity. The indicative shows that the actions of nature are guided by principles and immanent concepts; but the imperative shows that the principles are selfhood-factors and the immanent concepts logical-antilogical utterances of a comprehending subjectivity. The indicative shows that every creation is really a natural production; but the imperative shows that every natural production is originally a creation. Here is identity of nature and creation.

But speculative dogmatics too wills identity of nature and creation; let us then again listen a little to speculative dogmatics. "As the Johannine view contains that the world's existence has its ground in a creative *producing*, so it contains that the world is in consequence of a *transition* from non-being to being, by a *becoming*, a coming-to-be, a birth, a *fieri*, a *γίγνεσθαι*. The world thus has a double beginning, a cosmogonic and a creative, a natural and a supernatural. The cosmogonic ... is the relative, the finite, which therefore is also split up into *sporadic* multiplicity ... But the innumerably many natural beginnings are all grounded in the one creative, supernatural beginning, in the divine Logos-will, which encloses within itself the wellspring of life and of light, and out of its spiritual depth releases the whole multiplicity of life-forces to free self-movement. And only because this supernatural beginning, only because the creating will continues to stir in the many finite beginnings and in free omnipresence illuminates and works through the natural development, can the latter thoroughly get beyond the chaotic ferment, can the sporadic oppositions be united and harmonized into an organic and systematic whole. The world must therefore in every moment of its existence be considered as *natura* or as organic self-development, and as *creatura* or as progressive revelation of the divine *will*, and it is the one only *because* it is the [161] other".

Against this utterance two objections hold: first, that it is adapted to the rational concept of creation, but stands in conflict with the ecclesiastical dogma; next, that it is kept in a merely descriptive form, and is for that reason conceptless.

As regards the first point, the creation out of nothing (*creatio ex nihilo*) is in the

ecclesiastical sense an expression for the divine will's absolute, unconditioned power over everything that we in the sense of actuality call otherness, objectivity, thing-causes, etc. So far is it from being the case that the divine self should essentially need such an otherness, that on the contrary it can abolish it whenever it will; so far is it from being the case that the divine subjectivity should for its own actuality need an actually objective, that it can, at whatever moment it will, abolish objectivity. That the things and the thing-causes are created out of nothing means that they can again, at whatever moment it pleases omnipotence, become nothing; to *creatio rerum* there corresponds in the old dogmatics — and that with true consistency — *annihilatio rerum*.

“There is in the history of theology no dogmatician who has held fast the concept of God's omnipotence with greater rigor than Malebranche, none who has expressed with greater scientific consistency what lies in the creation-dogma than precisely Malebranche. . . . To be sure Malebranche has not been able in a speculative manner to see into the Father's primal ground, to discover world-germs in the Son's Pleroma and to mediate the process of creation in the plastic force of the Spirit; but the dogma he has, the pure dogma of the creation out of nothing. Of this dogma he has not merely declared that it must be thought (for because it is now and then said of a dogma that it must be thought, it is not thereby said that it really is thought); no, he has in earnest attempted to think it, to hold the thought fast and to apply it to a scientific [162] understanding of the created. To apply the thought of creation to an understanding of the created means: to see the whole world under a double point of view: *nothing and yet really something*. The concept in which this contradiction is resolved is the concept omnipotence; the created is in itself nothing, but at omnipotence's bidding it has become something. He who now looks upon what has come to be so one-sidedly that he sees only its nothingness, for him the world is semblance and shadow. Whether theology will call him Pantheist or Acosmist is a matter of indifference; the point is that he denies the creation in denying omnipotence. He who looks upon what has come to be so one-sidedly that he sees only its reality, forgets its nothingness and ascribes essentiality to it, for him the coming-to-be is a natural process and the world a realm of nature. Whether dogmatics must for the rest reckon him among Deists,

Naturalists or Atheists is in this connection a matter of indifference; the point is that he denies the creation in denying omnipotence. . . . It has indeed been supposed that one could go a step further and improve the doctrine of creation by ascribing to the created some independence after all, some disposition to inner self-development, some capacity for activity . . . It is however a dubious improvement . . . For what is a relative independence? A degree of determinate being outside omnipotence, a self-acting which, however slight it may for the rest be, is nevertheless not omnipotence's acting, thus: an actual limit to omnipotence. If this actual limit is now meant in earnest, then omnipotence is an actually bounded power and no longer omnipotence. If on the other hand the Almighty still has, as before, the limit in his power, then the actual limit is still, as before, a nothing in itself, and the miraculous relation between Creator and creature must continue. A relation that has begun by a miracle must also be continued by a miracle: not merely for some moments, not merely, if I may so put it, for a week or a fortnight after the creation, but for centuries, for millennia, in the eternity of eternities must the created things continue to be in themselves what they originally are and have been, a nothing, a pure nothing for the Almighty. It is this consistency that Malebranche holds fast, and therefore he cannot think self-activity in any creature, be it angel or man; for essential self-activity is a divine matter, and God himself cannot create gods: *il n'en peut faire de véritables causes, il n'en peut faire des Dieux.*"⁶³ [163]

Are the causes of nature, the actual thing-causes, created, namely in the dogmatic-ecclesiastical meaning, or are they uncreated? This is the question, the inescapable fundamental question. If the question is answered with Yes: the causes of nature are created! then the world quite rightly has "a supernatural," a "creative" beginning; but then it is nonsense to speak of its *also* having a "cosmogonic", a "natural" beginning. If the question is answered with No: the causes of nature are uncreated, then the world quite rightly has a "natural" and "cosmogonic" beginning; but then it is nonsense to speak of the world's *also* having a "supernatural" and "creative" beginning.

Only on the condition that the category of creation is conceived rationally can the identity of nature and creation be comprehended. The contradiction that the

⁶³Om Theologiens Naturbegreb af R. Nielsen. I Anledning af Reformationsfesten 1855. p. 22 ff.

created should be both something and yet in itself nothing is then resolved in this, that power is self-power only by having power over another, and can have power over another only when this other itself stands in force. Separated from the infinite self-power the subsisting other is a semblance, a nothing; but in unity with self-power the existing other is substantial; its substantiality is, by opposition to self-power, the latter's real moment.⁶⁴ The contradiction that there should here be an actual limit [164] to omnipotence is resolved in this, that the actual limit, power's own real negation, precisely expresses power's reality: without real negation power would be only ideal, not real; but the abstractly ideal power is only half-power, not omnipotence. Instead of making omnipotence into an actually bounded, thus restricted power, the actual limit is on the contrary a categorical expression for the original doubling of power, for the power-word's eternal reality.

When speculative dogmatics here and there makes a run at explaining the created's "given independence" from this, that God renounces his power, or that he releases "the magical possibilities," then this is an unmistakable testimony that "the dogmatic talent" has renounced thought and released all manner of fantastic notions. Let one but try to think something by a notion such as this, that the Almighty in the creation has really — of course, to a certain degree — renounced his power. What concept is one now to form of such a renunciation; it must surely have happened either by power or by impotence? If it has happened by impotence, thus from lack of power, if God during the creation has, on account of the "given independence" of the created, fallen into a certain voluntary impotence, then the miracle of creation becomes not a miracle of omnipotence but a miracle of impotence. If on the other hand it has happened by omnipotence; if God during the creation has renounced his power in such a way that this his renunciation has precisely become a proof of his infinite power, unrestricted in all respects, then he has also, by renouncing his power, retained his power, and consequently not renounced his power at all.

To speculate about the creation without insight into the logical functions belonging here is a dubious business; only by reducing the relation between Creator and creature to a fundamental relation between subjectivity and the objective actuality, and thereby

⁶⁴Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 112–113.

to a logical relation between imperative and indicative functions, will it be possible to [165] come to clarity about categories so rich in content as *nature* and *creation*.

In consequence of the imperative functions the natural objects, the actual objects, are moments for the producing subjectivity, the infinitely overreaching self-power; in consequence of the indicative functions the natural objects, the existing objects, have essential independence over against subjectivity; in consequence of the imperative functions the thinking, judging subjectivity is *acting*, in consequence of the indicative functions the acting subjectivity is thinking, *judging*. The fundamental relation between the indicative functions and the actual world of the natural objects then lets itself be reduced to the idea in judgment and object.

If the actual object could really determine the judgment without itself being determined by the judgment, then subjectivity would have to relate itself, in its system of indicative functions, to the natural objects as a mirror to the mirrored objects. But even in the purest contemplation the subjective mirroring is nevertheless more than a mirroring; the subjective mirroring is in its ideality an incessant thinking and judging. Outside the idea, thus on the level of finitude, the object about which judgment is passed stands in an outward and indifferent relation to the judgment and the judging subjectivity. The object determines the judgment, but the judgment's indicative function does not make it recognizable that the judgment at the same time determines the object. Where this moment is psychologically emphasized, the distance between subjectivity and "the thing in itself" becomes, as we have seen above, only the greater.

It is otherwise when the relation between judgment and object is seen in the light of the idea. Here it becomes clear that the object can determine the judgment only insofar as the judgment determines the object. The most decisive expression of the fact that the judgment essentially determines the object is had in the imperative functions. On the basis of the imperative functions the divine subjectivity consider the objects [166] of nature in their objective immediacy as productions of the word of power. The objective element in these productions, which is characteristic of the power-word's reality, is determinative for the judgment's indicative functions.

The judging subjectivity, which contemplatively lets the object determine the

judgment, rests with infinite superiority in the contemplation of the objective development of the objective, because in its self-absorption it eternally knows that the object which determines the judgment is originally itself determined by the judgment; the contemplative subjectivity, which in the system of indicative functions conceals itself beneath the productions of nature, then knows itself identical with the practical subjectivity, which breathes spirit through the principles and in every natural production recognizes its own creature.

3) *The categorical Power-Language: interpreting Functions.* What it signifies that there are thoughts in things, concepts in objects, must now be clear from the foregoing. But if there are thoughts in things, then there must surely also be *meaning* in things; is it then certain that there is, in an objective sense, meaning in things? In relation to the pure concept, opining stands far beneath knowledge; but with respect to the relation between concept and existence an insight into the meaning of things can stand above an objective knowledge of the essence of things. For the cognition of the objective essence of things it is sufficient to lay finite causality at the ground and to explore the laws of things; for the apprehension of the meaning of things there is required a glance at the task which existence has solved, an insight into the purpose that was to be attained by means of things, a purpose which alone can be said to give them, not an immediate being, but an essential significance; that there are *thoughts* in things, physics teaches; but what it properly means that there is *meaning* in things must be cleared up in logic.

[167] In the logically explicative a distinction has been made between a comprehending of the object as a whole and a comprehending of the object's parts. In this respect there is said to be "a *twofold kind of comprehending*." — "As regards, namely, the given object in the *whole*, there is discerned," it is said, "*how* the connection therein is constituted, or *how* the manifold therein is bound into unity. As regards, on the other hand, the *singularities* and the single relations, there is discerned, a) *why they are* and b) *why they are* so constituted *as they are*, in that there is discerned how the whole object's mode of connection *carries or can carry them along with it in this way*; so that they, with the constitution they have, are seen as *co-requisite (integrating)* and at the same time *co-engaging* or at all events *co-belonging*, or naturally *entailed*, members

in the whole. When therefore, as regards the object in the whole, merely the *inner constitution* or its *mode of existence* is comprehended, there are on the other hand discerned, as regards the singularities and the relations, at the same time their *grounds of existence* (*rationes essendi*), or at all events their grounds of possibility, and moreover their *existence-significance* or their *real significance* in the given whole. The whole is here only *presented* or *described* according to its inner constitution; the singularities, on the other hand, are at the same time *interpreted* and *explained*. The first kind of comprehending we will — it is said further — “call a *connection-comprehending*, perhaps also a *formal comprehending*, and the concept a *connection-concept*, perhaps also a *formal concept*; the latter, on the other hand, with respect to the use of the word *reality*, a *real comprehending*, and the concepts *real concepts*. A comprehending of the former kind lies here at the ground of the comprehension of the latter kind; for it is the connection-concept concerning the whole object’s how, its inner how namely (which must not be confused with its outer constitution), from which the insight into the why of all the *singular*, from which therefore the real comprehending in respect [168] of all this singular, proceeds.”

That the distinction thus set up between connection-concept and real concept is superficial, unhelpful and one-sided must, with a little reflection, easily strike the eye. The whole cannot possibly determine the parts without the parts conversely having to determine the whole; if the why of the parts is to be derived from the how of the whole, then the why of the whole must also be derived from the how of the parts. Everywhere that there can be talk of a comprehending, there must be a grounding, and thus a why. Without why no ground, without ground no grounding, without grounding no comprehending, without comprehending no concept. A connection-concept concerning the whole object’s inner how without a why cannot be laid at the ground of any insight into the why of the singular, and that for the simple reason that such a connection-concept cannot be given. That there can be, e.g., two kinds of tailors: ladies’ tailors, who do not sew for gentlemen, and gentlemen’s tailors, who do not occupy themselves with sewing for ladies, is not contrary to sound human understanding and is not to be censured in logic; but that there should now also be two such kinds of concepts as: pure how-concepts, which do not concern themselves

with any why, and peculiar why-concepts, which float on top of “the inner how”, is contrary to sound human understanding, and must be censured in logic.

The connection-concept concerning the whole object’s inner how is nothing else, and indeed cannot be anything else, than the concept of the mutual connection of the *single parts*; but the concept of the parts’ mutual connection is nothing else and cannot, regarded essentially, be anything else than the concept of their constitution as determined in the connection: as the connection is, so is the constitution, as the constitution is, so is the connection. If it is now impossible to form for oneself [169] a connection-concept of the whole without comprehending the connection of the parts, then it is also impossible to comprehend the connection of the parts without comprehending *why* each single part has just this and no other constitution. “The insight into the why of all the singular” can only be laid at the ground of “a connection-comprehending” of the object’s inner how insofar as this connection-comprehending is itself laid at the ground of an insight into the why of all the singular. — But if we regard the distinction set up between “connection-comprehending” and “real comprehending” as a groping indication of the difference, decisive for the cognition of existence, between the objective concept and the meaning uttered in the concept, it does after a fashion admit of application.

“The grounding reflection” has already taught us that the sufficient ground is objective as ground of existence only insofar as it is at the same time subjective as motive-ground. To the two-sided ground there corresponds here a two-sided why. The objective why reflects itself in the objective concept, the connection-concept which expresses the object’s inner how; from this how there then shines forth the why of the whole as well as of the parts: this reflection of why and how gives us the concept, but not its meaning. One may think of natural products such as feldspar, granite and the like. It will yield no meaning to lay the concept of feldspar’s inner how at the ground of an insight into the why of its single parts, when this why is not to concern the ground of existence but the motive. As it goes with the feldspar, so with the whole earth, so long as the comprehension keeps to the purely objective. If, on the other hand, we ask after the meaning of the feldspar and of the earth-globe’s existence, it is at once noticed that what is aimed at here is not the objective ground,

the ground of existence, but the subjective ground of that which exists, the motive, the motive-ground holding for the production of the feldspar and of the earth-globe.

If the object is not a natural product but a manufactured article, e.g. a clock, then [170] it certainly lies near at hand to lay the connection-concept concerning the whole's inner how at the ground of the cognition of the single parts' why, for the whole's how involuntarily takes on the stamp of an arbitrarily chosen task. In the clock the master-workman has solved a determinate task in a determinate way; therefore the clock has become such a one, just such a whole, with such parts in such a composition. The whole is, on the master-workman's side, purpose and the parts means: it is thus a subjective, not an abstractly objective why that is here reflected upon. Yet even from the teleological standpoint it holds that it is not merely the why of the means that must be sought in the how of the purpose, but also conversely the why of the purpose that must be sought in the how of the means: in the anticipation it is the purpose that motivates the choice of the means, insofar as the determining considerations are subjective; but it is conversely the means offering themselves that motivate the choice of the purpose, insofar as the determining considerations are objective.

Everywhere that the relation between a whole and its parts admits of being apprehended teleologically, the work in question will speak to the observer in a language that interprets for him the master-workman's meaning. So surely as there is meaning in the thing, it must be just as possible for the productive subjectivity to express itself in facts as to express itself in words; but speech in facts is different from speech in words: the language of facts is a *categorical power-language*.

A swinging pendulum represents an objective concept, but this concept is as yet without meaning; if, on the other hand, the swinging pendulum is set by the escapement in reciprocal action with a clock's wheelwork, then the union of pendulum and escapement in the actual composition is just as eloquent as the union of subject and predicate in the logical proposition: the pendulum's swing then yields a determinate meaning. That a barrel, wound about with a cord whose free end bears a weight, is set in motion by gravity presents to the reflecting person an objective concept; but [171] the concept for itself is as yet without meaning. If, on the other hand, the barrel is connected with the clockwork's barrel-wheel, and in such a way that the latter

follows the barrel only when this is turned by the weight's heaviness, but not when, during the winding up, it is turned in the opposite direction: then we have in the mechanical connection of such members just as clear a meaning as in a grammatical connection of the words of language. Just as the single mechanical member for itself can yield no meaning, so the single word for itself can of course yield no meaning either. The single word for itself can, by the mere naming, designate a concept; the single member for itself can, by its individual shape, its mere appearance, represent a concept. The propositions of language can, according to the meaning, be partly principal clauses, partly subordinate clauses, partly protases, partly apodoses, etc.; the same holds in corresponding fashion of the compositions, the practical-antilogical propositions in the machine that solves its task. Every composition, every practical-antilogical proposition, is determined by a logical-antilogical judgment. What the master-workman has through the system of such judgments said to himself during the production of his work, that he now says to the thinking observer through the system of real propositions in which the completed work yields meaning.

To the language of facts, the categorical power-language, there corresponds a system of *interpreting* functions. The interpreting functions have at first glance a striking similarity to the explicative ones. In both it is a matter of a recognition of the concept uttered in the production, a judging of what is produced, a development of its significance; and yet the difference between explicative and interpreting functions can be brought out with categorical emphasis.

By the explicative function the produced object is measured chiefly by the production's indwelling concept: "this wheel is badly made"; "this wheel is well made"; [172] "thus shall a wheel be". The explication motivates all judgments by the concept as concept; it keeps to the concept of production, not to the producing subjectivity. By the interpreting function the matter goes the other way round. The concept of production could not, as shown above, be indwelling in the production if it were not at the same time hovering above it. The hovering concept, subjectivity's proper meaning-concept, is decisive, and that in a twofold sense, for the interpretation.

In the first place the producing subjectivity must necessarily anticipate the solution of its task in objective as well as in subjective respects; it then lies in the nature of

the case that the conditions in the objective can in many ways alter and restrict the execution of the original plan. Here there shows itself a difference between what is attained and what was intended, between the production's indwelling and hovering concept, between the thought uttered in the work and the master-workman's proper meaning. From this standpoint the productions of nature in their immediate finitude may even be said to stand in a certain disproportion to the divine meaning, a disproportion which the all-capable subjectivity nevertheless sublates again by divine interpretation.

If there is now on the master-workman's side a finite difference between the completed work and what was originally intended, then — and this is the next principal point — this difference must surely acquire a heightened significance for the outsider who sets about understanding the factual language of the production and reading the master-workman's meaning out of the work: from this standpoint the difference between the merely explicative and the interpreting functions is unmistakable. Through the explicative functions the contemplating subjectivity has directly to do with the relation between the work and its concept, the regard to the master-workman is a secondary regard; by the interpreting functions the observer will, on [173] the other hand, interpret in the work itself the master-workman's thoughts, grasp his original meaning; in this way he then has through the work chiefly to do with the master-workman's subjectivity. — Here is a turning point where the significance of the interpreting functions for teleology must properly strike the eye. Why is it that scientific consciousness has so much difficulty in coming to agreement with itself concerning the purpose of nature, the wisdom revealing itself in nature? Evidently because two strong considerations here come into conflict with each other: the regard to the objective, for nature is from first to last objective, and the regard to the subjective, for teleology is essentially subjective: means and purposes exist only for a judging subjectivity. Those who fix their gaze exclusively upon the objective must then consistently reject teleology's significance for the cognition of nature; those who one-sidedly fix their attention upon the subjective expose themselves to slipping their own individual meaning under the productions of nature, a meaning which then in turn comes into conflict with the objective concept indwelling in the productions.

Seen more closely, the conflict is grounded in teleology's own essence; for teleology will on no account let go of the objective; it will only lay it under the overreaching subjectivity. So long as the distinction between the objective and the subjective is critically fixed: either a subjective or an objective, teleology's problem will never be able to be solved. Kant felt this when, instead of making teleology's principle a constitutive principle, he made it a regulative one: the interpreting functions shine through, but the interpretation is as yet only psychologically subjective.

Sciences such as botany and zoology cannot refrain from applying categories of typically teleological origin; but so long as the ontology of subjectivity is not thoroughly cleared up, it will be impossible to decide how far the teleological principle [174] is "constitutive" or merely "regulative". One demands an objective knowledge of the subjective: this is the contradiction; one applies indicative functions where one absolutely must use the interpreting ones: this is the obscurity.

"If we hold fast" — to adduce an example from natural science — "to the presupposition that, with respect to the elementary as well as to the organic wholes, a distinction must be made between the rational and the meaningless: then the consequences fall out as of themselves. Just as an animal's organization would necessarily become meaningless if its organs stood in mutual conflict with one another, if it had, e.g., teeth like a beast of prey but limbs like a hoofed animal, so would a totality such as the solar system also become meaningless if the planets, instead of moving in a closed line about the sun, came to describe curves in which they removed themselves to infinity from it ... Indeed, if one — granted, what cannot without further ado rest upon accidental circumstances either, that the orbit absolutely had to be a conic section — had possibilities only for ellipse and parabola, one might even so let chance rule; for, it goes without saying, while the probability of a parabola is infinitely small, since among the infinitely many possible cases only a single one can be favorable to the parabola, the probability of the ellipse, which has an infinite multitude of favorable cases, is so decidedly preponderant that even the accidental would in this connection have to look like the in itself rational. But now there is here, as is well known, not merely a choice between ellipse and parabola, but also, what especially comes into consideration, a choice between ellipse and hyperbola; and a hyperbola makes the

system just as meaningless as a parabola. If we therefore go back to the beginning, the alternatives show themselves: either an ellipse or a hyperbola, that is to say: either a rational or a meaningless totality; here is an essential difference between the dominion of chance and that of reason".⁶⁵

Here in the interpretation of the phenomenon it is expressly aimed at giving the proof of the teleological as objective a character as possible, and yet the objective in the conduct of the proof is precisely what is insufficient. The proof is essentially subjective, built namely upon an *interpretation*. Were the proof to be completely objective, then it would have had to be precisely the parabola, not the ellipse, that corresponded to the in-itself rational. The proof would then come to run thus: "The parabola is, insofar as the orbit depends on accidental circumstances, the most improbable of all curves; since now the parabola is nevertheless the only rational one, it is seen from this that the rational cannot be explained by blind natural causes, but must be referred to a divine wisdom intervening in the course of things". [175]

What then does one demand, in order that the proof may be objective? The meaningless! First a discord is to be set between the natural causes and the rational; next the divine subjectivity is to use the discord in order to intervene in finite fashion and bring its wisdom to light; one demands, in other words, a discord between the indicative and the imperative functions in the Godhead itself: for the revelation of wisdom one demands wisdom's self-contradiction.

The scientific foundation of all natural teleology is the cognition that the objective productions are productions of a divine subjectivity; that the divine subjectivity in these productions utters eternal thoughts with the stamp of divine meaning. Every object is a word of power, every member a syllable, an element, a tittle in the system of practical-antilogical propositions that make up the categorical power-language. How far a human interpretation is able to hit upon the original meaning in this categorical power-language of actuality becomes a question for itself — here there can in any case only be talk of an approximation; but this is the absolute, that there is in things a meaning, a divine meaning, that the divine meaning corresponds punctually to a divine interpretation, that the interpreting functions have ontological validity for the [176]

⁶⁵Forelæsn. over "Phil. Propæd." Universitetsaaret 1861–62. p. 96–101.

idea itself.

γ) The Validity of the Judgment: the Modality of the Functions.

Throughout the whole preceding treatment of the judgment, with respect to its form as well as to its object, it has of course been constantly presupposed that the judgment as judgment must have validity. Only the valid judgment can logic acknowledge; the invalid it must reject. When here, notwithstanding, there is in what follows a special question about the judgment's validity, validity does not stand immediately against invalidity; but validity of one kind stands against validity of another. Insofar as one judges with full consciousness, there will in a judgment about the object always hover before the one judging a judgment about the judgment's validity. This judgment will, in relation to the constitution of the object as well as of the cognition, be different in essentially different cases; to investigate this difference is, in other words, to investigate *the Modality of the Functions*.

That, for an all-sided illumination of thought's activity, a distinction is made between functions of different kinds must not be understood as if the functions of different kinds had a special independence and an existence of their own in consciousness alongside one another; on the contrary! they are different forms under which the activity of thought comes forward, manners in which it brings itself to light. That thinking must become different by the different manners of operation is a matter of course; it is indeed, as one says, the manner on which in all things everything depends. But that the thinking which is of different kinds by its different manners of operation is notwithstanding one and the same thinking shows at the same time that the manner is not the matter itself, that essentially everything depends on the thinking, [177] not on the manner. The contradiction that the manner is at once both essential and yet unessential is a striking proof of thinking's substantiality; for only in thinking's substantiality does the contradiction find its solution.

In the imperative, indicative and interpreting functions, e.g., thinking is the same and yet not the same; that is to say: thinking becomes in the different functions essentially different from itself. The difference is so thoroughgoing that it looks as if each function-system must have its own principle; and yet there is here only one

principle: thinking's essence is in principle one and the same essence. Through an essential self-distinction thought is able to develop and hold fast its essential unity; thinking's ideal power over its oppositions gives the unity substantiality: the deeper the oppositions are, the stronger is the substantial unity. Since now thinking with its logical substantiality does not hold itself back behind, but passes wholly over into its functions, the functions must, despite their mutual essential difference, at the same time pass wholly over into thinking's unity.

In relation to one another, to keep to the example, the imperative, the indicative and the interpreting functions are different in ground and in operation. What is accomplished by the one system cannot be accomplished by the other; the relation in which the all-capable subjectivity sets itself to the objects by virtue of the imperative functions is in actuality quite another than that which is determined by the system of the indicative ones.

But with respect to thinking's substantial unity it is so far from being the case that the functions of the different systems should exclude one another or stand in conflict with one another, that they on the contrary are contained in one another, pass over into one another in an immanent manner, and harmonize. Thus the anticipating functions passed through the executive over into the explicative, and these again over into the former; thus the imperative functions came to rest in the indicative, in that the meaning conditioned by the unity-in-difference of both systems found its clarification [178] in the interpreting functions.

From the functions' reciprocal relation it is seen that their relative independence is one with their modality: to thinking's substantiality there corresponds the functions' modality; to the functions' modality there corresponds in turn the judgment's validity.

In formal logic the judgment's validity is treated under "the division of judgments according to their modality;" but modality itself is not investigated. In Kant modality has a merely subjective significance; in Hegel it is treated partly as measure, partly as mode of the Absolute⁶⁶ exclusively from the objective side; it shall now show itself

⁶⁶Cf. Die objektive Logik. Erstes Buch. Dritter Abschnitt. p. 395: *Das Maaß*. Zweites Buch. Dritter Abschnitt. p. 191: *Der Modus des Absoluten*. In the 2nd Book's 3rd Division, p. 192, Hegel expresses himself among other things thus: "Der Modus, die *Aeußerlichkeit* des Absoluten, ist ... die als *Aeußerlichkeit gesetzte* *Aeußerlichkeit*, eine bloße *Art und Weise*; somit der *Schein* als *Schein*, oder die *Reflexion der Form in sich*; somit die *Identität mit sich*, welche das *Absolute* ist. In der That ist also

that modality's significance for the judgment and its functions is both objective and subjective.

Modality's subjective significance with respect to the judgment's validity shines forth immediately from the distinction between assertoric, problematic and apodictic judgments, insofar as the distinction is determined exclusively by the corresponding certitude of the judging subjectivity.

[179] So long as one now keeps one-sidedly to the subjective, the assertoric, the problematic and the apodictic can in manifold ways run into one another: the one may for his part have ground to express himself problematically about that concerning which the other straightforwardly judges assertorically, and conversely; indeed, so obscure can subjectivity be that the one judging imagines himself to know with apodictic certainty what he nevertheless possesses only in the form of assertions and immediate assurances.

It is otherwise when the matter is seen from the objective side. Hereby the judgment's matter, now in the form of object, now in the form of content, acquires a peculiar significance. That about which one judges can namely in part be of such a constitution that it one and alone is suited to an assertoric judgment, while another, according to its nature, expressly answers to a problematic one, and another again to an apodictic one. If it is a fault to use the assertoric judgment in a matter that demands an apodictic one, then it is also a fault to demand an apodictic judgment where there only can and shall be an assertoric one.

When the "dogmatic talent" assures us that the truth of faith is to him "the most certain of all", he utters his conviction in an assertoric judgment, and against this nothing can in and for itself be objected; but when the same "talent", from an inward urge toward speculation, declares that the doctrine of faith seriously stands in need of scientific grounding, that its content, in other words, is suited to the apodictic judgment: then everything goes round for the "talent". For of what kind is the certitude now? If faith as faith gives the full certitude, then the testimony is the highest, and the believer then expresses himself in assertoric judgments. "Verily, verily I say unto you", such an opening announces precisely the assertoric. If, as concerns the certitude, faith as

erst im Modus das Absolute als absolute Identität gesetzt; es ist nur, was es *ist*, nämlich Identität mit sich, als sich auf sich beziehende Negativität, als *Scheinen*, das *als Scheinen* gesetzt ist".

faith cannot be enough for the dogmatician, although the truth of faith is to him “the most certain of all”, then by scientific grounding he must thus be seeking a still higher certitude, a certitude by which the truth cognized in faith can become to him still more certain than the most certain of all, a seeking that is incontrovertibly meaningless.

The meaninglessness in the alleged seeking becomes still more conspicuous when [180] we consider that the way from faith’s assertoric to science’s apodictic judgment goes through the problematic.

When Anselm with his *credo, ut intelligam* builds upon the assertoric, Cartesius with his *de omnibus dubitandum est* expressly points to the problematic. If the one of these directions is true, then the other must, as concerns the cognition of faith, evidently be false. If Anselmus is right when he says: *fides præcedit intellectum*, then Cartesius must necessarily be wrong when he says: *dubitatio præcedit intellectum*; unless speculative dogmatics will apprehend the relation between faith and doubt in the same profound manner in which it apprehends the relation between creation and cosmogony, so that faith is essentially faith because it is doubt, just as creation is essentially creation because it is cosmogony, and doubt conversely doubt because it is faith, just as cosmogony is cosmogony because it is creation.

Let it now be with speculation as it will; we shall in what follows show modality’s objective significance, in that we shall show that the essential difference between assertoric, problematic and apodictic knowledge depends originally on the difference between the immediately determined, the undetermined and that determined in reflection. To the assertoric there correspond functions of immediate determinateness, to the problematic functions of sublated determinateness, to the apodictic functions of reflected determinateness.

αα) The assertoric Judgment: Functions of immediate Determinateness. That there is an immediate determinateness which does not admit of being dissolved in reflection has in our foregoing been emphasized every time we have had occasion, from one side or another, to treat of the antilogical. The antilogical has its ground of existence in itself, breaks through by power, is because it is, and to that extent does not admit [181] of being grounded. The sensible qualities in their existential immediacy do not admit of being grounded: no rational person can ask why the red is red, the hard hard, the

heavy heavy, as little as anyone can ask why the like is like, the height high and the depth deep. There are in all reflection reflexes of immediate determinateness, and in all immediate determinateness something that must be apprehended straightforwardly as it shows itself: to every such apprehension there answers an assertoric judgment. It is characteristic that the assertoric judgment has in its form a direction to actuality, that this direction coincides immediately with an assurance, and the assurance with immediate certainty: S is really (I assure you) P; the actual determinateness is namely not merely immediate, but in its immediacy antilogical, and no antilogical determinateness can give any other assurance than the one that is expressed in the assertoric judgment.

The assertoric judgment is logical-antilogical in a peculiar sense. Its form is logical, its content both logical and antilogical; in actuality it always gives us an antilogical content in logical form, but the logical form gives the content in turn a logical stamp. "The stone is really gray"; this judgment seems at first glance to be logical in content as well as in form, but if we look more closely, we easily discover that the logical content is only a determinateness reflected in the form: the actual content is in its actuality an existing object with an existing property, i.e. with a property inhering in existence. The predicate "gray" designates here not at all the general, but on the contrary the singular. A general judgment such as: "the stone is gray", can be an expression of the fact that the thing, the singular, is subsumed under a property (the general); but the assertoric judgment: "the stone is really gray", does not fit such designations. He who [182] says: "the singular is really the universal", is thoughtless; for in actuality the actual is never the universal, and that for the good reason that the actual as actual is always an immediately determinate, and the immediately determinate is not the universal. The assertoric judgment: "the stone is really gray", does not aim at gray in general, but at the gray in this immediate determinateness, the actual gray, the gray stone.

Since now the content of the assertoric judgment must always be of a two-sided character, *antilogical* by reason of the object, *logical* by reason of the form, it follows of itself that the development of the judgment's validity is laid out with particular regard to each of the principal sides and to their mutual relation. Thus we come to a separate treatment of the antilogical or of the objective side of modality, of the logical

or of the subjective side of modality, and finally of the logical-antilogical essentiality of the content, whereby the validity of modality is determined on all sides.

1) *The antilogical Element in the assertoric Judgment: the objective Side of Modality.* The assertoric judgment comprehends a sphere of its own, a sphere of infinite extent, namely the whole of actuality from the standpoint of the power-determinations, the antilogical elements. Actuality's world has indeed its essentialities, its grounds, its possibilities, laws, species, genera, etc., categories that in the last instance withdraw from the immediacy of assertoric knowledge; but here in this connection the express talk is not of essentialities in the actual, but of actuality's actual facts in their given diversity and infinite multiplicity. It must indeed be conceded that the various determinations of actuality with their antilogical immediacy incessantly alternate, are altered and transformed; the present vanishes, the existent is altered, that which exists goes to ground, etc.; but in all these alternations the one antilogical element is relieved point for point by the other. The present that vanishes gives place only to another present; [183] every present is now really *thus*, not otherwise; it determines the assertoric judgment and is determined in turn by this. That which exists passes away, it goes to ground; but the ground forms on that account no chasm between that which exists and passes away and that which exists and arises; at every point in the actual transition that which exists follows upon that which exists, everywhere *this!* and *this!* and *this!* Here is a stream of antilogical elements that knows no interruption: there are in the wall of actuality no cracks, no fissures.

If truth were immediately one with actuality, and actuality immediately one with the totality of the antilogical determinations, then the assertoric judgment would be truth's logically adequate expression; now, on the contrary, since the determination of actuality is only a moment, even if a real moment, in the actually true, the assertoric judgment can indicate only one side of truth, not truth itself, the whole truth. It is an error when the immediate determination of actuality is without further ado made one with truth; but it is also an error when the determination of actuality is volatilized in its immediacy and transformed into semblance because it is not truth itself. The relation between sense-perception and thinking will in this connection be able to be illuminated from a new standpoint.

The Sophist Protagoras started, as is well known, from the principal proposition that “man is the measure of all things, both of those that are, that they are, and of those that are not, that they are not”. It is a peculiar relation between sense-perception and thinking, between judgment and object, that thereby comes to light. That Protagoras starts from the sensible and originally lays emphasis on sense-sensation is certain; just as it is also unmistakable that he sophistically disparages thinking and undermines all cognition of truth. But it is also certain that Plato, however much he asserts the right [184] of thinking, has yet not quite thought himself into that which here lies at the ground of the sophistic way of viewing.

“Were man”, it is said in the Theaetetus, “the measure of things merely as a sense-perceiving individual, then an animal just as fully as the wisest man, indeed as a god, could cognize the true (ὅτι πάντων χρημάτων μέτρον ἐστὶν ὅς ἢ κυνοκέφαλος ἢ τι ἄλλο ἀτοπώτερον τῶν ἐχόντων αἰσθησιν).”

In this objection two very essential points are overlooked. In the first place the relation between the sensible and the actual, and therewith between the sensible and the true, is overlooked. In that Plato misjudges the sensible, he must, as was shown in the first chapter⁶⁷, necessarily misjudge actuality, and, in that he misjudges actuality, misjudge truth. In the second place the relation between judgment and object, and thereby the relation between a human and an animal sense-perception, is overlooked. In that Protagoras makes man, not the pig, not the werewolf, not the frog, the measure of things, he nevertheless apprehends, be it with clear or unclear consciousness, man expressly as judging subjectivity. When the one says: “the wind is really cold”, the other: “the wind is really warm”, then it is two assertoric judgments that bring forth the contradiction and thereby call forth the question about the true. The assertoric judgment is in this way, by reason of the sense-impression, set in no contingent but in an essential relation to the question. By merely setting the pig against the frog, the bird against the fish, the question of truth cannot arise at all: the question arises expressly through the contradiction, the contradiction through the assertoric judgment; but the pig, the frog, the bird, the fish are only sense-perceiving, not judging subjectivities. [185] Only when the relation between actuality and the assertoric judgment is appre-

⁶⁷Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 182–183.

hended clearly can Protagoras's sophistry be fully illuminated. It is the reciprocal determination of object and judgment upon which the emphasis falls. In that a beginning is here made with the sensible, a beginning is here made immediately with the actual: "the wind is cold, it is really cold"; in such a statement the judging subjectivity does not think at all of prescribing to the wind whether it is to be cold or warm, whether it is to *be* at all or not. The judging one will not act upon the wind, but cognizes himself as affected by the wind; it is, in other words, not the judgment that determines the object, but conversely the object that immediately determines the judgment: the judgment is correctly assertoric. Wherein then lies the sophistical? In a fraudulent use of the judgment, for the judgment conceals a contradiction. The judging one is affected by the actual object; but he is affected only in the manner that exactly answers to his individuality: in that he will judge assertorically about what affects him, he comes involuntarily to judge about the affection he receives, thereby about his own subjective state, thus literally about himself. It is just the characteristic thing about the assertoric judgment that from being immediately objective it suddenly becomes immediately subjective, that from being a judgment about the object it transforms itself into a judgment about the judging one, the judging one's judgment about himself.

The Protagorean sophistry has excellently laid the contradiction bare, but not resolved it. Instead of cognizing the actual as a moment in the true and seeking the true in the law, the Sophist remains standing at actuality's antilogical punctuality, and now uses the contradiction, in which individuals through assertoric judgments bring their contingent subjectivity to light, for a game with truth.

From another side and in another manner the relation between actuality and the assertoric judgment has been misjudged by the Epicureans. In Epicurus's *Canonic* too the criterion of truth is sensation or sense-perception (αἴσθησις). "A motion is produced in us, which is sense-perception, and where there is a motion, there must be something moving. Therefore all sense-perceptions are true; for things really move us just as we perceive them. The visions of the madman and of the dreamer are also true; for such images are really conveyed to them. Orestes really saw the Eumenides, but [186]

he erred in this, that he took them for palpable objects”.⁶⁸

But despite the apparent agreement between Epicurus and Protagoras as regards the point of departure, Epicurus has nevertheless noticeably gone a step further. The advance is marked by the fact that weight is here laid upon the difference between effect and cause, between the objective and the subjective in the appearance. Had the Eumenides that Orestes saw really been palpable, then they would also have had actuality for others than Orestes; they would, in other words, have had objective actuality. Already from this it is discerned what conditions actuality itself offers for the closer determination of the objectively valid. Instead of rushing overhastily into syllogisms from what is perceived to what is not perceived, the observer is called upon to let the one kind of sense-perception support the other, until with the united testimony of the different senses he has so many marks of the objectivity of what is perceived that he may with full assurance dare to say: what is perceived is really an existent object.

The manner — for with modality everything depends upon the manner — in which heterogeneous sense-perceptions correspond in the apprehension of one and the same objective unity speaks in actuality for the unity’s substantial being, its independence [187] of the sense-perceiving subjectivity; this testimony of actuality is confirmed still more closely by the fact that several perceivers observe the same sensible under the same conditions in the same manner. If now in addition the existent object’s relations to other existent objects, thus the mutual reciprocal action of things, are made the object of immediate observation, then actuality has furnished the contemplating subjectivity all the contributions to the establishment of the objective and the true that it is in a position to furnish through the totality of immediate impressions. But however these contributions may for the rest be apprehended and combined, it is nevertheless evident, when we lay due weight upon the antilogical elements, that the logical ground on which the assurance rests is a totality of assertoric judgments. The assertoric is recognized precisely by this, that the one judgment is just as original as the other; here in this respect there is no transition from assertoric to apodictic.

The striking immediacy with which actual impressions of actual objects determine

⁶⁸Efterladte Skrifter af Poul Møller. 4de Bd. 3die Udg. Kjøbenhavn 1856. p. 256.

the assertoric judgment explains the certainty with which the judging subjectivity, despite all Humean reasonings, orients itself in the actual world. If we here let the emphasis fall upon the objectivity of things, their objective differences and objective relations, then we have the standpoint of empiricism. The empirical judgment is essentially an impression-judgment, the impression-judgment essentially assertoric. But the impression-judgments, bound to the antilogical and secured by the facts, are at the same time hovered over by a reflection that frees itself from the antilogical punctuality and in the logical sense demands the universal: the dualism that thereby forces itself upon consciousness lets us see Hume's misunderstanding from a new side.

All true concepts must, this is Hume's fundamental thought, be concepts of actuality, thus original impression-concepts. But whence then come the untrue concepts? From the distortion that the impression-concepts undergo in the following reflection! [188] First, then, is the impression, then follows reflection; first the sense-impression, then the judgment; first the assertoric judgment, then the universal-logical one. Here is an evident confusion of what belongs to principle with what belongs to the phenomenal. As regards the phenomenal, Hume may psychologically be right; but in principle he is wrong. According to the phenomenon it must indeed seem as if the sense-impression already stood clear before consciousness before any judgment formed itself; but in principle it is, as we have seen above in Protagoras, just as originally the judgment that determines the impression as the impression that determines the judgment. According to the phenomenon it should indeed seem as if the assertoric judgment, the judgment about this singular, determinate object in this singular determinate case, preceded the universal-logical judgment: the judgment about what holds for all possible cases; but in principle it is just as originally the universal-logical judgment, the judgment as judgment, that must determine the assertoric one, as conversely. If, then, an error is made in the judgment about this substance with these accidents, the error is not, as Hume maintains, that the categories substance and accident are laid at the ground in the judging of actual objects; this error does not in any case concern the assertoric judgment. What here concerns the assertoric judgment is solely and alone the application of the general categories to the singular case. If it is untrue that A in a given

case is cause, B effect, then the error is not, as Hume maintains, that the categories cause and effect are laid at the ground in the judging of something actual, but the error is that the assertoric judgment has in the given case made a false application of the categories of causality; whether it has for the rest applied them to a relation in which they do not fit, or has confused the actual cause with something else, e.g. with conditions, attendant circumstances, etc.

[189] According to Hume it should be the universal-logical judgment that had the assertoric one for its ground; but it is conversely the assertoric judgment that has the universal-logical one for its ground. According to Hume the categories of actuality should make good their reality by excluding the category of cause; but the matter is just the opposite: it must, even according to Hume's own method, be precisely the category of cause that lies at the ground of the categories of actuality. What then is the infallible mark of a true category of actuality? That it mediately or immediately has its origin from a corresponding impression! With this it then agrees that the assertoric judgment is laid at the ground of the universal-logical one, for the assertoric judgment with its antilogical element stamps precisely every concept of actuality as an impression-concept. But hereby there is presupposed precisely a relation between impression and concept which, so far as the concept is concerned, must be recognized as a relation of dependence as necessary as it is actual: the impression is related to the concept as cause to effect. If we think the causal relation away, the concept stands in a contingent relation to the impression; a determinate concept of actuality can just as well be thought to follow from the one impression as from the other; the impression that in one moment awakens the representation yellow can in another moment awaken the representation blue, and the impression that the one time gives a color can the other time give a tone: where then is the standard that is to display the difference between true and false concepts?

What is true in Hume's view is the moment characteristic of empiricism and of the assertoric judgment, namely that every existence in every case individualizes and precisely thereby modifies the concept, so that every singular phenomenon in every moment must necessarily demand its immediate apprehension, its separate judging, if the cognition of the actual is to be quite adequate. The question of an

adequate cognition of actuality stands then in the very closest connection with the logical treatment of the problem of omniscience. In relation to actuality's antilogical punctuality omniscience must be a collective knowledge, a particular immediate [190] knowledge about all existent things in all the singularities of existence: "Yea, even all the hairs of your head are numbered"; these words logic must in this connection acknowledge literally.

"But", someone might object, "an omniscience that counts the hairs of the head is surely just as incomprehensible to us as an omnipotence that by its mere word creates the world out of nothing; if science can acknowledge the religious expression for omniscience, why should it not just as well acknowledge the religious expression for omnipotence? If revelation's word about omnipotence is to be rejected because it is incomprehensible, then the same must surely hold when the talk is of omniscience". We answer: The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas everywhere makes a distinction between what is for us unfathomable and what is in the idea incomprehensible. An omnipotence that unconditionally creates the world out of nothing is not merely unfathomable for us, but incomprehensible in the idea; an omniscience, on the contrary, that immediately holds of the singular is comprehensible in the idea, for its concept is a necessary consequence of the articulated reciprocal determination of knowledge and actuality.

Already at an earlier stage⁶⁹ the relation between the category of omniscience and the ideal of knowledge has been particularly illuminated with regard to the ontology of sense-perception⁷⁰. In the present connection the illumination is heightened by the fact that the infinite multiplicity of sense-perceptions and sense-determinations receives its ideal form in a corresponding multiplicity of assertoric judgments. The assertoric functions are then also, as regards the objective side of modality, originally akin to the explicative and the indicative, and appear as modifications of both.

The assertoric function modifies the explicative in that, with emphasis on the given, it lets the taut opposition of concept and existence, upon which explication [191] supports itself, disappear in immediate unity. If we let the judgment: "this is really a branch", receive its significance from the explicative functions, then it begins, as we have seen, with the concept's furnishing the standard for existence, and ends

⁶⁹Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 257–263.

⁷⁰Cf. Grundideernes Logik I. p. 423–427.

with the given existence's being acknowledged as the representative of the realized concept: in this existing thing the concept branch is realized. Such a mediacy, such an opposing and mediating is not noticed on the assertoric standpoint; the concept is indeed recognized in the existing thing, but the concept is not weighed as concept, the reflection is like a glance: the recognition is quite immediate.

The assertoric function modifies the indicative in that, with emphasis on the given, it makes the logical identity of concept and existence recognizable by intimating the opposition. From the indicative standpoint the actual existences, seen in the light of reflection, answer to the eternal categories: the satisfaction is that the logical clarifies the antilogical and is enriched by antilogical reflexes. The complete equilibrium between the logical and the antilogical, which is the result and the presupposition of the indicative functions, would bring the heterogeneity of concept and existence into forgetfulness if the assertoric function did not, by its antilogical element, give the immediately actual a preponderance.

2) *The logical Moment in the assertoric Judgment: the subjective Side of Modality.* Vibrating between the logical and the antilogical, the assertoric judgment will constantly give the antilogical element the preponderance so long as the object in question is outwardly objective. If, on the contrary, the judgment's object is inward, and in its inwardness thus of subjective nature, the relation will reverse itself: the logical moment will become the preponderant one; but this preponderance will then bring it about that the assertoric acquires an ambiguous character. The inner is, as [192] inner, with all its immediacy still always a reflected. Pain is immediate and yet in reflection; enjoyment, fear, hope, joy, etc. likewise. Here, with these determinations of inwardness, very different combinations of immediacy and reflection can be given, but in all of them immediacy is reflected, reflection immediate. He who says: "I am really glad", utters himself in an assertoric judgment; his state of mind is given, he has an immediate assurance of it, and more than an immediate assurance of his momentary state of mind no one can have.

The inner has its outer and reflects itself therein. As reflection, reflection is always logical; but the outer stands over against reflection with antilogical determinateness; in the clash it depends upon which party in actuality gains the upper hand, either

immediacy over reflection or, conversely, the latter over the former.

If immediacy gains power over reflection, then the inner will stand straightforwardly painted in the outer, will be recognizable by the utterance. In a judgment such as: “the man is really sorrowful”, the judging one’s immediate, though reflected, assurance answers to the immediate, though reflected, appearance of sorrow in the sorrowful one’s outer. If reflection will weaken the assurance, then immediacy reacts at once with heightened emphasis: “it does not help, what you say, he is really sorrowful”.

Under the tension between reflection and immediacy, a tension which is here conditioned by actuality’s own doubling into inner and outer, there is seen a fusion of assertoric and interpreting functions. When the judgment’s object is not the judging one’s own but another’s inner, then the judgment rests upon an interpretation of the utterances through which the two subjectivities correspond. “The man is really angry, I assure you, I have indeed heard it from his own mouth; yes, he is thoroughly angry, I can see it from his mien”. That such judgments expressly presuppose a determinate [193] interpretation of the speaker’s words and mien is noticed involuntarily when someone comes forward with the opposite assurance: “the man is really not angry, he means nothing by it”. Insofar as reflection is set in movement, it seems indeed as if the judging ones must grasp at proofs and grounds; but on account of the prevailing immediacy the grounding is a semblance; the grounding consists in the one assertoric judgment’s being exchanged for the other. “The man”, whose anger is disputed, “has really meant what he said”; “no, he has really not meant what he said.” “His mien really betrays anger”; “no, his mien really betrays no anger”; “it is really earnest!” “it is really all a jest!” That the assertoric function, however, does not straightforwardly coincide with the interpreting one, but becomes an alteration of it, a subjective modality, one of the manners in which the interpreting function can utter itself, follows straightforwardly from the fact that the grounding which interpretation essentially demands essentially fails to appear so far as the assertoric function is concerned. On the stage of immediate actuality no essential grounding can here be given and none is to be given: the assertoric interpretation is a straightforward translation of actuality’s own language, and actuality’s language is a categorical power-language.

How striking, how unambiguous this categorical power-language is can be seen everywhere where sound common sense is proved right against contorted school-theories. According to the Cartesian doctrine of the relation between soul and body the animal could, as is well known, have no soul: every animal was to be regarded as an automaton. When one struck a dog and it whined, its whining was not at all any utterance of pain; it was mechanically a sound, as when one blows on a flute. It is thus, according to this way of viewing, an absurdity to issue a prohibition against cruelty to animals; one might just as well issue a prohibition against cruelty [194] to locomotives. And yet cruelty to animals is held to be something ignoble and punishable: has Cartesius then really been refuted? Yes, but not theoretically (the theoretical refutations do not namely come into consideration here), but practically, that is to say: by a power-language; not by an arbitrary one, no, by a categorical one, actuality's categorical power-language. In that the language of facts is categorical, the immediate understanding must be assertoric. "The dog really has a soul, it shines out of its eyes; the poor animal can really feel pain". These are only assertoric judgments, but judgments that, so to speak, strike speculation to the ground with doomsday-blows.

If, conversely, reflection gains the upper hand over immediacy, then the subjective side of interpretation becomes predominant; the assertoric interpretation gives, on this standpoint, what one understands in the ordinary sense of the word by an *opinion*.

That the category opinion hovers in a peculiar manner between subjective and objective, between reflection and immediacy, can easily be shown. The immediate apprehension of the immediately objective is not yet an opinion; for there is surely no one who will call the assumption that water is fluid, or that the sun shines, an opinion. If someone were to point at the sun when it stood highest in the heavens and say: "see, it is now my opinion that the sun is shining", then one would take it either for an utterance of caprice or for a sign of affectation. On the other side, a thoroughgoing reflection of essential relations likewise does not lead to opinion, but to that which is more than opinion: it leads to knowledge. That semblance must presuppose essence, that the ground must have its consequent, the cause its effect, is with the judging subjectivity not an opinion but a knowledge. Where reflection, on the contrary, is set in movement in such a way that it neither denies immediacy nor unconditionally

bows under it, there is the proper place for opinion, there it has its proper scope. If [195] we set the two assertoric judgments: “the man is really angry”; “no, the man is really not angry”, over against each other, then it is, properly speaking, not a contradiction between two concepts but a strife between two opinions that we have before us.

It is the immediacy of an actuality reflected into itself that constitutes the objective ground of opinions. Such actualities reflected into themselves we have in state, art and religion. On the stage of piety, naivety and simplicity the judgment about these actualities is still immediately assertoric. “What the authorities command is really right”; “what the master has there produced is really beautiful”; “what the priest says is really true”. In these judgments the power of the immediate is so preponderant that subjective reflection is held bound: it is dominating prejudices, secure propositions of authority, fixed dogmas that we here find before us; but they are not yet opinions proper. That liberation of subjectivities, that mobility in reflection, that facility in hovering considerations which favors the emergence of opinions in society, just as the warmth of June favors the emergence of flies, sets in only at a later stage.

It is the stage of culture, the stage of the subjective reflections, that is properly to be apprehended as the stage of opinions. “Now what the authorities command is really not always right”; “nor is everything that an artist produces really beautiful”; “one really cannot believe everything the priest says either”. What then is right? what then is beautiful? what then is one to believe? Yes, it is precisely about this that there are so many different opinions. While the interpreting functions, in virtue of the grounding, illuminate the objective meaning of things, the assertoric ones on the contrary turn attention — not toward the objective, toward the meaning in things — but toward the subjective, toward individuals’ opinions about things: we get a host of political, aesthetic and religious opinions; every opinion is an assertoric judgment, determined by subjective reflection. In opinion the objective and the subjective elements are in a [196] peculiar way set free and yet bound together. Subjectivity is emancipated; for what is easier for the singular than to form an opinion for himself, and what is the singular’s spiritual property, if it is not his “unpresuming opinion”: every individual, even a schoolboy, has at this stage an unpresuming opinion. And yet the opinion points objectively straight at the thing; it is the opinion about the thing that decides what

the thing is. The thing is the actual, and the opiner lays weight upon the actual, upon the matter; it is of course not about his individual opinion, but about the matter, the important matter, that he is concerned. Could anyone convince him that his opinion was incorrect, "he would truly, for the sake of the matter's importance, gladly change it"; but that is impossible, for, since it is now once for all his unassuming opinion that the matter really stands as he opines it to stand, it would indeed be treachery against the good cause if he changed his opinion.

Opinion is an assertoric judgment; when the assertoric is strongly stressed, opinion rises to assertion; in the assertion subjectivity will then expressly vouch for the objective: the opiner becomes assertive. In that the opiner becomes assertive, it looks undeniably as though he wanted to force his contingent subjectivity upon others; but that is not the meaning of it. The meaning is that the assertive one is zealous for the matter, is the only one who sees the matter as it really is. The assertive one only opines that his opinion ought unconditionally to be *everyone's* opinion, and that for the simple reason that it is the only correct opinion. Opiners are liberal, for everyone surely has the right to keep his opinion; but when the many opinions run against one another, and each holds to his own because it is the one correct one, the many unequal opinions must nevertheless fall at last into a serious conflict: the task is then [197] to find the opinion valid for all, the general opinion, more precisely the public opinion, *Opinion*.

It is of logical interest to characterize the struggles of opinions, the struggles for Opinion, because these struggles, seen at a distance, look as though truth were at stake, and yet in principle they are indifferent to truth. It is not truth, but actuality, not actuality as it utters itself in the categorical power-language of facts, but actuality as it, subjected to the interests, veiled in the cobwebs of reflections and colored by the opinions, addresses subjectivities, that the strife is about.

The manner in which the strife is conducted is in many respects instructive. Here there is investigating, here deliberating, here grounds and counter-grounds are adduced; the whole armory of logic, with judgments, syllogisms, proofs, etc., is ransacked in order to procure weapons for the combatants: one reasons, discusses, argues; one crosses swords with the other. But, if we look more closely, the strife is

fleeting; reflection plays upon the surface of actuality, often brilliantly, like sunbeams upon a rippled sheet of water, but the ground is shallow, absorption is wanting. The characteristic thing is that however much is said here about principles and questions of principle, it nevertheless never comes, and in the sharply bounded sphere of opinions, assertions, assurances, assertoric judgments never can come, to any real investigation of principles. Reflection has a dexterity in moving as though it went to the bottom of the thing and reached the ground; but this bottom is no essential ground, it is a crust of crystallized opinions. Reflection has the facility of stacking the assertoric judgments in such a way that to the uninitiated it looks like batteries of striking arguments, whole fortifications of irrefutable proofs. It is semblance, but a semblance of reflection, which corresponds to the immediate in the essence of actuality.

In every strife, let it move otherwise upon the precincts of politics, of art or of [198] religion, it makes an essential difference whether what is striven for is really a truth or an Opinion. This can never be heard directly from the battle-cry, for the battle-cry of course always sounds upon truth; but it can be seen from the method, it can be known by the manner in which the strife is conducted. For a method that must be rejected when truth is at stake may be precisely the one that recommends itself as the only right one when Opinion is at stake. We can illustrate this by a couple of examples.

If the strife is political, and one of the standard-bearers comes forward with the declaration that he, as regards the opposing party's standpoint, would make it a matter of conscience to weary the hearers' patience with adducing proof for what all who are gifted with sound sense have long since agreed upon, that it belongs among the spurious standpoints, and will therefore confine himself to a demonstration of facts that are so conspicuous, so eloquent, etc. — then we hear at once that it is not truth, but Opinion, that he is concerned about. Were the spokesman concerned about truth, it would have to be of the greatest importance to him that the difference of principle between the standpoints should become properly clear to the hearers, for the facts appealed to will of course look different according as the light falls in from the one side or from the other. In a struggle for Opinion, on the contrary, the speaker's procedure is practically—tactically perfectly correct. It is an assertion, an assertoric judgment, that the opposing party's standpoint belongs among the spurious standpoints; an

assertion, an assertoric judgment, which rests upon the assertion that all who have sound sense can see it without further ado. This assertion, this assertoric judgment, rests in turn, if anyone among the hearers should get scruples and opine that one might after all also be of another opinion, upon the assertion, the assertoric judgment, that he who cannot see that the opposing party's standpoint is a spurious one really [199] cannot be said to have sound sense. This assertion, this assertoric judgment, rests then in the last resort upon the assertion that an individual who in actuality does not have sound sense is not entitled to have a say about political standpoints. With such a substructure of assertions, upon such a timberwork of assertoric judgments, the speaker is sure of himself, sure of his standpoint, sure of his strife: he strives for Opinion.

If the strife is aesthetic, the method must likewise vary according as the aim of the strife is a truth or an Opinion. If the aim is a truth, the way can at times be long and troublesome enough. For an assessment of the works of art it is of course not enough to have natural taste and to have visited a number of museums; what matters in the assessment, if it is to have scientific worth and to serve truth, is above all that the judgment be motivated. In order to be able to motivate his judgment, the one who judges must before all else be sure of the relation between concept and phenomenon, between the universal and the individual; but to that there belongs a study of the concept in science as careful and as penetrating as that of the phenomenon in art. It is otherwise when the strife concerns an Opinion. Here a standard-bearer and trumpeter can spare himself the trouble of science's analyses. "What indeed comes of these dry abstractions, these colorless philosophical concepts? No, phenomenon and feeling and feeling for the phenomenon, that is and remains after all the main thing." Since now the finer feeling is developed only through contact with the manifold phenomena of art, while the eye of the understanding is opened by reading descriptions and composing descriptions of the many objects of art, kinds of art, artists and judges of art from the various ages, the standard-bearing art critic must, for Opinion's sake, so arrange his performance that the public can both have confidence in his pure taste, his fine sense, and at the same time be impressed by his great learning and detailed [200] descriptions. In such an apparatus, an apparatus which a quick head will be able

to procure for itself, especially on a journey abroad, in the course of a few months, Opinion's standard-bearer has everything that he aesthetically needs for opinions, assertions, assertoric judgments.

Yet here, for the method's and Opinion's sake, there is still one thing to observe. An apparatus of opinions, assertions and assertoric judgments may be as large and imposing as it will, so long as one keeps to the phenomenon: it soon shows itself insufficient when one in earnest engages with something scientific. The method here demands a certain caution; for the method is that one, without directly engaging with science, preserves a certain scientific tinge, the tinge that suits precisely the assertoric judgment. When the assertoric judgment, instead of being set up in all crudity as an assertion, acquires through a tincture of "feeling" and learning a scientific tinge, it transforms itself and advances from simple opinion to fine remark: let one work above all by fine remarks!

That a remark can have a scientific tinge, indeed can become almost of full scientific weight, may then be seen from the esteem that Opinion grants, not of course to the philosophical systems, but to the philosophical remarks. Yes, Opinion has really a taste for philosophical remarks. No wonder that, for Opinion's need, philosophies are delivered by the ell, philosophies that are woven together out of nothing but remarks. In such remark-philosophies there may then in many things be much to become aware of and much to remark, for the becoming-aware goes upon immediacy, and the remark runs precisely along the boundary, the assertoric boundary, between opining and knowledge. If now remark-philosophy notoriously enjoys great esteem in public opinion, why should a remark-aesthetics, an art criticism of fine remarks, especially when they are exhibition-remarks, not enjoy the same esteem?

If the strife is theological, then one cannot sufficiently praise, recommend and [201] admire the Opinion-method. Here, e.g., is a writing that is rightly regarded as one of the most remarkable products of spirit in our century. It is a Christian philosophical writing, charmingly written toward a reconciliation of faith and knowledge. As eloquent proof of the writing's deep philosophical spirit there serves the fact that, although it is rejected by those who really understand philosophy, it has nevertheless, in spite of the severe criticism, won immense circulation and scientific recognition

among all those who do not understand philosophy; for its philosophy is theological. "We dare," says the reviewer, "freely assert that this writing is in the hands of all who unite with higher culture a deeper sense for true Christianity. We can prove our assertion; for we assert that if there really are cultivated persons in whose hands the writing is not, then these cultivated persons have no sense for true Christianity. We can prove our assertion, for we assert that if there really should be true Christians in whose hands the writing is not, then these Christians are without higher culture." Such assertions are reprehensible, indeed contemptible, when the strife is for a truth; but as assertoric judgments with reinforced emphasis they produce an excellent effect when the strife is for an Opinion.

3) *The assertoric judgment's logical-antilogical essentiality: double-sided modality.* To articulate a unity-in-difference of the antilogical with the logical is by no means an exclusive distinguishing mark of the assertoric functions; for the same can in a certain sense be said to hold of all functions. No, what is peculiar to the assertoric functions is precisely this relation between actuality and reflection, that the actual in its antilogical immediacy must either govern thought by a categorical power-language or, insofar as thought takes on the stamp of subjective independence, then by goading opposition bring about such a rising of reflection that the accentuating interplay of logical and [202] antilogical determinations of form, which conditions real knowledge, becomes visible from all sides; only thus can modality's objective as well as subjective validity be fully illuminated.

In three ways will actuality be able to enter into ideal process with reflection, according as it either lets itself be transformed into a phenomenon immediately transparent for its individualized content, and thereby into the idea's mirroring; or, as regards its character, indeed retains its finite reality, but undergoes a transformation in that it is apprehended not as something present but as something past, and thus damps down the antilogical edges; or, with the stamp of a divine reality that is raised above the finite difference between present and past, forces itself upon subjectivity as an actuality of a higher order, a superactual actuality, an actuality that makes a breach with the actual. In the first case the assertoric function is *aesthetic*, in the second case *historical*, in the third case *religious*.

The *aesthetic* unity of essence and phenomenon is assertoric; herein lies this, that the difference to which the unity corresponds is likewise assertoric. If we consider the phenomenon, the form is antilogically determined as the actual itself: this Jason in marble has, e.g., just as immediate an individuality as this workhouse inmate in flesh and blood; but “Jason is really beautiful,” “the poor wretched man is really not beautiful”: the one assertoric judgment has here the same validity as the other.

But upon what does the validity now rest? That both figures really are, the one as statue, the other as existing individual, places them both, as regards actuality’s antilogical immediacy, in a certain sense upon an equal footing: the assertoric judgment that apprehends the immediately actual shows us modality’s objective side. The difference between the beautiful and the unbeautiful is thus an actuality-difference; it is the actuality-form itself that turns the scale. The actuality-form is in its objective immediacy independent of the considering subjectivity; the really beautiful is thus [203] really objective: beauty is in the beautiful one with the actual.

But unbeauty is in the unbeautiful also one with the actual. Thus: the actual is one with the beautiful, and the actual is one with the unbeautiful; thus: the actual is different from the unbeautiful, for it is one with the beautiful; the actual is different from the beautiful, for it is one with the unbeautiful; thus: the actual is, as actual, different both from the beautiful and from the unbeautiful, can just as well be unbeautiful as beautiful, stands in an external and indifferent relation to beauty. What then becomes of beauty? It transforms itself into idea, is taken up into imagination and reflects itself in subjectivity. It is thus the beholder, not the beheld object, that itself decides what is beautiful and unbeautiful. From modality’s subjective side man is again “the measure of things,” both of the beautiful ones, that they are beautiful, and of the unbeautiful ones, that they are unbeautiful.

In the aesthetic domain the assertoric function’s original kinship with the explicative and the interpreting ones is quite conspicuous. From reflection’s, hence from subjectivity’s logical standpoint the task is to recognize the concept realized in the object; the function is to that extent explicative. But in the aesthetic sense the recognition must be immediate. In the immediate recognition the form goes into one with its content; the concept vanishes as concept and transforms itself for intuition

into prototype: to recognize the concept in the object is to measure the object by the prototype. If now the immediate appraisal says that the object corresponds to the prototype, the judgment falls that it is really beautiful; if the object deviates notably from the prototype, the judgment falls that it is really unbeautiful; if the object stands in striking conflict with the prototype, the judgment runs that it is ugly. On account of [204] the form's antilogical determinateness and the recognition's immediacy the aesthetic judgments are originally assertoric.

The assertoric character of the aesthetic judgments makes it explicable that about the beauty-phenomena and about the beautiful there can prevail an agreement as striking as the disagreement.

The assertoric judgment is immediately subjective; the aesthetic judgments are judgments of taste: each of those who judge has his taste; what does it help to want to dispute about the difference between a good and a bad taste, when the judgment about taste is itself a judgment of taste? And yet there is really agreement here; people of good taste join together, understand one another and support one another in combating the bad: that is a striking agreement. The striking agreement must be ascribed to a categorical power-language; but this time it is not actuality in its contingency, but actuality impregnated by the idea, the idea in actuality's antilogical form, that speaks to subjectivity.

The assertoric judgment is immediately objective. The aesthetic judgments are judgments of intuition; it is not the judgment that determines the object, but the intuited object that determines the judgment. Intuition's object is common to the many who intuit: "see, this figure, how beautiful it is! these features, these lines, how lovely they are!" — "And now this statue, how clumsy, how disproportioned!" etc. But although the objects are the same, although the aesthetic outbursts are exchanged, among the sober-minded and the expert, for interpretations, whereby the assertoric functions rightly prove their kinship, not only with the explicative ones, insofar as the interpretation proceeds according to an assumed prototype, but also with the interpreting ones, insofar as the one subjectivity will address the other through the work of art, there is nevertheless disagreement here, just as the interpretations get under way, a striking disagreement; even the experts can now, with their best will,

not come to agreement.

Has beauty then no objective validity? Yes, certainly! it is precisely what is peculiar [205] in its objective validity that makes the judgment about it so immediately subjective. But then must not beauty's validity rest upon subjectivity? Yes, certainly! it is precisely what is peculiar in its subjective validity that the judgment about it is so immediately objective.

The unity-in-difference of objective and subjective has its universal validity in the idea; it is neither the objective for itself nor the subjective for itself, but the idea itself, that is beauty's measure; therefore Plato speaks of self-beauty, the invisible beauty by which all visible beautiful things are beautiful. And yet Plato sees wrongly; for the idea in its invisible universal essentiality is not beauty; only as an idea of power in intuitable form does the beauty-idea have existence. As beauty-idea the idea, the prototype of that which exists, is itself an existing figure: the existing figure immediately determines the assertoric judgment. Thus the accentuating interplay of subjective with objective in logical-antilogical moments continues unceasingly; but it is explained by the idea, for the aesthetic actuality is transparent in the idea.

The *historical* unity of essence and phenomenon is assertoric; but in another way than the aesthetic. For the idea the aesthetic actuality must be perfectly transparent; this is now not so with the historical. The historically actual bears the stamp of finitude and thereby of contingency. The fact is indeed by its contingency in the idea's power, but by no means the idea's adequate phenomenon; to that extent the reflection repelled by antilogical immediacy cannot go directly to the idea either in order to find the explanation. Actuality has, on the contrary, in becoming historical, the peculiarity of being transposed into pastness; by this transposition it occupies reflection without giving up immediacy.

That the past, although it does not have presence's immediacy, nevertheless has [206] an immediacy, is involuntarily discerned from such judgments as: "Caesar was really murdered," "Canute the Great really conquered England." However many proofs and grounds one may scrape together for the confirmation of such judgments, the immediacy-element will always be decisive. The vanished has indeed lost its immediacy insofar as it has vanished; but it has preserved it insofar as it has not vanished.

In the present narrative the vanished is surely not vanished; the vanished actuality has in the narrative a reflected presence and works in this presence with reflected immediacy.

But the fabricated can in a poetically intuitable narrative just as well take on the stamp of actuality as the vanished actual: upon what does the separation between the fabricated and the past actual now rest? Evidently upon a manifold of immediate and mediate actuality-impressions! If the reader is not himself an investigator, he takes the narrative upon the narrator's authority; but an impression of authority is, with all the determinations of immediacy comprised in it, always an actuality-impression. If the reader is an investigator, manifold considerations — of the source or the sources, of the event's character, its relation to other events, etc. — will come into account; but the main thing is that the many particular impressions gather themselves at last into a total impression, and that this total impression, which speaks for the event, is a decisive actuality-impression.

Through the total impression the vanished works in a mediate and yet immediate manner; it works immediately, for the monument stands there, the report captivates attention, and the attentive hearer sees the event before his eyes; it works mediate, for the monument sets at a distance, the narrative reminds in every particular of the [207] distance between the present and the past: reflection is in movement.

The accentuating interplay of reflection and immediacy is here of a peculiar kind. Upon the aesthetic ground reflection can melt immediacy; for the phenomenon is essentially semblance; that the assertoric function nevertheless plays the principal role lies in this, that the sublated immediacy is instantly restored to antilogical determinateness, since the phenomenon is an existent figure. Upon the historical ground, by contrast, reflection cannot melt the immediate, for a fact is still a fact, even though it belongs to the past; immediacy's ideal process with reflection must then be seen in the mediate. Between the beholder and the event the relation is restless: constantly a distancing that alternates unceasingly with a corresponding approach. Mediate the beholder approaches the event, and the event out of the past comes to meet him; during the approach immediacy grows: the actual event makes an actual impression. But what is thus present is nevertheless something past, it removes itself again; it

must go back to its place when reflection begins, just as the revenant must go back when morning dawns. It is this restlessness that comes to rest in faith, as historical faith (*fides historica*).

Historical faith is an assertoric function, peculiarly determined by reflection's transposition of the mediate into the immediate. Historical faith is determined by actuality-impressions, its ground is immediacy, its judgment is assertoric. No reflection can give immediate assurance; only the actual can speak for the actual; this is modality's objective side: the assertoric judgment is immediately objective. But the actuality-impression that founds historical faith is, on account of the mutual distance of beholder and event, nevertheless only a mediate impression, an impression of an actuality really absent and present only in reflection: this is modality's subjective side; [208] the assertoric judgment is immediately subjective.

The *religious* unity of essence and phenomenon is assertoric in a quite peculiar sense. Historical and religious faith resemble one another in this, that both rest upon immediate impressions of something immediately absent: faith is an assertoric assurance of a non-present actuality. Only when the question arises what it really is that hinders the immediate presence of the actual does the difference between historical and religious faith come to light. What prevents the historically actual from working with the whole immediacy of the present is solely and alone pastness; could pastness be sublated, the past would of course work with the same immediacy as the present, for in essence they are of the same kind. It is otherwise with the religiously actual. The religiously actual cannot, even though it be something now existing, come forward as something immediately present. A miracle cannot be intuited as immediately present; its presence proclaims itself, on the contrary, as a breach with everything actually present; such a breach terrifies, and the terror makes the present into something absent. What is thus absent is, in its terrifying presence, the hidden, the mysterious, the inexplicable.

"What is it then?" Contemporaneous with the miracle this question is only an exclamation; sober deliberation cannot be contemporaneous with the miracle, for the miracle's immediacy overwhelms reflection. When composure sets in and deliberation begins, the miracle is over; deliberation therefore meets, even in the contemporaries,

never something present, but always something past.

“What was it then?” Here it shows itself that faith, the religious faith too, is an assertoric assurance of a non-present actual. It is not a grounding of faith, but [209] faith’s logical character as assertoric assurance, that is here treated of.⁷¹ What the fact is objectively must be decided immediately subjectively. Between the fact and the judging subjectivity the distance is infinite, by reason of the miracle. To sublate the infinite distance is here expressly posited as subjectivity’s infinite task; and yet the solution of this task is immediately determined by an impression of the miracle, hence of something actual.

Seen from this standpoint faith has not doubt but offense for its decisive opposition. Offense is, logically seen, an assertoric judgment just as much as faith is: “This is really a miracle!” “This is really a deception of the eyes!” The believer and the offended one both appeal to the fact, the actual in its immediacy, for the assertoric judgment is immediately objective. “This is really (I can surely feel it upon myself) a work of God!” — “This is really (sound sense teaches it) a natural event!” The believer and the offended one both appeal to an inner sense for the difference between semblance and [210] actuality, falsehood and truth; for the assertoric judgment is immediately subjective.

In the strife between faith and offense it is not merely fact that stands against fact, but in an infinite sense subjectivity stands against subjectivity, explanation against explanation, understanding against understanding: it is the assertoric functions that here furnish the ground for the interpreting ones. So long as the ground is assertoric, faith has a spiritual superiority over offense, insofar as the believing subjectivity with its positive forces lives a higher life than the offended one, who can employ forces

⁷¹As regards the concept’s religious validity, we refer to S. Kierkegaard’s writings, in particular to “Uvidenskabelig Efterskrift” and “Indøvelse i Christendom”. — “If there is to be any meaning in saying that the miracle proves who Christ is, then we must surely begin with our not knowing who he is, hence in the situation of contemporaneity with a single human being who is as other human beings are, in whom there is nothing *directly* to be seen, a single human being who then works the miracle and says of himself that he works the miracle. What does this mean? It means that this single human being makes himself into more than a human being, makes himself very nearly into God: is this not offensive? You see something inexplicable, miraculous (nor anything more), he himself says that it is a miracle — and you see before your eyes a single human being. The miracle can prove nothing; for if you do not believe that he is the one he says himself to be, then you deny the miracle. The miracle can draw attention — now you are in the tension, and it depends upon what you choose, the offense or the faith; it is your heart that shall be made manifest.” *Indøvelse i Christendom*. p. 106.

and passions only negatively. But if the ground is to be changed, if *credo, ut intelligam* is to be thrown together with *de omnibus dubitandum est*, if the opposition is to be not faith and offense but faith and doubt, then the way goes from the assertoric to the problematic, and then offense has triumphed.

That offense triumphs with doubt goes without saying; for doubt, which is faith's torment, is offense's relief. If the assertoric ground is given up, the reflecting subjectivity must either remain in the problematic or work its way through to the apodictic. The apodictic rests in rational necessity, but rational necessity is only in science. Can faith-science then attain the apodictic? Speculative dogmatics answers: to a certain degree! but the apodictic to a certain degree is nonsense, an assertoric nonsense that stands far below the problematic.

ββ) The problematic judgment: functions of sublated determinateness. If we, after Kant's example, were merely to employ the judgment of modality in order to assure ourselves of the a priori validity of the corresponding categories of the understanding, a detailed treatment of these judgments at science's present stage would doubtless be altogether superfluous. But it is not the assurance about the categories' validity, it is a many-sided development of the categories valid in themselves, that is here treated. [211] Hegel has indeed held that the categories actuality, possibility and necessity had to receive their complete development in "the objective Logic," a development which in his system precedes the doctrine of the judgment. On this occasion we must remark that actuality-reflection⁷² with all the categories belonging under it may very well be treated independently of the doctrine of the judgment, only that it not, by a misleading abstraction, be treated as independent of all thinking and judging subjectivity; but that the development of the categories actuality, possibility and necessity which corresponds to actuality-reflection by no means renders superfluous a development corresponding to the doctrine of the judgments, will already be seen from what has been adduced under the assertoric judgment, and will press itself forward still more strongly when the talk is of the problematic one.

From whatever standpoint we conceive the problem of possibility, be it as a general essence-problem, as an objectification-problem, or in particular as an anticipation-

⁷²Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 105–133.

problem: from all sides it shows itself that possibility and subjectivity stand in so close a connection that possibility cannot possibly be developed except in reflection of subjectivity. It is the subjectivity free in itself that frees possibility and gives it existence; but only in the word, by the judgment, is subjectivity free, in the logical sense; if now the doctrine of the judgment can alone develop the freedom of subjectivity, and if possibility's liberation to ideal determinate being rests upon free subjectivity, then it is evident that the doctrine of possibility must stand in intimate connection with the doctrine of the judgment.

According to the assertoric judgment, actuality stands antilogically over against thinking: the antilogical immediacy can in many ways repel, attract, move and determine reflection, but the moved reflection is not in a position to dissolve actuality. [212] According to the problematic judgment, reflection gains complete power over actuality, nothing actual withstands the dissolution: here abstraction is made from the antilogical. The characteristic mark of the actual is determinateness, the immediate, antilogical determinateness; the characteristic mark of the possible is the dissolution of the actual's determinateness, hence the indeterminate.

Seen from the subjective side, the indeterminate is the same as the uncertain. The standpoint of uncertainty is represented by skepticism; the possibility corresponding to uncertainty we shall therefore call the skeptical. From the objective side, indeterminateness is a categorical expression for the actuality that is not, hence either vanished or not yet come to be, actuality concealed in objective essentiality; this possibility, conceived as objective essentiality, we call the dogmatic. By determining indeterminateness, from the subjective as well as from the objective side, we see that indeterminateness, and with it possibility, must originally be determined to sublate itself; upon this insight rests the ontology of possibility.

1) *The skeptical Possibility: the subjective Side of Modality.* On the assertoric foundation, immediacy's action upon reflection is partly attracting, determining and binding, partly repelling, loosening and liberating; the two-sidedness is seen already from this, that the assertoric judgment is at once both immediately objective and immediately subjective: through the immediately subjective the assertoric passes over into the problematic. So long, however, as the immediate is in a position from one side or another

to master, determine and bind reflection, the assertoric has decisive preponderance: the positive, the actual, is secured by the fact that thinking goes in the leading-strings of fact.

If thinking is to be liberated, and the reflecting subjectivity to become aware of its infinite relation to itself through another, then the actual beginning can be made only by this, that actuality itself shows itself repellent toward reflection. The problematic [213] does not have its point of departure in itself; it springs by immediate consequence out of the assertoric. One cannot properly say that skepticism abstractly begins with doubt; on the contrary! it begins immediately with immediate certainty; but since immediate certainty has in itself the negative determination of turning over into uncertainty, doubt naturally has at once an actual beginning in this coming-to-be of uncertainty.

How immediately and distinctly reflection in ancient skepticism took aim at actuality in its manifoldness of heterogeneous phenomena is seen already at a fleeting glance at its "Tropes." What is adduced in the "Tropes" about "the difference of animals," "the difference of men," "the difference of the senses," "the various circumstances, distances, relations" etc., in which the thing is found, shows sufficiently what it means that the problematic proceeds from the assertoric, that uncertainty has its origin in an immediate certainty.

The task is to think the actual, that is to say: by considered thought to assure oneself of the immediate certainty; in this task a contradiction lies concealed. To think the actual is, in other words, to transform the singular actuality-determinations into thought-determinations. But the actuality-determinations in their immediate singularity are contingent, the thought-determinations in their reflected generality necessary; the thought-determinations are logical, the actuality-determinations antilogical: here is the contradiction. This contradiction comes to light on the assertoric foundation in that the objects in their existent difference occasion the judging subjectivities, in their likewise existent difference, to mutually divergent and conflicting judgments: "The wind is really cold"; "The wind is really not cold"; that is the contradiction, the old [214] contradiction, which was already to be seen in Protagorean sophistry.

Repelled by actuality and bent back into itself, reflection now seizes the assertoric

judgment from the subjective side with heightened energy. Not enough that reflection transforms the judgment into opinion and opinion into assertion; the subjective element is intensified to the utmost by this, that opinion is set against opinion, assertion against assertion, and in such a way that the one opinion, the one assertion, receives precisely the same validity, hence the same invalidity, as the other. The immediately determined actuality has in this way become something wholly indeterminate, something for reflection indeterminable.

Skeptical reflection has not in an objective manner penetrated the essence of actuality, hence has not in the objective sense dissolved actuality either; on the contrary! what the actual is in itself, something or nothing, essence or semblance, substance or accident, of this the skeptic knows nothing, nothing at all. It is thus possible that the actual is in itself something; but it is also possible that it is nothing; the one of the two conflicting assumptions is in actuality just as possible as the other; actuality with its immediate determinations is thus only in itself an indeterminate, insofar as it is for subjectivity indeterminable: the dissolution is subjective, the skeptical possibility uncertainty.

That every immediate determinateness, and therewith every actuality-determination, in the moment it is touched by reflection transforms itself into indeterminateness, that consequently no true certainty can be had about actual things, is now the discovery to which skeptical reflection has led. In what sense this reflection can be said to signify an advance will be evident when we take everyday consciousness as our measure. For everyday consciousness it holds that we have immediate certainty about one thing [215] while we are in uncertainty about another, so that the uncertainty that obtains can under certain conditions be raised to certainty; for the skeptical consciousness immediate certainty has once and for all vanished, that is to say: it has been transformed into semblance, its credit is undermined; it turns over into uncertainty, it is a deception. For the unmasking of this deception the ancient skeptics employed a multitude of examples, heaped together from all the various nooks and corners of actuality. On these exemplifications, with their repetitions, variations and alterations, no particular weight can however be laid so far as the principle is concerned; they are a kind of empirical filling-mortar, prolix enumerations calculated to make up for the lack of

progressive development and to fill out the emptiness.

“But,” one might ask, “when skeptical reflection, repelled by actuality, was thrust back into itself, must we not then expect that it, after having lost the certainty about the nature and constitution of existing things, would with all the greater energy set about understanding itself and coming to certainty about its own essence?” To this it must be answered that the manner in which reflection here gives up actuality is precisely what makes it impossible for it to become transparent to itself. Reflection is repelled by immediate actuality, hence by the phenomenon, and has in turn thrust the phenomenon away from itself; just thereby it has become a phenomenon to itself, and for that reason cannot conceive itself as essence. Only a phenomenon can be thrust back by a phenomenon; essence as essence the phenomenon cannot thrust back. — The thought of the Eleatics could nevertheless in a way hold fast to itself in the One; but neither had it let itself be thrust back by the manifold; it was not uncertain about the nature of the manifold, it was on the contrary quite certain that the manifold-being was a non-being, and just for that reason it could be certain of itself in the one-being. Fichtean reflection too makes an end, in its own way, of the whole outward actuality, in that it makes the thing into a barrier for the I; but this dissolution of the actually objective signifies no uncertainty; on the contrary! thought in subjective idealism [216] gains the force to reduce the thing to a barrier precisely by this, that in its other it is able to hold fast to itself: it knows what semblance is, and therefore it also knows what essence is. It is otherwise with skeptical reflection.

Skepticism gives up actuality and declares it to be semblance; but since the declaration has only subjective significance, is only a designation for uncertainty, it being just as possible that the actual is in itself not semblance as that it is semblance: then skepticism concedes that it does not know what semblance is. But a reflection that does not know what semblance is does not know what essence is either, and cannot possibly see through its own essence.

It is in this respect characteristic that the skeptics conceive the inward and the intellectual, cognition, understanding etc., just as phenomenally, outwardly and immediately as sensible things. Thus e.g. when they speak of the possibility that man should

be able to cognize himself;⁷³ the understanding and cognition are considered in such investigations in the same immediate manner as blue and yellow. For so immediate a conception the understanding is only a phenomenon; of such a phenomenon one has only immediate certainty, the fleeting certainty that is instantly uncertainty.

[217] Uncertainty-reflection can moreover be driven to a remarkable degree of acuteness and subtlety without the reflecting subjectivity thereby coming a hair's breadth nearer to essence-cognition. Thus e.g. in the reflections on cause and effect. "If anything is a cause, then either a body must be the cause of another body, or an incorporeal of an incorporeal, or a body of an incorporeal, or an incorporeal of a body." The facility in setting up and assuming various cases is conspicuous; it is everywhere the phenomenal immediacy, with the corresponding immediate assumption, that yields the point of departure. Only assume something: every assumption shall at once give place to the opposite assumption; only posit a possible case, and the opposite case shall show itself just as possible; set up whatever determinate case you please as actual: the actual case shall at once change into an absurd, hence into an unthinkable case. "If a body is to bring forth another body in and for itself, then this its being in itself must, which is contradictory, bring forth a being outside itself, and thus, which is absurd, act outside its own nature. If, on the other hand, a body is to bring forth a third in combination with another, then out of one there will come not merely two, or out of two three, but an infinite number, which is impossible"⁷⁴ etc.

The dialectical dexterity with which the ancient skeptics, for the most part by straightforward use of what they found in their predecessors, the great philosophers, know how to exhibit grounds for and against every assumption, has led Hegel to an overvaluation of the whole spirit-phenomenon. "Only ancient skepticism," he says, "is of a true and deep nature, while the more recent is rather Epicureanism. For whereas

⁷³"For if man is to cognize himself, then either the whole man must be the cognizing subject, or the whole man the object of cognition, or one part of man the cognizing and another part the object of cognition. But if the whole man is the cognizing subject, then the object of cognition is sublated, and if the whole man is the object of cognition, then the cognizing subject has vanished. If, on the other hand, only one part of man is the cognizing and another part the object of cognition, then man, since his parts are the body, the senses and the understanding, must either with the body cognize the senses and the understanding, or with the senses and the understanding cognize the body." E. Frisenberg Nielsen. *Den antike Skepticisme*. Kjøbenh. 1862. p. 75.

⁷⁴E. F. Nielsen. *Den antike Skepticisme*. p. 117 & 118.

ancient skepticism is directed precisely against the thinking of the understanding, which lets determinate difference hold as ultimate, as being, the more recent skepticism is on the contrary directed against thoughts, against the concept and the idea, hence [218] against the higher philosophy. The more recent skepticism, which in this way lets the reality of things stand quite undoubted, is then not even a peasant philosophy; for even peasants know that all earthly things are perishable, that their being is thus just as good as their non-being."

Of the misunderstanding contained herein the following statement gives what seems to be an apt and quite satisfactory characterization. "In order to explain the Hegelian overvaluation," it is said⁷⁵, "we must expressly note the difference there is between a negative use of the categories and a higher consciousness of the significance of the negative itself. With reference to the seventh trope, where it is said e.g.: "Wine strengthens when it is enjoyed in moderation, but weakens and dissolves the body when it is enjoyed to excess," Hegel emphasizes that the skeptics have, if only indirectly, intimated that quantity and composition are so far from being a matter of indifference with respect to quality and dissolution, that with the change in quantity there follows a change in quality as well. But that Hegel in this connection reads his own logic out of the skeptical reflections is conspicuous. It has assuredly as little occurred to any of the ancient skeptics to lay a special logical weight on the essential connection between the quantitative and the qualitative as it is on the whole in keeping with their spiritual tendency to ascribe essential validity to any category whatsoever. To adduce yet another example of Hegel's soaring interpretation, we refer to the following statement in him: "The skeptics seek everywhere to exchange the expression "it is," which contains in itself something fixed, something that maintains itself under all circumstances, for the expression "it seems" or "everything is movable." But if they thereby sublate sensible likeness and identity, and consequently *this* generality, then [219] another enters; for generality, or that which is, lies precisely in this, that one knows e.g. that to the jaundiced that shows itself yellow which to another shows itself e.g. white, etc. Against such a generality, which is indeed not true because it is immediate, its non-generality is therefore demonstrated with full justification within this generality

⁷⁵E. F. Nielsen. Den antike Skepticisme. p. 190–192.

itself by means of another generality.” “But” — so runs the objection — “the whole context nevertheless shows plainly enough that the skeptics by no means strive to set the one generality against the other in order thereby to clarify the consciousness of a truer and higher generality, but much rather, in accordance with their all-dissolving tendency, to set the one assumption against the other, and just thereby to make the general unrecognizable. The ideality of skeptical negativity is plainly overshadowed by that darkness of consciousness in which the skeptic moves. There is in the dissolving acumen a certain unconscious — half-conscious blindness, which makes one easily take the skeptic’s words literally when he declares that he does not even know whether he knows anything.”

“Skepticism remains,” according to Hegel⁷⁶, “standing at the negative as result and thereby fails to recognize that negation has a determinate affirmative content in itself, whereas the speculative method determines negation as the negation referring itself to itself, as the negation of negation, or more precisely as the infinite affirmation. Skepticism exercises its dialectic according to contingency, since it, just as the material presents itself to it, shows in this material that it is in itself the negative, whereas the speculative method exercises its dialectic in virtue of necessity, in that it proves that the idea as speculative idea is neither a straightforwardly positive nor a straightforwardly negative, but such a union of both that the negative and the positive in this union everywhere reflect one another.”

[220] Skeptical negation separates itself into a swarm of isolated negations, just as skeptical contingency into a swarm of particular cases. To the assumption of each single case corresponds the assertoric; to the rejection of each assumed case, the problematic. The beginning is everywhere, for here one begins everywhere with a case; the end is everywhere, for the certainty about every case transforms itself everywhere into uncertainty. It is the negatively pointed interplay of the assertoric and problematic functions that characterizes skepticism: only in this interplay can uncertainty incessantly come to be.

“It might well seem as if his⁷⁷ (the skeptic’s) seeking led at least to the determinate

⁷⁶Cf. Vorlesungen über die Geschichte der Philosophie. Zweiter Theil. Werke. Vierzehnter Band. p. 475 & 514.

⁷⁷E. F. Nielsen. Den antike Skepticisme. p. 3–5.

result that no truth is to be found. But to let the skeptic fix this proposition is again to misunderstand skepticism and to confuse it with a negative dogmatism. The thetic conception of the negative is precisely characteristic of negative dogmatism, in that it is not merely assured that something is uncertain, but also that it is certain that something is uncertain. Negative dogmatism then knows what is certain and what is uncertain, and is thus certain of its proposition and of its opposite. The skeptic, on the other hand, sees with his double vision the doubling everywhere, even in truth's negative expression. A statement such as: everything is uncertain, is therefore, on his view, itself uncertain, and this last again uncertain, and so on to infinity. It stands correspondingly with the expressions: everything is false, nothing is true, etc. ... But even though the Aporetic indicates uncertainty never so much, the indication will always take on the semblance of a fixing, a positing, since it must after all remain a statement, a negative expression being able to stand fast just as well as a positive one. He must nevertheless, as it seems, concede and assert that he has a sure and certain cognition of the insecurity and uncertainty of cognition. As one who now [221] would avoid the reproach of sublating, by his mere statement, the equilibrium of grounds and counter-grounds, the skeptic calls himself an Ephectic, for only by making epoche, by holding back every assent, every expression, i.e., in other words, by keeping silent, can he guard himself against every misunderstanding and satisfy his ideal demand. Silence is thus the highest dissolution into uncertainty. It is not a silence in which one rests as in inwardness and self-absorption, for this pure silence is not skeptical; but the silence in which the negative is consummated, in that it shows that nothing is decided, the silence in which there is undecidedness, uncertainty, in which there is possibility."

It is the skeptic's task to bring about an equilibrium between the conflicting assumptions, the mutually contradictory opinions, an equilibrium which means that the one is just as reasonable, and therefore just as absurd, as the other. When this equilibrium has been brought about for the single case, a new case must at once present itself, so that the proceeding can begin afresh. Were there here but one single case, attention would have to fasten continually upon the uncertainty attained by the equilibrium: it would then have to be certain that uncertainty had once and for all been attained;

this standing uncertainty is insufferable. The skeptic cannot straightforwardly deny uncertainty; for by a denial of uncertainty he would confirm certainty. Neither can he straightforwardly confirm uncertainty; for a confirmation of uncertainty would then itself yield a certainty. All contradictions uncertainty can balance out; *the contradiction of certainty and uncertainty alone it cannot balance out*: if certainty is posited, then uncertainty is excluded; if uncertainty is posited, then certainty is excluded. Every time the skeptic is to acquiesce in a last decisive uncertainty, he makes epoche; he keeps silent, and the silence expresses that uncertainty is held fast, not in the form of certainty, but in the form of uncertainty. To speak would in such cases be a rashness; [222] to declare oneself straightforwardly for uncertainty would be to place it in the form of certainty, to assume uncertainty as the certain, hence to contradict oneself.

Everything is uncertain; this is skepticism's principal proposition. But no one can get him to fix the certainty that everything is uncertain. No, he fixes nothing, he keeps silent; the silence means that he cannot at all enter upon *general* answers to *general* questions. To enter upon a general answer to a general question would for skepticism be the same as to deliver a definitive declaration; but one single such definitive declaration overturns his whole skepticism.

But does there not then lie in this proposition: everything is uncertain, a definitive declaration? By no means! that is to say, in the skeptical sense. Instead of engaging with the universal and saying: uncertainty is universally valid, the skeptic goes at the singular, and consoles himself that in every single case he will manage to get the uncertainty out, will manage to hold it in continued becoming: only in continued becoming is uncertainty infinite.

The skeptical possibility is infinite uncertainty; *the infinite, i.e. endless uncertainty, is in infinite becoming*. If becoming ends in determinate being, if uncertainty is, so to speak, permitted to stand still and settle down into an existence, then in reflection it is all over with it: an uncertainty that is, a certainty that uncertainty is, is a certainty negatively reflected into itself. With uncertainty's transformation into negatively reflected certainty, skepticism is transformed into negative dogmatism: the skeptical possibility has become dogmatic.

2) *The dogmatic Possibility: the objective Side of Modality*. Indeterminateness must

always have its foundation in some determinateness or other, uncertainty in a certainty, the problematic functions in a non-problematic. So long as the non-problematic coincides with actuality's immediate determinateness and the certainty corresponding to it, the foundation is assertoric. If the subjectivity reflecting on its own reflections [223] gives up assertoric immediacy, reflection must itself posit and presuppose its reflected foundation.

The reflected foundation is now in the first place conditioned by the removal of the immediate; this is the negative side of the matter. If the immediate determinateness is taken away, then only indeterminateness is left; if certainty is taken away, then here there is only uncertainty. How then shall the negative now by itself be able to yield a positive? The indeterminateness reflected into itself is itself negative determinateness; the uncertainty determined in itself is negatively determined certainty; the new foundation is thus a determinateness won within indeterminateness, a certainty affirmed within uncertainty: instead of actuality's immediacy we have obtained an immediacy of thought; this is the positive side of the matter.

The reflected foundation is, on account of negation and "the negation of negation," infinitely affirmative, but not antilogically positive; it is in actuality itself not an outer, but an inner; not a phenomenon-determination, but an essentiality. Only in actual essentiality can actuality-reflection come essentially to itself; actual essentiality, the actuality anticipated in reflection, is dogmatic possibility.

The skeptical possibility was negative with respect to the objects as well as to the reflecting subjectivity; the dogmatic possibility is affirmative for the objects as well as for subjectivity. The affirmative possibility is objective as the possibility of things, the possibility out of which the actual proceeds, the possibility that only takes up the conditions for becoming actual, and only becomes actual in that it at once reaches and oversteps its own limit, for the limit of possibility is indeed actuality. The affirmative possibility is subjective as the thinkability of things, for only in the form of thinkability, of thought, of the concept can an actuality with all its determinations be there as possibility. The affirmative possibility receives its particular dogmatic stamp [224] from this, that the supposing functions pass over into the problematic ones.

Just as the skeptical possibility arose from the fact that the problematic function

sprang out of the assertoric, so the dogmatic possibility now arises from the fact that the problematic springs out of supposing functions. What the assertoric functions are in relation to immediate actuality, the supposing ones are in relation to the reflected immediacy of essentiality. The movement is this: here, by logical slipping-under, a thought-determination is posited in reflected and yet immediate unity with a corresponding being-determination: the immediate unity of thinking and being is dogmatic. Once the being-determination in question has been set up, the testing follows; reflection places itself over against its own presupposition as before a logical object; the thought is represented, the represented is thought; this is the unrest; in this unrest lies the negativity: the negativity at once represented and yet thought awakens the problematic.

For dogmatic reflection the possible is quite generally one with the thinkable; the supposed unity of thinkability and possibility corresponds straightforwardly to the supposed unity of thinking and being: as the thinkable, possibility is subjective; as the possible, thinkability is objective. Hence it comes that the test of the possible coincides with the test of the thinkable, just as the test of the impossible coincides with the test of the unthinkable. The mark of the thinkable is freedom from contradiction; the same mark holds for the possible (*possibile est, quod non implicat contradictionem*). The mark of the unthinkable is contradiction; the same holds for the impossible (*impossibile est, quod implicat contradictionem*). But this supposed unity of thinkable and possible, of unthinkable and impossible, now calls forth doubt about the objective essence of possibility.

[225] “Everything in which no contradiction lies is possible, whether it exists or not. Indeed everything that exists has first been possible before it came to be: otherwise it could never come to any actuality. That which has existed is still possible, although it no longer exists, and it remains possible without end ... A man would never have come to be had it not been possible that his parents could have brought him into the world; and, after he is dead, one can say the same, he would never have lived had his life not been possible. The possible is consequently eternal, and every possibility is eternal, because no time can be thought, either before or after, at which it should

either begin or cease again.” These words of Eilschow, an independent thinker⁷⁸ from the Leibnitz-Wolffian period, are well suited to characterize the dogmatic possibility. Thus: possibility is eternal; it is a thought’s agreement with itself in the form of a being’s agreement with itself; that which is self-agreeing agrees with itself for all eternity, whether or not there is anyone who thinks upon it.

First, then, the possible is posited as identical with the thinkable; next the thinkable is, on account of thought’s supposed unity with being, posited in the form of the possible as so being, that the dogmatist falls into doubt whether he shall let possibility rest eternally upon itself, or make the eternally thinkable dependent upon an eternally thinking one. The eternally thinking one is God; it lies in the immediacy with which the supposing functions presuppose God, that the problem takes on a tinge as much theological as logical. One might then be tempted to emancipate possibility from God. “Yet we shall,” says our dogmatic philosopher, “not make every possibility into a little divinity that has the ground in itself for itself, which seems to follow from what I have said. Some old school-sages have fallen into the perverse thought that the possibilities [226] did not depend upon God or have their ground in his essence, because one could think of them and prove them without representing to oneself that they had their ground in some eternally-necessary being, or in God. A triangle is possible because a figure can be enclosed by three lines: one can say neither that these three lines nor that their meeting in as many points is possible because there is a God. It seems much rather that this possibility would be undeniable even if he had never existed; and an atheist who denies God does not for all that deny the triangle’s possibility. What then are we to lay down?”

Three preliminary possibilities now present themselves concerning the eternal possibilities: either they are grounded in themselves, or in God’s will, or in the divine understanding. “Are we to say with Cartesius that they are grounded in God’s will and good pleasure alone, so that a thing is possible merely because God wills that it shall be so, then it must also be conceded that the same thing can become impossible as soon as he finds it good. A triangle became possible, then, when God willed that three lines in as many points should be able to enclose a space; but how could it now

⁷⁸Fr. Chr. Eilschow. *Philosophiske Breve*. Kjøbenhavn 1748. p. 147.

come about that the same could become impossible, or how could God resolve that three lines should henceforth no longer be able to compose a figure? If one concedes that the latter resolve is impossible, as one cannot but concede, then the first, which makes the triangle possible, must be eternal; afterwards at the very least: that is to say, what God has once willed should be possible must thereafter remain so through all eternities ... But that is not yet all that can be called to mind. Just as Cartesius must concede that what has once become possible according to God's will always remains so, so can we also maintain that what is now possible has been so always; for as great a violence as one must do to the understanding in order to represent to oneself that the time could come when a triangle should be as little able to enclose a [227] space as two straight lines now can do it, just so completely must one also violate the understanding in order to represent to oneself that there has been a time when God could have made a two-sided figure possible and a triangle impossible. From this it follows that just as one must concede the eternity of the possibilities afterwards, so must one also concede it beforehand, or that all possibilities are, without beginning and end, unchangeable, necessary, eternal".⁷⁹

What is here said of the eternal possibilities holds dogmatically for all the abstract a priori concepts, the so-called eternal truths (*veritates æternæ*). But although possibility is in its universal concept eternal, and in this its eternity indifferent toward the difference between actual being and non-being, possibility cannot possibly, in relation to the thing, be indifferent toward the thing's possible determinate being. If the possibilities are made independent of God, and things are only actualized possibilities, then things seem thereby to become independent of God as well: how now is this possible? "The possibilities of things are dependent upon God, but not upon his bare will and good pleasure. They are grounded in his infinite understanding and the same's eternal representations of all that could be brought forth by his omnipotence. Were God not to exist, then no thing would be possible, that is true enough; but a possibility is for that reason as little created by God as he can be said to have created his own understanding".⁸⁰ — The dogmatic possibility is indeed an eternal concept, but with all its eternity nonetheless, remarkably enough, a restless concept. If the

⁷⁹Eilschov. Philosophiske Breve. p. 147–49.

⁸⁰Anf. Skr. p. 150.

possibilities of things cannot rest upon God's "bare will and good pleasure", since the eternal concept is raised above all arbitrariness; if the possibilities cannot be independent of God, since no thing would be possible if God did not exist, then they must presumably be in the divine understanding. But with this assumption too the dogmatic reflection strikes upon difficulties. Were the possibilities of things to depend [228] upon the divine understanding because all possible things depend upon God, then God, who has created things, must surely also have created the possibilities; but that is altogether impossible. The understanding cannot then determine possibility; the possibility-concept is objective: the understanding has to respect the concept's unchangeable objectivity. "I say it is enough that the properties of things do not contradict or overturn one another; therefore they are possible, and they need no other ground for their possibility than just this non-contradiction. Or how am I to comprehend the connection in this syllogism: this or that thing has been, is and remains eternally possible; therefore there exists a being which eternally represents its possibility to itself. Our forefathers did not think that many of the things which the moderns have proved in the mechanical and physical sciences were possible before art in our days discovered them; but have they for that reason not been so? The ancients knew, for example, only quite a few electrical bodies, and did not represent to themselves that water could be electrified; yet nature was then, as now, filled with electrical bodies. We know it; but they did not know it. Their representation and ours alters just as little in nature as one can say that a mirror in a room makes the things that are found in it, or that there is a chair, table, benches because one can see all this in the glass When we say that the infinite representation-force represents infinite things to itself, ours by contrast only certain things then we set down all the difference that there is between God's understanding and ours. The former represents to itself at one stroke all possible things, the latter only a few, and those by degrees; the former is unrestricted, the latter is restricted, etc. But in all this we still find no ground in God's understanding for the possibility of things. So much the famous Wolf shows, that God's will without antecedent necessity cannot have invented the ideas in which the possibilities are contained; since they are unchangeable and therefore [229] eternal; but it is by no means a consequence that they are therefore grounded in his

understanding.⁸¹”

From these utterances it will be possible to see what the relation is between dogmatism's slipping-under and its problematic functions. The dogmatic thinking is hypostatizing. First it makes the possibilities into pure thought-beings and gives them an objective determinate being; alongside this it posits the Godhead as the absolute substance; and now the question arises how far the possibilities are in God or outside God.

Thus the dogmatic reflection can, according to the foregoing, apprehend the possible as the thinkable, stare at this in-itself thinkable as at a being, without seeing the impossibility that the merely thinkable should be able to have any determinate being other than that which it obtains through thinking: thought's logical objectivity impresses the dogmatic thinker. The possible that I think, says the dogmatist, does not become possible because I think it; but I think it possible because it — independently of my thinking — is possible. “A triangle is possible even before I learn to represent it to myself in thought. I can afterwards represent it to myself; but the figure's possibility is older than my representation, and the latter does not contain the ground of the former. If I inscribe it upon a surface, then it has me to thank for the fact that it exists; but by no means my preceding representation for the fact that it is possible⁸²”. Thinking and representation clash with one another. In that thinking objectifies its concepts to itself, these concepts take on a represented objectivity; through the represented objectivity thinking's own products become independent of thinking: the dogmatic thinking comes as a stranger to what is its own and thereby becomes a stranger to itself.

[230] So long as representation clashes with thought, an altered point of departure will constantly lead to an altered result: here, in dogmatism as in skepticism, there is possibility for a multitude of highly different points of departure and therefore also possibility for a multitude of mutually conflicting results. The difference is only this, that while the skeptical reflection finds itself repelled by every result, because in every result it strikes upon the antilogical, the dogmatic reflection will every time find self-confirmation in the result it has won, since this result is nothing other than

⁸¹Eilschov. *Philosophische Breve*. p. 154–55.

⁸²Anf. *Skr.* p. 155.

its own logical essentiality, slipped under by supposing functions. What infinitely interests the skeptics, that something problematic incessantly results from every possible assumption, surprises and torments the dogmatist. The dogmatic thinker supposes at every moment, once a demonstration is concluded, that he has found something fixed, something whereby he can set himself at rest, and does not heed that contradiction smoulders in possibility, that possibility is like a snake in the grass.

If the dogmatist, e.g., starts from the consideration that the thing's possibility can exist prior to the thing only in this, that it has existence in a representation independent of the thing's actuality, then he will soon see that it is the representation that makes possibility independent of the thing. But the general representation cannot possibly represent itself: every representation must presuppose a representing subjectivity. Thus, in that the possibility independent of the thing is dependent upon representation, and representation upon the subject's representing, the independence of possibility from the thing must precisely be grounded in its dependence upon subjectivity: the eternal possibilities, independent of all possible things, must be grounded in an eternal, thinking, willing substance independent of all possible things. Now it is thus certain that the eternal possibilities are in God.

But in this certainty there is concealed once again a good deal of uncertainty. For [231] when the divine will is posited as dogmatic positive reality over against or alongside a corresponding reality, namely the divine understanding, then it is still uncertain how far the eternal possibilities that are in God are to be assumed to rest either upon God's will or upon the divine understanding. Everything here depends upon the point of departure: one can dogmatically start from the understanding, but one can also start from the will. Here, as we have seen, Wolf and Cartesius stand sharply opposed to one another. Wolf assumes that all possibilities are grounded in the divine understanding, Cartesius that they rest upon God's will. The author of the "Philosophiske Breve" attaches himself most nearly to Wolf, but attempts a grounding of his own. "It is of no use," he says, "to defy an Aristotelian opponent under the customary philosophical armor, with which some believe they can ward off every thrust. It is of no use, I would say, to come forward with the general fundamental rule: *Everything that is must have a sufficient ground why it rather is than is not*, and thereupon to syllogize thus: every

possibility must have a ground why it is rather a possibility than an impossibility: this it cannot contain in itself; otherwise it were God, consequently in something else” “the said principal ground concerns only the realm of actual, and not of possible things.” The author’s agreement with Wolf is then, in consequence of the corrective applied, grounded in a disagreement; the result is the same, only the ways are different. But the dogmatic separation of way and result leads precisely into new entanglements and new contradictions. In the corrective applied there is concealed a contradiction.

Dazzled by the pure concept’s formal objectivity, the author of the “Breve” sets the eternal possibility self-subsistently against all actualization; relying upon the axiom of contradiction he does not notice the contradiction that a possibility which lacks a
 [232] ground of existence, and therefore, so long as the ground is lacking, can never become actual, is impossible. Between possibility and actuality he interposes the ground, and does not notice that possibility itself stands just as sorely in need of the ground in order to become possible as “the realm of actual things” does in order to be actual. “Everything that is, namely everything that is actual, everything that exists, must have a ground why it exists, and rather in that manner than in any other; but not so long as it remains in possibility. — So long as it is merely possible, it has ground enough in itself for itself”; — *without God things are possible*. “God necessarily represents to himself all possibilities, such as they are, that is, as possibilities, as things in whose properties and constitutions no contradiction is found: further ground they do not need. If any of them is to come into being outside God’s representation, then God himself must prove that it is possible, then he must create, then he must will that it shall exist⁸³”: *without God things are impossible*. Thus: *without God things are possible; without God things are impossible*; this is the contradiction.

After Eilschov has in this manner, by tacking among contradictions, pursued by contradiction, brought movement into Wolf’s congealing syllogism, he then goes over to setting forth his own view of the matter, and arrives at a result that is quite characteristic of the dogmatic reflection; for in the result contradiction is again seen. He will, as he expresses himself, show “that all possibilities are grounded in God’s understanding, and that they consequently have their ground in God’s possibility

⁸³Eilschov. Philosophische Breve. p. 156 ff.

alone, above which there is none.” First he elucidates the matter by an example from “numbers and magnitudes”, for of these it holds that “the less is always enclosed in the greater down to the first unity.” “The possibility of the one is grounded nowhere but in itself; but it has in itself the ground of all other numbers’ possibility;” it is therefore so apt “that Pythagoras has called God by a name which is full of emphasis, [233] *Unity*”. Now follows the explanation. God’s possibility is solely and alone grounded in itself, because it is determined by itself without regard to anything else, just as unity, the original unity, is determined by itself without regard to any finite number. Were now a thing’s possibility to be thought independent of God’s possibility, then it would likewise have to be thought to be determined by itself “without the help of any other possibility”: but this is, on account of the thing’s finitude, impossible. “When I ask whether a thing is possible, I become unreasonable if I do not first posit the constitution of that thing about which I am asking.” The finite is in its limits undetermined, and must therefore be determined; only in being determined does it become possible. It is indeed in general possible that a line can “lie evenly between its points”, but an infinite straight line is impossible. “When one then names an infinite straight line, one says a line which is to have points, that is, bounds, for otherwise there is no line, and which at the same time is to have none, for otherwise it is not infinite; that is, *one contradicts oneself*.” — By these considerations the author of the “Philosophiske Breve” then arrives at the result that the possibilities of things are contained in God’s possibility, just as the finite numbers are in unity. “Were no infinite representation-force possible, then no finite thing would be possible: because every finite possibility is not of necessity determined; *it must first be determined by the infinite*. This determination cannot take place except in representation, so long as the possible is not actual, or does not exist. *Consequently the possibilities of finite things have their ground in the infinite representation-force and by no means in themselves*⁸⁴.”

But a syllogism which in this manner is to solve the problem will precisely on account of the manner — with the modality of the functions everything depends upon [234] the manner — be a new beginning of the problematic. For if the possibility of things must be determined by an infinite understanding, because the finite, that which is

⁸⁴Eilschov. Philosophiske Breve. p. 160–61.

in itself undetermined but nonetheless determinable, can be determined in infinitely many manners, then there must, dogmatically understood, be something arbitrary in the manner in which the infinite understanding expressly determines each single possibility: if the single possibilities are dependent upon the divine understanding, then they are thereby dependent upon the divine will as well. In this manner — and everything depends upon the manner — the strife between Cartesians and Wolfians can never end.

Thesis. It is God's arbitrariness that has determined the finite possibilities. Proof. The possible is in its finite determinateness opposed to the necessary; for the possible is determined *thus* only because it could also be determined *otherwise*. What is determined *thus*, although it could be determined *otherwise*, is determined with arbitrariness; thus ...

Antithesis. God's arbitrariness has not determined the finite possibilities. Proof. Necessary is that whose opposite is impossible or contradictory. Now it is contradictory that the possible should be impossible; consequently every possibility is necessary. The necessary cannot be determined arbitrarily; thus ...

It is characteristic that Kant, in the course of his attack upon dogmatism, set up "the antinomy". The antinomy is dogmatism's consequence; its secret is an interchange of essential points of departure: in the antinomy the dogmatic possibility becomes impossibility; the task is to get this impossibility transformed back into possibility.

3) *The Ontology of the Possibilities: two-sided Modality.* It has come to be regarded as a sign of the Hegelian dialectic's superiority over "the finite understanding" that it [235] has been able to solve the Kantian antinomies. In a certain manner this superiority is unmistakable. In two points Kant shows himself entangled in dogmatic prejudices. He is transfixed by the immediacy in the dogmatic points of departure. In his thesis one standpoint holds, in his antithesis another and opposed standpoint; between the opposed standpoints no essential transition is here given: one comes by a leap from the one to the other. He is transfixed by the immediacy in the dogmatic limit. The dogmatic limit is a fixed, existent limit, secured by a distinction that supports itself upon the axiom of contradiction — and upon *principium exclusi medii*.

In both respects Hegel's logic has illuminated the error and by this illumination

earned itself immortal merit. The Hegelian logic can, so far as the form is concerned, with full right be called a logic of the possibilities. Possibility is at bottom transition; he who cannot understand the Hegelian logic cannot understand any essential transition in the concept. There may be much to object to in many of this logic's transitions in detail; but one thing is the transition determined by determinate categories, another is the transition-concept: the general transition-concept is possibility. Should anyone object that it is not possibility but becoming that is in Hegel the proper and first transition-category, then one must answer to this that becoming as transition from being to nothing can acquire no significance at all if it is not seen how it is possible that being can become nothing, and nothing being. All who have raised objection to this transition have really raised objection to its possibility.

The controversies about the logical becoming, the immanent transition, the axiom of contradiction, *principium exclusi medii* and the like can all be brought under the one decisive standpoint, the standpoint of possibility. It is an old joke that a dialectician can make black into white. Insofar as an actual opposition is here thought of, he who makes black into white is plainly a sophist. In actuality black is not white, white not [236] black; in actuality *principium exclusi medii* holds without contradiction. But when the talk is not of the actual but of the possible, is he then also to pass for a sophist who should point out the possibility of a transition from black to white? Should it be sophistical to point out how the opposed concepts pass over into one another with inner necessity, so that the one, essentially regarded, is the other's possibility: then it would have to be sophistical as well to point out connection, ground, grounding, etc.

How inwardly the question of possibility hangs together with an altered apprehension of the axiom of contradiction is seen by setting the possibility-concept against its oppositions. The possible is opposed to the impossible, the necessary and the actual. That the possible is the necessary is of course a contradiction; but if the possible is set abstractly against the impossible, then it becomes, according to Wolf's own definition, precisely the necessary: necessary is that whose opposite is contradictory; the impossibility of the possible is contradictory; thus the possible is necessary. But the possible can be altered; the unalterability of the alterable is contradictory, consequently the possible cannot possibly be the necessary. If the possible is set against the actual, then

it is a contradiction that the possible should be the actual; but if the possible cannot be actual, how can the actual then be possible? The contradiction hidden in possibility the ancients have illuminated from manifold sides; but only Hegel has seen that the solution of the contradiction lay precisely in the transition, that in other words the possibility-concept is a transition-concept.

The opposition between possible and impossible is relative; only between necessary and impossible is the opposition absolute; the opposition between possible and actual [237] is again another than that between possible and necessary. Had Hegel been attentive to the different strength and the differently constituted character of the oppositions, he would with his possibility-forms have found quite other transitions than those now to be found in his logic; but that he has dissolved contradiction into possibility and raised the possibility-form to immanent transition-form must be appreciated. We shall now test the different oppositions.

The opposition between the possible and the actual is, in the newer as well as in the older philosophy, botched in manifold ways. In that the dogmatists without further ado identify the possible with the thinkable, the actual becomes merely a modification of the possible: "everything in which no contradiction lies is possible, whether it then exists or not". In possibility the difference between actual and unactual is then in this manner entirely effaced: in possibility the unactual is actual, for it is indeed actually possible; and the actual unactual, for in possibility it passes only for a possible. It is the subjective modality that is here without further ado confounded with the objective. In subjective modality the possible is indeed the thinkable, and the thinkable indifferent toward the opposition of actual and unactual. To think the actual is to transform it into a possible, that is, to apprehend it logically as a concept; it is, in other words, to abstract from its actuality; for the actual is in actuality not a concept, it is an existence; it is not logical but antilogical: possibility is logical, actuality antilogical.

When the antilogical is posited, the logical is sublated; when the actual is posited, the possible is sublated: the antilogical has been logical, for existence has been concept, reality has been ideality, power has been knowledge, the actual has been possible. But the actual as actual is not what it has been before it became actual. He who says that the actual as actual is still possible says, after all, that the actual still is what it was

before it became actual; he speaks ambiguously, and easily becomes a sophist. The [238] ambiguity is that the subjective modality is given out for objective, the concept for its existence. The concept has not by an alteration become existence, the logical not by an alteration become antilogical; it is a manifestation of power, a real reversal, upon which the transformation rests; it is a manifestation of power, a real reversal, whereby the possible has become an actual: this is the character of the objective modality. To reduce the possible and the actual to indifference in the thinkable is an error which Hegel with all his dialectic has in common with the dogmatists. The only one who has been rightly attentive to the opposition between possible and actual is Kant; but he has not been able to master it.

If the opposition of possible and actual is apprehended in all sharpness, then the objection lies near “that since there can be given no even transition from possibility to actuality, the above commendation of the Hegelian possibility-concept as an immanent transition-concept must presumably be retracted”. This is however a misunderstanding. It is true that the immanent in the transition cannot be apprehended so one-sidedly that the difference between the subjective and the objective in modality should vanish in pure objectivity; but the reciprocal determination of subjective and objective, logical and antilogical, is in the transition so infinite, the conversion so continuous, that the immanent is seen in transformation: as transition-concept possibility is essentially a transformation-concept.

Possibility is a word of knowledge, actuality a word of power; the opposition of possible and actual is a decisive opposition of knowledge and power. But then the transition from possibility to actuality is thereby determined as a conversion of knowledge into power, an incessant transformation of conceptual determinations into existence-determinations. Since now, as we have seen from many sides, the same totality of determinations can be both in the form of knowledge and in the form of power, the opposition of possible and actual cannot straightway be referred [239] to a lack in possibility, that it e.g. has some conditions but lacks others. By one-sidedly emphasizing this distinguishing mark one could easily arrive at the Megarians’ assertion that the possibility which lacks conditions is, on account of the lacking conditions, impossible. No, if the opposition of possibility and actuality is itself to bear

the stamp of actuality, then it must take up into itself another opposition, namely an opposition between possible and possible, between the one possibility and the other. Where an actuality is possible, its opposite is also possible: possibility has alternating terms.

The significance of possibility's alternating terms has already shown itself in anticipation; the further development is conditioned by the alternating modality of the anticipating functions. The relation between possibility, anticipation and preformation has been indicated in an intuitive and popular manner by Leibnitz. In his Theodicy Leibnitz has, as is well known, started from the presupposition that God, in order to be able to create the best world, has made a choice among infinitely many possible worlds. With regard to this Kuno Fischer⁸⁵ has then believed he could point out "the contradiction" in the Leibnitzian "world-concept" in the following manner: "Of the countless worlds that are possible God chooses the one he creates. The actual world is for that reason metaphysically contingent and only morally necessary. But what are those countless worlds that are possible in the divine understanding? One thing can be apodictically maintained, that they all consist of monads, for even the divine understanding cannot represent things to itself otherwise than as monads. Must not now all monads be ensouled bodies, representing forces, analogous beings?

[240] And the analogous beings must, different as they are, form a gradual order, a perfect graduated series in which there is not the slightest interruption. Every thinkable monad is a thinkable difference, and this must, according to the law of continuity, be actual. If we now assume that the possible worlds do not consist of monads, then they are unthinkable, thus impossible in the logical, and consequently also in the divine, understanding. If we assume that they are monads which exist only in the divine understanding but not in nature, then they are plainly *lacking* in nature, then there is here a *défaut d'ordre*, then the actual universe is no perfect graduated series, thus not the most perfect, not the best world. Our syllogism runs: either those countless worlds are impossible, or, if they are possible, then they must also be actual. In both cases there is outside the actual world no other world possible".

Against this criticism, however, objections must here be raised, if not on the

⁸⁵Geschichte der neuern Philosophie. Zweiter Band. Mannheim 1855. p. 509.

monads' behalf, yet on the possibilities'. From modality's objective side it is indeed perfectly correct that the possibility which, either because it has something contradictory in its concept, or because it lacks and, according to the conditions of actuality, will forever come to lack a condition, is impossible. But does the matter now also stand thus when we consider possibility from modality's subjective side? By no means. In the subjective sense it is so far from being the case that the contradictory, and to that extent in the objective sense impossible, should be an unthinkable, thus something impossible in the subjective sense, that contradiction on the contrary lets itself be thought as a sharply designated logical concept, and that so distinctly that the objectively impossible becomes a subjectively possible.

"What does contradiction mean? An existent nothing is a contradiction; a round square is a contradiction; a flying horse is also a contradiction. Nonetheless these contradictions are of different kinds. A flying horse one can represent to oneself, but not think. The unthinkable does not lie directly in the logical, that the predicate [241] "flying" contradicts the concept "horse", for this concept could indeed be extended; but in this, that the whole concept thus extended stands in conflict with the conditions and laws of experience. It is otherwise with the round square; here the contradiction is seen immediately in the representation itself. To represent the square as round is impossible: to think a round square is, on the contrary, possible, insofar as it is possible to think the predicate's *conflict* with the subject. The contradiction is thus not merely this, that the predicate's conflict with the subject makes the judgment meaningless; but the contradiction is in a higher sense this, that the contradiction itself, this unthinkable, nevertheless admits of being thought"⁸⁶. If the absurd did not admit of being assumed, if the unthinkable did not admit of being thought at all, then there would be no insight, no grounding, no comprehending. Upon what, then, does insight into what is acceptable rest? Manifestly upon an insight into what is to be rejected. Upon what does the cognition of the reasonable, of that which is in itself consistent, rest? Naturally upon a cognition of the absurd, of that which is in itself conflicting and inconsistent. How is it possible to think the thinkable except precisely through the opposition to the unthinkable? But then, for the sake of the opposition, for

⁸⁶Philos. Propæd. p. 43.

the sake of the thinkable, the unthinkable must after all in some manner be thought. So supple is thought that it thinks with ease its own negative, its own negation.

According to Aristotle one would indeed have to assume that the thought of the false, the absurd, the imperfect was straightforwardly excluded from perfect thinking; but this is an insipidity in Aristotelian dogmatism, an insipidity whose consequence is that the Godhead is not even able to think the possible. If now the Godhead cannot [242] think the possible, then neither can it properly think the actual, and what can it then think?⁸⁷ It is not the case that the thinking subjectivity should be ignorant of the false, the unthinkable, in the same degree as it is knowing of the true and the thinkable; on the contrary, in the same degree as insight into the true rises, in the same degree insight into the false rises also; in the same degree as the possibilities, the objective possibilities that are determined to pass over into actuality, are seen through, in the same degree are the merely subjective possibilities also seen through, those possibilities that are determined to be excluded from actuality, since in the objective sense they are sheer impossibilities.

As one of the most telling examples of the difference between the impossible and the possible, the merely subjectively and the objectively possible, the imaginary magnitude of mathematics may be adduced. Does the imaginary magnitude belong to the possible or to the impossible? Since it is a magnitude, it must naturally belong to the possible; it admits of being assumed, of being designated, one can indeed calculate with it: it cannot then straightforwardly belong to the impossible. But the imaginary magnitude nevertheless stands in a determinate opposition to the real one; this opposition would lose all significance if there were not in the real something possible that is impossible in the imaginary. Let the problem be, e.g., to determine the intersection between a straight line and a circle. "If we call the straight line's distance from the centre p , the radius r , the chord that is cut off c , then we have, to the question: how great is the chord? as answer: $c = 2\sqrt{r^2 - p^2}$. If now $p > r$, c becomes imaginary, or, as Newton expresses it, impossible. The imaginary c thus indicates the impossibility that the line can cut off any chord from the circle. But why now is this impossible? Because the line lies wholly outside the circle. But then there is

⁸⁷Grundideernes Logik I. p. 447.

after all a line here, and we can from another side see something real connected with [243] the imaginary. For by transforming $2\sqrt{r^2 - p^2}$, for $p > r$, into $2\sqrt{p^2 - r^2} \sqrt{-1}$, one sees that the imaginary magnitude has a real component, and that this component is precisely that piece of the tangent to the given circle which is cut off by a circle tangent to the given line. — In order now to see quite clearly how the impossible and the possible are determined by one another, the imaginary alternating with the real, we will consider the adduced example a little more closely. Suppose the problem be put in the following form: There are given two concentric circles, the one with radius p , the other with radius r ; let there be found the length of a chord in the outer one which is tangent to the inner one. In the solution of this problem we must then distinguish between:

1) $p < r$, so that one obtains

$$c = 2\sqrt{r^2 - p^2}; \quad (\text{I})$$

2) $p > r$, so that one obtains

$$c = 2\sqrt{p^2 - r^2}. \quad (\text{II})$$

By multiplication with the imaginary magnitude $\sqrt{-1}$, one can then easily reduce (I) to (II). From this it follows that (I) is impossible when (II) is possible, and conversely that (II) is impossible when (I) is possible. This mathematical matter is then at the same time in perfect agreement with the logical, for p cannot possibly, — in such cases dialectic knows very well what it has to concede to formal logic, — at one and the same time be both greater (to which (II) gives the answer) and also (to which (I) gives the answer) less than r .⁸⁸

With the doctrine of what we shall here call the imaginary and the real possibilities the doctrine of divine foreknowledge stands in the closest connection. It has already been adduced under “the logical ideal”⁸⁹ in what sense the old theologians ascribed to [244] God a conditioned knowledge (*scientia media* [*sc. de futuro conditionato s. futuribili, hypothetica, simplicis intelligentiæ*], *qua Deus perspicit omnia, quæ, positis quibusdam conditionibus, evenire potuissent*). To this there attach themselves, naturally in a spec-

⁸⁸Om Begrebet Nøiagtighed med særligt Hensyn til Hr. Prof. Steens “Bidrag”. Efterskrift til “Philosophie og Matematik” af R. Nielsen. Kjøbenhavn 1860. p. 26–27.

⁸⁹Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 235.

ulative manner, pronouncements in speculative dogmatics. “The contradiction that has been supposed to lie between the concept of a free course of the world and the divine omniscience” — so it runs in the doctrine of “the free course of the world and God’s manifold wisdom” — “rests upon a one-sided conception of omniscience as mere *foreknowledge*, upon a misapprehension of the *conditioned* in the divine decree ... The final end of the world’s development, with the whole series of moments of development necessary in and for themselves, must be thought to stand fast in the eternal decree; but the actual execution of the eternal decree, the whole fullness of the actual determinations of the course of the world, insofar as these are conditioned by the freedom of the creature, can also be the object only of a conditioned foreknowledge, that is, they can be foreknown only as possibilities (as *Futuribilia*), since other possibilities may become actual”.

If speculative dogmatics only meant something by what it thus says, if one could really bring it to lay scientific weight upon its free course of thought and its own “manifold wisdom”, it would now be an easy matter to extort from it the following admission: “If the world-possibilities really depend upon the alternation of the conditions, and the alternating conditions restrict foreknowledge, then the consequence must be that every foreknowledge of the actual becomes wholly impossible. On these terms it would not be possible for an omniscient being to know exactly today what the weather will be tomorrow”. If, on the other hand, the connection between the
 [245] conditions is to be conceived thus, that he who knows the state of the world at a given time can from it predict the alternation of the conditions for all times to come, then “the conditioned” has set no limit whatever to foreknowledge; but possibility is transformed into a futuric necessity, the course of the world is unfree. What does speculative dogmatics now communicate upon this head? Ambiguities! According to speculative dogmatics “the conditioned in the decree” is to restrict foreknowledge to a certain degree; according to orthodox dogmatics the doctrine of the world-conditions is on the contrary to extend the representation of foreknowledge. What orthodox dogmatics teaches *de Futuribilibus* is indeed not developed into concept, but the assumption of a *scientia, qua Deus perspicit omnia, quæ positis quibusdam conditionibus evenire potuissent* nevertheless contains significant hints toward a logical separation

between imaginary and real possibilities. The possibility which *positis quibusdam conditionibus* is imaginary can again *positis quibusdam conditionibus* become real, and conversely.

Since the opposition between the subjective and the objective, the imaginary and the real possibilities is not absolute but relative, and since this relativity can on account of the alternating conditions run through innumerable gradations: it is seen that the reciprocal determination of possible and impossible, possible and possible, possible and actual must, in consequence of the two-sided modality of the anticipating and preforming functions, be manifold. If there are in the divine knowledge assertoric judgments in an infinite system, then there is also an infinite system of problematic judgments: there is in the circle of the possibilities infinitely much more than there is in actuality. That Leibnitz has let the Godhead determine the actual world by the exclusion of innumerable possible ones can from the standpoint of the possibilities by no means be laid to his charge; what can be laid to his charge on logic's behalf is the manner, the manner in which he lets the anticipation, the choice and the preformation [246] of "the best world" take place.

That the Godhead's choice among innumerable possibilities acquires in Leibnitz a strongly anthropomorphic tinge derives, to be sure, in part from this, that in his popular presentation he has had to accommodate himself to the reader's power of comprehension and as far as possible to avoid conflicts with the theologians; but, according to the fundamental character of his philosophy, essentially from this, that representation is constantly at odds with thinking. While creation is for thought a fundamental relation, it is for representation a supernatural event. The choice by which the Creator hits upon the best world forms in Leibnitz a peculiar boundary-line between possibility and necessity, between the abstractly subjective and the independently objective.

Prior to the choice subjectivity reigns one-sidedly; the Godhead's gaze beholds as it were a sea of billowing possibilities, all is in suspense; for every possibility is, however completely actuality may be anticipated, a hovering determinateness; perhaps thus, perhaps thus! the problematic functions are, under the anticipation, in infinite movement.

After the choice, on the other hand, all is changed, the best world is now completely determined; all its possibilities are at one stroke transformed into sheer peculiar dispositions, in their peculiarity unalterable, dispositions that develop themselves with inner necessity. From every side everything is now determined, calculated in advance and fixed so punctually that the whole development is a becoming, a continually unfolding necessity: here there is no room for possibility.

What in Leibnitz should have been developed into concept has remained standing at a representation. Only representation can want to set from eternity a finite limit between possible and necessary and then suppose that the matter is thereby settled [247] once and for all. The concept shows that the relation between possible and necessary is an infinite reciprocal relation; but since the opposition of the possible and the necessary is so absolute that the possible can as little be made into a necessary as the necessary into a possible, the development of the concept will demand a closer determination.

γγ) *The Apodictic Judgment: Functions of Reflected Determinateness.* The immediate determinateness, scepticism's presupposition, turns over through reflection into indeterminateness; the determinateness reflected in the indeterminateness transforms itself for intuition into an immediately determinate essentiality and forms the presupposition for dogmatism. That the reflected determinateness passes for immediate makes the dogmatic reflection recognizable: different points of departure condition different results; the conflicting results introduce indeterminateness anew, every time it is supposed to have been overcome. As possibility-philosophy dogmatism will develop a system of objective essence-determinations; but since with all its eye for the essence of possibility it is not able to see through the form of possibility, it fixes its essence-determinations as finite being-determinations, and must halt before the impossibility presented in the antinomy. To the ontology of the possibilities dogmatism has, however, furnished characteristic contributions, by seeking on the one side their origin in the all-determining subjectivity, and on the other side by demanding the objective connection of the possible with the actual and the necessary. Although in this way a problem has arisen which the dogmatic reflection is not able to solve, yet those conceptual elements have been procured by whose working-up the solution

of the problem will be attained.

It is the form, the possibility-form, upon which everything essentially depends in the working-up of the elements; but when the emphasis falls upon form and development of form, possibility, actuality and necessity will reflect one another as different forms of one form, particular determinations in one totalized determinateness. [248] Since now the totalized unity of the form-determinations is itself form, there enters the form-question characteristic of the modality of the functions, whether it is possibility, actuality or necessity that furnishes the comprehensive form-unity, or whether the unity itself is perhaps a still higher and more concrete form: we shall then investigate the form-unity.

In the development of form possibility, the still indeterminate determinateness, can be determined as unity of actuality and necessity. The actual is, in essential opposition to the necessary, an alterable; the necessary, in opposition to the actual, an unalterable. Each of the terms thus opposed has at one and the same time its opposition, its negative, within itself and outside itself; it has and is its own opposite.

As the form of the alterable, immediate actuality has necessity, the determinateness of the unalterable reflected into itself, outside itself: the alterable is not the unalterable, the contingent not the necessary. What then is actuality in its abstract immediacy, in its pure contingency? Its positive being is to be determined negatively; the alterable is the not-unalterable, and has in actuality this negative determinateness for ground and foundation: the alterable is possible only through the unalterable.

As the form of the unalterable, necessity is in itself negatively determined; the unalterable can subsist only as the negation of the alterable; but if the negation of the alterable is to continue, the alterable itself must continue. A negation that has nothing to negate is impossible. If the alterable can no longer be negated, because it has vanished, the negation will instantly attack the unalterable. The unalterable is possible only through the alterable.

But that the alterable is possible only through the unalterable is in other words to say that the unalterable is the possibility of the alterable; that the unalterable is possible only through the alterable shows likewise that the alterable is the possibility [249] of the unalterable. With the doubling that the alterable itself contains the unalterability

from whose negation it proceeds, alterability is expressly determined as actuality; with the doubling that the unalterable itself contains the alterability upon whose negation its self-confirmation rests, unalterability is expressly determined as necessity. That the actual has necessity for its possibility means that necessity is possibility by means of the actual; that the necessary has actuality for its possibility means that actuality is possibility by means of the necessary. In this way, then, the possibility-form is the form-unity of all forms. *All is possibility, all is possible*⁹⁰.

[250] If now all is really possible, then it is also possible, by the modality of the development of form, that the actual can constitute the uniting middle of possibility and necessity, that in other words the actuality-form can become the principal form. In its reflected opposition to actuality the objective possibility is one with actuality; this contradiction makes itself known in this, that the possible, although it is not actual, must nevertheless, insofar as it is objective, have existence in some actual or other, and thus be as an actual: only in the actual is there an actual possibility. Only the actual possibility is real, the unactual is imaginary; the imaginary possibility is in the objective sense impossibility. If now possibility, in order to become actual in one manner, must already beforehand be actual in another manner, then it follows from this that possibility is a modal determination, and thus only a side-determination in the actual: actuality is immediately itself and possibility.

In immediate unity with its possibility the actual must necessarily reflect necessity.

⁹⁰Although it is only form-determinations, pure determinations of reflection, that are dealt with here, one must nevertheless not imagine that they are without significance for actuality. What a different conception of the relation between possibility, actuality and necessity may come to signify for existence in its most decisive crises, S. Kierkegaard has masterfully developed in his work "Sygdommen til Døden". — "The believer possesses the eternally sure antidote against despair: possibility; for with God all things are possible at every moment. This is the health of faith, which resolves contradictions. The contradiction here is that, humanly speaking, destruction is certain, and that there is nevertheless possibility. Health in general is to be able to resolve contradictions. So bodily or physically: a draught is a contradiction, for in a draught cold and heat are disparate or undialectical; but a healthy body resolves this contradiction and does not notice the draught. So too with faith. ... — The fatalist is in despair, has lost God and thus his self. But the fatalist has no God, or what is the same, his God is necessity; for as with God all things are possible, so God is this, that all things are possible. ... In order to pray there must be a God, a self — and possibility, or a self and possibility in the pregnant sense, for God is this, that all things are possible, or that all things are possible is God; and only he whose being was so shaken that he became spirit by understanding that all things are possible, only he has involved himself with God. That God's will is the possible makes it possible for me to pray; is it merely the necessary, then man is as mute as the beast." Anf. Skr. p. 35–36.

Necessity is, as we have seen, the possibility of actuality, and only through this possibility essentially different from actuality; that actuality is in immediate unity with its possibility means, then, that it integrates itself by means of possibility, that it is in unity – by means of possibility in reflected unity – with necessity. Through reflection actuality does indeed lose its peculiar stamp, insofar as it is to be immediate; but the loss is made good by this, that reflection sublates itself: reflection's self-sublation in reflected determinateness is necessity. Through that immediacy with which reflection begins and is broken off, through the immediate immediacy, actuality has taken [251] possibility up into itself; through that immediacy in which reflection is completed and therefore itself ends, through the reflected immediacy posited by reflection, actuality has taken necessity up into itself. In this way it is then the actuality-form that is the form-unity of the forms: *All is actuality, all is actual.*⁹¹

It is immediacy, the immediate determinateness, with which reflection begins; it is immediacy, the reflected immediacy, in which it ends. So long as the actual can by reflection be converted into the possible, and the possible again by the returning immediacy become the actual, so long, in other words, as reflection and immediacy continue to designate an alternation, the principal form will alternately assume now the stamp of possibility, now that of actuality, and necessity will be a subordinate form. But when the immediate itself has become reflected, and the reflected immediate, the alternation ends, and necessity, the fundamental form of the unalternating, shows [252] itself. Why can the finite opposition of immediacy and reflection not maintain itself? Because each of the opposition's terms is equally alternable. Immediacy, which in the infinite just as in the finite presupposes reflection, changes about and becomes reflected; reflection, which in the finite as in the infinite presupposes immediacy,

⁹¹“For it is not so, as the philosophers explain, that necessity is the unity of possibility and actuality; no, actuality is the unity of possibility and necessity ... Already in relation to seeing oneself in a mirror it is necessary to know oneself; for if one does not, then one does not see oneself, but merely a human being. But the mirror of possibility is no ordinary mirror, it must be used with the utmost caution. For of this mirror it holds in the highest sense that it is untrue. That a self looks thus and thus in the possibility of itself is only half the truth; for in the possibility of itself the self is still far from being, or is only half, itself. The question then is how this self's necessity determines it more closely”. S. Kierkegaard. *Sydommen til Døden*. p. 32–33. But however willingly one must, from existence's and actuality's own standpoint, concede that actuality is the unity of possibility and necessity, there lies in this no obstacle to necessity's also being conceived, by a change of standpoint, as the unity of possibility and actuality.

changes about and is resolved into the immediate: the reflected becomes immediate. Not even the separation between immediate and reflected immediacy, a separation with which reflection has exerted itself to the utmost, is able to maintain itself. At reflection's beginning the first, and thus immediate, immediacy becomes a reflex in the beginning reflection, and thus *reflected*; with reflection's completion its last reflex vanishes in the immediacy that has come to be, and is thus existent, and is thus no longer reflected but *immediate*. Reflection may now turn and twist as it will: always it gets the same out of the different and the different out of the same; always the same and the same, that which in all alternations is unalternating, the unalterable that masters all alterations, the necessary. As the absolute unity of the possible and the actual, necessity is now the principal form: *All is necessity, all is necessary*.

That now each of the results of the development of form, with all its many-sidedness, is nevertheless — on account of the shifting modality — itself one-sided, strikes the eye. Were the result: all is actuality, all is actual, the last and highest, then, as the empiricists assert, the assertoric judgments would exclusively furnish the contingent foundation of cognition; the logical functions would in innumerable modifications be functions of immediate determinateness. Were the result: all is possibility, all is possible, the highest of the development of form, then, as the sceptics assume, the problematic judgments would constitute the groundless ground of cognition, and [253] all logical functions would be functions of sublated determinateness. Were the result, finally: all is necessity, all is necessary, the only rational one, then, as dogmatism presupposes, the apodictic judgments — axioms, definitions, etc. — would have to furnish the essential, fixed foundation of cognition; the logical functions would then in all possible ways have to be modified into functions of reflected determinateness.

The results obtained have in a certain manner the same validity. The apodictic judgment will as little be able to displace or dominate either the assertoric or the problematic as any of these will ever be able to make itself the sole ruler of knowledge. The assertoric, the problematic and the apodictic are in modality three forms under which the validity of the judgment originally comes forward; but in the logic of the ideas — it lies in the essence of logic — it is a matter of course that the apodictic form must be the overarching one. For closer elucidation the different phases of the

apodictic are then brought out.

Insofar as the necessity-form arises through reflection's sublating and arresting itself, the apodictic coincides with the logical: the apodictic is *logical*. Insofar as reflection can reach immediacy only by the help of an immediate, and the immediate, in whose reflex reflection comes to a stand, is as real negation opposed to reflection, the apodictic must coincide with the antilogical: the apodictic is *antilogical*. If now the logically apodictic is not to come into conflict with the antilogical, both forms must become modal determinations of one absolutely overarching form, the rational: the apodictic is both as logical and as antilogical *rational*. Thus:

1) *The Logical-Apodictic: essential necessity*. In the Hegelian logic necessity is treated in three different places: in "the objective logic" under "actuality", in "the subjective logic" under "the judgment" (das Ur theil der Nothwendigkeit) and under [254] "the syllogism" (der Schluß der Nothwendigkeit); against such a distribution nothing can, in a systematic respect, well be objected. Characteristic, on the other hand, is it that while the development in the objective part of the logic is detailed, acute and fruitful, the treatment in the subjective part is by contrast short, aphoristic and barren. The ground of this is easy to see; it is the misapprehension of subjectivity that avenges itself upon this point also.

When necessity is elucidated by means of the judgment, one would surely expect to see its significance from the subjective side, and this all the more as its objective significance has already beforehand passed through its logical development. But no! The judgment is objective, in the concept of subjectivity, so objective that it objectively judges itself; necessity must then present itself objectively a second time. Necessity was now, as the necessity of the concept, to receive a step-by-step development through the categorical, the hypotheticalal and the disjunctive judgment⁹²; but the remarks

⁹²"Dieß ist die Nothwendigkeit des Begriffs", says Hegel concerning the disjunctive judgment — "worin erstens die Dieselbigkeit beider Extreme einerlei Umfang, Inhalt und Allgemeinheit ist; zweitens sind sie nach der Form der Begriffsbestimmungen unterschieden, so daß aber um jener Identität willen diese als bloße Form ist. Drittens erscheint die identische objektive Allgemeinheit deswegen als das in sich Reflektirte gegen die unwesentliche Form, als *Inhalt*, der aber an ihm selbst die Bestimmtheit der Form hat; das eine Mal als die einfache Bestimmtheit der *Gattung*; das andere Mal eben diese Bestimmtheit als in ihren Unterschied entwickelt, — auf welche Weise sie die Besonderheit der *Arten*, und deren Totalität, die Allgemeinheit der *Gattung*, ist". — That these remarks are merely adduced on the occasion of the judgment, and are by no means conceptual determinations that are developed with inner necessity out

that are adduced on the occasion of the judgment's form are so far from carrying
 [255] the development of the concept of necessity further that they on the contrary serve to divert attention from the main matter. Only by modality can the determination of necessity show itself to stand in essential dependence upon the judgment. The dependence is known by insight: in insight the subjective meets with the objective.

The objective that corresponds to insight is the evident; the evident never presents itself in a merely immediate light: the light of the understanding is always reflected. And yet in the reflected light reflection is sublated, insight is in its reflecting immediate, in its immediacy reflected. To insight's reflected immediacy there corresponds the immediately evident; to the immediately evident the immediately apodictic. The immediately apodictic has at first glance a striking similarity to the assertoric. "Water is fluid"; "the straight line is the shortest way between two points"; with regard to the immediate in the assurance both judgments seem to fall under the same category, and yet there is here a difference of sphere: the first is assertoric, the last is apodictic. That the last judgment is essentially apodictic is seen from this, that it is reflection, not sense-perception, that gives us the certainty. We draw in thought innumerable lines, we compare them, and now discern, without immediately seeing the innumerable lines, that the straight one must be the shortest. Insofar as the insight rests upon a comparing, the light in the evident is reflected. But a proper adducing of proof nevertheless does not take place; the whole comparison rests upon an estimation: the proposition is as axiom immediately evident.

That the self-evident rests essentially upon reflection, that no axiom stands so fast that it must not fall before a dialectical attack, is at the standpoint of dogmatism a logical mystery. And yet the experiment can be made with any axiom whatever. "Two
 [256] magnitudes which are each severally equal to one and the same third are mutually equal"; this proposition wavers on the instant, when it is properly reflected through. Is there then really any contradiction here? "In order to see what it actually is that is here spoken of, one must expressly note that what is here spoken of is not things that have magnitude, but magnitudes. If what were spoken of here were not the magnitudes themselves, but things that have magnitude, e.g. an apple, a triangle, an hour, etc.,

of the peculiar essence of the judgment, is obvious.

then there would certainly not be a trace of contradiction here. That two triangles which are each equal to one and the same third are mutually equal is self-evident. So long as we have to do with concrete magnitudes, difference and plurality can very well subsist together with equality of magnitude; but when pure magnitudes are in question, the matter stands otherwise. A plurality of magnitudes presupposes with necessity that the one must be capable of being distinguished from the other: without mutual difference no plurality. But by what should pure magnitudes be mutually distinguished from one another if not by their size? If the magnitudes are mutually equal, then every glimmer of difference has vanished, and therewith plurality has vanished as well: that several magnitudes are mutually equal thus means, in other words, that they are not several, but one and the same magnitude, which, however many times it be repeated, is nevertheless not multiplied, but continues to be the selfsame”.⁹³

Should anyone hold that logical investigations of this kind are altogether unfruitful, we need only recall how intimately the question of the difference of pure magnitudes hangs together with the question of the *principium indiscernibilium*, a question that is decisive in the assessment of the Leibnizian philosophy. Should anyone hold that the dialectic by which dogmatic axioms are shaken must absolutely be sophistical, it must here be noted that it is not the negative result, but its interpretation and application, [257] by which sophistry is to be known. When an axiom has been shaken, the sophist interprets this to mean that it is the apodictic judgment that has been overturned, and uses the negative result for a play of thought. True dialectic understands the matter otherwise. That the axiom can be shaken means that the apodictic rests upon reflection; the wavering of the proposition is the expression of the fact that reflection has been set in movement. The movement is conditioned by abstraction. When the abstract proposition is set up as an axiom, there must always be some accessory determination or other to hold it in immediacy. Thus mathematics holds the various equal magnitudes apart from one another by designations, by accessory representations of sums, products ($3 + 3 = 3 \cdot 2 = 12 : 2$), powers, etc. When now the dialectician lets abstraction take away the accessory representations in question

⁹³Forelæsninger over “Phil. Propæd.” Universitetsaaret 1860–61. p. 2–3.

and sets thought in unrest, he is fully conscious of what he is doing; for he knows with himself that the whole operation is meaningless if he does not give back to the proposition the immediacy that has been subtracted from it and thus brings reflection to rest again. In this way it becomes evident that the proposition is an apodictic judgment and, as apodictic judgment, a true axiom.

Sound human understanding relies, and rightly so, upon the immediately evident; but when a separation is to be made between the assertoric and the apodictic judgment, the task is not so easy. To test the apodictic by the help of contradiction acquires significance only when one has first fully tested the contradiction. How difficult it can sometimes be to point out and to test a contradiction is seen from manifold examples, and reminds us, as concerns the exertion of the ancients over their problems, in this connection especially of the Liar (*ψευδόμενος*). “When someone says that he is lying, does he then lie with this his statement, or does he speak the truth? Here either Yes [258] or No is required as an answer. “Yes, he is lying!” — And he says so himself, calls the thing by its right name, says what is true, and therefore does not lie. “No, he is not lying, he speaks the truth!” — One must then believe what he says; now he says precisely that he is lying, so he is not speaking the truth”. Whether Yes or No be answered here, what is answered here is answered in an apodictic judgment. The reflection-movement arises from this, that the concepts lie and truth are incessantly exchanged for one another; they are two apodictic judgments in mutual conflict, an antinomy in sophistical form.

That there is a sophism here is immediately evident. But when this immediately evident is now at the same time to yield a corresponding insight, it must be shown exactly wherein the sophistical consists; only thus can the sophism be expressly annulled. There are two judgments which are here struck together into one; a judgment about a judgment is fused with the judgment judged. He who says: I am lying, judges about a statement which he either has given or will give, and so far, therefore, about a judgment. If we call the judgment in the statement *x*, the judgment about the statement *a*, it is then seen that the speaker must apodictically be truthful in the one judgment when he is apodictically a liar in the other. If the judgment *x* is a truth, then the lie lodges in the judgment *a*; if the judgment *a* is a truth, then we have the liar in the

judgment x. He who himself says that he is lying must absolutely either have said something, or in his statement refer to something, in which he is not lying; he becomes a liar, then, by being truthful, and truthful by being a liar. — Instead of dismissing the sophism with contempt, we must rather admire the ingenuity with which the knot is tied, and take it, not as a sign of mental derangement, but as a speaking proof of the logical energy of Greek thinking, when we hear that Chrysippus wrote six books upon this thought-riddle, and that Philetas of Cos contracted a consumption through excessive exertions to solve it. The immediately evident must be raised to insight; the apodictic must be seen to be apodictic. [259]

The assertoric judgment has the problematic outside itself and precisely for that reason falls so easily forfeit to the problematic; the apodictic judgment, on the other hand, has through reflection the problematic within itself, has overcome it and masters it. That the apodictic is evident of itself shows that the problematic has been overcome; that what is evident in itself rests in reflection is seen from this, that the problematic, in order to be overcome, must be presupposed: insight depends upon the transparency of the problematic sublated in the apodictic.

Nor is it, then, dialectic alone that for the sake of grounding shakes the axioms and gives the immediate up as prey to reflection; an exact science such as mathematics does the same. For mathematics it can in several cases be doubtful whether a proposition is to be set up as an axiom, regarded as a definition, or proved as a theorem. The theorem and the axiom are both apodictic judgments; the difference is that the former is mediately, the latter immediately evident. But this difference thinking can sublimate; for the immediacy in the immediately evident is reflected, and the reflection in the mediately evident is, through the illumination itself, immediate.⁹⁴

In the apodictic judgment reflection has equalized the difference between subjective certainty and objective essentiality. The assertoric judgment is immediately [260]

⁹⁴In “Elementær Geometri” by C. Ramus, Kjøbenhavn 1850, the proposition about the straight line between two points is set up as an *axiom*. “An axiom (*axioma*)” — it is said on p. 7 — “presents a truth as immediately given, in that its necessity is evident in itself (e.g. only one line can be the shortest between two points)”. By this we are referred back to something preceding (p. 5), where it has already been said that the line which indicates the shortest distance between two points is the straight line. In “Elementær Plangeometrie” by L. Oppermann, Kjøbenhavn 1845, the definition of the straight line is on the other hand given by itself (p. 4), and the proposition: “The shortest line between two points is straight”, is then set up later on (p. 43) expressly as a *theorem* with a detailed proof.

subjective because it is immediately objective; the apodictic is reflectively objective because it is reflectively subjective. In what sense the logically apodictic rests upon the determinateness fixed by reflection is seen from judgments in which the knower reflects upon his own knowledge. In this way any judgment whatever can be determined by an apodictic judgment. The blackboard is *actually* black, therefore: the judgment about the color of a blackboard is *necessarily* assertoric. Chemical attraction is *perhaps* electrical, therefore: the judgment about the identity of electrical and chemical attraction is — at the present stage of science — *necessarily* problematic. The objective essentiality of knowledge is determined apodictically by knowledge itself: there is given, in formal reflection, an apodictic knowledge of the assertoric and the problematic just as well as of the apodictic. But the objectivity in the form of knowledge is one thing, the objective in the content of knowledge another. As concerns the content of knowledge, it is only the idea, the Absolute itself, that can give true apodictic certainty.

When it seems as though there were in the relations of the finite much about which apodictic certainty could be had without direct regard to the idea, it must here be noted that the apodictic in such cases is conditioned, and the conditioned in all reflections a reflex of its unconditioned. “The critical separation of the pure intuition without concept and the pure concept without intuition is in its essence untrue; concept and intuition are moments for one another reciprocally, their dialectical unity is their truth, in the idea they are one. The critical separation of the categories of quantity, [261] quality, relation and modality has its significance in the finite, but is, when it is a question of essence itself, idealess and untrue. To the critique’s finite separation there corresponds an equally finite connection; but the idea is as little a sum of finitely connected categories as it is a category of reason for itself, i.e. one existing over against the rest. The idea is, as idea, the inner principial totality of the categories, the truth in the categorical determinations. The critical separation of a thing in itself without properties and a phenomenon of properties without a thing in itself is idealess and untrue; the truth is that the thing is determined by its properties and the properties by the thing: the infinite reciprocal determination is grounded upon the idea. The critical separation of a subject for itself without object and an object for itself without

subject is, from the side of essence, the highest idealessness. To deny the identity of the subjective and the objective is to disown the idea and to make all cognition of truth impossible.”⁹⁵

As concerns the visible world, there is an essential difference between seeing things in the light and seeing the light as light; in the intellectual there is a still greater difference between seeing truth piecemeal in the true propositions and seeing the true propositions as moments in truth itself. The truth in every true proposition, in every apodictic judgment, is a glimmer of the light of the idea; just as no object can be seen in pure darkness, so neither can any truth be cognized in pure idealessness: everywhere in the evident, be it the immediately or the mediately evident, it is an illumination of the idea that is seen in insight. But dispersed among the many illuminations, distributed over the many apodictic judgments in their partly unconditioned immediacy, partly finite conditionedness, the rays of the idea’s light cannot yet gather themselves in the focus in which the idea illuminates itself; the relatively apodictic still lacks its Absolute.

In this connection the relation between mathematical and logical truths, between [262] the apodictic judgments of mathematics and those of logic, can be more closely illuminated. Singly and in their special connections the mathematical propositions bear a far stronger stamp of apodictic validity than the logical. The logical propositions find themselves, under the streaming movement, in undulating transitions. This undulating, this dialectical swinging and hovering, gives them, for the superficial observer, something wavering, something slippery and untrustworthy, which does not seem able to subsist together with the demand for apodictic certainty. It is otherwise in mathematics. The mathematical propositions do indeed also bear the mark of relativity, insofar as in their mutual connection they depend, the one upon the other; but in spite of this dependence and reciprocal conditionedness each proposition is nevertheless for itself so exactly determined, and gives singly so incontrovertible a certainty, that the apodictic thereby acquires a punctual omnipresence: it can literally be pointed out at every point. And yet one notices in mathematics nothing of the idea as idea; with what right, then, can it be said that every apodictic glimmer is a

⁹⁵Philos. Propæd. p. 181–82.

fulguration of the idea?

In the system of the apodictic judgments of mathematics the idea of knowledge is present from first to last; but that the idea, despite its apodictic presence, does not let itself be noticed as idea has apodictically its ground in the peculiarity of punctuality. The punctuality with which each single principal proposition is brought out and held fast for itself gives finitude, mediacy and conditionedness so decisive a preponderance that the inner infinity must keep itself hidden. Indeed, so foreign can the essence of infinity be to a mathematician's consciousness that he even conceives the concept of infinity as a sort of "*mixed concept*" and asserts that in mathematics there is no
 [263] problem of infinity at all.⁹⁶ In a logic of the ideas, on the other hand, the single propositions cannot come forward with any special apodictic independence, since every relative determination is a moment, a glimmer of the Absolute. But precisely this reflected form of the apodictic moments, a form transparent in reflection, makes the idea, the absolutely apodictic, visible.

The general principal forms of modality: possibility, actuality and necessity, recommend themselves by turns to sound sense in such a way that now finitude, now infinity, now the side of actuality, now the side of the idea is turned toward the observer. At the stage of finitude it holds that there must necessarily be something that is merely *possible*, something that is *actual*, and something that is *necessary*. Seen under the standpoint of infinity, the difference between possible, actual and necessary steps so
 [264] far into the background that the one of the forms involuntarily gains power over the

⁹⁶That thinking mathematicians, however much weight they may otherwise lay upon the satisfying results of the method of operation, have nevertheless never been able to get the concept that is inconceivable to their thought (the concept of infinity) separated in a satisfying manner from the method that rests upon this concept, is shown by the history of mathematics from Leibnitz and Newton (Cf. Mathem. og Dialekt. p. 90–91, p. 95 ff.) down to the present time. "In the first place, when the principle is unknown, we cannot indeed know whether all the consequences that follow from it may likewise be admitted: we go as though blindfold, and it might well happen that after laborious exertion we should at last stumble upon something which displayed precisely the nature of the principle, i.e. upon something we could not comprehend. In the second place: is it not a shameful degradation of reason to let it follow a connection of links, a series whose beginning and end it cannot see through?" These scruples of Savrien's sufficiently explain the unrest and tension in which the analysis of the infinite has constantly held mathematical reflection (Mathem. Dial. p. 55–56), whose problem — as a prize question set by the Berlin Academy in the year 1784 characteristically enough expresses it, "wie aus einer widersprechenden Voraussetzung so viele wahren Sätze haben können hergeleitet werden" — will not cease to return. Forelæsninger over "Phil. Propæd." fra Universitetsaaret 1860–61. p. 47–48.

two others, and now it is said: now that everything is possible, now that everything is actual, now that everything is necessary. If the emphasis falls upon becoming (Heraclitus), then everything is possible; if the emphasis falls upon being and that which is, then everything is actual (the Megarians); if the emphasis falls upon the essence of actuality reflected into itself, the infinite substance, then everything is necessary (Spinoza). In the logical sense necessity is overreaching, but the overreaching necessity is essentially subjective.

2) *The Antilogical-Apodictic: actual Necessity.* For the closer determination of the essential or subjective necessity it is necessary to determine the objective or actual; if the subjective necessity is logical, then the objective must be antilogical. But in insight necessity must be known by the apodictic; if there is an antilogical necessity, then there must be a certainty which is at one and the same time both apodictic and antilogical; there must, in other words, be an *insight into the antilogical*. All insight is essentially logical; an insight into the antilogical is then a hard contradiction: an antilogical apodictic must at first glance appear to the observer as a *contradictio in adjecto*.

The objective, antilogical necessity is hard, the hard necessity is immediate; but even in its hardest immediacy necessity is nevertheless essentially reflected and stands, through reflection, open to insight. It is precisely the objective necessity that with all its hardness steps mediatingly in between the logical and the antilogical, and makes an insight into the antilogical possible. The logical essentiality of necessity reflects itself in the universal; its hard immediacy is seen in the singular. If the gaze is fixed exclusively upon the singular, then necessity disappears; it is lost in a contingency. The contingent is because it is, has its ground in itself, or rather: it has no ground, because in all immediacy it is an existent ground and consequently groundless; in this contingency [265] resembles the hard necessity that is blind in its hardness. The immediately necessary is a contingent, the contingent is an immediately necessary: here the antilogical is seen. But precisely in that the hard immediacy antilogically repels reflection from itself, this repelling will essentially be an attraction. Subjectivity, which cannot reflect the contingent through, can nevertheless reflect upon it, and thus make it the object of a reflection.

As object of a reflection the contingent readily shows itself in its difference from and unity with the objectively necessary. That the contingent is in itself groundless then means that it has its ground outside itself; that it is because it is means that it is because an other is; that it is because an other is means that it, as an outward singular, stands over against another outward singular. It is otherwise with the necessary. That the necessary is because it is signifies that it is impossible for it to have its ground outside itself, since it has its conditions and therewith its sufficient ground in itself alone. Insofar as the necessary comes forward as the singular case, it reflects itself in the universal necessity; as a necessary it has in this reflection the universal, not outside itself, but in itself: the universal inherent in the necessary cases is power. All manifestations of immediate power are, in their immediate singularity, sheer cases, in their outward reciprocity contingent; but power itself, the universal reflected in the singular and yet in reflection immediate, is necessity, the *actual* necessity.

How the actual necessity, antilogical in the form of power, stands to insight can be seen from the apodictic judgment. Upon the antilogical foundation the apodictic judgment has so striking a likeness to the assertoric that in the singular cases it is even difficult to keep them apart. “This body is actually heavy”; “the body is [266] necessarily heavy”; in the first case attention is fixed upon the body in its immediate singularity, and the judgment must become assertoric; in the latter case attention is fixed upon the corporeal essence in the body, and the judgment must become apodictic, namely antilogical-apodictic. The assertoric judgment is determined by the object, the antilogical-apodictic by power. The object in its peculiarity is a word of power; but the object’s objective meaning, the powerful, universal thought, makes the power-word a word of knowledge.

The great Kantian question: “how are synthetic judgments *a priori* possible?” can in this connection be paralleled with the question: how are antilogical-apodictic judgments possible? That the synthetic judgments have a predominantly empirical, and thus antilogical and so far assertoric character is presupposed in the Kantian question; if the synthetic did not in the first instance come forward *a posteriori*, it could not be a problem to find it *a priori*. That the analytic and so far apodictic judgments are of an aprioric character is likewise presupposed. Kant asks precisely after the

synthetic, not after the analytic, because the analytic judgments, as Hume has already brought out, do not, on account of the formal essence of identity, enrich cognition.⁹⁷

With the Kantian opposition between analytic and synthetic judgments we further [267] parallel the opposition between apodictic and assertoric. The assertoric judgments are judgments of actuality, thus judgments of experience, thus synthetic; the apodictic judgments are judgments of necessity, thus judgments of reflection, thus analytic. But now it has shown itself in the doctrine of the form of judgment that the analytic judgment necessarily presupposes the synthetic, and conversely; thus in every judgment the aprioric must necessarily presuppose the empirical, and conversely. The judgment of actuality must, in order to be a judgment, reflect necessity, and the judgment of necessity, insofar as necessity is objective, actuality; in that the judgment of necessity reflects actuality, the analytic judgment becomes empirical, antilogical; in that the judgment of actuality reflects necessity, the synthetic judgment becomes [268] aprioric, logical. The relation between the empirical and the aprioric in our judgments of experience Kant determines in the following way: “all judgments of experience are empirical, but not all empirical judgments are on that account judgments of experience. Judgments such as: the room is warm; sugar is sweet, wormwood is bitter, are

⁹⁷ Analytische Urtheile (die bejahenden) sind also diejenigen, in welchen die Verknüpfung des Prädicats mit dem Subject durch Identität, diejenigen aber, in denen diese Verknüpfung ohne Identität gedacht wird, sollen synthetische Urtheile heißen ... *Erfahrungsurtheile*, als solche, sind insgesamt synthetisch. Denn es wäre ungereimt, ein analytisches Urtheil auf Erfahrung zu gründen, weil ich aus meinem Begriffe gar nicht hinausgehen darf, um das Urtheil abzufassen, und also kein Zeugniß der Erfahrung dazu nöthig habe. Daß ein Körper ausgedehnt sei, ist ein Satz, der *a priori* feststeht, und kein Erfahrungsurtheil. Denn, ehe ich zur Erfahrung gehe, habe ich alle Bedingungen zu meinem Urtheile schon in dem Begriffe, aus welchem ich das Prädicat nach dem Satze des Widerspruchs nur herausziehen und dadurch zugleich der Nothwendigkeit des Urtheils bewußt werden kann, welche mich Erfahrung nicht einmal lehren würde. Dagegen ob ich schon in dem Begriff eines Körpers überhaupt das Prädicat der Schwere gar nicht einschließe, so bezeichnet jener doch einen Gegenstand der Erfahrung durch einen Theil derselben, zu welchem ich also noch andere Theile eben derselben Erfahrung, als zu dem ersteren gehörten, hinzufügen kann. Ich kann den Begriff des Körpers vorher analytisch durch die Merkmale der Ausdehnung, der Undurchdringlichkeit, der Gestalt &c., die alle in diesem Begriffe gedacht werden, erkennen. Nun erweitere ich aber meine Erkenntniß, und, indem ich auf die Erfahrung zurücksehe, von welcher ich diesen Begriff des Körpers abgezogen hatte, so finde ich mit obigen Merkmalen auch die Schwere jederzeit verknüpft, und füge also diese als Prädicat zu jenem Begriffe synthetisch hinzu. Es ist also die Erfahrung, worauf sich die Möglichkeit der Synthesis des Prädicats der Schwere mit dem Begriffe des Körpers gründet, weil beide Begriffe, ob zwar einer nicht in dem anderen enthalten ist, dennoch als Theile eines Ganzen, nämlich der Erfahrung, die selbst eine synthetische Verbindung der Anschauungen ist, zu einander, wiewohl nur zufälliger Weise, gehören. Kritik der reinen Vernunft. Werke. Zweiter Band. Leipzig 1838. p. 42–44.

empirical; but as mere judgments of perception they have only subjective validity, and are for that reason not judgments of experience. The judgment of perception expresses only that two sense-sensations are united at a given time in me, the sensing subject." This is, as we have seen above, a conception of the assertoric judgment from the immediately subjective side. It stands otherwise with the judgment of experience. "What experience teaches me under certain circumstances, it must teach me and everyone at every time" ... "Therefore I utter all such judgments as objectively valid, as e.g. when I say: the air is elastic, then this judgment is in the first instance only a judgment of perception; I refer two sense-sensations to one another. If I will that it shall be called a judgment of experience, then I demand that the connection be placed under a condition which makes it universally valid." But in order that an immediate judgment of sense-perception may be able to become a judgment of experience, it is required that the sense-perception be subsumed under some "concept of the understanding" or other; "the air, e.g., falls under the concept of cause; this concept determines the judgment about the air with respect to expansion as hypothetical. Thereby this intuition is now represented, not merely as belonging to my sense-perception of the air in my state or to a state for others' sense-perception, but as *necessary*;" the judgment becomes universally valid, and thus a judgment of experience, through this, "that certain judgments, which subsume the intuition of the air under the concept of cause and effect, precede and thereby determine the sense-sensations, not merely respectively by one another in my subject, but on the whole with respect to the form of the judgment (here the hypothetical) and in this way make the empirical judgment universally valid".⁹⁸

From this it is seen that the Kantian judgment of experience falls between the assertoric-objective and the antilogical-apodictic: in its unity with the judgment of perception it expresses the assertoric, in its unity with the category of the understanding it expresses the apodictic. But in three points the deviation is discernible.

In the first place Kant must restrict the apodictic to the psychologically subjective, since the aprioric with him has only psychological-subjective validity. "We must", he says, "separate the empirical laws of nature, which always presuppose particular sense-

⁹⁸Cf. Kant's kleinere metaphysische Schriften. Werke. Dritter Band. Leipzig 1838. Prolegomena zu jeder künftigen Metaphysik. p. 215 ff.

perceptions, from the pure or universal laws of nature, which, without particular sense-perceptions lying at their ground, contain merely the conditions for their necessary union in experience, and in regard to the latter nature and *possible* experience are entirely and altogether the same, and since the lawfulness in the latter rests upon the necessary interconnection of the phenomena in an experience, without which we could not cognize any object whatever in the sense-world, and thus upon the original laws of the understanding, it does indeed sound somewhat strange at first, but is nonetheless certain, when I say with respect to the latter: *the understanding does not draw its laws (a priori) from nature, but prescribes them to it.*⁹⁹

In the second place the critique of reason mystifies the relation between “the things of sight (*Phænomena*)”, which make up “the sense-world”, and “the separate beings of the understanding (*Noumena*)”, which are supposed to make up “the world of the understanding”. For the critique inculcates in the most emphatic manner “that we do not at all know and cannot know anything determinate about these pure beings of the understanding, since our pure concepts of the understanding, as also our pure intuitions, go out only upon objects of a possible experience, and thus upon mere [270] beings of sense”. Since now “the beings of the understanding” are assumed to be indeterminable, every mediation between the universal categories and the individual objects, or, more exactly, between the universal in the categories and the individual in the objects, is lacking.

In the third place the Kantian critique is not in a position to state how the in-itself objective really stands to sense-perception and thinking; whether, e.g., it first individualizes and determines the sensible through the pure intuitions and thus fills out the forms of the understanding; or whether it perhaps first determines the forms of the understanding and through these the sense-impressions corresponding to the intuitions; or whether it at one stroke, and thus equally originally, fills out and determines both the forms of intuition and the categories. In the first case the unknown objective has the greatest affinity to the sensible, in the second case to the intellectual, in the third case it is equally akin to both.

The first deviation is removed in the following way. Reflected in the ontological

⁹⁹Prolegomena z. j. k. Metaphys. p. 240.

subjectivity, the aprioric has not merely subjective, but also objective validity, not merely validity in knowledge, but also validity in power. It is thus not the human understanding that prescribes laws to nature; it cognizes, on the contrary, in nature the objectively aprioric validity of the laws: to this cognition there corresponds the apodictic in the judgments of experience. Every judgment of experience can now be both assertoric and apodictic, according as the corresponding immediacy is *merely immediate* or *reflected*. Determined by the object in all immediacy, the judgment is assertoric, is from the subjective side what Kant calls a judgment of perception (ein Wahrnehmungsurtheil), and becomes, when reflection is set in movement, easily problematic. Determined, not by the object in its immediacy, but by the necessity [271] revealing itself in the object-relations, the judgment is apodictic. It is not the law as law that in the actual case expresses the necessity; for the law as law presupposes a liberated, hovering reflection in a determinate opposition to the singular case in which it is fulfilled. Such a reflection does not take place here; the necessity reflects itself in the case itself, and the case works upon the insight with striking immediacy. When the table tilts, and glasses and plates are on the point of falling, the mistress of the house raises the alarm: "Take care! it is going over, it absolutely must go over, if you do not" etc. Here we have an example of an antilogical-apodictic judgment. The alarmed mistress of the house involuntarily receives an impression of the conditioned necessity. She does not indeed yet see the destruction, for it has not actually taken place; but she does see it before her eyes, she sees it immediately and yet in reflection, for she discerns *the necessity*, "if not" ... In such an insight there does not fall first a glance at the general laws of nature, particularly at the law of falling, then a glance at the conditions obtaining, and finally an understanding that the law of falling will, in the case that threatens danger, be sorrowfully fulfilled: such a mediacy, so finite a parcelling-out, stands in ludicrous conflict with what is momentary in the insight. And yet, despite the immediate and the momentary, all the moments indicated by the parcelling-out are present in the reflection; for the reflection is *momentary*: it is the momentary reflection in which the insight sees the necessity.

If the momentary reflection is confused with immediate sense-perception, then the antilogical-apodictic judgment, the necessity-judgment about the singular actual case,

is confused with an assertoric judgment, an immediate actuality-judgment, and the confusion is in full swing. If there is no apodictic judgment about the singular actual case; if every actuality-judgment is without more ado assertoric: then necessity in its objectively actual presence is once and for all lost. We must then either, with Hume, [272] renounce all actual necessity, or, with Kant, let the human understanding prescribe its laws to nature.

The defect in “the particular beings of the understanding” now likewise lets itself be removed. What indeed are “the particular beings of the understanding” other than existence-categories, categorical substantiality-forms, objectively a priori power-concepts, whereby the thing in existential singularity shows itself as an individuation of its universal. Such expressions as carbon, nitrogen, boron, silicon and the like designate at one and the same time categories and existing materials. As categories the “particular beings of the understanding” are objectively a priori substantiality-forms (*Noumena*); as categorically determined materials they are existing substances, sight-things in material immediacy (*Phænomena*). The certainty that the substance carbon exists in manifold repetitions of actually existent carbon is antilogical-apodictic. The antilogical is determined by the immediate carbon-existence, and in this immediacy points to the assertoric; but the apodictic, which is determined by the carbon-substance, rests upon momentary reflection and secures the insight into the universally valid. Such judgments as: “Carbon occurs in pure state as diamond and as graphite, less pure as coal, anthracite” etc., are from the standpoint of chemistry antilogical-apodictic. The same holds of judgments that immediately concern the compounds of the materials. “With chlorine and fluorine boron forms gaseous compounds which fume strongly in the air; with nitrogen it forms a white, amorphous, fire-resistant body which phosphoresces strongly with a greenish light when it is heated in the air” etc. If such judgments were not *apodictic*, they would be without scientific worth; if the apodictic were not *antilogical*, they would not be actuality-judgments, hence not experience-judgments, not characteristic of an experience-science.

It lies in the nature of the case that an actuality-judgment which, in accordance with [273] the antilogical immediacy, is assertoric, must be able to become problematic; to that extent the experience-science does not give out its judgments about the singular “sight-

things” in the singular cases as infallible either. But however many correctives the judgments about the singular may undergo, the experience-science must nevertheless of necessity — hence apodictically — hold fast the universal validity of the ground on which the appraisal originally rests: *the assertoric judgments about the singular are individuations of apodictic judgments about the universal*. Though the judgments about the compounds of carbon, boron and chlorine in the singular cases, with the conditions determined in the singular, may be manifoldly corrected and altered, it is nevertheless apodictically certain that carbon is always carbon, boron boron and chlorine chlorine; that is to say: every one of the existing substances is, under all changes, like itself; the unchangeable actualizes itself in its changes, the universal is realized in the individual, the necessary reveals itself in the singular cases.

In this respect we can grant Kant his right when he insists that the pure concepts of the understanding have no significance, “wenn sie von Gegenständen der Erfahrung abgehen und auf Dinge an sich selbst (*Noumena*) bezogen werden wollen”;¹⁰⁰ but by thrusting out the *Noumena* he makes precisely the unity of the concepts of the understanding with the objects inexplicable. Concepts such as: carbon, nitrogen, boron, chlorine etc. cannot possibly pass for pure essentialities existing in themselves; so far is it from being the case that the particular substance-categories, Kant’s “beings of the understanding”, should have independent determinate being as “Dinge an sich” (*Noumena*) over against the existing materials, that the universal category in its separation from the particular ones is much rather itself a shadow. It is just the [274] particular that mediates the union of the universal with the individual. The unity-in-difference of the universal substance (the category) with the existing substance (the object) by means of the particular substance (“the being of the understanding”), the unity-in-difference of general substance with carbon-substance in carbon, of general substance with nitrogen-substance in nitrogen, of general substance with sulphur-substance in sulphur, etc., is a necessary unity, one antilogical-apodictic by its actual necessity. If, on the contrary, reflection holds fast the subjectively a priori concept of the understanding for itself, while sense-perception for itself is fettered by the existing material, and “the being of the understanding” (*Noumenon*), the particular

¹⁰⁰Prolegom. p. 232.

substance, is excluded as something in itself indeterminable, then actual necessity is misconstrued, and with it the antilogical-apodictic.

The third defect in Kant is only a modification of the two foregoing; its removal must therefore be regarded as a closer illumination of the correctives already applied. The necessary unity of the a priori and the empirical, the universal and the individual, the intellectual and the sensuous is, categorically determined, a power-unity, and only as such an actual necessity-unity. The categorical judgment here expresses the equilibrium between the sensuous and the intellectual; this (a sensuous) is carbon (a substance-category). Now while the assertoric judgment lays immediate stress on the sensuous, without giving up the intellectual, the apodictic judgment lays a decisive stress on the intellectual, without however, as antilogical-apodictic, giving up the sensuous. Seen in the light of both judgments, the existence in question is a word of power, with its actual necessity an element in the categorical power-language. In the actual necessity, the necessity for the momentary reflection in the striking case, the intellectual is a sensuous, the sensuous an intellectual.

It is a great error, an error which does not indeed directly, but nevertheless indirectly, stem from the abstractions of formal logic, that what is necessary in actuality should let itself be found out by induction and analogy, hence by a comparative consideration of several singular cases, although each singular case yielded only an assertoric certainty. In this way a certain number of assertoric judgments should then at last be able to lead to an apodictic one; how thoughtless! Actual necessity is in the judgment determined by an original insight into the actual itself; the actual itself is, in antilogical immediacy, the actual case: the apodictic certainty is in actuality just as original as the assertoric. The reflection by which the judging subjectivity immediately discerns the necessity in the actual case is a *momentary* one; from the momentary reflection, determined by the essence-impression that is immediate in actuality, the antilogical-apodictic has its origin.¹⁰¹ [275]

3) *The Rational-Apodictic: absolute Necessity.* As the necessity is, so is the insight; as the insight into the necessary is, so is the certainty; as the certainty is, so is the apodictic. The essential necessity, the reflection-necessity, is logically objective and

¹⁰¹How induction and analogy unfold their significance on the ground herewith given will have to be shown in a later connection.

to that extent ontologically subjective; the actual necessity, the impression-necessity, is objective, factual and to that extent antilogical: the unity of the essential and the actual necessity must therefore be a unity which has in itself the logical and masters the antilogical; this unity presenting the absolute necessity is the *rational* one.

“The rational” is indeed not seldom apprehended so one-sidedly that it thereby acquires now “the Irrational”, now “the Suprarational”, now “the Extrarational” as [276] its opposite; but for the idea of science these oppositions are all vanishing, for the idea of science is absolutely rational. Hegel’s words: “the actual is the rational”, have often enough been misunderstood, and the misunderstanding again and again refuted. That the actual is rational by no means says that every fragment of actuality, every singular state, event or action should directly satisfy reason. On the contrary! There is in finitude, with its parcellings-out and distortions, infinitely much that immediately stands in conflict with reason’s eternal demand; but mediately the finite, in all its conflict and confusion, belongs of course to the actual development of reason’s content. What immediately conflicts with reason must mediately serve its purpose: reason is not merely in the idea the infinite wisdom, but in actuality the overreaching power by which the idea subjects all conditions to itself.

In what sense the absolute necessity is the form for reason’s content is seen from the way in which everything, all differences, all oppositions and contradictions enter into the necessity. Thus the impossible in the formal sense is a necessary just as well as the possible. For if there were no boundary between possible and impossible, if everything were equally possible and just for that reason equally impossible, then there would be no necessity; but if the boundary is necessary, then the impossible is — for the boundary’s sake — just as necessary as the possible. The unessential is a necessary just as well as the essential. For if there were no difference between the essential and the unessential, if everything were equally essential and precisely on that ground equally unessential, then there would be no necessity; but if the difference is necessary, then the unessential is, if for nothing else, then for the difference’s sake, necessary. What is necessary must also be essential: the unessential is thus with necessity essential. In this way one could go on to infinity.

[277] The interplay of forms under which necessity confirms and again dissolves every

relative determination has in actuality not merely formal but also real validity. There must in the actual itself be something unessential, in order that the essential may be. Insofar as the unessential in this way becomes essential, it does indeed seem as if the actual boundary between essential and unessential were effaced; but this is only an illusion. The necessity that gives the unessential an essential significance, the same necessity demands that the unessential shall acquire significance precisely as an unessential. Still more sharply, and in a more existential way, the necessary opposition between the necessary itself and the contingent comes forward. It is e.g. impossible to drink *a* wine without drinking *this* wine. But why just this one? It might just as well be either this or this ... or this! Which "*This*" one chooses is, insofar as it merely comes to choosing a wine, altogether indifferent: a "*This*", just a "*This*", is thus contingent. But whichever one chooses, it is nevertheless altogether unavoidable that one comes to choose a "*This*"; a "*This*", just a "*This*", is thus necessary. The insight that the contingent is not necessary is rational only in union with the insight that the contingent is nevertheless necessary. That the contingent is necessary does not then say that the opposition of necessary and contingent is to be given up, but on the contrary that it is to be maintained. In this way every relative determination has its determinate validity, i.e. its necessity: in the totality of the relatively necessary moments the absolute necessity consists; the absolute necessity is the form for the infinite reason.

Should anyone now ask whether one must not then, for reason's sake, demand something irrational in the same way as one must, for the essential's sake, demand something unessential, or for the necessary's sake something unnecessary: then the answer does not lie far off. There must indeed be a difference, an essential difference, [278] between rational and irrational, just as between necessary and unnecessary; but just as the difference by which the unnecessary itself becomes necessary falls under the absolute necessity, so too the necessity with which the irrational — however much it conflicts with the rational — announces itself falls under the absolute reason. Seen in the idea, the absolute reason can as little have anything irrational against it as the absolute necessity can have anything unnecessary outside it. Nor can it do, on the standpoint of the idea, to give the rational an opposite in the antirational in a manner

corresponding to that in which the antilogical is set against the logical.

The opposition of the logical and the antilogical means that the logical, however much it shows itself to reflection as an infinitely overreaching, is nevertheless in its essence one-sided, just as pure knowledge is a one-sidedness over against power. It is otherwise with the rational; here knowledge is in unity with power, for power is in its essence just as rational as knowledge.¹⁰² The infinite reason determines the logical by the antilogical, and conversely. The certainty of the validity of the idea, i.e. of the absolute reason, is rational-apodictic. Since now the antilogical has its rational validity just as well as the logical, actuality too in its difference from possibility and necessity, possibility in its difference from necessity and actuality, necessity in its difference from possibility and actuality, has rational-apodictic validity in the infinite kingdom of reason. The assertoric judgments can in the idea as little be transformed into apodictic ones as the problematic can; but all three kinds of [279] judgment hold with relative necessity; for the perfect knowledge the validity of them all is rational-apodictic.

In order to discern how it is possible that systems of assertoric, problematic and apodictic judgments can have validity not merely outwardly in the objectification of the finite, but also inwardly in subjectivity's self-objectification, we must above all remember that the ontological self-objectification, which everywhere rests upon an objectification of other, is not empty, but infinitely rich in content. The content is reason itself, the idea's absolute content. Reflected in modality's three forms, the idea, and with it subjectivity, will then assume the following fundamentally different shapes. In relation to actuality, hence in the system of the assertoric judgments, subjectivity is intuiting, and the idea in actuality's form an idea of the phenomenon. In relation to possibility, hence in the system of the problematic judgments, subjectivity is self-determining, and the idea of the predetermined possibilities a purpose-idea. In relation to necessity subjectivity is thinking, comprehending, and the idea in necessity's form a universally valid essence-idea. Since the idea is under all three shapes identical with itself, it is a matter of course that modality's three forms must presuppose one another in such a way that the one, by its determinate appearance, always reflects the two

¹⁰²Only on the standpoint of faith, hence in a sphere that falls outside science, can there be talk of the antirational; the antirational then becomes the distinguishing mark of the paradoxical.

others.

As regards the idea of the phenomenon, an immediate separation between the phenomenon and the idea is presupposed in actuality. Here, in the actual world, there must be able to be phenomena which fall contingently outside the idea, as distinguished from phenomena in which the idea immediately lets itself be seen. Precisely by the fact that the idea-phenomenon in its ideal transparency steps into opposition to the actuality-phenomenon that in its contingency is idea-less, there forms itself an assertoric judgment about the beautiful, corresponding to the idea-phenomenon, hence to an ideal form: “this is actually beautiful”, and an assertoric judgment about the unbeautiful, corresponding to the idea-less phenomenon that [280] conflicts with the ideal form: “this is actually unbeautiful”. The conflict between the idea-phenomenon and the idea-less actuality-phenomenon is equalized in possibility: both phenomena can be altered in countless ways, and as the idea, which by means of the possibilities masters, fulfils and penetrates the idea-less actuality-phenomena to infinity, it satisfies the subjectivity that intuits itself in all and all in itself. If the judgment about the beautiful and the unbeautiful is, on account of the phenomenon’s immediacy, assertoric, then the judgment about beauty itself, i.e. the judgment by which the judgment about the difference, the essential difference, between beautiful and unbeautiful is originally fixed, is on the contrary apodictic, rational-apodictic.

As regards the purpose-idea, the idea of the determinate possibilities, it is self-evident that the all-capable subjectivity, by means of its power over otherness, hence over immediate actuality, must live in an infinite system of possibilities. But an infinite system of possibilities is only thinkable in an infinite system of problematic judgments. “God is this, that all things are possible”; that means here: for the absolute self nothing finite stands fast; all things are seen in infinite becoming, in transitions, in possibilities. Through the infinite system of the possibilities the divine subjectivity asserts its infinite self-determining by a particular determining of other: it transforms the actual into conditions and posits the possibility determined by the anticipation as purpose. The rational purpose can thus be realized on account of the possibilities; but it can in actuality also be partially disturbed, distorted and hindered on account of the possibilities. The judgment about the attainment of the purpose, of the good, is

in finitude conditioned and problematic; but in the idea itself rational-apodictic. Just as the assertoric judgments on actuality's ground are individuations of the apodictic [281] that corresponds to the necessity of the phenomenal idea, so too are the problematic judgments on possibility's ground specifications of the apodictic that in divine insight corresponds to the necessity of the purpose-idea.

As regards finally the essence-idea, the universal necessity-idea, the thinking subjectivity, comprehending all in the unity of knowledge and power, will objectify to itself all, the possible as well as the actual, the eternal as well as the temporal, the inner and ideal as well as the outer and real, in the word, by the word, as the word. The only thing absolutely necessary for the absolute reason's self-revelation is the word; in the word all is brought forth, by the word all is determined: the universal necessity-idea is the idea of the word. What then is the object of the judgment? A word of power! And the judgment itself? A word of knowledge! And the judgment's validity? A word of actuality, of possibility and of necessity! Or how should the identity of the judgment and the judgment's object, and therewith the truth, be able to become evident, if the object, despite its actual opposition to the judgment, were not in the word itself essentially one with the judgment. In the word as the word of power the intuiting subjectivity, with all power-actions and judgments, enters upon the objective, antilogically ruling actuality-necessity; in the word as the word of knowledge the thinking subjectivity goes, through all actual oppositions, into the logically-objective, ontologically-subjective essence-necessity; in the reflected unity of the word of power and the word of knowledge the all-comprehending subjectivity enters upon the absolute necessity, a system of rationally-apodictic judgments in which all has its relative truth because all has its relative necessity.

The judgment in and for itself is not the truth, for in the truth knowledge must presuppose power; the object in and for itself is not the truth, for in the truth power must presuppose knowledge. If now the word in the judgment for itself is a word of [282] knowledge, and the word in the object for itself a word of power, how then is the unity of this word, doubled in itself and by the doubling originally opposed to itself, to be more closely determined?

b) Functions of the Syllogism: Modal Functions.

If one lets the judgment about an object sink down to simple representation, and determines the representation not by a word but immediately by the object's image, then one should at first glance suppose that the agreement between representation and object would in this way be secured, and the agreement thus secured the best guarantee for the judgment's truth. But that a criterion of truth does not let itself be set up on these terms, the ancient Skeptics have, particularly by their objections to the Stoics' *φαντασία καταληπτική*,¹⁰³ sufficiently shown. The discussions that Sextus Empirikus has preserved for us concerning this point are in a high degree characteristic. "There is", it is said, "no representation grasping the object so peculiar that it may not derive from another object than the one to which it is just in a given case referred; this, besides the Skeptics, even the Academics, and then chiefly Arkesilaus and Karneades, have striven from many sides to establish. The assent (*συγκατάθεσις*), which the Stoics call apprehension (*κατάληψις*) and grasping representation (*φαντασία καταληπτική*), is, according to Arkesilaus, only an empty word; for such an assent, if it is given, must [283] either be given by the wise man or by the fool. But if it is given by the wise man, it is a knowledge (*ἐπιστήμη*), and if it is given by the fool, it is only an opinion (*δόξα*). If the assent we bestow on the grasping representation is to be the apprehension, then this is nowhere at home; for in the first place it is not the representation but the thought on which we bestow our assent; in the second place there is no representation so true that it could not also be false".¹⁰⁴ To distinguish the true representation from the false is not possible; for to wish to undertake such a distinction by saying with the Stoics: the true or grasping representation derives from an existing object, the false or non-grasping from a non-existing one, is in vain, since there are delusions which in clarity and vividness are not inferior to the true representations corresponding to actuality. "In his frenzy Herkules took his own children for Eurystheus's, and acted in consequence of this delusion of his, i.e. in the delusion he killed his enemy's children,

¹⁰³The definition of this otherwise somewhat ambiguous category is given in Sextus (*Adversus Logicos* I. § 402.) in the following terms: ἤν γὰρ καταληπτικὴ φαντασία ἢ ἀπὸ ὑπάρχοντος, καὶ κατ' αὐτὸ τὸ ὑπάρχον ἐναπομεγαμμένη καὶ ἐναπесφραγισμένη, ὅποια οὐκ ἂν γένοιτο ἀπὸ μὴ ὑπαρχοντος, that is: the representation which has its origin from the existing thing, and in perfect agreement with this is so impressed and imprinted in the soul that it cannot possibly derive from a non-existing thing. For brevity's sake we here use the designation: the grasping representation.

¹⁰⁴*Sext. Empirici Opera ed. Fabricius. Lipsiæ. Anno MDCCXVIII. Adversus Logicos. I. § 143–54.*

but in actuality his own".¹⁰⁵

But even if one starts from the presupposition that the representation in question has its origin from an actual object, it will nevertheless, the Skeptic assumes — and that from his standpoint, so long as reflection is here directed merely upon a finite comparison between representation and object, with perfect right — be impossible to point out a representation that should give so distinct an image of its object that by this image one would be in a position to distinguish the object from all others. For the forms can be quite alike, and the objects themselves nevertheless different. "I give", says Carneades, choosing the example of two eggs that are quite alike one another, [284] "the Stoic leave to try it alternately, now with the one egg and now with the other, how far the wise man, when he sees them, will be in a position to say which is which".¹⁰⁶

If one attempts to evade the difficulty by such evasions as that it is after all not a matter of stating universal determinations which should contain distinguishing marks for every singular case, that objects which are so alike one another that they cannot be distinguished in the representation itself by no means thereby lose the character of being actual, etc.: then the Skeptic makes with great ease a leap from the immediately singular to the abstractly universal; for his skill is, as we have earlier seen, to leap from extreme to extreme in such a way that he constantly leaps over the connecting middle term. If the difficulty in the extreme of the singular was that the Dogmatist with his "grasping representation" could not distinguish the one egg from the other, the difficulty in the extreme of the universal now becomes that his "grasping representation" can only be determined by the object which itself must be determined by the representation.

With respect to the universal in the reciprocal relation of representation and object, the Academic's objection runs that the Stoics make themselves guilty of a diallelus. "When, namely, we ask what a grasping representation is, they say: such a one as derives from an existing object, agrees with this, is stamped and imprinted in the soul, and of such a constitution that it cannot derive from a non-existing object."¹⁰⁷ But since now every determination must start from what is known, and we therefore ask further:

¹⁰⁵ *Adversus Logicos. I. § 406.*

¹⁰⁶ *Adversus Logicos. I. § 409.*

¹⁰⁷ *Adversus Logicos. I. § 426–29.*

what is the existent? they return to the first determination and say: existent is that which calls forth a grasping representation. Thus the determination of the grasping representation points back to the determination of the existent, and this again to the former; we thus obtain from neither the object-representation nor the object any distinct concept. How far the represented object has a merely apparent or both an apparent and an actual validity cannot therefore be decided by any representation whatever; if objects are to be appraised according to the non-grasping representation, then this must — what the Dogmatists themselves will not concede — be able to appraise the true. To take the grasping representation for the something *according to which* the true is to be appraised is ridiculous; for since a determinate distinguishing mark for the grasping representation is precisely what is sought, there must, for every representation that is set up as grasping, constantly be required a new representation for the confirmation of the first, and so on to infinity”.¹⁰⁸ [285]

To remove these difficulties is impossible so long as the standpoint is chosen exclusively in the finite; but in order that the infinite may come along, the representation must be determined by the judgment, and the opposition of judgment and object cleared up in the word. This is the train of thought we have followed in the doctrine of the judgment-functions. It begins with the nature-powerful thinking forming and shaping language, so that in the developed language-forms it can know and recognize itself. In the course of this development the subjectivity working with language and thoughts has not merely objectified to itself an actual outer world, but, since language presupposes and conditions an inner ideal objectification, an inward world as well, a world of essential content.

The essential thought-content articulated by language is in principle just as originally objective as subjective; the identity of the subjective and objective content is in the essence itself *the idea*, but in the form’s immediacy *the word*: the language- and thought-forming functions have in this way become idea-forming. That the idea-forming functions, from their peculiar point of departure begin with an immediacy as much a force of nature as the language-forming ones do, is seen from the formation of myth. The essential content of mythology exhibits moments of logical originality, [286]

¹⁰⁸Cf. E. F. Nielsen. *Den antike Skepticisme*. p. 91–97.

determinations of form in which an eternal reason has found itself mirrored; we have seen the ideal results to which the sublation of the mythical stage of consciousness can lead with inner consequence. True, the Gnostic idea-functions could not, by an ingenious union of imagining and thinking, give the absolute any adequate form; true, the theosophical functions, which let thought grasp the absolute absolutely only by slipping under it the form of imagination and making the form formless, had to lose themselves in the mystical; but at these transitional stages it nevertheless showed itself ever more clearly what it means that thought grasps the idea by the word. The mythical gods, the Gnostic aeons, the theosophical essentialities are different idea-revelations, which are determined by thought through the word, and which live and grow in the word. Clarified into concept, the idea then also reveals itself at last as the divine essence of the word, and the word as the eternal shape of the idea.

The identity of word and idea is at the same time an identity of judgment and content; the judgment absolutely is the word, the content absolutely is the idea. But the identity was grasped only from the side of form; its universal essentiality is as yet without actuality. From the standpoint of actuality, then, one could not begin with a further development of judgment and content; one had to begin with the sharp opposition of judgment and object. When the object is set up independently over against the judgment, one might almost fear that the object existing in outward contingency would withdraw from every determinate and reliable apprehension, so that the old quackeries with *φαντασία καταληπτική* would have to return. This awkwardness is removed by the fact that the judging subjectivity, in an overreaching manner, lets the judgment itself be determinative for the relation of judgment and object. The

[287] most immediate independence that can be granted to the object is recognizable in this, that it is the object which is assumed to determine the judgment; the consequence of this assumption is that everything dissolves, both the thought-determinations in the judgment and the reality-determinations in the object. If, then, it cannot be the object that determines the judgment, the question arises whether it is not perhaps, conversely, the judgment that determines the object. On this assumption the thought-determinations do indeed come into force, but so overreaching is the power of ideality that the object succumbs, is dissolved into concept and transformed into the content

of the judgment. The object's immediate independence over against the judgment has thus in a double way shown itself to be a lack of independence: if without concept it is to rest upon itself, it becomes a loose aggregate of properties without substance, crumbles away into contingencies and collapses; if in virtue of the concept it is to rest upon thought, and thus upon the judgment, it is transformed into a phantom and vanishes like vapour.

If the object is to remain in force, there must be an ideal power in the judgment; the ideal power in the judgment as logical judgment presupposes a real power in the acting that corresponds to the judgment, for originally knowledge presupposes power, and power knowledge. The object in its immediacy is not concept, but its existence has its ground in the concept; without ground no existence, without concept no object: as the ground is, so must the existence be; as the concept is, so must the object be. The object must thus have ideal determinate being in its concept in order to acquire actual existence in existence: the object must be anticipated; in the anticipation the judgment reaches out beyond the object, just as subjectivity reaches out beyond the objective. That the object comes to be on objective conditions by no means signifies that it is torn loose from the concept or arises alongside the concept through the co-operation of thing-causes; no, on the contrary! The realization of the object is precisely the realization of the concept: it is again the judgment that is overreaching; it is in virtue [288] of the antilogical judgment that the object is realized. In the antilogical judgment thought is power, in the logical power is thought; and since the expression of thought is originally the word, and the word is articulated in the proposition, the object comes to be essentially through a thought-proposition, actually through a power-proposition.

As a power-proposition reflected in a thought-proposition the object, seen in the light of the concept, is more than an immediate thing; in essence it is an objective judgment, a word, a word of power: judgment and object stand to one another as the word of knowledge and the word of power. In this unity-relation the opposition is preserved; for object stands over against judgment as power over against knowledge. But in the opposition the unity too is preserved; for the object is a power-proposition, just as the judgment is a thought-proposition. The real thought that is in the power-proposition corresponds in principle to the ideal power that is in the thought-proposition; thus

to infinity the object is determined by the judgment, and the judgment again by the object. Judgment and object are one in the word, since they are one in the idea.

The unity of judgment and object is a unity-in-opposition; from this unity-in-opposition the power of modality shines forth. The categories actuality, possibility and necessity point not merely to three different sides of existence, but they show at the same time, when we look more closely, that these three sides are three totalities, so that the standpoints alternate with the three judgments: everything (namely everything existent) is *actual*, *everything is possible*, *everything is necessary*. The three totalities thus form three different spheres, on account of modality; but the three different spheres are nonetheless side-determinations of one and the same existence, on account of modality: judgment and object thus enter into three different relations on account of modality. By this retrospect we shall illuminate the modality-relations somewhat more closely.

[289] At the stage of actuality the object stands, although essentially itself an objective judgment, in immediate independence over against the subjective judgment; the judgment immediately determined by the object is assertoric. If actuality so excluded possibility that the latter arose only within subjectivity and obtained a subjectively infinite play over against the former, then the whole of logic would fall prey to skepticism, and the old game with *φαντασία καταληπτική* would repeat itself in new turns. But now possibility, by virtue of modality, has objective being just as much as actuality: “everything is possible” — this is not an abstract subjective judgment that has excluded objectivity, but subjectivity’s original judgment about everything objective. What is already determined does not, insofar as it is determined, admit of further determination: only what is still undetermined can be determined. If it now stands fast, as was shown above, that no determination of existence is thinkable without a corresponding determination of concept, no determination of the object without a determining thought; if it stands fast that the ground of everything objective must in principle be determined subjectively and can be determined subjectively only insofar as the objective is still problematic, then the overreaching subjectivity must know the origin of all finite determinateness as problematic: “*everything is possible*”; the problematic judgment is not merely human, but divine.

In the problematic judgment the object is dissolved; it has gone under in indeterminateness, been buried in uncertainty; the problematic judgment does indeed have a content, but no object.¹⁰⁹ If the judgment in the original sense is to have both object and content, an object corresponding to the determinate content, a content corresponding to the determinate object; if, in other words, the unity-in-opposition [290] of judgment and object is to attain completed determinateness, then modality itself must be completed in necessity, and the apodictic judgment become the overreaching one. In virtue of necessity the identity of the judgment's content and object is determined in two essentially different ways: the identity is posited in the *content*, and to this corresponds the logically apodictic; the identity is posited in the *object*, and to this corresponds the apodictic in antilogical form. Both ways yield, with all their opposition, two sides of the same. From the antilogical side necessity is hidden in actuality, and still more determinately, in contingency. If anyone will maintain that necessity, by coinciding with contingency, must either make the contingent necessary, and thus sublate contingency, or make the necessary contingent, and so, which is self-contradictory, abolish itself: then he could surely profit by considering whether the judgment "the contingent is necessary" does not assert the significance of contingency just as fully as the judgment "the necessary is contingent" asserts the significance of necessity.

If necessity is present everywhere, in all cases and in contingent phenomena, without however — as the judgment "the contingent is necessary" forbids — transforming the contingent into semblance: then necessity, by yielding to the case, respecting actuality and itself assuming all the shapes of contingency, has precisely drawn everything contingent under itself, and has thereby proved its infinite superior power.

As the actual now stands to the necessary, so the assertoric judgment stands to the apodictic. If anyone will deprive the assertoric judgment of its peculiar validity and transform it into a reflex of the apodictic, then necessity protests; if anyone will make the assertoric judgment absolutely independent of the apodictic, then he precisely cognizes the necessary in its peculiar character, baptizes it, so to speak, with the

¹⁰⁹That at the standpoint of finitude a problematic judgment can be passed upon an object determinate in itself follows from this, that here, besides the judgment, there is a representation present which places the object itself outside the judgment.

[291] baptism of necessity, and in this way lets the apodictic vouch for the assertoric.

As for the opposition of the problematic and the apodictic judgment, it is at once evident that it coincides with the opposition of possibility and necessity. Since possibility as possibility has its necessity, possibility is itself a latent necessity, and from this it follows that in the problematic judgment there is an apodictic moment, and that this apodictic moment, far from annihilating the problematic, on the contrary vindicates for it an ontological right, a validity divine in the idea. The judgment offensive at first glance, *everything is necessary*, can thus be cognized as the logically overreaching one, and the apodictic knowledge corresponding to necessity be held fast as the ideal of logic, without the influence that necessarily belongs to the assertoric and the problematic suffering in the least thereby.

If the articulating reciprocal determination of assertoric, problematic and apodictic is fully acknowledged in the determination of judgment and object, then it is seen from this as well what the identity of the judgment's content with the judgment's object, seen from the standpoint of necessity, originally signifies. In virtue of necessity the judgment's object is identical with its content; for the apodictic judgment is in its essence logical, and every determination of the object is, in the logically apodictic judgment, transformed into a thought-determination and thereby into a determination of content. But in virtue of necessity the judgment's content is then also identical with its object; for the apodictic judgment is in actuality antilogical, indeed in the phenomenon assertoric, and every determination of content a reflex of a corresponding determination of the object.

It is in consequence of the overreaching necessity with its reciprocal determinations of logical and antilogical that the all-capable subjectivity transforms, by [292] categorical power-language, a world of actual objects into a world of objective judgments. How the concept thing stands to the concept property is determined by a thought-proposition, thus by a *subjective* judgment; the relation between the existing thing and the existential properties, on the other hand, is originally determined by a power-proposition, a practical-antilogical proposition, thus by an *objective* judgment.

The investigation of the relation between judgment and object has thus, with inner consequence, transformed itself into an investigation of the relation between judgment

and judgment. This investigation proceeds in three directions; for what matters now is: partly to determine the relation between judgment and judgment in the subjective sense, and thus to gain insight into the connection of the subjective judgments; partly to determine the relation between judgment and judgment in the objective sense, and thus to gain insight into the connection of the objective judgments; and finally to determine the relation between judgment and judgment in the subjective-objective sense, and thus to gain insight into the judgments' original connection in the idea.

To determine the relation between judgment and judgment is, so far as the connection is concerned, to determine which judgment is the original one and which the derived, that is, in other words, to derive judgment from judgment, and thus to *syllogize*: all syllogistic functions are in the logical sense connection-functions. That the category of connection forms the foundation is immediately discerned from this, that the same judgment can, without anything being altered either in form or in content, occur both as premise and as conclusion; the difference between premise and conclusion is decided by the connection. From this the relation between modality and connection is seen as well; if the judgment is premise in one connection and conclusion in another, then it is apprehended in the first connection in a different way from the last; as connection-functions the functions of the syllogism are categorically determined modal functions. Since everything here depends on the connection, everything at the same time depends on the mode, and thus on the mode of connection; for [293] the mode determines the connection and the connection again the mode.

In the categorical peculiarity of the modal functions lies the ground of their division. To the subjective syllogism, the determination of the mode of dependence of the subjective judgments, there correspond functions of subjective connection, *modal functions of knowledge*; to the objective syllogism, the determination of the mode of dependence of the objective judgments, there correspond functions of objective connection, *modal functions of power*. To the idea-syllogism, the determination of the mutual dependence of the subjective-objective judgments in reflection of the absolute itself, there correspond functions of subjective-objective connection, *modal functions of truth*.

α) Subjective Syllogism: Modal Functions of Knowledge.

For a survey of the inner connections and separate modes of dependence of the subjective judgments it is necessary from the outset to give oneself an account of the point of departure, the goal and the method. The point of departure, or more precisely the central point, the point about which the whole development turns, is subjectivity itself, the thinking, judging consciousness. The goal, the fundamental task to whose solution the modal functions co-operate in their various alterations, is an articulation of the content of the knowing subjectivity. Since the content, apprehended as thought-content, consists in a manifold of judgments, the knower can agree with himself and possess the riches of his content in full transparency only insofar as the manifold judgments are connected immediately or mediately into unity, or at least insofar as they show themselves mutually consistent through the peculiar mode of connection. With the task thus determined, the procedure, the logical method, is at the same time indicated. Since the mode of connection and of dependence is known from the syllogism, the subjective syllogism will naturally assume a different [294] form according as the mode of dependence is determined partially by the connection between two, between three, between several, or totally by the connection between all judgments. If the mode of dependence is determined by the connection between two judgments alone, the syllogism is *immediate*; if it is determined particularly by the connection between three or more judgments, the syllogism is *mediate*; if it is determined finally by the original connection, which transforms the judgments separated in representation and immediately set up for intuition into moments in an all-sided system totalized by the transparent unity of the mediate and the immediate, the syllogism is *immanent*. The transition from the immediate syllogism through the mediate to the immanence-syllogism exhibits, as we shall see, a progressive movement conditioned by the corresponding alterations of the modal functions.

αα) Immediate Syllogism: analytic Modal Functions. Just as one can in a one-sided and arbitrary manner restrict the logical judgment to the schema “the singular is (is subsumed under) the general,” so too one can in a no less one-sided and arbitrary manner dictate to oneself a schema according to which every logical syllogism must always require a separation of two extremes and a middle. When such a schema is to hold as the only canonical one, it is undeniably a matter of course that in logic there

can no longer be any talk of “immediate syllogisms.” Hegel, who with a view to this schema lets the judgment develop of itself into syllogism, so that the two extremes correspond to subject and predicate as the middle does to the copula,¹¹⁰ has to such a degree overlooked the old doctrine of “immediate syllogisms” that he has not even [295] been willing to waste a word on getting it dismissed.

Nonetheless the doctrine of the immediate syllogisms is, when we look more closely, just as indispensable in logic as the doctrine of the mediate, and that for the good reason that the latter first acquire their significance through the former. If we begin with the mediate syllogism “all men are mortal; Cajus is a man; thus Cajus is mortal,” it is easily seen that the syllogistic function cannot restrict itself to determining the conclusum “Cajus is mortal” after the two premises have been set up beforehand. By degrading the function to so formal and mechanical an act one misapprehends the logical significance of the syllogism. The logical in the syllogism first unfolds itself when the union of the subject and predicate of the consequent proposition is expressly posited as a task, when it has in other words been brought to consciousness that a proposition given in a determinate case has validity only insofar as it admits of being presented as a consequent proposition corresponding to determinate presuppositions. From this standpoint the mediate syllogism will on all sides demand and presuppose the immediate. The proposition “Cajus is mortal” is to be determined as a consequent proposition, *thus* it must have premises; the proposition “all men are mortal” is the one premise; *thus* the proposition “Cajus is a man,” must be the other; conversely! The proposition “Cajus is a man” is the one premise, *thus* the proposition “all men are mortal,” must be the other. These are nothing but immediate syllogisms; but if a single one of these immediate syllogisms fell away, what would then become of the mediate one? Let one analyse whatever mediate syllo gism one will: provided [296] only that one does not forget what and how much originally belongs to the syllogistic function, it will surely show itself that the mediate in every syllogism presupposes

¹¹⁰“Der Schluß hat sich als die Wiederherstellung des *Begriffes* im *Urtheile*, und somit als die Einheit und Wahrheit beider ergeben. Der Begriff als solcher hält seine Momente in der Einheit aufgehoben; im Urtheil ist diese Einheit ein Innerliches, oder was dasselbe ist, ein Aeüßerliches, und die Momente sind zwar bezogen, aber sie sind als *selbstständige Extreme* gesetzt. Im *Schlusse* sind die Begriffsbestimmungen wie die Extreme des Urtheils, zugleich ist die bestimmte *Einheit* derselben gesetzt.” Hegel. Die subjektive Logik. p. 118.

the immediate.¹¹¹

That the discoverer of the immanent method has had no eye for the pervasive significance of the immediate syllogism is remarkable enough, since he otherwise has so sharp an eye for mediating transitional forms; this circumstance, however, is by no means without a characteristic influence on the method itself. If Hegel had not regarded such logical movements as that from being and nothing through becoming to determinate being, from determinate being and existence through something and other to one (being-for-self), etc., as so objective that they could be carried out by the concept itself, without a comprehending subjectivity, then he would have seen from the outset that these movements in actuality took place by judgment following [297] upon judgment in unbroken connection; but a series of development in which the one judgment follows continuously upon the other will at the same time show how the one judgment follows immediately from the other for the free glance of thought; and that the one judgment follows immediately from the other is precisely an expression of the immediate syllogism. In a Hegelian logic one may choose whatever examples of immanent thought-movement one will: on closer inspection it will surely show itself that the transitions occur by immediate syllogisms. "The things that are equal," it says in Heiberg's *"logiske System,"* "thereby stand in relation to the common measure and consequently also to one another, since otherwise they could not be compared. But since all relation is difference, finitude, distance and motion, all this is immediately present in the absolute unity and difference of the original," etc. It is easy to reduce the indicated thought-movement to a series of immediate syllogisms. The things are equal, *thus* they must have been compared; the things have been compared, *thus* they must stand in relation to the common measure; the things stand in relation to the common measure, *thus* they stand in relation to one another. All relation is difference,

¹¹¹So that it may not seem as though the commendation of the immediate syllogism were an empty formality, and the syllogism itself without influence on the actual progress of scientific cognition, we choose at once an example from the exact sciences. If a mathematician begins the solution of a problem of integration thus: it is the expression $\frac{x^n dx}{\sqrt{a+bx^2}}$ that is to be integrated, *thus* it is the expression $\frac{x^{n-1}}{b} \cdot \frac{bxdx}{\sqrt{a+bx^2}}$ that is to be integrated, then everyone who reflects that a magnitude remains unchanged by being multiplied and divided by an equal magnitude will surely grant that here one begins with an immediate syllogism. But to what end this syllogism? Well, that is seen from what for the expert again shows itself as an immediate syllogism: the one factor, the expression $\frac{bxdx}{\sqrt{a+bx^2}}$, is evidently the differential of $\sqrt{a+bx^2}$; *thus* one can integrate by parts, etc.

finitude, distance and motion, *thus* finitude, distance and motion are immediately present in the unity and difference of the original, etc.

One will easily convince oneself that if in such a presentation a point is discovered where the immediate syllogism does not hold good, then the understanding of it fails as well. If anyone finds the syllogism “the things are equal, thus they must have been compared” untenable, since, as it seems, there may well be many things both equal and unequal that have not yet been compared: then he will also regard a grounding such as this, that the equal things must stand in relation to one another “since otherwise they could not be compared,” as insufficient.

To be sure, the connection in which the several propositions occur can shed a light over each one of them, so that transitions which are intelligible in the flowing presentation can become unintelligible when the propositions are torn in pairs out of the context in such a way that the one becomes premise, the other conclusion. From the flowing presentation it is clear in our example that here by “the things that are equal” are meant things whose equality we cognize by comparison; whereas the immediate syllogism “the things are equal, thus they must have been compared,” has what is offensive in it in this, that in the premise objective equality is spoken of, *thus* — an immediate syllogism — an equality that is not seen to be able to rest upon the subjective function of comparison. But the circumstance that the context as a whole co-operates in the understanding of the singular does not alter the matter; for the impression of the context now itself forms a premise that has the understanding of the singular for its conclusion, thus again — an immediate syllogism. “The context shows that a thought equality is spoken of here, *thus* — an immediate syllogism — an equality that necessarily presupposes comparison.” [298]

Since the context of a determinate passage forms the premise for an immediate syllogism, the reader must not forget that the premise so formed must itself become a consequent proposition to a more comprehensive premise, and that this must come about by a new immediate syllogism. “In an objective logic there can be talk only of an objective thinking, an objective comparison; *thus* in this — belonging under the objective logic — context there is talk only of an objective comparing.” One sees how the problem hidden in the relation between equality and comparison shifts

itself incessantly, by the immediate syllogism, from one standpoint to another. The immediate syllogism stands in the closest connection with what in the logical sense is called glance, insight, survey; indeed it is itself the divinatory advance of glance, insight and survey to mediate knowledge.

[299] If it is asked how many essentially different forms the immediate syllogism can assume, then everything depends chiefly on how one apprehends the relation between form and content on the whole. If the form is treated by itself in abstract-mechanical opposition to the content, then schematism arises; if the form is developed in logical unity with the content, the difference of form will rest upon a difference in the modal functions themselves; the difference of form thus developed then leads us to gain insight into the immediate syllogism's transition into the mediate.

1) *Schematism: the Schema of the so-called immediate Syllogisms.* To schematize is formal logic's strong side; the schema is its ideal, the completion of the schema its flower and crown. Everywhere that the logical formalism with its divisions and divisions of divisions has really penetrated, the schema is unfolded and ramified down to the microscopic. In exalted striving toward the completion of schematism, formal logic has accordingly not been able to restrict itself to a specification of the principal species of "the immediate syllogisms"; it has searched out the subspecies of each [300] species by itself, it has penetrated in earnest into the singular.¹¹² It is the pure zeal

¹¹²A survey of the principal species of the so-called immediate syllogisms might well afford a formal satisfaction, if one avoided all prolixities and illustrated each species by an example. An example such as: all birds lay eggs, *thus* some birds lay eggs, would then characterize the syllogism of subordination (*ratiocinatio subjectionis, vulgo subalternationis*); an example such as: no animal is moral; *thus*: every animal is a non-moral being, would suit the identity-syllogism (*ratiocinatio æqualitatis, æquipollentiæ, conclusio ad æquipollentem*); an example such as: all animals have voluntary motion, *thus* there is no animal that does not have voluntary motion, would be indicative of the syllogism of opposition (*concl. ad oppositam*), and an example such as: all men are mortal, *thus* some mortals are men, would illuminate the syllogism of conversion (*ratioc. per conversionem*) and so forth.

But here formal logic cannot stop. According to its scholastic principle the schema is a chief matter, and when the schema is a chief matter, then what counts is perseverance and consistency: with a principle one ought not to stop half-way. It is to be regarded as a consistency respectable in its kind that the editors of formal logic, after having for a time shown the weakness of yielding to the demands of the age and restricting the schema, once more acknowledge the old principle and unfold schematism. We shall now see how here, as regards the immediate syllogisms, reflection is directed not merely upon the species, but (Cf. Drbal. Lehrbuch der propædeutischen Logik. Wien 1865. p. 55–71.) also upon the subspecies.

Of conversion-syllogisms, e.g., there are now two species: proper conversion-syllogisms and contraposition-syllogisms. Of proper conversion-syllogisms there are again 4 subspecies: 1) con-

for the pure form; no one shall say that in such syllogisms as: what *all* birds do, that must *some* birds must do; what *no* animals are, *some* animals cannot be; some beings [301] of which what can be said of all men can be said must be men, etc. — too one-sided an emphasis is laid upon the logical content; a suitable employment, on the other hand, of universally affirmative and universally negative, particularly affirmative and particularly negative judgments for suitable conversions may well be said to produce an excellent effect, when the point is to get the schema as extensive and as widely ramified as possible.

Were there really any sense in such a schematization, the schema would surely at least have to be able to do service as a kind of register or table. But what logical service should that be? As a register the schema is of no use. The need for a register would presuppose that it mattered that the syllogisms, in order to be rightly understood, should form a certain series and be set up in a determinate order; but upon that no weight whatever falls here. The syllogism that what *all* birds do *some* birds must do is evident by itself without regard to series or register. It is wholly arbitrary, and for logical insight completely indifferent, whether one will place the equipollence-syllogism before the contradiction-syllogism, and this again before the conversion-syllogism, or the reverse. As a table, then, the schema is of no use either. Why does one draw up tables? Naturally in order to secure the results of laborious observations, involved analyses, extensive calculations, and the like. Thus one has star tables, logarithm tables, chemical affinity tables, etc.

version of a general affirmative judgment (all birds lay eggs, thus: some egg-laying beings are birds), 2) conversion of a general negative judgment (no idler knows how to value time, thus: no one who knows how to value time is an idler); 3) conversion of a particular affirmative judgment (some dogs are faithful watchers, thus: some faithful watchers are dogs); 4) conversion of the particularly negative judgment. For this conversion there are no rules. To prove that there are no rules, one constructs three geometrical figures, each consisting of two circles, which in the first figure intersect one another, in the third figure fall outside one another, while in the second figure the larger surrounds the smaller. If one now considers the first figure, then some objects falling under the sphere *S* do not lie in the sphere *P*, namely *x*, *y*, etc.; likewise there are objects belonging under *P* which do not lie in *S*, namely *n*, *z*... Besides, there are parts of *S*, namely *s*, which lie in *P*, and parts of *P*, namely *p*, which lie in *S*. Thus there are here four judgments: 1. some *S* is *P*; 2. some *S* are not *P*; 3. some *P* are *S*; 4. some *P* are not *S*. From this the conversion now follows: some *P* are not *S*. E.g. some duties are not duties of compulsion (not an object of compulsion), thus: something that is an object of compulsion is not a duty. Some examples are not good: thus something good is not an example... To get any such point out of it, one sets enormous schematic vehicles in motion, seventeen pumping-engines to procure a single drop of water. Here too it holds: *parturiunt montes, nascetur ridiculus mus*.

[302] But formal logic's immediate syllogisms are not results of extensive calculations; one can really syllogize that what *all* birds do *some* birds must do, without many observations or extensive calculations.

On every side formal logic's exertion with the schema stands in glaring disproportion to the logical yield: the schema is extensive, the logical yield = 0.

2) *The analytic Modal Functions.* The manner in which formal logic treats the immediate syllogisms is in serious conflict with its own principle and brings it at last into contradiction with itself. To an immediate syllogism there belong, after all, two distinct judgments, of which the one forms the premise, the other the consequent proposition. But how does this assumption now stand to logic's supreme axiom, the so-called principle of identity? If there are really two different judgments here, then the one cannot, without being different from itself, contain the other. But if the one of two judgments cannot be contained in the other, how then should the one be capable of being derived from the other? If, on the contrary, it is not two different judgments, but only two identical propositions, that we have before us, then the two propositions give only one and the same judgment, expressed in two different ways; but where there is only one judgment, there can impossibly be any question of a syllogism. That "All" consists of "Some", that the universally affirmative judgment contains the particularly affirmative but excludes both the universally and the particularly negative, is surely something that is self-evident in such a degree that there can be no room here for any syllogism. It is thus in consequence of formal logic's own principle that its doctrine of immediate syllogisms has at length been rejected¹¹³.

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^{113a} Diese angeblichen Schlüsse sind in Wahrheit keine Schlüsse, sondern nur die Hervorhebung (Aussprache) dessen, was zwar nicht ausdrücklich, doch aber unmittelbar im Obersatze mitgesetzt ist, so daß ich mir den Inhalt desselben nur klar zu machen brauche, um es auch in ihm zu finden. Wo der Mittelsatz fehlt, wo es also keiner Vermittelung zwischen der Prämisse und der Conclusion bedarf, da bedarf es offenbar auch keiner Folgerung, d. h. da findet die Function des Folgerns gar nicht statt, da ist auch überhaupt kein Schluß vorhanden. Mit andern Worten: die Function des Schließens und somit der Schluß als Ausdruck derselben besteht eben nur in der Ableitung der Conclusion aus der Prämisse *mittelst* des Mittelsatzes: wo also der Schlußsatz *nicht* abgeleitet, sondern nur ausgesprochen wird, daß sein Inhalt in der Prämisse mit gesetzt ist, da findet offenbar auch kein Schluß statt." Ulrici. Compendium der Logik. Leipzig 1860. p. 192. Let it be well noted that the rejection is founded directly upon a conception of the principle of identity in which there is in no respect any departure from formal logic.

From the standpoint of objective logic, however, objection can also be raised against syllogisms from one premise, although the difference here develops out of the identity. It is urged from this standpoint that between premise and consequent proposition there can here be only a reflection-difference, and that such a difference is determined only by a reflection, not by a syllogism. If we consider the matter abstractly objectively, then the immanent transition from essence to phenomenon, from ground to existence, from possibility to actuality, from cause to effect can assuredly not deserve the name of syllogism; for each of the separated categories is, when it is held fast for itself, so one-sided that, in order to answer to its determination, it must reflect itself in its complement. The advance indicated by the reflection is therefore just as much a retrogression; it is a transition which is yet no transition. In that the thought-movement goes forward from essence to phenomenon, it goes precisely from phenomenon back to essence. Here, then, there is no distinct judgment about the essence from which a judgment of its own about the phenomenon could be derived, for the judgment about the essence falls in objective reflection necessarily together [304] with the judgment about the phenomenon; just as little can one think here of a distinct judgment about the phenomenon from which a judgment of its own about the essence would let itself be derived, since the judgment about the phenomenon must in objective reflection necessarily fall together with the judgment about the essence.

These objections fall away when it is remembered, as was shown in an earlier connection, that objective reflection must everywhere rest upon the subjective. But the subjective in the reflection rests again — by virtue of the word — upon the judgment. From this standpoint it becomes, then, not merely possible but necessary to pass a distinct judgment about the essence in order to be able to pass a distinct judgment about the phenomenon. Here there are two questions for subjective reflection to answer: what is essence? what is phenomenon? That these questions must be answered by different judgments is incontestable. Since now the judgment that is passed about the phenomenon is just as much determinative for the one that is passed about the essence as the reverse, the judging subjectivity would find itself in an infinite hovering if the one of these judgments were not expressly posited as the original, the other as the derived. If, e.g., the judgment about the phenomenon is posited as the

original and to that extent immediate, then the judgment about the essence must direct itself accordingly; it must as consequent proposition be derived by analysis from its presupposition. The presupposition is premise, the consequent proposition conclusion; the phenomenon is apprehended *thus, therefore* the essence must be apprehended *thus*: here is an immediate syllogism.

What this means must surely strike the eye when the question is how far one may syllogize from possibility to actuality and from actuality to possibility. Formal logic is, in accordance with what has once been agreed, just as certain that every syllogism from actuality to possibility must be true: *ab esse ad posse esse valet consequentia*, as it is convinced that every syllogism from possibility to actuality must be false: *a* [305] *posse esse ad esse non valet consequentia*. That a syllogism from actuality to possibility can nevertheless just as well be false (the actual has been, but is no longer, a merely possible, since possibility has been superseded by actuality), as a syllogism from possibility to actuality can be true (the possible in the objective sense must become actual, for otherwise the possible becomes impossible), is easy to see. Everything depends, in the given cases, upon a distinct judgment about the possibility and a distinct judgment about the actuality.

The significance of the immediate syllogism becomes still more striking when we reflect that the objective categories determine one another only objectively, in that they show themselves determinative for the objects concerned. Only when the object is cognized as determined by its category does the reflecting subjectivity become judging; but in the objective relations the one categorical determination must necessarily draw the other after it, the one judgment lead to the other: here is an effect (the treetops are moving), *therefore* there must here be a cause (the wind); here is a phenomenon (the pallor and the flashing eyes), *therefore* there must here be a ground (strong emotion); here are determinate means (implements of agriculture), *therefore* there must here be a determinate purpose (agriculture). By apprehending the immediate syllogisms from the objective, practical standpoint one will convince oneself that they, far from being superfluous, play an important part in the subjectivity's orientation in the actual surrounding world. What would merely sensuous seeing and hearing be without a corresponding manifold of immediate syllogisms? Or how should one explain to

oneself the fact that there can be sense-deceptions, optical and acoustic illusions, if there were no immediate syllogisms?

Since now an immediate syllogism can in a given case just as well be false as true, logic must adduce a criterion by which the true can be distinguished from the false. It is the connection between the two judgments, premise and consequent proposition, [306] upon whose determination the matter essentially turns; let one then investigate how far this connection lets itself be reduced to a hypothetical judgment or not! If this reduction can be carried out, then the syllogism is reliable; if not, it is unreliable. "This is a plane triangle, thus the sum of the angles = two right angles"; this syllogism is true, for "if it is a plane triangle, then the sum of its angles must necessarily be two right angles." If, on the other hand, someone syllogizes thus: "The family was well this morning (8 o'clock), therefore it is well still (12 noon)": then it is easily seen that such a syllogism is not founded upon necessity, but only upon probability, and thus cannot be entirely reliable. In theory this is recognizable by the fact that premise and conclusum do not stand to one another as antecedent and consequent clause in a hypothetical judgment; in practice it is recognized by the fact that the syllogism has a reassuring effect only under ordinary circumstances, but not when there is danger afoot.

The analytic modal functions must accordingly aim not merely at stating the relation between the immediate syllogism's premise and conclusum in general, but also at determining, for every peculiar case, how far the syllogism's foundation is necessity or probability, and, if it is a probability, at stating its degrees. Should it in particular cases turn out that the foundation is not a being one, but hovers between the poles of probability and necessity, then it is the task of the judging subjectivity to draw a boundary-line between *syllogism* and *conjecture*, an often very fine boundary-line which both in theory and in practice is of decisive significance for the thinking that advances from judgment to judgment.

In order to apprehend the significance of the analytic modal functions in its whole extent, let one represent to oneself the subjectivity in relation not merely to a manifold of immediate phenomena, but, as judging subjectivity, to a manifold of immediate, [307] logical, antilogical, categorical, assertoric judgments. How should it now be possible

to bring about unity in such a consciousness, if it were not possible, by an analyzing reflection, to derive one judgment from another, if, in other words, it were not possible to make immediate syllogisms. Only by virtue of the immediate syllogism does an essential connection arise between judgment and judgment, only by virtue of the immediate syllogism is there continuity in advancing thinking. A continuously advancing thinking is an intellectual movement; but such a movement can surely go in the most different directions.

That there can here be question of a plurality of analytic modal functions rests then chiefly upon this, that not only can another judgment be derived from every judgment, but that from one and the same premise essentially different syllogisms can even be drawn. "Cajus is a man, *therefore* Cajus is mortal; Cajus is a man, *therefore* Cajus is immortal; Cajus is a man, *therefore* in need of sleep," etc. Each of these syllogisms acquires its peculiar significance from the peculiar direction in which the thought moves: the physiologist syllogizes otherwise than the ethicist, the ethicist again otherwise than the aesthetician, etc. "But", someone might ask, "are there now also different functions here in the logical sense? It really seems as if the thought functioned in the same way whether it is here syllogized: *therefore* C. is mortal, or: *therefore* C. is immortal; or: *therefore* C. is in need of sleep: insofar as the one Therefore is different from the other, this difference surely concerns only the content, not the form." We draw attention to the fact that every essential content-difference must always reflect itself in a corresponding form-difference. Wherever the content-difference withdraws itself from the form-difference, the content sinks down to being mere bare material. If the difference between a physiological, an ethical and an aesthetic content is more
 [308] than a material-difference, then the difference between a physiological, an ethical and an aesthetic syllogism is also an essential form-difference. The difference itself does not concern logic, but that there is here a difference, an essential form-difference, does concern logic. That formal logic does not know the essential form-difference is explicable; formal logic looks to the result and overlooks the thought-movement, it holds to the schema and forgets the form. If the whole attention is concentrated upon the conclusum that follows upon the immediate syllogism's *Therefore*, then the one Therefore is quite certainly like the other, there is in the function itself no noteworthy

difference. But whence now does that come? It comes from this, that one overlooks the thought-movement, the advance in which the syllogism-act itself marks a turn, and looks only to the result, whether, e.g., the concluding proposition is affirmative or negative, universally negative or etc., difference-determinations which one-sidedly suit the schema, the mechanical form torn loose from the content.

Concentrated in the *Therefore* which, according to the schema, supports itself exclusively upon the one premise, the thought-movement is reduced to a vanishing minimum, an element in which its *Whence* and *Whither* has become wholly unrecognizable. All *S* are *P*, *therefore*: some *S* are *P*, here is — under the aspect of a syllogism — an infinitely small movement from All being to Some being, a movement so small that one may even dispute whether it is progressive or retrogressive. It stands with the movement-differentials in the different *Therefore*s belonging to the immediate syllogism as with the different differentials in “the analysis of the infinite.” The elements *dx*, *xdx*, *adx*, *cosxdx* and the like can, when they are regarded as existent, be taken to be equal, since they are all infinitely near 0; but when they are integrated, then one sees *Whence* and *Whither*, then one sees the *movement*, and then the difference is thoroughgoing. So too with the logical movement-differential, the thought enclosed in *Therefore*; it acquires its logical significance from the whole thought-movement. [309] In virtue of the thought-movement it makes an essential difference whether it is a physiological, an ethical or an aesthetic *Therefore* that we have before us. To the fundamental difference in the immediate syllogism’s *Therefore* there corresponds the difference in the analytic modal functions.

3) *The Transition of the immediate Syllogism into the mediate*. It lies in the concept of the immediate syllogism that its consequent proposition must be derived from one premise; but it by no means lies in its concept that it must in every case be absolutely immediately evident. That this demand cannot be set up as universally valid is a direct consequence of the fact that what is instantly clear to the one may be obscure to the other. What one man sees at first glance another is perhaps able to grasp only after many preparations and explanations¹¹⁴. Talent for a particular science rests

¹¹⁴This difference is often of great comic effect. In “Hovmesteren i Knibe” Ane can see at once from the forgotten hat (thus by an immediate syllogism) that there has been a lady in the tutor’s room; but it costs her considerable effort before she can make the phenomenon evident to Hans.

upon a particular eye, but the particular eye is precisely recognizable by the ease and sureness with which the man gifted in a given direction makes immediate syllogisms. Objectively, or in and for itself, the demand cannot hold either; for in the first place there is no syllogism so absolutely objective that it could syllogize itself; in the second place there is no syllogism so absolutely immediate that it must not, when reflection is awakened, at once pass over into the mediate¹¹⁵. “The line from *a* to *b* is straight,
 [310] thus it is the shortest way between *a* and *b*”. Is this syllogism now evident by itself or is it not? Subjectively regarded, both conceptions hold, as has been shown in the foregoing. The syllogism is immediately evident, for it denotes an axiom; yet no, the
 [311] syllogism is not immediately evident, for the alleged axiom is really a theorem, and a theorem requires proof. Objectively regarded, the syllogism is, on the contrary, unconditionally immediate; for upon what does its immediacy rest? Solely and alone upon this, that its consequent proposition is derived from a single premise.

From this it follows again that the immediate syllogism can not only demand a rich and many-sided analysis, but can also have a rich scientific content. Syllogisms such as these: “The daily motion of the sun and the stars is only apparent, *therefore* it must be the earth’s motion that is actual”; “a stone thrown from a high tower deviates towards

¹¹⁵In a peculiarly naive way the mediacy in the immediate syllogisms also comes to light in this, that for every such syllogism a proof is expressly demanded. One proves — only think! — the validity of a syllogism such as this: it is true that all animals have voluntary motion, thus it is false that some animals do not have voluntary motion. The proof runs (Drbal. Lehrbuch der propädeutischen Logik. p. 59) thus: “If the judgment: all animals have voluntary motion is true, then the judgment some animals have voluntary motion must also be true. If it now be assumed that the judgment: some animals do not have voluntary motion were likewise true, then, since the judgments have the *same particular* subject, the propositions: some animals have voluntary motions and precisely *these same* (animals) have no voluntary motion, would be true at one and the same time, which conflicts with the axiom of contradiction.” How mediate the immediate syllogism must become through such a conduct of proof is further seen from this, that the proof of its validity expressly grounds itself upon the proof of the validity of the subordination-syllogism. This proof runs thus: “If the universally affirmative judgment: All *S* are *P*, is valid, then the particularly affirmative judgment: some *S* are *P*, must also be valid, for the opposite would, it is said, be ‘unreasonable.’” That all these conducts of proof are a fiasco must be granted, for he who cannot at an immediate glance see the contradiction in some animals not having voluntary motion, once it is given that all animals have voluntary motion, is a complete idiot; but a complete idiot does not become wiser by being referred to the axiom of contradiction.

For an assessment of formal logic’s formal obscurity the conduct of proof is characteristic insofar as it hereby becomes manifest that it has not duly made clear to itself the concept of the immediate syllogism. If the immediate syllogism is to be known by the immediately evident: where then does logic mean to go with its proofs? If the syllogism’s immediacy is to be known by its having only one premise, why then is it restricted to vacuous forms and examples?

the east, *therefore* the earth moves from west to east”, undeniably require for their right understanding a multitude of reflections and intermediate determinations; but for that reason they are, according to the concept laid down, none the less immediate. That the conclusum rests upon a single premise makes the syllogism immediate.

The immediate syllogism is a finite form to which an infinite content lets itself be reduced. The result that is science’s last and richest must, so surely as it comes about by a conclusion, be just as capable of being referred back to a single premise as that which is drawn from the very first and simplest axiom. The premise of the last conclusion must indeed, when it is analyzed, contain a manifold of premises; but the demand is that the many premises with their conclusions be reduced to one premise. It is an ever richer reduction which, in that it gives the premise an ever richer content, furnishes the foundation for the analytic activity of the modal functions. If great and content-rich knowledge-results could not be concentrated in immediate syllogisms, a true and comprehensive science would be impossible.

Were each single one of the premises lying in the content-rich premise to be brought forward, gone through and explained separately every time, then science would have to begin constantly over again at the treatment of every new point, and could in this way never come to an end with its investigations. One would, e.g., [312] hardly get very far in geometry if one could not support oneself upon such immediate syllogisms as: “The triangle is right-angled, thus the square on the hypotenuse is equal to the sum of the squares on both the legs;” “the figure is a circle with radius $= r$, *therefore* its area is $= \pi r^2$ ”; “ A is the area of the whole spherical surface, thus A is equal to the product of the diameter and the circumference of the great circle”, etc.

Since now the premise in an immediate syllogism can contain as great a manifold of mediately won results as one will, the transition from the immediate to the mediate syllogism is therewith at the same time motivated: the immediate syllogism is at bottom mediate. Were there a syllogism so immediate that it did not let itself be resolved into a mediate one, then its premise would have to be an absolute axiom evident by itself; but that such axioms are not to be had has been shown in the foregoing.

The immediate syllogism is not merely the presupposition of the mediate, but also

its result, and can as result be resolved again into its presupposition. A syllogism such as: “Cajus is a man, thus mortal”, evidently rests upon the tacit presupposition that every man is mortal; but when this presupposition is expressly brought forward, the syllogism acquires two premises: every man is mortal, Cajus is a man, thus — here is a mediate syllogism.

ββ) *The mediate Syllogism: synthetic Modal Functions.* While the analytic modal function, as regards the terms of the syllogism, holds to identity, the synthetic holds on the contrary to difference. Only by a peculiar co-operation of thinking and representing can there be brought about here an equilibrium of analysis and synthesis which makes the mediate syllogism possible. If in the often-cited example: “All men are mortal, Cajus is a man, thus Cajus is mortal,” one gives analyzing thinking a one-sided [313] preponderance over the synthesis conditioned by representation, then the syllogism loses its significance. This Hegel has done, and has for that reason been unable to acknowledge the syllogism. “The major premise”, so runs his objection¹¹⁶, “is correct only insofar as *the consequent proposition is correct*; if Cajus happened not to be mortal, the major premise would not be correct. The proposition that is supposed to be the consequent proposition must already be immediately correct for itself, since otherwise the major premise could not comprise all singulars; before the major premise can pass for correct, one must ask beforehand whether that consequent proposition is not itself an *instance* against it”.

From the objection it is seen that Hegel lets the analytic modal function absorb the synthetic and thereby sublate itself. If Cajus is a man, then, in order to be able to say what every man is, one must be able to say beforehand what Cajus is. In this way the identity of what Cajus is and what every man is is reduced to a tautological paraphrase: “Cajus is what every man is, when every man is what Cajus is.”

This formalism ceases, however, when finite thinking is brought into the right relation to intuition and representation. If the individual Cajus is set over against the concept man, so that the individual as subject is for the representation what the concept as predicate is for the thought: then it is seen that the subject, the single man, must have the universally human properties in an individual manner. Finite

¹¹⁶Die subjektive Logik. p. 151.

thinking, conditioned by the representation, now apprehends this in such a way that the individual's properties fall into two systems: systems of the universally human and systems of the individual ones; the individual properties being then assumed to hold either exclusively for *this* one or at all events only for *some* singulars.

Only when the analysis has been carried out in this way is there room here for a [314] corresponding synthesis.

In accordance with the separation of general and particular properties in every single man, the total cognition then divides into two partial cognitions. On the one side a property common to all men is apprehended and determined. This universally valid property is seen, under the aspect of thinking, to lie in man's essence; it is to that extent the category, the concept as concept, upon which the universal validity is founded. "Man is — it lies in human nature — mortal." But finite thinking is particularly conditioned by the representation; in that the universally valid property is brought forward, the gaze fastens not upon the pure concept, but upon the individuals in which the concept is realized, thus not upon man, but upon men. Thus we have in the major premise a cognition for itself: "*All men are mortal*". How do we now come to the minor premise? Evidently not by a continued analysis, but by a synthesis. In the cognition that all men are mortal, the cognition that Cajus is a man is by no means comprised. Cajus might, e.g., be either a horse or a dog or an elephant; indeed, there is in logic nothing even to hinder Cajus, if one will have it so, from being a stockfish.

If one will turn the relation about and say that it is really the cognition uttered in the minor premise that comprises the cognition of the major premise, this too is a misunderstanding. It is assuredly impossible to cognize Cajus as a man without seeing him as sharing in certain properties universally valid for human nature. But from this it by no means follows that representing thinking would need to reflect through all the properties of human nature in order to apprehend the single individual as a man. On the contrary! it is here expressly presupposed that the apprehension takes place in the well-known immediate manner, namely by intuiting the human figure. [315] The minor premise is therefore, in the particular cognition, just as independent of the major premise as the latter is of the former. In that the two distinct cognitions are brought together, the syllogism acquires its significance, and the modal functions

show themselves to be synthetic.

The cognitions uttered in the premises of the immediate syllogism are, with all their respective independence, by no means matters of indifference to one another. On the contrary! in that they are brought together, that is, in that the synthesis is carried out, it shows itself that by their union they form a new cognition. The consequent proposition, the new cognition, can be grounded in the premises in different ways; how the grounding is more precisely constituted in the particular cases must be decided by the analysis. For it depends upon how the elements of the syllogism, (*sylogismi elementa*), the terms which in premises and consequent proposition make up subjects and predicates, stand to one another. If particular weight is laid upon the formulae conditioned by the shifting position of the elements, we have *the Syllogistic*; if the question here is of the original fundamental determinations, then everything essentially depends upon a *Reduction* of the *syllogistic Forms*; if finally the distinct premises are apprehended as form-giving moments of a content continuously developing itself in syllogism-systems, then *the Dissolution of the Syllogistic* is logically motivated.

1) *Syllogistic*. The mediate syllogism is according to its concept the act of thinking which grounds a judgment's validity upon a union of two or more other judgments, and is designated in particular by the Aristotelian-scholastic name *Syllogism*. The Syllogistic, or the doctrine of the syllogisms and their application, then begins schematically with a distinction between the *simple* syllogism (*sylogismus simplex*), which has only two premises, and the *composite* (*s. compositus*), which forms itself by the connection of a series of simple syllogisms (polysyllogism). The simple, non-composite [316] syllogism is again divided into the *categorical*, whose premises are both categorical judgments, the *hypothetical*, at least one of whose premises must be a hypothetical judgment, and the *disjunctive*, at least one of whose premises must be disjunctive. — Schematization is once more in full swing¹¹⁷.

[317] Although the detailed schematization of the multiplicity and mutual difference
[318] of the forms set up also, as regards the mediate syllogisms, shows itself to stand

¹¹⁷It is a rich harvest that scholastic syllogistic offers to the sharp-witted, whose thinking-mechanism is especially assisted by rubrics and schemata. If we designate, in the categorical syllogism, the conclusion's subject by *S*, its predicate by *P* and the middle term by *M*, then the following schema gives us the four figures:

First Figure	Second Figure	Third Figure	Fourth Figure
$M-P$	$P-M$	$M-P$	$P-M$
$S-M$	$S-M$	$M-S$	$M-S$
$S-P$	$S-P$	$S-P$	$S-P$

If one now moreover lays particular weight on the division of judgments into universally affirmative (*a*) and particularly affirmative (*i*), after the two first vowels in the verb *affirmo*, into universally negative (*e*) and particularly negative (*o*), after the vowels in the verb *nego*, then one obtains, by letting each of these 4 kinds of judgment in each of the 4 figures serve alternately as major and minor premise, 64 possible combinations; and when one thereupon applies the three golden rules: *ex mere negativis nihil sequitur* (no *M* is *P*, no *S* is *M* yields no syllogism), *ex mere particularibus nihil sequitur* (some *M* are *P*, some *S* are *M* yields no syllogism) and *conclusio sequi debet partem debiliorem præmissarum* (when one of the premises is negative, the conclusion becomes negative; if the one premise is particular, the conclusion becomes particular), one will find that only 19 of the combinations yield true syllogisms. These 19 combinations are then applied in the 4 figures in such a way that each figure thereby obtains its valid moods. — Thus, e.g., the first mood in the first figure is *Barbara*: *M (a) P, S (a) M, ergo: S (a) P* (everything immaterial is imperishable, all absolutely singular beings are immaterial, thus: all absolutely singular beings are imperishable). The third mood in the first figure is *Darii*: *M (a) P, S (i) M, ergo: S (i) P* (all acids color blue vegetable matters red, some oxides are acids, thus: some oxides color blue vegetable matters red). In the third figure, on the other hand, the fourth mood is called not *Darii* but *Datisi*, a remark which, as one sees, is very important: *M (a) P, M (i) S, ergo: S (i) P* (all fungi are cryptogams, some fungi are parasitic upon other organisms, thus: some things parasitic upon other organisms are cryptogams).

If one has once said *A* — this is an acknowledged saying — then one must also say *B*. If one really wishes to lay scientific weight upon the three Aristotelian figures, then it is quite in order that one should also demand respect for the fourth, the Galenic. Why should the fourth figure not, considered as figure, be just as respectable as the three others? True enough, the fourth figure has not quite so many moods as the third, for the third figure has six moods: *Darapti, Felapton, Disamis, Datisi, Bocardo, Ferison*; but it has nevertheless more than either the first or the second. These namely have only four moods each, the first: *Barbara, Celarent, Darii, Ferio*, the second: *Cesare, Camestres, Festino, Baroco*, whereas the fourth has five valid moods, very important for “science,” namely: *Bamalip, Calemes, Dimatis, Fesapo, Fresison*. Thus: if the fourth figure is to go, then away with them all! but if one is in a position to hold on to the fourth figure, one is also in a position to hold on to them all.

Only by holding on to all four figures will one rightly be able to grasp the deep logic in the ingenious verse that derives from Petrus Hispanus (he became, though we do not precisely venture to maintain that it was for the verse’s sake, afterwards Pope under the name of John XXI, and died in 1277); the verse runs as follows:

Barbara, Celarent primæ, Darii, Ferioque.
Cesare, Camestres, Festino, Baroco secundæ.
Tertia grande sonans recitat Darapti, Felapton,
Disamis, Datisi, Bocardo, Ferison. Quartæ
Sunt Bamalip, Calemes, Dimatis, Fesapo, Fresison.

If one now takes note — for in so acute a verse there is much to take note of and exceedingly much to remark upon — that not only the vowels *a, e, i, o*, but also the initial letters *B, C, D, F*, are significant, in that they call to mind what is analogous in the kinds of syllogism belonging under the different figures (*Bamalip*, e.g., analogous with *Barbara*), then one is inspired by the logical “conscience”; and if one moreover becomes aware — and here there is much to become aware of — that even the consonants *s, p, c, m* acquire a deeper meaning through this, that they according to the verse:

in disproportion to the logical yield, there is here nevertheless, on account of the synthesis, a plurality of intermediate determinations and middle terms which makes it explicable that thinking, reflecting upon its own laws, can find itself impelled to seek an exhaustive determination of cases and rules.

Already the categorical syllogism's three elements: *the middle term (terminus medius)*, the common third to which the conclusion's subject and predicate must each for itself be referred, *the minor concept (terminus minor)*, the conclusion's subject, and *the major concept (terminus major)*, the conclusion's predicate, must present points of combination and awaken interest in a schematization. If one now takes note of how *the major premise (propositio major)*, the premise in which the major concept is connected with the middle term, and *the minor premise (p. minor)*, the premise in which the minor concept is united with the middle term, are formed in different cases: then one easily discovers that the middle term can change place in the premises and thereby give these a different character. In the syllogism: "all *men* are mortal, Caius is a *man*, thus Caius is mortal," the middle term is subject in the major premise, but predicate in the minor premise; in the syllogism: "no rectangle is *equilateral*, all [319] squares are *equilateral*, thus no square is a rectangle," the middle term is predicate in both premises. The question then arises, how many cases are there really here, and what may these different cases signify? Once one has found out that through the middle term's different position four syllogistic figures can be formed, then the cases belonging under each of the figures, which show themselves now fit and now again unfit for an adequate syllogism, will provoke the question of the different ways in which one can syllogize in each single figure. The schematism shows to that extent a striving to secure the cases and to bring the special under the universal; but the endeavor is fruitless, the movement illusory; instead of immersing itself in its own essence, thought carries on a combinatorial play with the forms that vary upon the surface.

2) *Deduction of syllogistic Forms.* There holds of the mediate syllogism what has

"*S vult simpliciter verti, P verte per accid.*
M vult transponi, C per impossibile duci;"

indicate what alterations must be undertaken with each of the kinds of syllogism in the three last figures, when they are to be reduced to the first figure, then one feels "*testimonium spiritus*".

already been said of the immediate: the development of form must go as one with the logical development of content. But the development of form, a deduction of the syllogism's particular forms, is conditioned by a corresponding *reduction*, a leading back of the manifold to the beginning itself, the simple first.

Among the logicians who in more recent times have aimed at a rational reduction of the mediate syllogism's particular forms, we must especially name Ulrici¹¹⁸. "In the universal's relation to the singular," he says, "in the genus's relation to the species, as in the species' relation to its specimens, thus in the concept of the judgment, there lies immediately this, that what holds (is predicated) of the universal must also hold of the singular comprised under the universal, and that what holds of the genus must also hold of its species, subspecies and specimens." In consequence of this presupposition Ulrici reduces the syllogism's necessity to the first logical axioms: " $A = A$, of like holds like, what holds of the genus must hold of its species and of their specimens; this is the [320] universal axiom for all *positive* syllogisms; further: A is not = *non A*, of like the unlike does not hold, and of the unlike not the like, what does not hold of the genus cannot hold of its species and their specimens; this is the universal axiom for all *negative* syllogisms".

"From the universal axiom for all positive syllogisms it follows: 1) that when a whole species is subsumed under a general predicate-concept or higher genus-concept, then every one of the species' specimens is also subsumed under the same concept. With the syllogisms formed according to this norm the first so-called syllogistic figure is implicitly given. From the same universal axiom it follows: 2) that a subject which is to be subsumed under a higher genus-concept must necessarily be subsumable under some one or other of the species-concepts comprised in it, an axiom which belongs to the second syllogistic figure, in which it finds especially a negative application. From the axiom it follows further: 3) that when a species is subsumed (allows itself to be subsumed) under two different genera, each of these must also in part be subsumable under the other. The syllogisms formed according to this norm belong to the third figure. Finally it is: 4) a consequence of the general axiom that when a species-concept is to be subsumed under a genus-concept, and this again under a higher genus-concept,

¹¹⁸Compendium der Logik. Leipzig 1860. p. 183–194.

then some specimens belonging to the last concept must also be subsumable under the species-concept; and from the axiom for all negative syllogisms, that when the genus-concept under which the species-concept is subsumed does not belong under a higher genus-concept, no specimen of this last can be subsumed under the species-concept; as also that, when the species is not subsumed under the lower genus-concept, some
 [321] specimens of the higher genus-concept must also be excluded from the species-concept. It is the syllogisms formed according to this norm that are designated by the fourth figure¹¹⁹ ”.

But however clear and judicious this deduction must be said to be in its main features, it nevertheless suffers from formal logic's old, well-known fundamental defect, that difference is held outside identity, and contradiction is left standing as a piece of logical lumber. If the equation $A = A$ is to express identity, and identity so expressed is to be principle, then logic will be unable to bring it as far as a judgment, let alone as far as a syllogism. Even if one were, with Ulrici, to regard the proposition in which a singular as singular is subsumed under the general as being the only logical judgment, it is nevertheless clear that by such a proposition one goes far beyond pure identity. Could a glance at the judgment not at once teach one that the identity $A = A$
 [322] is a tautology, and a tautology insufficient to ground a judgment, then an attempt to deduce and determine the syllogism, in particular the mediate one, ought nevertheless to be able to do so. It is reciprocal determinations of genus, species and individual about which the whole matter turns. How is it now possible to think the species as middle concept between genus and individual, without seeing this middle term on the one side identical with the individual, on the other side with the genus? But the

¹¹⁹Under his Hegelian standpoint Heiberg has in a very simple and natural manner deduced the three figures with rejection of the fourth, the non-Aristotelian one. After having indicated the system of the three syllogisms by a) $E-S-A$, b) $S-E-A$ and c) $E-A-S$, according to the position that the singular, the particular and the universal each time occupy, he continues: “Since the predicate is always of greater extension than the subject, in the first syllogism every preceding term is subject, and every succeeding one predicate. But in the second syllogism the middle term is subject, and the extreme terms predicates, and in the third the extreme terms are subjects, and the middle term predicate. Or: in the first syllogism the term which is first predicate becomes afterwards subject; in the second one subject is common to two predicates; and in the third one predicate is common to two subjects. But in the conclusion of all three syllogisms the first term is subject, and the third predicate. [Here it is to be remarked that with the completed system of syllogisms subject and predicate become of equal extension; the relation between species and genus disappears; the general is not of greater extension than the singular. Herein already lies the transition to objectivity]”. *Specul. Logik.* § 155.

genus is of course different from the individual; the middle term is thus identical with two different things and, despite this doubling of identity, identical with itself; here are three identities in one identity: such a triune identity has in truth its difference not outside itself, but in itself.

If one overlooks the unity-in-difference without which the middle term could not possibly unite the extreme terms, then one will also remain standing at a very one-sided conception of the syllogism-function itself. This is precisely the case with Ulrici. Instead of cognizing the fundamental function as it comes forward in its particular forms, i.e. as it actually functions, he holds fast to its abstract likeness with itself; function = function, just as $A = A$, and in this way obtains a function that cannot function¹²⁰.

That difference belongs just as originally in the ground, and thus in every fundamental function, as identity; that identity itself is in the ground difference, has “the grounding reflection” in its place¹²¹ already demonstrated; that a fundamental function, when it is held fast in abstract generality, cannot be applied at all, and thus [323] must remain in an empty being without being able to reach intellectual existence, can even be proved outright mathematically.

$F(x) = y$ is every possible function and precisely on that ground indeterminate: with such a function no reckoning can be done. Insofar as the function is *in abstracto* as fundamental function, it is, by being in the ground, only in possibility. “In relation to the reduction possibility is ground; in relation to the deduction the ground is possibility. The identity of ground and possibility is seen from the disjunctive judgment’s different forms: A is neither B nor C nor $D \dots f(x)$ is neither ax , nor x^a nor $a^x \dots$: the particular determinations are dissolved in the universal, and have thereby gone to ground; A is, in the ground, both B and C and $D \dots f(x)$ is, in possibility, both ax , x^a and $a^x \dots$. Insofar as what is particular in the ground’s content lets itself appear, it is reflected

¹²⁰“Es giebt ... vier ... Schlußfiguren, die sich insofern logisch unterscheiden lassen, als sie aus dem allgemeinen Grundsatz alles Schließens in seiner positiven wie negativen Form, der zugleich die Norm für die Gestaltung aller Schlüsse ist, unmittelbar sich ergeben. Sie bilden indessen, wie von selbst einleuchtet, keineswegs vier verschiedene “Arten” von Schlüssen. Denn sie sind keineswegs Modificationen der logischen *Function* des Schließens, sondern nur — im Grunde unerhebliche — Specialformen der allgemeinen *Gestalt* der Schlüsse”. Anfr. Skr. p. 188.

¹²¹Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 93–99.

in possibility; where one case is possible, at least two cases must be possible, for if the possible case's opposite were not also possible, the case itself would be necessary: possibility has alternating terms. If now one of the terms is to be posited as existent, then the disjunctive judgment in its usual form shows: A is either B or C or $D \dots$, $f(x)$ is either ax or x^a or $a^x \dots$ the tension between the alternating terms¹²² .

What in this respect holds of the mathematical functions holds in corresponding fashion of the logical ones. It is not possible to apply the syllogism's fundamental function without specifying it according to one of the four figures. If the judgment: "Caius is mortal," is demanded as conclusion, and the judgment: "all men are mortal," is given as the one premise, then the judgment: "Caius is a man," must surely be the
 [324] other premise; it is then by no means arbitrary, but altogether necessary, that the syllogism should correspond to the first figure. If the judgment: "some animals living in the water are mammals," is demanded as conclusion, and the judgment: "all whales live in the water," is given as the one premise, then one must necessarily have either: "all whales are mammals"; or: "some whales are mammals," for the other premise, and it is then a matter of course that the syllogism falls under the third figure. If now the syllogism-function is recognized, as was shown above, not only by the act of thinking through which a conclusion is derived from given premises, but also by the synthetic activity of thought through which the premises are found out and set up, then it lies in the nature of the matter that the syllogism-function is modified with each of the syllogism's typical "special forms." For the synthesis of the premises takes place under other conditions and in another manner when the middle term is to be subject in the major premise and predicate in the minor premise, than when it is to be predicate both in the major and in the minor premise, and in the latter case again under other conditions and in another manner than when it is either to be subject in both premises or predicate in the major premise and subject in the minor premise. If one overlooks this, the act of syllogizing must sink down into a thoughtless mechanism; but if one sees this, one will also see that the synthetic modal functions must change with the changed synthesis.

3) *The Dissolution of the Syllogistic.* But what significance do the mediate syllogisms

¹²²Mathematik og Dialektik. p. 50–51.

really have for knowledge and science? It has been objected against the syllogistic, especially in more recent times, that it finitizes the forms of knowledge, parcels out cognition, and, through the syllogisms' "well-known convenience for proving the most diverse, indeed even contradictory things," promotes scepticism. The syllogism's arbitrariness lies in this, "that the one who conducts the proof can choose the middle term (*terminus medius*) at pleasure. For since every thing presents several points of view for consideration, and the more of them the more concrete it is, it can by any [325] single one of these be joined in syllogism with the most diverse, indeed even opposite things. ... E.g., if one wishes by syllogisms to prove, first that man is an animal, next that man is not an animal, then one says in the first case: "Man has senses, organs, circulatory, digestive, nervous system, etc., in short, all the conditions for animal life. Whatever has these conditions is an animal. Thus man is an animal." — In the second case one says: "The animal is not a rational being. Man is a rational being. Thus man is not an animal"¹²³ .

What is true in this objection is however obscured by the fact that syllogism and proof are without more ado run together into one. Here, as far as the syllogism is concerned, there is only a question of cognition's formal side, not of its real content. The essential development of form must indeed also be a development of content, but it is then a logical, not a real content that is being thought. It is the articulating determination of the connection of judgments, and thus of cognitions, that gives the syllogism, the mediate as well as the immediate, its essential significance. That now a *methodus mathematica*, which binds advancing cognition to a chain of continuous syllogisms, cannot be commended in philosophy, is a settled matter; but the syllogism's significance as a scientific reduction-formula ought not on that account to be overlooked. The Anselmian proof of God's existence, which, when it is, if we may so say, seen in foreshortened perspective, allows itself to be reduced to the following syllogism: "the most perfect being (*id quo majus cogitari non potest*) must have, not a merely thought, but also an actual being; God is the most perfect being; thus God has, not a merely thought, but an actual being," is indeed, considered as proof, unsatisfactory; but as a reduction-formula for an infinitely rich content the syllogism is nonetheless [326]

¹²³J. L. Heiberg. *Speculativ Logik*. § 148. Anm. 1.

of pervasive significance. For the major premise contains the whole of ontology, the minor premise the whole of the philosophy of religion, and the syllogism itself the insight that both sciences in conjunction bring forth. Certainly the single syllogism, and still less the single judgment, cannot give the richer content an exhaustive, secure and all-sided designating form; but for all that it is nonetheless of importance that great totalities can, for punctual illumination, be concentrated in a single syllogism, indeed in a single judgment.

It is further alleged as a defect in the use of syllogisms that an infinite series is established which science cannot sublate. "Since the two judgments contained in the syllogism, $E-S$ and $S-A$, are presented as isolated propositions, as premises, i.e. as something that does not lie immediately in the syllogism but precedes it, it is required that each of these propositions shall previously have arisen as a concluding proposition in a preceding syllogism, or, as one says, that it shall have been proved. This presupposes two preceding syllogisms, but since the premises of these must likewise have been proved in what precedes, these two thus presuppose four preceding ones, these again eight preceding ones, and so on in an infinite series, which in its 21st member would comprise about a million and a half syllogisms, and thence rapidly rise to billions and trillions ... To believe oneself in possession of the truth because one finds oneself in a system of syllogisms is still more unreasonable than to believe oneself free because one is permitted to walk about in a cage; for even the smallest birdcage is larger in relation to the whole earth than the cognition brought forth by syllogisms is in relation to that which they presuppose¹²⁴."

[327] But as regards the objections in this direction also, it must be remembered that the demonstration of a misuse proves nothing against the true use. It goes with the syllogistic on the whole as with the finitizing of thought. If the finite were not present in the development, the infinite could not be comprehended at all. If the immanent method can treat *reflection*'s endless series as conditions for the finite's transition into the infinite, why then should it not be able to treat *the mediate syllogism*'s endless series in the same way; if the series of reflection allow themselves to be sublated, why should the syllogistic series not also allow themselves to be sublated?

¹²⁴Heiberg. Speculativ Logik. § 148. Anm. 1.

There is in the whole of Hegelian logic not a section whose content cannot with ease be reduced to syllogistic form; but if the content of the immanent development can be reduced to syllogism, then the syllogism must surely also be reducible to immanent development. Let one begin, e.g., with the beginning: “In a system there can be only one beginning that is the true one; logic is a system, thus in logic there can be only one beginning that is the true one. It lies in the nature of the beginning that it must be contentless; only “pure being” is contentless; thus logic must begin with pure being. “Pure being” is absolutely contentless; the absolutely contentless is nothing; pure being is thus nothing.” — In this way one can then go on through being, essence and concept, and transform even the very last syllogism into a scholastic syllogism¹²⁵.

But what do we now learn from this? In the first place, that the syllogistic form is an abbreviation characteristic of the reduction, an abbreviation quite suited to gather together and preserve the results of a development already traversed. In [328] the second place, that the manner in which the results won are apprehended and presented in the relatively independent judgments which make up the syllogism’s premises corresponds exactly to the manner in which the immediate premises are again dissolved and surrender their content to a development of the concept liberated from syllogistic constraint, a development of the concept that is then identical with the logical development of the matter. One need only consider how, e.g., the two premises: “pure being is absolutely contentless, and the absolutely contentless is nothing,” are laid out, grounded and clarified through in the immanent development of the concept, and one will soon discover how the syllogistic series allow themselves to be sublated. In the third place, that every logical development of content, whether it otherwise proceeds in the immanent or in the syllogistic form, must necessarily pass through a system of judgments. But a system of judgments is impossible without a corresponding system of syllogisms. What indeed is the syllogism other than the logical expression for a system of judgments, the immediate syllogism for a system of two judgments, the mediate for a system of three judgments, the chain-syllogism for a system of several judgments, etc.

¹²⁵That one may along the way have use for all four syllogistic figures, and, when it finally comes to performing feats of skill, even get occasion to apply both *Darapti* and *Bamalip*, both *Ferison* and *Fresison*, is a matter that is understood of itself.

“Many,” says Heiberg¹²⁶, “stand in the mistaken belief that when one adduces grounds in one’s discourse, these are cryptic syllogisms. But now one gives grounds, and then stands in reflection; now, when one stands in ideality, one brings forward syllogisms, but never scholastic syllogisms. When one says: “Caius is imperfect, because he is a man,” that is no syllogism. One states the ground of his imperfection. His human nature is the essence whose phenomenon is imperfection.” If these and similar misunderstandings did not hang together in the innermost way with the [329] Hegelian mystification of the judgments’ and the syllogisms’ metaphysical objectivity, we should not dwell upon them further; but there is in the manner of viewing here set up a crookedness which for the principle’s sake absolutely must be corrected. The crookedness is that the syllogisms, like the judgments, are to figure objectively at a stage where they have not even yet become subjective. If one says: “Caius is imperfect, because he is a man,” one certainly sees the imperfection grounded in human nature, insofar as one sees objectively; but the proposition: “Caius is imperfect,” is surely nevertheless a judgment, and the proposition: “Caius is a man,” likewise. In order to get sight of the syllogism, one must see to getting sight of the judgment; in order to get sight of the judgment, one must not only see objectively, but also subjectively. The grounding: “Caius is imperfect, because he is a man,” evidently rests upon the syllogism: “Caius is a man, thus imperfect,” an immediate syllogism which reflection with infinite ease transforms into a mediate one: “Every man is imperfect, Caius is a man, thus” etc.

Once it is cognized that judgment and syllogism must be determined subjectively, and thus originally presuppose a judging and syllogizing subjectivity; once it is cognized that every thought, whether it otherwise stands in “reflection” or in “ideality,” can be determined as thought only insofar as it is determined in the word by a judgment: then it will also be seen that the connection of thoughts is one with the connection of judgments, and the connection of judgments, even where the syllogistic form is not expressly brought out, essentially one with a system of immediate and mediate syllogisms.

γγ) *The immanent Syllogism: dialectical Modal Functions.* How the judgment as

¹²⁶Specul. Logik. § 148. Anm. 1.

judgment becomes form for the absolute content has already been elucidated under “Functions of the Judgment.” Since now the single judgment first obtains its significance in the connection with other judgments, and reflects the connection the more deeply the richer its content is, thus in an infinite depth when it has the idea, the absolute [330] itself, for content: it follows from this that only an infinite system of judgments will be capable of containing the absolute. But an infinite system of judgments is, when the middle terms are emphasized, *eo ipso* an infinite system of syllogisms. As the form for the absolute develops itself into a system of syllogisms, it is a matter of course that all parcelling-out and finitude must be sublated. The single premises then become moments for the corresponding syllogism, as each single syllogism becomes a moment for a relative totality of syllogisms, and each relative syllogism-totality again a moment for the totalities’ pervading total-syllogism. In order to be able to become a moment, each of the particular terms, be it premise, single syllogism or syllogism-totality, must have a particular determinate being; for the moment arises only through a disappearance of the particular determinate being. Through the reciprocal determination of the terms’ moment-being and immediate determinate being that thus sets in, the modal functions become dialectical.

Insofar as the premises of the single syllogism give up their particular determinate being and become moments in the act of syllogizing, the syllogistic is abolished: the syllogism is *immanent*. The immanent syllogism can thus be a moment in a totality of syllogisms and a syllogism-totality for itself. As the absolute’s subjective form the immanence-syllogism presents three principal sides, in that it corresponds originally to *subjectivity itself*, to the development of *subjectivity’s content* and to *the free necessity* with which subjectivity possesses its content. We consider each of these principal sides by itself.

1) *The immanent Syllogism as Form of Subjectivity itself*. That subjectivity’s absolutely original syllogism must correspond to an absolutely original judgment can be expressly demonstrated. If the schema $E-S-A$ is to hold for an original syllogism of subjectivity, then surely every one of its members have absolute originality. E, [331] the singular, cannot then signify a certain singular, this or that singular, a singular among several others, but singularity itself, singularity as principle. But singularity

as principle is selfhood: *the absolutely singular is the absolute self*. A, the general, can then for its part just as little be an abstraction of something common to many, an abstract general, for an abstract general is only a relativity; the absolutely universal is¹²⁷ infinitely concrete: *the absolutely universal in all concretions is the absolute self*.

What holds abstractly in the uttermost abstraction, namely that the infinite opposition is an infinite unity, and conversely, the same holds concretely in the completed concretion: the singular is absolutely one with the universal only by being absolutely opposed to the universal. If now the unity of the singular and the universal cannot be immediate, since it rests upon opposition, and the opposition not immediate, since it rests upon the unity: then it follows of itself that here there must be a mediation. Only by the determination of this mediation can the relation between reflection, judgment and syllogism be more closely fixed.

In reflection the absolutely singular is indeed separated from the absolutely universal; here there is posited in one and the same selfhood a thoroughgoing opposition between self and self. But this opposition vanishes again for reflection as quickly as it is posited, for the self is after all itself, from whichever side it be seen: the self-opposition is a reflex in the unity, just as the self-unity for its part is a reflex in the opposition. It is otherwise in the original judgment: that the self in the absolute sense is both subject and predicate means that the opposition of subject and predicate is just [332] as ineradicable as the unity. While reflection incessantly levels out the opposition of opposition and unity, the judgment sets itself with decisive emphasis against this all too fleeting levelling, and expressly demands the subsistence of the opposition in the totalized unity. Since now it is in an equally absolute sense a serious matter with the identity and the opposition of the members, the opposed members, the subject (the absolutely singular) and the predicate (the absolutely universal), form extremes whose middle term, S, *the absolutely particular*, shoots up out of the ground of identity. The original judgment develops with unrefusable consequence into immanent syllogism.

According to the immanent syllogism, subjectivity is at once the absolute presupposition of the original judgment and its result. The judging self cannot possibly be derived from the judgment; the judgment presupposes a judgment-act, the judgment-

¹²⁷Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 181–192.

act a judging selfhood: upon the judging selfhood rests the absolute priority of the self. But as the first logical expression of the original act of selfhood, the judgment is not directed upon this or that finite object, does not have this or that relative content; no, the original content of the judgment, of the original judgment, is subjectivity itself, the judgment-act a first absolutely necessary act of self-positing, a primitive deed whereby that which judges in the concept originally divides and apports between selfhood and otherness¹²⁸.

The judgment in which eternal subjectivity utters its essence is not, as Fichte assumes, a tautological proposition: $I = I$; such a tautological proposition is an uttermost abstraction of psychological thinking, but no *in concreto* original judgment. In the concretely original judgment the self, the absolutely singular, is as subject set over against the self, the absolutely universal, as predicate. The thoroughgoing opposition, subjectivity's self-opposition, is posited and determined by this, that the subject in the judgment is itself the judging subject and the predicate of the judgment the original concept in which the subject grasps itself as object. [333]

That the fundamental act whereby subjectivity makes itself subject and predicate, so that the predicate becomes the objectified subject, is neither an immediate self-mirroring nor an abstract reflecting, but a logical judgment, acquires decisive significance for the determination of the immanent syllogism. In order to utter its essence in the judgment, and by this utterance to separate itself into subject and object, subjectivity must necessarily hover over its own self-separation and to that extent posit itself, not merely as the *singular* in the subject of the judgment and the *universal* in the predicate, but likewise as that which in the judging selfhood is identical with subject and predicate and yet different from both, thus as the *particular*. It is by this threefold self-separation (E–A, E–S, S–A) that subjectivity transforms the original judgment of its essence into an original immanent syllogism.

¹²⁸“Das Urtheil (ἀπόφανσις, als Bestandtheil des Schlusses πρότασις = *propositio*) ist gleichsam der richterliche Bescheid, welchen das Denken über das Verhältniß zweier Begriffe ertheilt; daher ist das Wort “*urtheilen*” nicht, wie Einige behaupten, von “*Ur- und Theilen*” abzuleiten, sondern es kommt von dem mittelhochdeutschen Worte “*urteilen*”; niederdeutsch: *ordelen* (wovon “*Ordalie*”) *aussagen*, zu Recht erkennen, rechtlich entscheiden.” Drbal. Lehrbuch der propädeutischen Logik. p. 29. If it really came down, in a logic, to bringing linguistic and dialectical etymologies into agreement, it would surely not be difficult to show that “*ordelen*” is at bottom “*urtheilen*” and “*urtheilen*” “*ordelen*”.

But subjectivity's threefold self-separation, which by a continued hovering of the self-hovering selfhood can be doubled and repeated to infinity, would nevertheless sink down into an infinitely empty formalism, if there were not given here in subjectivity itself a means whereby extremes and middle could keep themselves separate in their mutual transition. But such a means is *the Word*. If the Word were not, the subjective [334] thinking, and therewith subjectivity, would eternally consume itself; if the Word were not, the immediate other of intuition would stand as an alien, inexplicable object upon which mute subjectivity would have to stare itself blind; if the Word were not, the self, the singular, would be so shone through by the particular and the universal that the pure light of reflection, the indeterminate clarity indeterminable in itself, would at last vanish into differenceless unity and lose itself in pure darkness.

By mediating between thinking and intuiting, and thus making principled self-determination possible, the Word puts the immanent syllogism into force. In the Word thinking has its elementary determinations of otherness, its infinite store of images and representations. In the actual world, in the infinite realm of the realities, there is not an object, no whole, no part, not a thing, not a property, without the Word's being able, by image and representation, to take up and render what is peculiar therein. Enriched with reflexes of all possible real determinations, the Word now has that ideality whereby in reflection it gives up its immediacy and sacrifices itself for thought so inwardly and absolutely that the thinker through the Word thinks himself in all things and all things in himself, and comprehends his subjectivity as *the absolutely universal*.

The absolutely universal is indeed a thought; but it is not a poor thought, for thought lives upon the Word, and the Word has an infinite richness. The absolutely universal is indeed, considered for itself, a word; but it is not an empty word, for the Word that nourishes thought is enriched by thought, and thought is infinitely rich.

In the thinking enriched by the Word, subjectivity comprehends itself under all three shapes, that of singularity, that of particularity and that of generality, but is nevertheless, inasmuch as the universal syllogizes itself together with the singular through the particular, as yet posited only in the one-sided form of thinking, of the universal: subjectivity is thinking. The opposition of subject and object is indeed

thought as a thoroughgoing, absolute opposition, but it is nevertheless as yet only a [335] thought opposition; the unity of subject and object is indeed thought as an absolute unity determined by the particular selfhood — at once hovering over the extremes and yet dwelling within them — but for all that it is nevertheless only a thought unity. The whole immanent syllogism has, by the one-sidedness of the thinking that thinks through all things, itself become an extreme.

Over against selfhood in its extreme of the universal there now stands, not as before the extreme of the singular, but a selfhood-extreme of the particular. This change of extremes is decisively determined by the Word. In thinking the Word is negative, its immediacy burns away in reflection; only the manifoldness of illuminations, shadings, gleams and reflexes makes up the richness of the subjectivity that thinks itself in all things and all things in itself. That reflection cannot now consume this richness and plunge subjectivity into such poverty that it looks like a shadow of abstraction, a psychological spectre of $I = I$, is prevented by the Word; for the Word, which is negative in its unity with thought, is positive in its unity with intuition. The Word must indeed sublate all sensuous immediacy and to that extent effect a transformation of all sense-images; but the pictorial elements that are consumed by thinking are transfigured in intuition and determined by the Word. Insofar as the Word is negative, the image passes through the representation over into thought; but insofar as the Word is positive by means of intuition, thought is resolved into the representation, and the representation into a transfigured image, a thought-vision, an intellectual intuition. In infinite manifoldness of visions, images and representations the intuiting subjectivity is all that it is and can be in the universal as well as in the singular, in the Word, by the Word, as the Word. By its positive side in intuition and its negative side in thinking the Word is the particular. It is not a single extreme of subjectivity, but the whole subjectivity in extremes and middle, that is transfigured by the Word. The thinking subjectivity, objectifying itself in the Word, is thus determined as *the* [336] *particular*: by means of the particular as object, the self as subject is the universal by being the singular, and the singular by being the universal.

And yet there is here still an indeterminateness, a wavering, a touch of formalism, which threatens to hollow out the syllogism and to transform the doctrine of subjectiv-

ity into logical phraseology. "How can subjectivity, as that which is particular in the Word, at one and the same time both hold itself in opposition to the singular on the one side and to the universal on the other, despite this opposition likewise be identical with the singular as well as with the universal, indeed by this identity bring it about that the singular is itself the universal, the universal the singular?" Such a question is, from the standpoint of formal logic, not merely natural but, in the present connection, perfectly justified. By insight into subjectivity and the immanent syllogism the matter can however be cleared up.

All determination of subjectivity is essentially self-determination, but a self-determination that presupposes another and is conditioned by another. That the complete determination of subjectivity assumes a threefold form has its ground precisely in this, that the determination of the other is to be resolved into the determination of the self. On the level of relativity and finitude this is now an impossibility. The determination of the other stands, in the psychological sense, as a barrier, a hindrance to self-determination. Face to face with the other, the mighty barrier, self-determination is impotent, abstract and formal. The impotence is then to be seen upon thought and word alike, for pure self-thinking is an empty reflecting, and the word a name that is capable of nothing over the object. Referred to the subjectivity that is formal and abstract in its limitation, the immanent syllogism with its extremes and middle must naturally also become formal. The difference between the self-thinking and the thought self, between the self-objectifying and the objectified subjectivity, is here a [337] difference of word, thus only a difference of name: the determinations are nominal. But when the talk is not of the psychological, but of the ontological, not of the relative, but of the absolute subjectivity, nominalism must vanish.

It is the absolute ideality of the almighty Word upon which the emphasis falls. Already in the doctrine of the idea-forming functions the thinking subjectivity was grasped as the origin of the Word, the intuiting subjectivity as the Word itself, and the subjectivity determining itself by thought and Word as the developed unity of both. But so long as the judgment had not passed over into syllogism, the knowledge-word with its ideality and the power-word with reality were still so finitely separated that power one-sidedly ran upon otherness, while knowledge ran upon self-determining

and selfhood. In the progressive development of the functions, what was one-sided in the opposition was gradually sublated; in the passage of the judgment into syllogism the ideality of knowledge and of power was expressly posited in the Word. Now that the Word thus acquires subjective, ideal significance from power and knowledge alike, its mighty ideality, capable of all things and overreaching in all things, comes to light.

What the Word determines concerning subjectivity's threefold self-separation in the threefold form of the immanent syllogism, it determines not merely on behalf of knowledge but also on behalf of power, not merely on behalf of selfhood but also on behalf of otherness: subjectivity's determination by the Word is its own absolute self-determination, for the origin of the Word is, in its opposition to the Word, identical with the Word.

If we now let *the middle term* indicate the difference between the three syllogisms of the syllogistic system, then the schema E–A–S becomes designative of subjectivity as *the absolutely universal*, E–S–A of subjectivity as *the absolutely particular*, and S–E–A of subjectivity as *the absolutely singular*. That every one of the members of the total syllogism is itself a syllogism, and every one of the particular syllogisms in turn a moment in the total syllogism, is conditioned by the Word; we shall now see how [338] the Word works as the ideality of power.

The thinking subjectivity uses the Word, as has been said, negatively. In the immediate word of knowledge and of power the ideal richness of all-existence is enclosed; but the immediacy is sacrificed to thought. What it means that the Word in the infinite thinking must be used negatively can be elucidated from yet another side. It does indeed make an essential difference whether, with such expressions as: the singular, the particular, the universal, we reflect upon the word or upon the thought. If we reflect one-sidedly upon the word, then we have here, in the singular, the particular and the universal, three different words. These three different words are, in all superficiality, three different appellations; each appellation then requires, if it is to signify anything, a peculiar representation, an intuition, an image of what is named: by the immediacy of the word we are led away from the thought over into the circuit of images, intuitions and finite representations. It is otherwise when reflection is here expressly made upon the thought, the thought made almighty by the negativity of the

Word. The three words are now three ideal power-determinations, three substantial concepts; in this sense it is with the Word as with light: we see the objects in the light and forget the rays of light; we see the thoughts in the Word and forget the appellations.

Subjectivity, the thinking One (E), receives through the Word's negative working no images, no visions, no finite representations, but an incessant vanishing of countless images, visions and representations, countless particular thoughts. In particular thoughts subjectivity posits an essential difference between the thinker, the thinking and the thought; by this difference it thinks itself particularly. The subjectivity thinking by the Word (E) and the subjectivity thought in the Word (S) now form substantial extremes; but in the negative functions of the Word, in the infinite thinking, these extremes have their essential middle. Insofar as the infinite thinking is the middle of the extremes, thus the working form in which the thinker is himself the thought, subjectivity is determined by determining itself as the infinite unity that thinks through [339] all things, that is capable of all things in thought, thus determined as *the absolutely universal* (A). The schema E–A–S is satisfied.

By the infinite self-thinking subjectivity may indeed be said to brood, sunk deep in its absolute unity; the unity is an infinite deep, but the deep is clarity: magical visions, gnostic aeons, dream-images of βυθὸς and σιγή, προπάτωρ and ἔννοια, vanish before the energy of thought in the immanent syllogism. The energy of thought is the Word's negative working. In its negative working the Word is hidden; but the hidden Word must become manifest, its negative working pass over into the positive.

The thinking subjectivity, sunk deep in itself, which keeps the Word hidden, is *the origin of the Word*. The Word does not come to the aid of thought from without; the Word that is determinative for thought is originally determined by thought itself: the Word is with necessity in thought, it is born of thought. Born of thought, the Word first acquires positive significance as word: the thinking subjectivity becomes intuiting in reflection, and the schema of the syllogism is changed into E–S–A.

With the reflected immediacy of the Word *the particular* comes into force. Thinking must indeed, as was shown above, presuppose both the particular and the singular; but in thinking as thinking the said extremes can work only negatively, through

reflexes; only when the immediate emerges from the stream of reflection, and thought is coloured by the light of intuition, does the difference break forth, and the particular come into its right. With the stamp of immediate intuitability the particular is likewise determined as the objective, the outwardly manifold; the intuiting subjectivity (E) now fixes its gaze upon the particular (S) and sees a manifoldness of visions. But they are not sense-images; they are visions in words, a multiplicity of particular judgments, that stands before the gaze of subjectivity. In each of these judgments the word is particular; the immediacy is in the subject, the reflection in the predicate: subject and predicate are determined particularly by particular words; the unity of immediacy and reflection must then also be determined by a particular word. The particular word is relative; the relativity lies in the manifoldness. By its relativity the word of selfhood has taken up otherness; to otherness objectivity attaches; the word particularized in objective determinations thus stands as subjectivity's other over against subjectivity itself: by the particular word the intuiting subjectivity itself becomes a particular (S). [340]

If subjectivity is set sharply over against the Word, then it shows itself clearly how the particular comes forth; it is not merely subjectivity that becomes particular by means of the Word, it is, in accordance with the original unity of Word and thought, just as much the Word that becomes particular by means of subjectivity. If subjectivity is in the Word *subjectively* two-sided by being itself and its other, then the Word is in subjectivity *objectively* two-sided by being itself and its other; if subjectivity, with its relative acts of thinking, particularized by relativity, is an absolute unity, then the Word, with its relative elements, particularized by relativity, is likewise an absolute unity. With its gaze fixed, not upon the Word in itself, but upon *the Word's other*, upon the word *particularized* in manifoldness and difference, the intuiting subjectivity sees only *its other*, not *itself*: the particularity is on both sides relative. By losing itself in the relative, the intuiting subjectivity would then not merely become particular over against its other in the Word, but likewise particular over against itself in the thought; the intuiting subjectivity would, in other words, not be thinking, nor the thinking intuiting; by a finite separation of thought and intuiting, the infinite subjectivity would sink down into finitude and impotence; but that is a contradiction, indeed an infinite self-contradiction.

In order to sublate the self-contradiction, the intuiting subjectivity must therefore
 [341] raise itself above the relative, transfigure thinking by intuition, intuition by thinking, and grasp itself absolutely by comprehending the Word. As subjectivity is, so is the Word; as the Word is, so is subjectivity. In the absolute Word the thinking subjectivity intuits its own image. There is in this image an objective immediacy, for the thinking subjectivity is *intuiting*; but subjectivity's image is subjectivity itself, thus a non-pictorial image, an almighty thought-image, the subjectivity objectified in the Word and as the Word. In the absolute self-objectification, therefore, thinking goes together with intuition, the general (A) together with the particular (S); herewith the syllogism has reached its completion in the form of particularity.

“But” — one might ask — “is there now also any true logical necessity that the syllogism should repeat itself in the form of singularity as well? It really does seem as though everything had already been said here that can in any way be said, from the general standpoint of subjectivity, about the immanent syllogism. If it is given from the beginning that subjectivity itself is the absolutely singular, the absolutely particular and the absolutely universal alike, then it must surely be an art as easy as it is unfruitful to transpose the three members in three different ways, to justify these transpositions calculated upon the middle term by suitable paraphrases, and to let Hegelian combinations of E, S and A step into the place of *Barbara*, *Celarent* and *Baroco*”.

It is however no empty schematism, but a clear exposition of the absolute energy of the Word and of thought, that is aimed at here in the present connection. If it came down merely to the designation, the linguistic expression, the categorical formal side, then the word energy has, in Aristotle and after him in the Neoplatonists, the Scholastics and Leibnitz, been grasped, determined and explained from many sides. But when it is not the word energy, but the energy in the Word, at the cognition of
 [342] which the aim here essentially lies, definitions, paraphrases and formal explanations will not suffice. The primitive energy of the Word, the energy in the divine Word, is determined by a unity-in-opposition of knowledge and power: in the Word and by the Word knowledge is different from power, in the Word and by the Word knowledge is identical with power. From this it follows that, when the unity is posited, the

opposition breaks forth with irresistible force: in this irresistibility is the energy; conversely, when the opposition is posited, the unity raises itself with overreaching, irresistible superiority: in this superiority the energy is seen. Since now the Word, in the absolute sense, is identical with subjectivity, the energy of the Word must likewise be the energy of subjectivity; but subjectivity's absolute energy is its absolute self-determination.

By absolute self-determination the subjectivity identical with the Word then grasps itself in all things, all things in itself, and thereby becomes absolutely determined as *the absolutely singular*. In the determination of subjectivity as the absolutely singular the Word works at once negatively and positively. It works negatively; the absolute self-determination is negative energy, for the self can be the absolutely singular only by being the absolutely universal. But since the universal in the form of thinking has its mighty opposition in the intuition of the particular, the self-determination becomes recognizable by the energy with which the negative word of thinking masters and sublates immediacy. Yet the Word can work negatively for thinking only by working, with equal energy, positively for intuition. The absolute self-determination is positive energy, for the self can be the absolutely singular only by positing itself against everything other and everything other against itself, thus only by becoming the absolutely particular. The negative energy with which subjectivity excludes the other in order to posit itself is a force-measure for the positive energy with which subjectivity posits the other in positing itself, and conversely. In energetic unity of negative and positive working, the absolute self-determining is an absolute willing: only the willing [343] subjectivity can in the proper sense be said to be *the absolutely singular*. With the absolutely singular as middle term, the immanent syllogism is developed into being the adequate form of ontological subjectivity.¹²⁹ In this form subjectivity has rest, [344]

¹²⁹“But”, the attentive reader will perhaps ask, “is this not a masked attempt to explain the Trinity, and thus to encroach upon that Church privilege of speculative dogmatics which excludes all philosophical concurrence?” We answer that the rational forms with which dogmatics, in order not to restrict itself outright to a compilation of scriptural passages, is wont to adorn its doctrine of the Trinity are all borrowed, sometimes even scraped together, from various philosophical systems. An all-sided development of the immanent syllogism as subjectivity's original form falls, on the contrary, wholly and entirely under logic; here nothing is borrowed from without, least of all from dogmatics. What in the objective doctrine of the Trinity is genuinely theological, and to that extent belongs exclusively to dogmatics, philosophy, and especially logic, will take good care not to covet. To this belong such

for extremes and middle are simultaneous; but this rest is an eternal movement, for extremes and middle are posited and transposed to infinity.

2) *The immanent syllogism as form for the content of subjectivity.* In the absolute subjectivity the content is itself absolute; the difference between subjectivity and content is thus a difference in the absolute itself, a difference between absolute and absolute. But the difference in the absolute itself is one with relativity. Since now the absolute must absolutely have the relative as an immanent determination, the difference between subjectivity and the content can rest solely upon the twofold relation in which the relative stands to the absolute: *either the relative is resolved into the absolute, or conversely the absolute into the relative.* If the relative is resolved into the absolute, then the immanent syllogism gives us, as was shown above, subjectivity itself; if on the contrary the absolute is resolved into the relative, then the syllogism gives, as shall be shown in what follows, the immanent form for the content of subjectivity.

The difference in the relative's relation to the absolute is recognizable upon every one of the members of the syllogism. That the singular, insofar as the relative is resolved into the absolute, must become subjectivity itself, has been shown; but when it is now the absolute that is resolved into the relative, what then becomes of the singular? A swarm of singulars! That the universal, insofar as the relative is resolved into the absolute, must become subjectivity itself, has been shown; but when the absolute is now resolved into the relative, what then becomes of the universal? A plurality of universals! And what, on the same terms, becomes of the particular? A multiplicity of particulars!

"dogmatic elucidations" as, e.g.: "If it can be said that the one God as it were looks into the world with three faces (τρία πρόσωπα), then it must also be said that these faces are not merely turned outward toward the world, but that they are also turned inward toward themselves, that they see themselves in mutual mirroring. Otherwise they would not be the revelation of God's true inwardness, but only deceiving masks". That is an important, a very important "dogmatic elucidation", for from it one sees that each face must, in order not to be "a deceiving mask", at one and the same time be turned both inward and outward, and consequently be a double face. In order not to have "three deceiving masks" by merely having three outward-turned faces, the Triune of dogmatics must therefore have, at the very least, six faces. Further: "the whole Trinity stands in one present Now, three eternal flames in the one light". Further: "the God revealed to himself, to whom all is revealed, *has* not an eye, but he *is* eye". Thus: the Triune of dogmatics *has* six faces, but not an eye. For he *is* eye, a triune eye: three flames in one light, six faces in one eye! To get such an eye, with such flames, in such a light, with such faces, into science — for that supernatural powers are required, indeed for that are demanded faith and *testimonium spiritus*.

In subjectivity itself, the absolute subjectivity, there is no finite difference whatever between genus, species and individual. Only with relativity does the separation come. It is relativity that in the genus effects the separation of the many species, and in each species again the separation of the many individuals. Sprung from the absolute, relativity is principled, indeed itself a principle: the principle of relativity is the principle of particularity; otherness in thought and word is the energy of the principle. [345]

If the principle of particularity did not, through otherness, work through the infinite content of subjectivity, then the subjectively objective, the differenceless universal that levels out all thoughts, all concepts and forms, would rest in infinite uniformity and condense itself into eternal darkness. But when the principle of particularity sets the universal trembling, when thought shines in the Word, and the Word, with the light of thought in the colour-gleam of relativity, disperses the darkness and opens an entrance for cognition: what visions then present themselves to intuition, what shapes will the gaze of thought then meet in the realm of the ideas? Surely it can hardly be the “playing possibilities”, “plastic prototypes”, “magical actualities” of “the speculative dogmatics”, a “heavenly host” of those “visions” which cannot be content with a “revelation *ad intra*”, but are in importunate tension to slip out and be “released to a revelation *ad extra*”? By no means! In order to see such visions, speculation in company with faith must first take in a quantum of ecclesiastical *spiritus*, for in a sober state thought sees something quite different. “Magical visions”, speculative hallucinations are not fitting for a divine subjectivity, and poorly enough for a human one. With a host of such visions individuality may perhaps become a fermenting mystic, but not a poet, still less a thinker.

The visions that arise for the poet, the prototypes that hover before the thinker, have, as influxes from the source of the ideas – however strongly the stream may run – always the distinguishing mark that they come with the Word, order themselves into thoughts and are transfigured in judgments; even in the mythical consciousness the visions must, for all their magic, subordinate themselves to the power of the Word. But visions that subordinate themselves to the power of the Word do not have the “creaturely” obtrusiveness, that apocryphal importunity, of immediately “desiring to be released into a revelation *ad extra*”; no, on the contrary! they clarify themselves [346]

precisely into revelation *ad intra*, for the word of knowledge in the deep of the ideas is revelation *ad intra*.

In the realm of the ideas, in the deep of the Godhead, there is nothing fermenting and nothing immediately being: all is determined by thought and the word, all consists in infinite reflecting, judging and syllogizing. In the infinite judging and syllogizing the three fundamental determinations that hold for the absolute totality of the content — the singular, the particular and the universal, or: the individual, the species and the genus — have the same original validity. It is necessary for the thinking subjectivity to comprehend its content in the form of the universal, since it is itself the absolutely universal; it is necessary for the intuiting subjectivity to apprehend its content in the form of the particular, since in its reflecting intuiting it is itself the particular; it is necessary, finally, for the willing subjectivity, determined by self-determining towards another, that it must represent its content to itself as articulated into nothing but determinate singulars, since it is itself the absolutely singular. The content of subjectivity is thus not parcelled out, so that one part by itself should fall under the universal, another under the particular, a third under the singular; by such a parcelling-out the Absolute would, instead of being absorbed into the relative, be lost in nothing but finite relativities. But when the whole undivided content, in itself indivisible, is to be distributed among the three forms, then the contradiction that the undivided nevertheless underlies a fundamental division can be resolved only in this way, that two of the forms alternately constitute extremes which have the third for their middle, thus only by a system of immanent syllogisms.

In the course of the system's development the movement now goes: partly from the singular through the particular to the universal, whereby the syllogism-series become categorical, and the emphasis falls upon *subsumption*; partly from the universal [347] through the particular to the singular, whereby the syllogism-series become disjunctive, and the emphasis falls upon *disjunction*; finally it is discerned what it means that the movement goes in both directions at once, so that the syllogism-series are totalized, and the decisive emphasis falls upon *individuation*.

Categorical Immanence-Syllogisms: The Subsumption-Problem. In formal logic there smoulders a remarkable conflict between reflection and the judgment, a conflict that

concerns precisely *being subsumed* under something and *being* something. According to the judgment the individual is its species, the species its genus. But according to reflection the individual cannot possibly be its species, nor the species its genus; for the species, which has a greater extension than the individual, is what the singular individual is not; the genus, which has a greater extension than the species, is by its greater extension what the species is not, and the species, which has a greater content than the genus, is by its greater content what the genus is not. For finite reflection the singular cannot possibly be the particular, any more than the particular can be the universal.

Although reflection in formal logic is otherwise eager enough to secure to the judgment its general form, that the copula *is* shall not be confused either with the verb *is* or with the reality *is*, it nevertheless reserves to itself the right to decide what meaning may lie in the copula of the judgment. The judgment reduced to its typical form says straight out: the singular is the universal; this is a horse, the individual is its species; the horse is a pachyderm, the species is its genus; but reflection assures us that it cannot possibly be meant so. The singular is not the universal, but the meaning is that it is subsumed under the universal; the individual is not species, but the meaning is that it is subsumed under the species etc.

It is characteristic that the judgment, when it literally answers to the form determined by logic itself, cannot be understood literally. Every time the judgment assumes its logical stamp, the paraphrase "*is subsumed under*" is displaced by the copula "*is*"; [348] every time reflection steps in with its explanation, "*is*" is paraphrased into "*is subsumed under*". Out of this tension there arises, then, *the subsumption-problem*.

In formal logic the subsumption-problem cannot come forward for sheer subjective reflecting; in "speculative" logic it cannot come forward for sheer objective being. From the standpoint of finitude and of one-sided concepts it is certainly a contradiction that the subject should be its predicate. Here there is indeed not merely a difference, but a *finite* difference between the singular, the particular and the universal, between thing and concept, between individual, species and genus. Now in order properly to bring out the finite difference without giving up the unity, emphasis is laid upon subsumption. It is otherwise from the standpoint of the idea. In the idea there is

indeed also difference, a pervasive difference between the individual and the species, between the species and the genus; but in the pervasive difference finitude is sublated. The individual is in an *individual* manner what the species is in a *particular*, and the genus in a *general* manner. There are no other and no more conceptual determinations in the individual than there are in the species: the identity of individual and species is absolute, the individual *is* its species. But the conceptual determinations, which in the individual are all individual, singular-moments in the singular, are in the species all particular, reflection-moments in the peculiar thought-image: the difference between individual and species is absolute, the individual *is subsumed* under its species.

As regards next the relation between the species and the genus, it might well seem at first glance as though the species contained more and consequently other determinations than the genus; but this way of looking at it has validity only for abstraction. Seen in the idea, the species has the same totality of determinations as the [349] genus; the difference rests solely upon the mode of determination.¹³⁰ In opposition to the genus as the universal, the species is the particular, and therefore the species-determinations have the form of *particularity*, the genus-determinations the form of *generality*. If we let, e.g., the categories swine, tapir, horse and elephant represent the species, and the category pachyderm the genus, then it is easy to show that the species cannot possibly contain more determinations than the genus, inasmuch as the genus, just as well as the species, is not an empty schema but a relative absolute. The horse is not a pachyderm and then something more, but the pachyderm itself in a peculiar shape. Nor, then, do the horse and the elephant stand to one another in such a way that they should have a complete likeness in being pachyderm and, alongside this, an unlikeness in the form-determinations that fell outside being pachyderm. No, the likeness is pervasive, since the unlikeness is pervasive. There is indeed a difference between the foot-form of the elephant and that of the horse, but this difference falls precisely in the genus, just because it falls in the species: the elephant's foot is the pachyderm's foot just as well as the horse's foot is. The genus is indeed different from its species in that the species are mutually different from one another; but by this difference the genus is at the same time identical with its species. If, then, reflection is

¹³⁰Cf. Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 218–20.

here directed upon the identity, the species *is* its genus; if reflection is here directed upon the difference, the species must *be subsumed under* the genus.

The double-sided relation between individual, species and genus finds its logical development and confirmation in the categorical immanence-syllogism, which we may therefore also call *the subsumption-syllogism*. When the judgment has posited abstract unity, and thereby abstract difference, between the singular and the universal, then the syllogism introduces the particular as middle term, and by this middle term reconciles subsumption with being. In this respect it makes an essential difference whether a judgment is apprehended immediately as a judgment or as a conclusum. If we say “the horse (the individual) is a pachyderm”, “the elephant (the individual) is a pachyderm”, then we are tempted to set up the two immediate judgments as premisses and to draw the inference that the horse is what the elephant is, that the horse is elephant and the elephant horse. It is otherwise, however, when each of the judgments adduced is apprehended as a concluding proposition, as a conclusum. The horse (the individual) is then not without more ado a pachyderm, but is subsumed under the genus pachyderm; the individual horse is not without more ado the species horse, but is subsumed under the species. If the individual were immediately subsumed under the genus, subsumption would one-sidedly displace being; but inasmuch as the species steps in between in such a way that the individual is subsumed under the species, and the species under the genus, being emerges out of subsumption, for the individual *is*, as we have seen, essentially its species, the species essentially its genus. [350]

The immediate judgment “the horse (the individual) is a pachyderm” is then, when we look more closely, a consequent proposition torn loose from its premisses. In reflected unity with the premisses the judgment as consequent proposition will run thus: this individual is, as horse, a pachyderm; thus, as regards the remaining judgments, this individual is, as swine, a pachyderm; this individual is, as elephant, a pachyderm, etc. But in this way the species-difference is laid into the genus. The pachyderm is not without more ado pachyderm; for the pachyderm horse is different from the pachyderm elephant, from the pachyderm swine, etc. The genus is thus identical with itself only in that it posits and deposes the species, just as the species is identical with itself only in that it posits and deposes the individual; the universal

is identical with itself only in that it posits and deposes the particular, just as the particular is identical with itself only by positing and deposing the singular. But that the genus deposes the species, and the species in turn the individual; that the universal deposes the particular, and the particular in turn the singular, is logically grounded in disjunction.

- [351] *Disjunctive Immanence-Syllogisms: The Disjunction-Problem.* Formal logic's schema: *A* is either *B* or *C*, now *A B*, thus not *C*; or: now *A* is not *C*, thus *A B* — yields a meagre return for cognition so long as it is held fast in empty abstraction. As form for the idea, the absolute content, the disjunctive syllogism acquires, on the contrary, an infinite significance. If the subject (*A*) is the universal-absolute, then the terms of the predicate (*B* and *C*) must be particular-absolutes. The particularity is expressly indicated by the disjunction: either *B* or *C*, and to that extent falls outside *A*; for *A*, immediately as *A*, is not different from itself, not a particular in itself: *A* is only what *A* is; in *A* the particular is not. And yet, according to the disjunctive judgment, the disjunction falls precisely within *A*. It is precisely *A* as *A* that is either *B* or *C*. Here the judgment is again in contradiction with reflection. In expressly saying that *A* is either *B* or *C*, the judgment presupposes that *A* is at bottom both *B* and *C*, namely in the one case *B*, in the other *C*. Made anxious by the contradiction, reflection would now gladly transform the disjunctive judgment into a mere possibility-judgment, a judgment that determines possibility by limiting and specifying its alternatives. Outside the idea, in the idealess multiplicity of empty forms, it may now indeed be much the same whether one takes the disjunctive judgment for a paraphrase of the problematic or sets it up by itself, for it is certain that disjunction itself one does not understand. Seen in the idea, disjunction is absolute, and the disjunctive judgment's difference from the problematic is recognizable precisely by the syllogism. The distinguishing mark of the disjunctive judgment is just this, that according to its original significance it forms the premiss for as many positive-negative syllogisms as the predicate contains alternating terms, an incontestable proof that disjunction is categorical. If the judgment is apprehended merely as the expression of possibility, then here, however many terms the predicate
- [352] may contain, there can be had the premiss for only a single positive syllogism. *A* is either *B* or *C* or *D*, that is to say: *A* is perhaps *B*, perhaps *C*, perhaps *D*. Whence come

the three alternatives? From uncertainty alone! The alternatives are only subjective, not objective. In an objective sense there is here only a single term; when this is posited, the rest are excluded, their nothingness has become manifest; if, conversely, the rest are excluded, then the remaining term must be posited; with this the matter is settled. The positive in the syllogism is then at once separated from the negative in such a way that, to the multiplication of the forms, two separate syllogisms arise, a positive one by the so-called *modus tollendo ponens*, and a negative one by *modus ponendo tollens*. It is otherwise in the Absolute; here disjunction is what the judgment says it is, objective, i.e. logically objective. The Absolute, undivided in itself and indivisible in the finite sense, is by the disjunction in principle separated into peculiar, mutually exclusive absolutes: either *B* or *C* or *D*; each of the particular terms has the same objective validity. The positing of every term is reflected in the negation of the rest, and conversely; therefore each term must be grasped by a positing of its own and demand a syllogism of its own. Since the positing of each single term reflects itself in the negation of the rest, each syllogism by itself is at once both negative and positive: *modus ponendo tollens* reflects itself in *modus tollendo ponens*, and conversely. In the positing *A* is *B* the negation reflects itself, thus *A* is neither *C* nor *D*; conversely, in the negation: *A* is neither *C* nor *D*, the positing reflects itself: thus *A B*.

And what, then, is the essential result of these syllogisms? nothing but categorical judgments: *A* is *B*, *A* is *C*, *A* is *D*; these judgments, resting upon disjunctive syllogisms, are now the expression of the fact that the universal is a particular.

With regard to subsumption we sought a grounding of the judgment: the particular is a universal; with regard to disjunction we have found just the reverse, namely that the universal is a particular; subsumption and disjunction still fall apart from one another, a sign that the problems are not yet completely solved. The solution of the problems is made difficult by the fact that syllogisms and general reflection-movements are only too easily confused. If we say: "All is general, the general is all", then it makes an essential difference whether what is to be thought here is a reflection-proposition or a system of syllogisms. As a reflection-proposition it is a paraphrase of the ground's first proposition, "All is at bottom one", that we have before us, and the movement corresponding to the proposition is reduction. When the outer multiplicity of existence [353]

is led back to the unity of the ground, the ground-unity is the concretely universal; but as a logical function reduction will herewith at the same time signify that the manifold is dissolved in the ground-unity, that the existent goes to the ground. It is otherwise, however, when the reflection-movement is developed into syllogism. Instead of reduction, subsumption then holds. Subsumption dissolves nothing; it preserves all: the singular does not go to the ground in the particular in order that the particular may in turn go to the ground in the universal; no, the singular is preserved in the particular in that the particular is preserved in the universal. The syllogism is essentially a syllogistic union, and the syllogistic union a categorical expression of the fact that the extremes together with their middle are completely preserved. Insofar as the syllogism "All is general" is expressly apprehended as a syllogism, the syllogism is itself a system of categorical immanence-syllogisms, indeed a system of systems to infinity. The movement from the multiplicity of the singular through the particular to the universal is a movement from periphery to centre, a syllogism-movement that in absolute knowledge can run through innumerable intermediate stages. A mere proposition such as "this (the individual horse) is a living being" already contains, when it is to be reflected as consequent proposition in its corresponding syllogism, a

[354] multitude of essential middle terms between subject and predicate: "this is a horse, the horse is a pachyderm, the pachyderm is a hoofed mammal, the hoofed mammal is a mammal, the mammal is a vertebrate, the vertebrate is an animal, the animal is an ensouled being; the ensouled being is a living being; thus: this individual is a living being". If I say: "this (the writing-desk) is an existent," what a distance does there not then seem to be here between the individual in the subject and the universal in the predicate, when we consider that *this* (the house) and *this* (the star) and *this* (the Emperor of China), in short, all individuals, things and properties, must be subsumed under the existent. If determinate being is now posited as the universal, the existent on the other hand as the designation for every determinate individual, any singular whatever, then it is easily discerned that the way from the existent (the subject) to determinate being (the predicate) is at once infinitely long and yet infinitely short; a straight and yet infinitely ramified line.

The thinking subjectivity, which has its whole content in the general, sees all the

singular at one glance, because at one glance it sees the infinite system of syllogisms in which each singular, through its middle terms, goes together with the universal.

But now it would indeed be impossible that an infinite system of syllogisms should be thinkable without a corresponding system of middle terms. What, now, is the middle term in categorical determinateness? Always a particular! Whether we choose the schema $E-S-A$ or $S-E-A$ or $E-A-S$, the middle is, in the character of middle term, always the particular, for in its difference from the extremes it reflects the extremes' relative unity. But thereby it also comes about that the extremes, in their relative unity with the middle, come to reflect their mutual difference, that the extremes, in other words, become particular themselves by virtue of the particular in the middle. But when the extremes become particular by being extremes, since the middle is particular by being middle, then in this way all the content-forms become particular: all is a particular, the particular is all. If we now confuse the syllogism with a reflection-movement, then the reflection-movement is an immanent but ambiguous conversion of reduction into deduction, and conversely. By reduction all, the singular together with the particular, is dissolved into the general; but by taking up into itself all determinations of the singular and the particular, the general must itself coalesce with the totality of particulars. But just as the universal has no other subsistence than its reflection in the particulars arising from the dissolution of the singulars, so these particulars have no other subsistence either than the reflection in the universal determined by that dissolution. The ground-reflection is a mutual dissolution. The unity of the general is dissolved and goes to the ground in the multiplicity of the particular, inasmuch as this multiplicity is dissolved and goes to the ground in the unity. To this there corresponds, then, the ground's second main proposition: "All is at bottom different." With difference the emphasis falls upon deduction, and by deduction the particular arises; but with unity the emphasis falls again upon reduction, and the particular is drowned in the ground. [355]

If pure reflection can carry it no further than to a development of the proposition that all is at bottom a particular because all is at bottom a general, and conversely, then it is at once evident that the complete determination of the particular must rest upon the syllogism. In the syllogism, i.e. in an infinite system of syllogisms, the

intuiting-reflecting subjectivity sees the particular everywhere: the general grounds itself in grounding the particular, and by virtue of the particular the singular as well. The movement that thus goes from the general through the particular to the singular, a syllogism-movement from centre to periphery, is determined by disjunction, thus by a system of systems of disjunctive syllogisms. An example: “The existent is in its
 [356] generality both a living and a non-living (A is both B and C), but in its particularity either a living or a non-living (A is either B or C). The non-living is *posited*, thus the living is *excluded*; the living is *posited*, thus the non-living is *excluded*. The living and the non-living are both, by mutual exclusion and corresponding reciprocal determination, posited as particulars. By virtue of the carried-through disjunction the universal is concluded and closed off in itself in such a way that the particular is at the same time singly concluded and closed off.”

Since disjunction in each of the particular systems must now be continued right down to the extreme of the singular (the living being is either plant or animal, the animal either mollusc or articulate or vertebrate, the vertebrate either etc. down to the individuals), we must recognize that in propositions such as “the existent is (in the present case) either a horse or an ox”, the way from the subject (the existent) to the predicate (horse) must, for the judgment’s sake, be infinitely short, and for the syllogism’s sake infinitely long.

The Totalization of the Syllogism-Systems: The Individuation-Problem. Whence, then, has the individual its first and proper origin? Realism (*univers. ante rem*) answers: from the universal, and exerts itself to whip the concepts up to such a concentration of the particular in the singular that it may look to reflection as though the individual in its immediacy really were an intellectual condensation of the universal. In opposition to realism, nominalism (*univers. post rem*) starts from the presupposition that the in itself individual, far from having any proper origin, is much rather itself the original, and then, by the aid of abstraction, gives it the appearance that it is the universal that is a derivative. The realists misuse *disjunction*, the nominalists *subsumption*: the former lose themselves in an individualization that never reaches the individual itself; the latter hold fast to an individual that must exclude every individualization. From
 [357] both sides, then, the particular too is misapprehended; for the originally particular

presupposes that the universal is just as much determined in principle by the individual as the latter is by the former, that the universal and the individual have, therefore, the same originality.

Since all three fundamental forms are equally original, and the content in each of them identical with its form, the universal, the particular and the individual must have the same absolutely ideal reality. Here there can then just as little be talk of universalizing the individual as of individualizing the universal. It follows, on the contrary, from the principle of relation that the three ideal realities must absolutely subsist by virtue of one another: the relatively universal subsists by virtue of the particular in original unity with the singular; the particular subsists by virtue of the singular in original unity with the universal, and the singular by virtue of the universal in original unity with the particular. The fully developed relation is thus syllogism. But a subsisting in syllogism is a subsisting in ideal energy, a subsisting in infinite subsumption and disjunction: the articulating reciprocal determination of subsumption and disjunction is individuation.

The individual does not come to be by finite individualization; it *does not come to be*, for it *is*. And yet the individual cannot subsist without individuation, for individuation is the completed syllogizing, and the individual subsists in eternal syllogism. Here, in the determination of the relatively absolute, there is not an individualizing activity alongside a universalizing one; for individuation, which gives the individual subsistence, at the same time gives the universal a being different from the individual and precisely thereby individual; only a ratiocination-philosophy that splashes about in words can imagine that it is really speaking of something when it speaks quite generally of the “all-universalizing”, the “all-individualizing” etc.

If now each of the fundamental forms is, by virtue of individuation, a totality [358] developed in itself which embraces the whole content of subjectivity, then the extremes and middle of the totalized syllogism must necessarily constitute *three immanent regions*, and each region by itself must in its form embrace the whole infinite system of categorical and disjunctive syllogisms. To the region of the universal there corresponds, then, subjectivity as thinking; to the region of the particular, subjectivity as reflecting-intuiting; to the region of the singular, subjectivity as willing. Just as little as the

absolute subjectivity can be said to give up its unity because its opposition of thinking, reflection-intuiting and willing separates itself into three phases, just as little can the three immanence-regions bring about a splitting of the original reason-content, as though the content were stratified and the ideal world parcelled out into heterogeneous provinces. As pervasive as the opposition is between thinking, reflecting intuiting and definitively determining willing, just as pervasive is also the opposition of the total syllogism holding for the content, according as it takes place in the region of the universal, of the particular, or of the singular.

From the standpoint of the general survey, the region of the universal may most nearly be referred to what Neoplatonism has apprehended on the one side as the pure light (τὸ φῶς), on the other side as the divine reason (ὁ νοῦς). But although the most acute among the Neoplatonists, Plotinus e.g., determined the Absolute itself as the infinite energy¹³¹, they were nevertheless not able to see through the relation between [359] “the One” and “the Reason”, since they were not yet able to discern the identity of the activity of reason with the immanent syllogism¹³².

If we refer “the first being” (οὐσία), the “in itself reposing” ground-energy (ἐνέργεια ἐστῶσα), to the syllogism-region of the universal, then we easily find the expression for the absolute unity, exalted above all particular determinations, in the thinking selfhood, the subjectivity identical with itself in all thinking. The self that thinks its content thinks, by the negative functions of the word, the singular and the individual just as sharply and distinctly as either the particular or the universal. The thinking self thinks, by its negatively determining word, the totality of all syllogism-systems through all individuations in all directions, without the multiplicity in the least degree either infecting or weakening the original unity. It is precisely the transparency of

¹³¹Εἰ οὖν τελειότερον ἡ ἐνέργεια τῆς οὐσίας, τελειότατον δὲ τὸ πρῶτον, πρῶτον ἂν ἐνέργεια εἴη· ἐνεργήσας οὖν ἤδη ἐστὶ τοῦτο, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν ὡς πρὶν γενέσθαι ἤν· ὅτε γὰρ οὐκ ἦν πρὶν γενέσθαι, ἀλλ’ ἤδη πᾶς ἦν. Ἐνέργεια δὲ οὐ δουλεύουσα οὐσίᾳ, καθαρῶς ἐστὶν ἐλευθέρα· καὶ οὕτως αὐτὸς παρ’ αὐτοῦ αὐτός. Πλωτῖνος. Cf. Kirchner. Die Philosophie des Plotin. Halle 1854. p. 35–46.

¹³²“Aus der reinen Einheit geht zunächst der Geist des Universums hervor, dem alle einzelnen Geister entspringen ... Das erste Sein (οὐσία) und die erste Thätigkeit (ἐνέργεια) lebt er in ruhender That (ἐνέργεια ἐστῶσα), in sich ruhend, aber um jenes sich bewegend (ἐνεργῶν). Man darf die göttliche Vernunft nicht mit der menschlichen verwechseln, die einem äußeren Sein gegenübersteht. Es ist von keiner Vernunft die Rede, die durch Berechnungen und Schlüsse zur Wahrheit gelangt, sondern von der, die Alles hat und Alles ist und ewig bei sich selbst bleibt”. Kirchner. Anf. Skr. p. 46.

terms and syllogisms corresponding to the syllogism-energy that in this region makes the realm of reason an eternal realm of light.

If we next refer “the unfolding of the highest unity”, in which the Neoplatonists place the origin of “the ideas”, to the region of the particular, then we become able to exchange the veiled, figurative and half-mystical intimations for pure logical determinations. To the intuiting-reflecting gaze every determination presents itself with necessity as a particular. To speak of the particular’s stepping out of the universal, of [360] the separation of the coloured rays out of the pure light, of the passage of the uniform into the multiform (τὸ ποικίλον), is to speak of thinking’s passage into reflecting intuiting, a passage that takes place by the word, inasmuch as the word exchanges the negative functions for positive ones. The immediacy of intuition that thereby arises introduces into reflection precisely that tinge of finitude in which the Neoplatonists saw a characteristic difference between an intellectual matter (ὕλη νοητή) and a multiplicity of changing forms¹³³.

Under the region of particularity there belong now genera and species (γένη and εἶδη). This is, however, not to be understood as though it were an indeterminate multiplicity of “visions” and “plastic prototypes” that involuntarily emerged out of the eternally billowing sea of the reflections; no, individuation’s determinate difference between genus and species is in all genera and in all species an express syllogism-determination. By the syllogism-determination the individual is everywhere present in the species, since the species is present in the genus; the peculiar individual (the individually particular) syllogizes itself together, by virtue of the species (the particular in the special sense), with the genus (the particularly universal).

That the Neoplatonists with Plato take the ideas (εἶδη) for “archetypes”, and that Plotinus with Aristotle regards every εἶδος as an individual essentiality (οὐσία), can in a certain sense be approved; but the fundamental error is that the individual essentialities are apprehended in a merely immediate and therefore superficial manner. [361] The conception is equally superficial whether with Plato we let these essences rest

¹³³ Among the several passages occurring in Plotinus which Kirchner adduces, the following (Anf. Skr. p. 48) is especially characteristic: Εἰ οὖν πολλὰ τὰ εἶδη, κοινὸν μὲν τι ἐν αὐτοῖς ἀνάγκη εἶναι, καὶ δὴ καὶ ἴδιον, ᾧ διαφέρει ἄλλο ἄλλον. Τοῦτο δὲ τὸ ἴδιον καὶ ἡ διαφορὰ ἢ χωρίζουσα ἢ οἰκεία ἐστὶ μορφή· εἰ δὲ μορφή, ἔστι καὶ τὸ μορφούμενον, περὶ ὃ ἡ διαφορὰ. Ἔστιν ἄρα καὶ ὕλη ἢ τὴν μορφήν δεχομένη καὶ αἰεὶ τὸ ὑποκείμενον.

in eternal unconditionedness, or with Aristotle lose ourselves in a forming of matter. In order to master its matter the forming essence must at the same time hover above the matter. The singular essence hovering above its matter cannot be determined individually without being determined particularly; cannot be determined particularly as species without being determined particularly as genus; cannot at one and the same time be determined as individual, species and genus except by an immanent syllogism.

If we finally bring the whole content of subjectivity under the region of singularity, the region of the individual, then it must become properly evident to us what individuation originally has to signify. Neoplatonic reflection does not, so far as the principle is concerned, get beyond εἶδος; but εἶδος belongs essentially to particularity: Neoplatonism does not reach punctual determinateness, but remains in speculation. It is a resolute step on Herbart's part that, in order to get out of speculation without entangling himself in the metaphysical contradictions of empiricism, he lays "the reals" at the foundation, and by this punctuality means to secure for himself the absolutely individual. But as intellectual atoms the reals are themselves burdened with contradictions far too glaring for them to be able to render the immanence-syllogism superfluous. Leibniz with his monads is, so far as individuation is concerned, plainly the one who comes nearest to the true. The monad is really an individual which, instead of excluding the species and the genus, has on the contrary drawn the genus and the species into itself: the region of singularity may to that extent well be conceived as a region of monads. The willing subjectivity is, through the definitive opposition of the determinate self and the determinate other, *exactly representing*; the representations, the ideal objects of the absolute positings, undeniably look like monads.

But as pure products of representation without species and genera the monads can [362] neither be thought nor intuited. If the monad is to be thought, it must be absolutely determined as the universal. The monad is then according to its concept one in all; the monadic is in all monads like itself. The disjunction: A is either B or C or D, must be transformed into: A is either A₁ or A₂ or A₃, for A₁ is as monad essentially identical with A₂ and with A₃. The disjunction is *thought*; but since the difference remains at the negative, particularity cannot come forward in particular. That the disjunctive judgment becomes premise for a syllogism, that A by exclusion of A₂

and A_3 is expressly posited as A_1 ; by exclusion of A_1 and A_3 as A_2 ; and by exclusion of A_1 and A_2 as A_3 ; that thus A_1 , A_2 and A_3 can all be subsumed under A , shows however that the subsumption is likewise *thought*. The thought subsumption is just as negative a determining as the thought disjunction; the individual is a negation of the universal, because the universal is a negation of the individual. But when all monadic determinations are negative, since they are thought and as thought essentially universal, then the thought monad is itself negative in all individuations: *the monad is the universal; the universal is monad*.

If the monad is made an object for reflecting intuiting, then the particular comes especially into force. The disjunction: A is either B or C or D , transforms itself into an expression for an articulation of particularity: S (the monad in its particularity) is either S_1 or S_2 or S_3 . The particular within particularity, or the express difference between S_1 , S_2 and S_3 , now at the same time gives the subsumption its peculiar significance: S , the generally particular, under which S_1 , S_2 and S_3 , the specially particular, are subsumed, is determined as genus: *the monad is genus, the genus is monad*; the specially particular are at the same time determined as species: *the monad is species, the species is monad*.

If finally the monad through original representing is expressly determined monadically, then it is a matter of course that the monad as individual has subsistence only [363] through the monad as species and the monad as genus. For absolute representing presupposes reflecting intuiting with the same necessity with which it presupposes universal thinking. If it is necessary that the monad be represented, then it is also necessary that it be reflected; thus: if it is necessary that it be conceived as individual, then it is also necessary that it be conceived as species and genus. Individual, species and genus are monadically different and monadically identical in one and the same syllogism. But just as monadic difference maintains itself in the extreme of the individual by means of the acts of representation, the absolute positings of the willing subjectivity, so monadic identity maintains itself in the extreme of the universal by means of thinking, the system of subjectivity's negative functions.

The monad as the individual and the monad as the universal thus constitute two regions; but the two regions are extremes which have the monad in the form of particularity for their middle. Truth, individuation carried through, lies just as little in

the extremes by themselves as in the isolated middle, just as little in the individual by itself as in the particular or in the universal; the truth in the content of subjectivity is identical with the truth in subjectivity itself, for truth is a syllogism, a syllogism totalized in systems of syllogisms.

3) *The immanent Syllogism as Form of free Necessity.* In individuation the reciprocal determination of selfhood and otherness has found a characteristic expression. All individual determining is originally self-determining; but all self-determining is in turn a determining of other by other. If reflection here falls upon selfhood, then the individual determination is an expression of *freedom*; if reflection here falls upon otherness, the individual determination is an expression of *necessity*. Just as free-
[364] dom corresponds essentially to subjectivity, because it mirrors selfhood, so necessity corresponds to objectivity, because it corresponds to otherness.

Insofar as we here look to what is subjective in thought, judging and syllogizing, weight is here laid upon self-determination, and thereby upon freedom. Insofar as we here look to the content of the thought, the judgment and the syllogism, thus to that by which thought, judgment and syllogism are essentially determined, we here look to the objective, thus to necessity. So long as the necessity by which the thinking subjectivity is originally determined, and the freedom with which subjectivity in all thinking determines itself, are not cognized in their origin in principle, the relation between the Godhead and the ideas will not be able to be cleared up.

When Plato in aesthetic naïveté now speaks of God as having created the ideas, now again lets the creating God look to the ideas as to eternal prototypes, then by the first expression freedom, by the last necessity, is indicated;¹³⁴ but when the higher unity of necessity and freedom is explained to the effect that freedom persuades necessity, then the logical fails. By his naïve utterances Plato has indicated a problem upon whose solution philosophy can only begin to work when it has grasped it in its whole depth. In the Middle Ages the problem acquired a special significance in the

¹³⁴Plato, or rather the Platonic Socrates, sometimes expresses himself in such a way that God must be assumed to have created the ideas. Ζωγράφος δὴ, κλινοποιός, θεός, τρεῖς οὗτοι ἐπιστάται τρισὶν εἵδεσι κλινῶν. Ὁ μὲν δὴ θεός, εἴτε οὐκ ἐβούλετο, εἴτε τις ἀνάγκη ἐπὶ μὴ πλέον ἢ μίαν ἐν τῇ φύσει ἀπεργάσασθαι αὐτὸν κλίνην, οὕτως ἐποίησε μίαν μόνον αὐτὴν ἐκείνην ὃ ἔστι κλίνη. *Platonis Dialogi Lipsiæ MDCCCLX. Πολιτείας* I, p. 290. On the other hand in *Τίμαιος* (cited edition p. 333): εἰ μὲν δὴ καλός ἐστιν ὁδε ὁ κόσμος ὃ τε δημιουργὸς ἀγαθός, δῆλον ὡς πρὸς τὸ αἰδίων ἔβλεπεν.

Schoolmen's dispute over the relation between the idea of the good and the divine will. According to the Thomistic proposition: *Deus vult, quia bonum est*, it is the idea that determines the will, the objective that moves subjectivity, necessity that is the ground of freedom; according to the Scotistic proposition: *Bonum est, quia Deus vult*, it is conversely the will that determines the idea, subjectivity that governs the objective, freedom that dissolves necessity. How the problem even in the most recent times moves through ethics and the philosophy of religion is seen among other things from the way in which Feuerbach has set idea and God against one another. Instead of making, e.g., the idea of justice a predicate of God as subject, one ought, according to Feuerbach's direction, to make the divine the predicate and the idea of justice the subject; instead of the religious judgment: "God is just," one ought to posit the ethical judgment: "Justice is divine." Not only in ethics and the philosophy of religion, but in aesthetics too the problem must come forward, when the question of the reality of beauty is to be answered in the last instance. But that the problem stirs so strongly in the more concrete spheres of the doctrine of ideas contains precisely a summons to investigate its origin in logic; for if it is to be solved from the ground up *in concreto*, it must first have been solved *in abstracto*. [365]

That the opposition in principle between freedom and necessity has its logical origin in the opposition between the thinker and the thought, between the subjective and the objective in thinking's own essence, cannot be doubted. All thinking presupposes with necessity a thinking subjectivity; but the thinking subjectivity must then also with necessity think something. If now the thinker becomes in this way just as dependent on the thought as the thought on the thinker, then the reciprocal dependence and with it necessity does indeed seem to be the original; but the necessity so formed is the preformation of freedom. The logical essence of subjectivity is thought; the thinker determines in all thoughts and in all thinking essentially himself: every act of thinking is originally an act of freedom. The thought has indeed objectivity and in objectivity necessity; but what is objective in the thought is so far from weighing upon the thought that it is on the contrary a vehicle for the energy of thinking and thereby for freedom. [366]

Although freedom is just as essentially different from necessity as the subjective

is different from the objective, yet neither has freedom any finite limit in necessity, nor necessity in freedom. Everything happens originally with freedom, because everything happens with necessity, and conversely. Every thought in which subjectivity posits its freedom has as conclusion its necessary premise in an already presupposed thought, and thereby comes to lean upon necessity. The presupposed thought, which exercises the power of necessity over the one that follows, is itself a product of freedom conditioned by a preceding necessity. Seen immediately, the premise is free, the conclusion necessary; but since every premise in the infinite circuit is itself conclusion, and every conclusion premise, freedom is in every syllogism the subjective moment of necessity, necessity the objective moment of freedom: necessity is free, freedom necessary.

That the immanent syllogism is the adequate form of free necessity (*libera necessitas*) is now to be known by this, that it is able to express the absolute opposition of freedom and necessity in absolute identity. The reconciliation of the absolute opposition with its corresponding identity can, according to what has preceded with us, just as little be sought in an immediate being as in a finite becoming; everything depends on the energy with which movement and rest infinitely presuppose and sublate one another.

In this idea-movement the various systems of syllogisms belonging under “relation,” the hypothetical, categorical and disjunctive, can enter. From the standpoint of the [367] absolute, in which subjectivity itself penetrates its content, the hypothetical syllogism will serve to exhibit the relation between necessity and freedom. “If A is B, then C must be D,” by this judgment the judging subjectivity has acknowledged necessity and yet reserved freedom to itself. The reservation lies in the antecedent; how far the antecedent is to be assumed depends exclusively on how far subjectivity itself will posit it. The syllogism’s *p. minor*: “Now A is B, thus” ... designates an act of judgment which begins with freedom and ends with necessity. The determination of the individual, the non-necessary, is in the realm of ideas an unconditional act of freedom; that this act of freedom in turn yields an element for necessity is seen from this, that the premise which expresses freedom acquires significance only through that in the conclusion which expresses necessity.

It is the relation between subjectivity and its content that is to be more closely determined by the idea-movement. Insofar as the movement goes from self to self within subjectivity, from the self, the universal, from the self, the particular, from the self, the singular, and back through the doubling of the middle, the movement is central: in the central movement necessity is a moment for freedom. Insofar, on the other hand, as the movement takes place in the content, freedom is a moment for necessity. The movement in the content is, like the central movement, threefold: a movement from the center (the region of the universal) through middle and periphery back to the center; a movement from the middle (the region of the particular) through center and periphery back to the middle; finally a movement from the periphery (the region of the singular) through center and middle back to the periphery. Under these movements disjunction and subsumption alternate with one another infinitely. The movement from the center through the middle to the periphery takes place by disjunction — in systems of disjunctive syllogisms; the movement from the periphery through the middle to the center takes place by subsumption — in systems of categorical syllogisms. The movement from middle through center to periphery and from periphery through center [368] to middle brings with it a crossing of individuations in the most various directions.

By making the immanence-syllogism the form of free necessity or, what in this connection is the same, of necessity's unity with freedom, we have, superficially regarded, done nothing but develop a form for forms, a form of forms; for freedom is indeed form just as much as necessity. It can then be emphasized once more that the logical development of form must always yield a logical development of content; every pervasive determination of form is in the absolute itself a determination of content.

That necessity and freedom are two mutually opposed forms of the absolute is, in other words, to say that the absolute as the necessary and the free is originally opposed to itself; that a unity-form for necessity and freedom is here sought then acquires the significance that a unity-form is here sought for one and the same, self-opposed content. What this means becomes properly evident to us when we now, instead of treating the content from the side of form, reverse the relation and treat the form from the side of content, instead of letting the content reflect itself in the form, let the form reflect itself in the content.

When the form, the absolute form, is reflected in its absolute content, we have the idea. If the question is raised: is the idea essentially form or content? still more distinctly: is the idea the content which has the absolute for its form, or is perhaps the absolute the content which has the idea for its form? then it is at once noticed that a finite separation of form and content is here impossible. If the idea as idea is to be absolutely content, then it transforms itself into form; if it is to be absolutely form, then it transforms itself into content. If we grasp the idea as content in the form, the [369] three fundamental movements in the preceding development of form will give us the idea in the shape of three fundamental ideas: *truth, beauty, goodness*.

It is then in the first place evident that the form-movement in its syllogism from center to center, from the universal through the particular and singular to the universal, $A-(S, E)-A$, must give us the content of the idea in the form of generality and necessity, thus *the idea of truth*.

It is in the second place evident that the form-movement in its syllogism from middle to middle, from the particular through the singular and universal to the particular, $S-(E, A)-S$, must give us the singular transfigured in the universal and the universal individualized in the singular; an equilibrium of the free and the necessary so reflected in particularity that the free is necessary and the necessary free then corresponds categorically to *the idea of beauty*.

It is in the third place evident that the form-movement in its syllogism from periphery to periphery, from the singular through the universal and particular to the singular, $E-(A, S)-E$, must give us the absolute content in the overarching form of singularity, of self-determination and freedom, thus the will-idea, freedom itself, the *idea of the good*.

How adequately the syllogism corresponding to the first fundamental movement corresponds precisely to the idea of truth must strike the eye. That truth is one, that it has its essence in the universal, the necessary, the eternal, is generally acknowledged. But it is then also generally acknowledged that everything has its truth, that there are many and many kinds of truths, that eternal truth is not empty, but infinitely rich in content. It is likewise acknowledged that truth, although it rests in eternal being and governs everything with the irresistible power of necessity, nevertheless enters

into the temporal, involves itself with what is becoming; for when everything in all eternity has its truth, then time, becoming and what is becoming must also have their truth. It is finally acknowledged that truth, though in essence unlimited, yet has an actual limit in untruth, illusion, the lie, etc. [370]

These heterogeneous determinations all allow themselves to be reconciled and brought into agreement in the syllogism. In showing how the universal itself, by developing the particular and singular as middle, divides into extremes, the syllogism shows at the same time what it means that from the one absolute truth manifold relative truths can proceed, and that these relative truths, held fast each by itself immediately and finitely, can become untruths, illusions, deceptions and the like.

It is in the particular and singular that truth has its infinite wealth of determinations of content. Thus every special science develops truth from its own side, in its peculiar system of cognitions. But from the standpoint of finitude it is impossible to get beyond the separation of extremes and middle. The movement does indeed take place from the universal through the singular and particular to the universal; but the middle remains standing in outward independence; the extremes do not allow themselves to be joined together in a syllogism. The universal, which constitutes the first extreme and from which one sets out, is conceived in hovering intuitions, empty abstraction-concepts, with which one proceeds to the investigation of facts and phenomena, thus of the singular. The intuition of the singular is then to be resolved into its particular determinations, so that these particular determinations may in turn be taken up into the universal; the movement takes place from periphery to center: the method is *analytic*. But the singular and particular do not allow themselves to be resolved; the universal, which is the goal of the endeavor, remains standing as a last extreme; the goal, the concretely universal, is reached only in an approximation. The universal thus attained can next be held fast in its generality as a first foundation, the last extreme can be made the first. The particular and singular are then anticipated in this first foundation in such a way that the universal by inner self-division can yield, enclose and hold together its content's heterogeneous parts; the movement goes from center to periphery: the method is *synthetic*¹³⁵. [371]

¹³⁵In essential agreement with the Hegelian model Heiberg (Speculativ Logik. Prosaiske Skrifter.

[372] The opposition between analytic and synthetic method remains in reflection and cannot be raised to immanent syllogism; it belongs to finitude and does not reach the absolute. That the analytic method has the idea only in approximation is recognizable from the disproportion in which the individual, according to this method, comes to stand to the particular and the universal. The individual with which one here begins is an immediately concrete existence, a thing with many properties. What now does the analysis do? It exchanges the thing for its concept, and determines the concept by a definition. The thing, that which immediately exists, falls however outside the concept, as the antilogical falls outside the logical; even if the universal determinations won by the analysis correspond exactly to the singular determinations in that which exists, there is still here a yawning chasm between existence and concept: existence is sensuous and concrete; the concept is intellectual and abstract.

That the thing, the individual, is by abstraction separated from its concept is expressly seen from the definition. For it is not the individual but the particular, not the

Første Bind. p. 354–62) has sharply and aptly set forth analytic and synthetic cognition of the idea, namely under the presupposition that the one who cognizes is not a divine but a human subjectivity.

“Cognition, as life’s renewed immediacy, is itself immediate in its beginning, namely as *intuition*, and thus stands under the schema of the first (immediate) syllogism, E–S–A, whose significance is that the subject, by means of cognition, is joined together with objective truth. ... But the immediacy of intuition must, like every other, be sublated in its opposite, which is its dialectical development. Hereby arises *analytic cognition*, which stands under the schema of the second syllogism, S–E–A, whose significance is that cognition itself, by means of the subject, is joined together with objective truth or the general; i.e., that the cognizing subject makes its cognition an object, or places itself between its cognition and the latter’s object, and in this position sees the object joined together with cognition. This happens by *analyzing* cognition, i.e., by means of separation and abstraction bringing it into the form of the abstract-general. The form thus attained is *the definition*, at which analytic cognition remains standing, as at its goal.”

“The immediate certainty, contained in intuition, of the subject’s identity with the object in cognition is sublated in the analysis, where the subject, as the connecting middle between its cognition and the latter’s object, thereby at the same time separates these, so that their union takes place merely in the subject. The sublation of the immediate certainty has only the determination of being itself sublated, and of returning to its origin. This happens in synthetic cognition, which stands under the schema of the third syllogism, E–A–S, whose significance is that the object itself is the uniting middle which joins the subject together with its cognition. Just as, therefore, analytic cognition is the dissolution of itself into the form of the abstract-general, so synthetic cognition goes the opposite way, and brings the abstract into the form of the concrete; i.e., it constructs the object which the analysis regarded as given. And just as analytic cognition ends with the definition, so synthetic cognition begins with it.”

The defect of this presentation, however, is that it is not shown here how it becomes possible for the cognizing subjectivity to complete either the analysis or the synthesis and by this completion to appropriate the content of the idea.

thing but the concept, that is defined. In the definition's *genus proximum* and *differentia specifica* the relation between the universal and the particular is indeed reflected, insofar as the concept is determined as species, and the species as individualized genus; but since the genus is an abstractum, and the species, instead of appearing particularly as middle term between the genus and the individual, sinks down to a [373] logical mark appended to the concept of the genus: the definition cannot appear as syllogism, but takes on the character of an *identical judgment* in the proper sense¹³⁶.

That the synthetic method for its part is likewise unable to vanquish finitude and [374] appropriate the idea is equally evident. If the analytic method, far from mastering the subsumption and reaching from the individual through the particular to the concretely universal in the system of syllogisms, entangles itself in abstraction and ends with the definition: then the synthetic method begins with the definition, not with the concretely universal in the system of syllogisms, moves not through disjunctions in principle but through formal divisions, and thus reaches not the individuals, the concrete existences, but only theorems and formal proofs. The definition, which was to determine the *universal*, falls outside the division, which was to give the *particular*; the division in turn falls outside the theorem, and an immanent total syllogism shows

¹³⁶Heiberg in his speculative logic (Pros. Skr. 1ste Bind p. 356) has indeed endeavored to determine the definition as a syllogism; but the endeavor ends in much ambiguity, since he even three times changes his standpoint. First it is said that the definition, just as much as the judgment, must not be "regarded merely subjectively, as a human operation of thought, but objectively." Nonetheless it is still to be "the cognizing subject" which, even when the definition is objective, constitutes the middle term of the syllogism. "Just as every thing is a judgment, a syllogism and a system of syllogisms, so too every thing is a definition in the cognizing subject, namely a subsumption of the particular under the general, by means of the singular; i.e., cognition's subsumption under the abstract-general, by means of the cognizing subject." This way of looking at it is then finally altered to the effect that "the cognizing subject" drops away as middle term and the singular is represented by "the sublation of the subsumption"; the whole explanation ends, despite the careful exemplification, in something altogether inexplicable. "Furthermore," so runs the explanation, "it is by means of its singularity that the particular is subsumed under the general, so that the definition is in itself a syllogism standing under the schema of the second figure: S-E-A. Every definition therefore has three members: 1) that which is to be defined, S; 2) the subsumption under the general, A; and 3) the sublation of this subsumption, in that it is determined as singularity, E ... E.g. the definition: 'Man is a rational being,' contains the three members: 1) man; 2) a being (subsumption under the general); 3) but a being which is rational (sublation of the subsumption, in that the general is determined as singular)." The obscurity could hardly be greater. For how now does the singular in the sublation of the subsumption stand related to the singular as the cognizing subject? Are there here, in the sublation of the subsumption, two singulars or only one? How can "the general be determined as the singular" in the predicate, and the predicate become identical with the subject, when the subject itself is not the singular but the particular?

itself to be impossible.

In that finite knowledge, whichever way it otherwise prefers, the analytic or the synthetic, misses the necessary, pervasive reciprocal determination of individual, species and genus, it misses the truth and entangles itself in an untruth. If truth is determined as the necessary unity of thinking and being, concept and reality, then this unity must itself be expressly determined as syllogism-unity. The Aristotelian denial of the ideal independence of genera and species deviates just as much from the truth as the Platonic hypostatizing. There are indeed species and genera which do not have eternal validity (the species: whirlwind, of the genus: wind; the species: sandheap, of the genus: heap); but what does that prove? That the individuals corresponding to such species and genera (this whirlwind, this sandheap) likewise do not have eternal original validity! Seen in the light of the idea, individual, species and genus have the same necessity, though in different form, the same independence, though in different regions. Every idea is with necessity individual, species and genus in absolute opposition, and precisely therefore individual, species and genus in absolute [375] unity: the self-unity of the idea is an immanent syllogism-unity.

That the individual has its necessity in species and genus, the species its necessity in individual and genus, the genus its necessity in individual and species, is a proof of freedom's unity with rational necessity, and of this unity's original unity with truth. For freedom shows itself in this, that each of the syllogism's members preserves its independence; but since the independence of the extremes is one with the independent middle, and conversely: the reciprocal independence is identical with the reciprocal dependence, and freedom is posited as a moment in necessity. Upon freedom's complete merging into necessity truth depends.

But upon what then does untruth depend? Untruth can assume very different forms. It can show itself nominalistically in this, that an unconditional independence is ascribed to the individual and to what is individual at the expense of the species and the genus; it can show itself realistically in this, that genera and species obtain independence at the expense of the individuals; it can show itself in an overvaluation of thinking at the expense of intuition, of intuiting reflecting at the expense of representation, etc. But what especially dazzles and confuses finite subjectivity is attendant

representations of sensuous immediacy, of finite existential determinateness.

By mixing in attendant representations of the sensuously concrete and the intellectually abstract, finite knowledge is constantly entangled in the illusion that the individual is temporal and only the universal eternal, that individuals must perish and only the species, the genera or still more universal essence-forms endure. Hereby arises an intolerable conflict between the actual and the true. The individual is the actual; but the individual is in actuality perishable, and the actual to that extent something untrue. The universal (the species, the genus, etc.) is in essence the imperishable and to that extent the true. But the universal does not exist; it has its being in thought, [376] not in actuality: the true is thus not actual, and the actual not true; so hard is the contradiction.

In the immanent syllogism, by contrast, the individual and the particular are enclosed from both sides by the universal. With the singular and the particular as middle term, the idea of truth forms out of its universal two extremes whose syllogistic union is precisely the true concrete unity; in this way truth gains power over actuality: all the moments of actuality receive their truth.

Just as the universal would be one-sided and untrue if in the immanent syllogism it did not expressly have the particular as its opposite, so the idea of truth, the idea of essential objectivity, would itself become one-sided and untrue if it did not have the idea of beauty, the idea of phenomenal objectivity, as its absolute opposite. That the absolute opposition must be grounded upon absolute unity will in the present connection further become evident from this, that the idea of beauty is true only by being opposed to the idea of truth.

From two sides, namely, the idea of beauty becomes obscured, in that it either straightway melts together with truth and loses itself in necessity, or by immediate freedom is separated from truth and abandoned to contingency. The Neoplatonists, Plotinus in particular, identify the principle of beauty with beauty itself, the beauty exalted above all beautiful forms, a beauty which nevertheless cannot itself be beautiful, since it is different from the beautiful. "That which gives beauty is itself without shape; for what we call shape is something in itself formless which has received form, and

[377] thus has a share in beauty, but is not itself beauty”.¹³⁷ It is, in other words, the thought beauty, beauty in the form of truth, that is here posited as the highest. But when it is now the idea as truth, not specifically as beauty, that gives beauty, so that “having a share in beauty” must become the same as having a share in truth: how then does the principle of beauty stand to the beautiful shape? As the shape is formed there must, besides the form, be something that receives the form, namely the matter. If the matter were not formed, the shape could not come forth; but matter as matter stands in a contingent relation to the *determinate* form, and of course also to the *beautiful* form. There must then, according to the Neoplatonic view, be something contingent in the beautiful shape; but since something contingent steps in between the beautiful shape and the principle, beauty itself has sunk down into the contingent and therewith into the perishable.

“Macht’ ich doch, sagte der Gott, nur das Vergängliche schön”. These words, with which the poet lets Zeus console “perishable beauty”, contain an essential violation of the idea of beauty. Only earthly beauty, the beauty which in the changing phenomena must engage itself with the material and the contingent, can be perishable; the idea of beauty itself cannot possibly be perishable. The element of otherness which beauty originally demands cannot fall outside the idea; it must with necessity be a moment inherent in the idea itself. And yet reflecting intuiting posits an essential difference between self-determination and determination by another. The original unity of idea [378] and shape which expresses beauty is precisely a reflected unity of self-determination and determination by another, a reflected unity of freedom and necessity; a reflected unity so thoroughgoing that reflection itself dissolves into transfigured immediacy. The shape must be determined, for the idea of beauty must have its shape; if the determination is abstract self-determination, then the shape is arbitrary; if it is *in abstracto* a determination by another, then the shape is contingent. Against arbitrariness and contingency stands necessity. In the separation of the abstractly arbitrary, the abstractly contingent and the abstractly necessary, reflection is made finite; in the

¹³⁷ Ἀρχὴ δὲ τὸ ἀνείδεον, τὸ μὴ μορφῆς δεόμενον, ἀλλ’ ἀφ’ οὗ πᾶσα μορφή νοερά. Καὶ τὸ κάλλος αὐτοῦ ἄλλον τρόπον καὶ κάλλος ὑπὲρ κάλλος· οὐδὲν γὰρ ὄν τί κάλλος; ἐράσμιον δὲ ὄν τὸ γεννῶν ἂν εἴη τὸ κάλλος. Δύναμις οὖν παντὸς καλοῦ ἄνθος ἐστὶ κάλλους καλλοποιόν. Plotin. Cf. Kirchner. Anfr. Skr. p. 36–39.

finitized reflection unbeauty is seen, but in unbeauty the particular is again seen.

The unbeautiful and the beautiful have thus this in common, that they both rest upon the particular. There is a particularity which is unbeautiful, since it falls outside the idea, and a particularity which is beautiful, since it expresses the original unity of idea and shape and is thus identical with the idea. That the particular expresses the idea is conditioned by this, that the actual and the contingent dissolve into the necessary; by this dissolution freedom comes forth: the idea-shape is determined with freedom, since it is determined with necessity.

When there is talk of beautiful objects (a beautiful horse, a beautiful flower, a beautiful woman), it is easily seen that there is here no talk of different phenomena which each for itself have their share in one and the same beauty, but of different species of beauty. And yet beauty in all that is beautiful must surely be like itself: how then does beauty stand to the different species of beauty? Every philosophical system which remains in reflection without reaching the syllogism must certainly declare this problem insoluble. For an object to be able to be called beautiful there is required, in the first place, that it be an individual reflection of its species, for the species is its prototype; in the second place, that the species itself must have unambiguous [379] determinateness in opposition to other species, and thus be a typical individuation of the genus. Unbeauty can in this respect come forth in two ways: partly in that the individual stands in an aesthetic disproportion to the species (a deformity), partly in that the species itself is an aesthetic ambiguity (a toad).

That the many species of beauty are now assumed to be particular revelations of beauty itself, the one and same beauty, reflection in its one-sidedness apprehends in such a way that beauty is absorbed by truth, freedom by necessity. That the different species of beauty step forth independently as particular types, divine prototypes, the reflection that is unsure of the syllogism interprets in such a way that intuition has set itself up against thought, that the beauty which is identical with truth wants to separate itself from truth. The separation can moreover take place in two ways: either in that the divine prototypes are assumed to be eternal beings, independent in themselves, and the liberation of the particular must then rest upon an eternal contingency; or in that the Godhead, absolute subjectivity, arbitrarily determines the

particular types: “God creates the ideas”, so that the liberation is arbitrary.

These abstractions and contradictions disappear when the idea is expressly apprehended as syllogism. In the syllogism, not in the immanent syllogism of thinking but in that of intuition, the gaze is fixed in particular upon the particular, and the particular expressly determined as idea-shape, as type (παράδειγμα).

The idea-shape is with necessity; for the universal and the individual must — this is the idea’s inescapable demand — reflect themselves in the shape in such a way that the universal, with the individual as its moment, becomes genus (γένος), the individual, with the universal as moment, becomes species (εἶδος), and the species the middle in which the universal is syllogistically united with the individual. In this respect it holds that subjectivity does not arbitrarily produce, but originally intuits, [380] the eternal types determinate in themselves (δῆλον ὡς πρὸς τὸ αἰδίον ἔβλεπεν).

But the idea-shape is then also with freedom. The idea can take on the form of intuition only in that subjectivity intuits; but the intuiting subjectivity can be determined to the intuition of another by another only in determining itself. In countless intuitions, thus in countless shapes, the universal can unite syllogistically with the individual. Why now precisely in *this*, and not in another shape? Here there is not first a shape objective in itself, independent of intuiting, by which the intuiting subjectivity “has to direct itself”; no, the validity of the form is objective only insofar as it is subjective; the necessity with which the idea-shape is intuited is originally determined by intuition itself, thus by subjectivity, thus by freedom (οὕτως ἐποίησε μίαν μόνον αὐτὴν ἐκείνην).

The immanent syllogism is the free and yet necessary form in which the subjectivity that intuits the particular produces and preserves the eternal types of beauty.

As regards, finally, the third fundamental movement, the movement from the singular through the particular and the universal back to the singular, thus from periphery through middle and center to periphery, it shall now be shown that the syllogism corresponding to it is a will-syllogism which originally determines the idea of the good.

The willing self must absolutely will something; since selfhood is determined as will, and the will as the subjectively singular, otherness is with that determined as the

will's content, the content again as sheer ideal objects, a multiplicity of objectively singular things. Since the beginning is here made from the periphery, the beginning is made here with the hard opposition of singular against singular, of the willing self against the object of the will. The hardness in the opposition is to be apprehended from two sides. Insofar as the represented object of the will stands against the will, it falls outside the will and remains standing as an insurmountable barrier. Over against [381] the barrier the will is empty, and the empty will impotent. Insofar as the object of the will, by contrast, is posited and determined by the will itself, it falls under the will and cannot possibly hold itself up as a barrier. The barrierless will, unrestricted in itself, now determines its content singly in each single case, as it itself wills; the will's content, the good, is then from this standpoint absolutely determined by an absolute arbitrariness: *bonum est, quia Deus vult*.

But absolute arbitrariness is, when we look more closely at it, an intolerable contradiction. The power of arbitrariness was to show itself precisely in this, that the will which masters all barriers expressly posits and determines the objectively singular, and does with this whatever it wills. It is the will that in its absolute arbitrariness gives its content objective determinate being in the objectively singular; it is the will that in its absolute arbitrariness can recall this singular and make it into nothing. What follows now from this? From this follows with inescapable consequence that the singular has no objective validity; that the will, by consuming its objective opposite in all single objects, consumes its content and feeds upon itself. Absolute arbitrariness, which was to be an expression of the will's omnipotence, becomes, essentially regarded, an expression of its impotence.

In order that the contradiction may be resolved, the willing self must grasp itself as thinking. Since willing goes together with thinking, the thinking will becomes an objective universal will, a will which in each and all lets the content's own essential development hold good. But the content's essential development is a development in the form of thinking; in the completed form of thinking the objective content is by the immanent syllogism absolutely determined as truth. It is thus truth that takes on the form of the will, since the universal will takes on the form of thinking. In the form of thinking the universal will is of course absolutely determined by its content,

[382] for the content is expressly posited as the content of truth. From this standpoint it is thus by no means the will that arbitrarily determines the good, but conversely the good that essentially determines the good will: *Deus vult, quia bonum est*.

That this resolution of the contradiction is nevertheless also unsatisfactory is equally striking whether we consider first the content of the good or its form. As regards the content, the good is straightway exchanged for the true, since the will, as regards the form, has straightway become exchanged for thinking: the universal will is a pure thought-will. As thought-will the will is contemplative and theoretical; the contemplative essence of the theoretical will is recognizable in this, that instead of determining its content it lets itself, point for point, be determined by the content. But a will whose universal determining consists in letting itself be determined is a passive, will-less will, thus a will which is no will. By veiling the contradiction one can nevertheless still make an apparent advance, by letting the will, after it has by virtue of its unity with thinking become universal will, at the same time by virtue of its unity with intuition become a particular will. It is then in this way not only the idea of truth but also the idea of beauty that is immediately apprehended as a will-idea and made one with the good.

The illogical amalgamating of the true, the beautiful and the good is in general characteristically marked by an aesthetically superficial apprehension of divine wisdom. Not enough that the Greeks in all naivety identified the beautiful with the good (καλοκἀγαθία); “speculative dogmatics” continues still, in its logical impotence, to do the same. “What speculation calls the idea, the world-forming thought, is designated in Holy Scripture as the wisdom that played eternally before the countenance of the Most High, and in which he had his delight. And it is described not merely as an
[383] inner mirror-image in God, but also as the effecting, the all-forming thought. For wisdom (the idea, the divine Sophia, the heavenly Virgin, as the Theosophists have called it) is the *master-workwoman* of all things” etc. “The forming thought”, which points toward the idea of truth, “the heavenly Virgin”, which points toward the idea of beauty, “wisdom”, which points toward “an infinite purpose of will”, thus toward the idea of the good — these eternal hands on the clock of logic “Christian speculation” rakes together, in the most Christian of meanings, into one box.

By emphasizing the will's unity with thinking and intuiting, so much is nevertheless already won, that the objectively singular, the will's ideal object, can now form the middle term in which the willing subjectivity¹³⁸ lets the universal unite syllogistically with the particular. Since the middle term, the objectively singular, is by the will itself determined as its express object, the two extremes, thinking's universal and intuition's particular, are with that determined as the objective content of the thinking and intuiting will. By the extremes necessity is then determined, by the middle freedom is determined; by the syllogism itself the unity is determined, the unity decisive for the idea of the good, the unity of necessity with freedom in the form [384] of freedom.

β) Objective Syllogism: Modal Functions of Power.

It was shown in "the Logic of Subjectivity" from various sides that the Hegelian "syllogism" was too objective to be subjective, and again too subjective to be objective. The fundamental error was: 1) that the difference between the singular, the particular and the universal was posited and sublated in an altogether too fleeting and just therefore superficial manner;¹³⁹ 2) that the extremes' unity mediated by the middle term was apprehended as a unity of being, instead of being apprehended as an essence-unity determined by thinking and effecting, i.e. as a movement-unity;¹⁴⁰ 3) that, since every regard for the energy of movement was lacking, no true difference could be shown between the syllogism in the ideal system, the ontologically subjective syllogism, and the syllogism in the real system, the ontologically objective syllogism,¹⁴¹ so that the completion of the syllogism in teleology received only a schematic, not a

¹³⁸The logical-ontological opposition of the three fundamental ideas: the true, the beautiful and the good, is of decisive significance for life as well as for science. If the idea of truth did not have its independence over against the good, science would never be in a position to assert for itself a principle independent of the practical view of life; if the idea of the good did not have unconditional self-validity in opposition to the idea of truth, ethics and religion could not possibly assert for themselves a particular principle independent of science. The Middle Ages held to the principle of faith and cowed science; it made the idea of truth straightway dependent upon the idea of the good: that was barbaric. The present age goes to the opposite extreme; it holds to science and wants by the means of knowledge to dissolve faith; it makes without further ado the idea of the good dependent upon the idea of truth: the latter misunderstanding is just as striking as the former.

¹³⁹Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 530–32.

¹⁴⁰Anfr. Skr. p. 216.

¹⁴¹Anfr. Skr. p. 224.

significance essential for the content.¹⁴² The result was that the character of the terms and their mutual relation had to be stated, in each sphere and for each system, in a manner exactly corresponding to the energy of the functions.¹⁴³

In the present connection, where the task is to illuminate the objective syllogism from the standpoint of the logical functions, the objection to the objectivity of the Hegelian syllogism will essentially run thus: that the character of the objectification is overlooked and the function missed. The Hegelian proposition: *All is a syllogism*, [385] lets itself in an immediate objective sense be defended just as little as the proposition that *All is a judgment*. To be sure, the existing object is a judgment insofar as it is in essence a word of power; but thus it shows itself only when its immediate objectivity is again objectified: the logical functions of the word of power are all functions of a doubled objectification. For the immediate objectification the objects in their actual relations and connections are facts, not concepts and judgments, still less syllogisms. By the doubled objectification the objects become objective judgments, antilogical propositions in the categorical power-language: to the categorical power-language, the system of objective judgments, correspond the interpreting functions.

That the objective syllogisms can as little as the objective judgments be apprehended and determined without a doubling of objectification and the functions corresponding to such a doubling, is a matter of course, and lets itself be shown without difficulty. When the objective syllogism, as with Hegel, is to be apprehended exclusively from the standpoint of being and determined by indicative functions, it sinks down into an empty schema, a schema whose objective significance comes moreover to rest upon subjective reflection; whereas the system of the three syllogisms, even with the form to which it is restricted in the Hegelian logic, receives essential significance when it is borne, not by indicative, but by explicative and interpreting functions. We shall illustrate this by examples.

Of what he calls the product of the formal mechanical process Hegel expresses himself in the following way: “*Unmittelbar ist das Objekt vorausgesetzt als Einzelnes, ferner als Besonderes gegen andere, drittens aber als Gleichgültiges gegen seine Besonderheit, als Allgemeines. Das Produkt ist jene vorausgesetzte Totalität des Begriffes nun*

¹⁴² Anfr. Skr. p. 224–28.

¹⁴³ Anfr. Skr. p. 433–34.

als eine *gesetzte*. Er ist der *Schlußsatz*, worin das mitgetheilte Allgemeine durch die Besonderheit des Objekts mit der Einzelheit zusammengeschlossen ist; aber zugleich [386] ist in der Ruhe die *Vermittelung* als eine solche gesetzt, die sich *aufgehoben* hat, oder daß das Produkt gegen dieß sein Bestimmwerden gleichgültig und die erhaltene Bestimmtheit eine äußerliche an ihm ist”.¹⁴⁴

It is now easy to show how this utterance changes its character according as it is indicative, explicative or interpreting functions upon which it is assumed to rest. If one starts out from Hegel’s own presupposition, that “the product of the mechanical process” is to be held fast in immediate objectivity, then such an object is in antilogical actuality an external object, not a word of power, not a judgment, still less a syllogism. As existing object the object is wholly indifferent to the process whose product it is posited to be. First the object is presented as though its existence rested upon a mediation expressed in a syllogism; next it is presented as a product indifferent to this mediation, thus as an object whose existence is indifferent to the alleged syllogism. The mechanical object is thus a syllogism in the sense that it is no syllogism; what is crying in this contradiction is only muffled by the ambiguous turn: “aber zugleich ist in der Ruhe die *Vermittelung* als eine solche gesetzt, die sich *aufgehoben* hat.” If the ambiguity is to be removed, then the old confusion of objective movement of the matter with subjective movement of thought shows itself again. That a mechanical object comes forth as the product of a mechanical process, an aggregate e.g. of a process of aggregation, is logically in order; just as it is then also in order that such a process can be at a standstill when the product is finished, and “the mediation” in this rest be to that extent posited as one that “has sublated itself”. But this does not concern at all the process of which there is talk here. The mechanical process, which [387] is here to count as an objective syllogism, is so entirely a subjective thought-process that it concerns the intellectual element in the objectification, without in any way concerning the actual object.

If, by contrast, the object’s concept is set against the object, so that reflection is expressly directed upon the concept, then the functions become explicative, and then the Hegelian interpretation will also show itself in a better light. What is said

¹⁴⁴Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. p. 189.

straightway of the mechanical object, that it is “*presupposed* as a singular”, that it is “as a particular against others”, that it “as indifferent to this particularity is a general”, are really three chief sides of the mechanical object’s concept, and the comprehending subjectivity, which applies the concept’s measure to the object itself, is from this standpoint then also quite rightly called upon to let the concept’s three chief sides separate with an immediacy corresponding to “mechanism”, and thereupon to let the chief sides thus separated unite syllogistically as two extremes with a middle, and to that extent to give a syllogism corresponding to the object’s concept, thus an objective syllogism. But the concept of the syllogism in this syllogism cannot notwithstanding be completed unless reflection is expressly directed upon the satisfaction which the concept cognized in the syllogistic union of the extremes affords the comprehending subjectivity, i.e. unless subjectivity knows its comprehending of the given object to be identical with the comprehending that produces the object, and thus through the object corresponds with the producing subjectivity; but on these conditions the functions become interpreting.

The original connection between the objective syllogism and the interpreting functions becomes still more evident when we, instead of a mechanical formal process, choose a chemical one for treatment. If an objective syllogism requires only a syllogistic union of two extremes with a middle, every chemical process will be able to serve as
 [388] an example. If oxygen is the negative and hydrogen the positive extreme, then their affinity is the essential middle, and water the product which marks the completed syllogism. In this way the chemical process is interpreted by Hegel: “Er (der Proceß) beginnt mit der Voraussetzung, daß die gespannten Objekte, so sehr sie es gegen sich selbst, es zunächst eben damit gegen einander sind; — ein Verhältniß, welches ihre *Verwandtschaft* heißt ... Die Mitte, wodurch nun diese Extreme zusammengeschlossen werden, ist *erstlich* die *ansichseyende* Natur beider, der ganze beide in sich haltende Begriff. Aber *zweitens*, da sie in der Existenz gegen einander stehen, so ist ihre absolute Einheit auch ein *unterschieden* von ihnen *existirendes*, noch formales Element; das Element der Mittheilung (Hegel is thinking here in particular of water) ... Das Verhältniß der Objekte ist als bloße Mittheilung in diesem Elemente einer Seits ein ruhiges Zusammengehen, aber anderer Seits ebenso sehr ein *negatives Verhalten*, indem

der konkrete Begriff, welcher ihre Natur ist, in der Mittheilung in Realität gesetzt, hiermit die *realen Unterschiede* der Objekte zu seiner Einheit reducirt werden".¹⁴⁵

But however much value one must set upon the dialectical development of the concept which runs through this whole part of the Hegelian logic, it is in the first place evident that it rests upon explicative functions; its deviation from the development of the matter can be seen by looking to the presentation that is given in chemistry. Next it is obvious that the result of the chemical process cannot possibly be presented as a syllogism (Conclusum) so long as the development of the concept does not go beyond the merely explicative. For the chemical product to be transformed into a syllogism, it must expressly be presupposed that the result is anticipated in its presuppositions, that it comes forth as something originally intended, that the process with its extremes and middle first, upon the attainment of the result, shows itself in its proper significance; [389] but with this apprehension the syllogism becomes teleological, and the functions interpreting.

The movement of the concept in Hegel's logic from "mechanism" through "chemism" to "teleology" exhibits an interesting mixture of the true and the false, insofar as it rests upon a confounding of movement of the matter, objective movement of the concept and movement in subjective comprehending, thus, as regards the activity of thought, upon a confounding of indicative, explicative and interpreting functions. The presentation of "chemism" closes with the following words: "Der Begriff, welcher hiermit alle Momente seines objektiven Daseyns als äußerliche aufgehoben und in seine einfache Einheit gesetzt hat, ist dadurch von der objektiven Aeüßerlichkeit vollständig befreit, auf welche er sich nur als eine unwesentliche Realität bezieht; dieser objektive freie Begriff ist der Zweck".¹⁴⁶ Can there be any clearer utterance of the fact that the movement of the matter in chemism has been, not a real movement, but a movement of the concept, and the whole understanding built upon explicative functions? The presentation of teleology begins thus: "Wo Zweckmäßigkeit wahrgenommen wird, wird ein Verstand als Urheber derselben angenommen, für den Zweck also die eigene, freie Existenz des Begriffes gefordert".¹⁴⁷ Can there be any

¹⁴⁵Wissenschaft der Logik. Zweiter Theil. p. 202–203.

¹⁴⁶Anfr. Skr. p. 208.

¹⁴⁷Anfr. Skr. p. 209.

clearer utterance of the fact that understanding of the purpose in things rests upon an understanding of the understanding that produces things, that thus the functions decisive for teleology are interpreting? Here there are not first a couple of systems of objective, mechanical and chemical syllogisms which in an immanently objective manner form the transition to and complete themselves in teleology. No, the matter stands the other way round! Here the beginning is made at the lower stages with a tacit exchange of the object's objectification for a corresponding objectification of the [390] object's concept, thus with an exchange of indicative functions for explicative. By explicative functions, since attention is constantly fixed upon the concept-object, the thinker then discovers in the mechanical and chemical processes, not indeed proper syllogisms, for syllogisms in the proper sense presuppose a judging and syllogizing subjectivity, but yet something that resembles syllogisms, namely syllogistic unions of extremes with a middle; by pursuing these syllogism-analogies with increasing emphasis upon the concept-objects and the corresponding explications, the thinker at length reaches a turning point, when a light dawns upon him and it becomes clear what the concept of the objective syllogism properly is: that it is the end, the aim, the intention that gives the objective syllogistic union of the extremes the stamp of a syllogism. With his gaze fixed upon the intention and "the purposive", the thinker finally makes the discovery that what his understanding has been occupied with in all the lower instances is not the actual object, not even the object's objective concept for itself, but the concept's original meaning, the divine understanding that utters itself in concept and object: every objective syllogism is without difference teleological.

With this presupposition we shall then in what follows develop the objective syllogism's *formal concept, its relation to the word of power and to the categorical power-language*.

αα) The Formal Concept of the Objective Syllogism.

The difference between the subjective and the objective syllogism is originally determined by the difference between functions of knowledge and functions of power. The objective syllogism is determined by objective judgments, the objective judgments by the categorical power-language. The functions of the subjective syllogism are all indicative; the difference between indicative, explicative and interpreting functions, a

difference determined by judgment and object, can first receive its full significance in the objective syllogism. Here the indicative functions then correspond to the first [391] immediate objectification, the objectification whereby the object is apprehended as object; to the doubled objectification, the objectification whereby the object's concept becomes object, namely intellectual object, there correspond the explicative functions: by the explicative functions there arises a system of objective judgments. Finally, inasmuch as the objectification goes determiningly back upon the objectifying subjectivity, which seeks not merely the concept in the fact, but in the fact's concept the original meaning, it appears that the functions of the objective syllogism are essentially interpreting.

If one overlooks the peculiar character of the functions as interpreting, then it shall not be possible to exhibit a single example of a true objective syllogism. Let one choose the solar system, the relation between soul and body, the state with its citizens, government and laws, in short whatever example one will: so long as the chosen example is treated immediately objectively, i.e. so long as one looks immediately at the existing terms and the relations obtaining among them, it will be impossible to get beyond categories such as whole and parts, cause, effect and reciprocal action. Here, in the reciprocity of the factors, there are no objective judgments, and where there are no objective judgments, there are no objective syllogisms either. The highest one brings it to is to exhibit a totalized unity-in-opposition, a reciprocal action of three totalities, in which the one totality furnishes the unity when the two others form the extremes.¹⁴⁸

¹⁴⁸Trendelenburg makes several apt remarks with respect to Hegel's examples; as regards in particular the state as a system of three syllogisms, he says: "Nach dieser Ansicht wächst das Ganze dadurch kräftig zusammen, daß das Besondere, Einzelne und Allgemeine wechselsweise und gegenseitig Grund und Folge wird. Daß sich die Thätigkeiten des Ganzen und der Theile innig durchdringen, das bildet allerdings die Selbsterhaltung des organischen Ganzen. Will man die zusammenwirkenden Glieder das Allgemeine, Besondere und Einzelne nennen: so hat auch das im Sprachgebrauche einen Grund. Aber man verwirrt die Sache, wenn man das Analogon eines Schlusses bildet" (Logische Untersuchungen. Zweiter Band. p. 278–79). But when he then sets about giving an account of wherein the unsatisfactory element really consists, he plainly goes astray. He makes the syllogism, namely, into so typical a form that no union of extremes and middle deserves the name of syllogism unless it be in every way arranged according to the rules for a syllogism. That the state now cannot become a syllogism is evident, "denn die Bedürfnisse sind nicht als Art der Allgemeinheit des Staates, noch die einzelnen Bürger als Individuen oder Art eines Geschlechts den Bedürfnissen subsumirt". For the same reason the end with its means cannot be conceived as a syllogism either. "Im Zwecke ... soll das Mittel den *terminus medius* bilden,

[392] From the standpoint of the interpreting functions it will on the contrary appear that any example whatsoever, be it at first glance ever so unfavorable, provided only
 [393] it can furnish two extremes and a middle, lets itself be conceived as an objective syllogism. We choose one of the examples Trendelenburg has employed against Hegel. Let sulphuric acid and lime be the *terminus medius*, thus the particular, whereby the universal, the concept gypsum, closes itself together with the singular, the existence gypsum. Here, be it noted, no proof is to be given that gypsum is now also in a finite sense an objective syllogism; here it is only to be shown what it means to consider the formation of gypsum under the point of view of syllogism. From the teleological standpoint of the interpreting functions the existence gypsum is then expressly conceived as the product upon whose formation the preceding formation of sulphuric acid and lime is laid out; *the meaning* of the sulphuric acid and the lime is to be sought in the gypsum. In the concept the gypsum is anticipated; with this anticipation the beginning has taken place. The beginning is the syllogism's first premise; for the concept of the gypsum could not possibly be determined unless the determination of sulphuric acid and lime were included in the anticipation. Sulphuric acid and lime in particular existence now furnish a middle, not in an abstract objective sense, but in virtue of the relation in which the particularly existent are set on the one side to the determinate beginning, on the other side to the end, the attainment of the result, the actualization of the anticipated concept. The concept occurs here three times and in three different ways: 1) as anticipated concept, the universal, the concept in subjective possibility, 2) as concept in the objective elements, the particular, the concept in objective possibility, and 3) as realized concept, the singular. It is, according to what has preceded, incontrovertible that every concept which is to be realized must

durch den sich die subjective Vorstellung mit der Objectivität zusammenschließt. Die drei Termini des Schlusses wären in einem einfachen Beispiele: deutlich sehen wollen das eine Extrem, das optische Glas der Mittelbegriff, das wirkliche deutliche Bild das andere Extrem. Mag man hier vergleichungsweise sagen, daß sich das Subject mit der objectiven Welt, der es seinen Zweck abgewinnt oder einbildet, zusammenschließt: dies Bündniß ist noch kein logischer Schluß. Wie will man in den genannten drei Terminis das deutlich sehen dem optischen Glas als den Umfang dem Inhalt unterordnen? oder gar das wirkliche deutliche Bild den deutlich sehen wollen so subsumiren, wie sonst der Unterbegriff in den logischen Umfang des Oberbegriffs fällt? Man kann doch die wirkliche Ausführung nicht als eine Art der vorgestellten betrachten. Wenn der reale Schluß, wie er von Hegel in die Objectivität eingeführt ist, wirklich dem logischen entspräche: so müßte er sich in die vollständige Form eines Syllogismus fassen lassen" (Anf. Skr. p. 276).

pass through these three phases.

No concept can be realized immediately. Were a concept to be realized immediately, it would have to happen in one of two ways: either its subjective being in the anticipation would have to be transformed, by an absolute power-language, thus without conditions and middle terms, into objectively actual determinate being, which would then presuppose a miracle; or the concept would have to begin, without any [394] anticipation, by being so sunk into the objective elements that it was realized in blind objectivity, and came forth solely as result, as immediate product. But the product is as product only object, not concept. As result of the union of the sulphuric acid with the lime the gypsum is a chemical product, a salt; but this salt is in its immediacy no concept. In order that the concept may come to light in the gypsum, the gypsum as the product of the union must reflect itself in the union itself and in the united constituents; in this reflection subjectivity, and with subjectivity the concept determining the constituents and their union, shines through: only on the presupposition that there is here a concept determining in subjective form, and that the elements subjected to the conceptual determination have objective existence, can there be any question of a concept's realization.

But if decisive emphasis is now laid on this, that it is the anticipated concept, determined by the anticipation and determining its objective elements by a system of executive functions, that is realized, then the realization is thereby at once determined as syllogism. The objective in the syllogism is that the process ceases, that it comes to an end, that a result appears; the subjective, which determines the process of realization as a concept-movement and gives it the stamp of a syllogism-act, is that the subjective concept meets itself in the objective product; through the middle the end goes back to its beginning; here there is no interruption, but a completed circuit, a realized purpose, a syllogism. How closely akin the objective syllogism is to the actual closure, and this again to the attained aim, can even be seen from turns of speech such as: "when the end is good, then everything is good", *respice finem*, and the like. In these turns of speech sound sense has with vigorous one-sidedness emphasized now the objective, now the subjective side, and precisely thereby shown that the matter [395] must be seen from both sides. As regards the first saying, the objective may indeed be

emphasized so immediately that the good end which makes everything good becomes an adventurous occurrence, a happy outcome which suddenly brings those sorely tried to forget all adversities. But such an end, such an outcome is only a play of chance, a whim of fate, but no syllogism. That there is here no syllogism, but only an interruption, a stoppage, an arbitrary end, is evident from the objective as well as from the subjective side. Objectively regarded, the lack of syllogism is recognizable in this, that the interruption of the misfortunes can itself be interrupted again, and the happy end show itself as the beginning of new misfortunes. Subjectively regarded, the lack of syllogism is recognizable in this, that there is here no concept, no plan, that is realized. If the end is in truth to be good and to make everything good, then it must in development and explanation correspond to its middle and beginning; it must then, in other words, be a syllogism. For what indeed is the beginning? The anticipated concept! And the middle? The concept's objective elements! And the end? The concept realized in the elements! In the actualization of the concept the closure is a syllogism-act, an ideal power-act, a logical-antilogical act of the syllogizing subjectivity.

Since the syllogism, the true objective syllogism, is to gather and unite what is scattered in its middle and laid out in its beginning, it is seen from this that in poetry as well as in actuality it must belong among the great tasks to reach a syllogism. In what relation of dependence the true syllogism must stand to the true beginning is discerned from the well-known turns of speech: "Well begun is half done"; "a good beginning never gets a bad end", and the like. It is precisely the remarkable thing about these turns of speech that when they are taken from the side of finitude and regarded superficially, they are only half-true, indeed even untrue. In finite existence beginning, middle and end fall, precisely in consequence of the parcelling-out characteristic of finitude, so far apart from one another that the beginning may, as it is said, promise well, and yet in the course of the matter most sorrowful accidents may occur, just as in the morning it may promise to become fine weather, and yet, when noon comes, the sky may be overcast, and the day end with storm and tempest. When the relation between the end and the beginning is on the contrary seen from the side of essence, as in an objective syllogism, the turn of speech is perfectly true; the beginning is in the

objective syllogism nothing other than the anticipated end. In the result determined by its presupposition, in the end preformed by its beginning, nothing can come forth but what the presupposition and the beginning themselves contain. The good beginning is the disposition toward the good end; if the disposition is developed, if the beginning reaches through the middle to the syllogism, the end must absolutely become good: it is in this sense literally true that a good beginning can never get a bad end.

In the turn of speech *quidquid agis, prudenter agas, et respice finem* the word *finis*, like the Greek *τέλος* as well, means at one and the same time both end and purpose. But that the end is purpose, and the realized purpose end, means precisely that the end is syllogism, and the syllogism teleological. There are thus not, as Hegel assumes, abstractly objective, mechanical and chemical syllogisms which, themselves falling outside the teleological, are to introduce teleology; for every syllogism, however objective it may be in its facts, is yet syllogism only by virtue of the subjective and teleological in the syllogism-act itself.

If we now, after these elucidations, set the objective syllogism beside the subjective, the difference and opposition between them is so prominent that the way in which Hegel has sought to maintain their identity must be regarded as untenable. Nonetheless there is here in the opposition a unity; it is a unity-in-opposition of knowledge and power, to which we are again referred. Just as the functions of the subjective syllogism have their ground in a knowledge identical with ideal power, so the functions of the objective syllogism have their ground in a power identical with knowledge. The subjective syllogism-act is a theoretical thought-act with premises of logical judgments; the objective syllogism-act is, from the standpoint of the producing subjectivity, a practical thought-act with antilogical judgments for premises. From the standpoint of the contemplating subjectivity the syllogism expressed in the production is determined by interpreting functions. In the subjective syllogism what matters is a mediate knowledge of the concept expressed in the consequent proposition of the premises: the subjective syllogism is exclusively theoretical. The objective syllogism, on the contrary, is of both practical and theoretical significance. For the producing subjectivity the syllogism is practical, for the contemplating, on the contrary, theoretical: absolutely understood, the producing subjectivity must be contemplating,

the contemplating producing. It is the mediate actualization of the anticipated concept on which everything practically, and an insight into this actualization on which everything theoretically, depends.

In the features adduced the opposition has been emphasized; it will now be a question how far the identity lets itself be exhibited on the ground of this opposition. The task is to investigate how far the subjective syllogism lets itself be brought under determinations that originally hold for the objective, and conversely.

The point of view of the objective syllogism is, as we have seen, decisively teleological; this point of view can in a formal sense hold for the subjective syllogism as well. If the connection of subject and predicate in the consequent proposition is set as a task, then the solution of this task is indeed the syllogism's purpose, and the whole way of viewing it to that extent teleological. If it is asked here, to keep to the [398] hackneyed example, whether the subject Cajus lets itself be united with the predicate mortal, then the premises are means, the consequent proposition end. But this is, as said, only formal.

The point of view of the subjective syllogism is decisively logical, and by reduction to its finite schema syllogistic. The logical and syllogistic is recognized, particularly in the categorical syllogism, by this, that the subject in each of the premises is subsumed under its predicate, so that the consequent proposition becomes a necessary expression of the unity of the double subsumption. That the subject Cajus is subsumed under the predicate mortal is an expression of this, that Cajus is subsumed under that (man) which is subsumed under mortal. The question now is whether such a system of subsumptions also fits the objective syllogism. By the application of explicative and interpreting functions it will do well enough. In the formation of the gypsum the determinate salt-species (the gypsum) closes itself together with the genus (oxygen salt), $S-E-A$; but since the premises are antilogical, the subsumption must take place in reverse order. According to the first premise of the realization, the genus can be actualized only in its species; the actualized species is thus to be subsumed under an actualization of the genus. According to the second premise of the realization, the species can be actualized only in its individuals; the actual individual (the specimen of gypsum) is thus to be subsumed under an actualization of the species. Syllogistically:

a realization of the gypsum-concept is a particular realization of the universal salt-concept; in the actual gypsum the gypsum-concept is realized; thus: in the actual gypsum the universal salt-concept is realized in a peculiar manner. Practically: first the genus-concept, then the species-concept, and then the actualization of the concept!

Forced and far-fetched as this conception is, it yet shows this much, that one cannot, as formal logic is so inclined to do, delimit subsumption in a mechanical manner. If I conceive, e.g., the proposition: gypsum is a chemical combination of sulphuric acid and lime, as a definition of gypsum, then the predicate has indeed no greater extension than the subject, and to that extent there can here be no question of [399] subsumption; but the proposition can also be seen from another point of view; I can, namely, conceive the gypsum in a singular representation by itself, and regard the combination of the sulphuric acid with the lime as one of many possible combinations, thus as the particular. Finally, there is then nothing either to hinder the combination particularized in the concept from being set over against its actualization in such a way that the actualization is seen as the general, under which not merely the combination of lime and sulphuric acid, but all chemical combinations, if it is true that they are to count for more than possibilities, must be subsumed. But when this has been discerned, it shall for the rest be conceded that, just as the teleological point of view is inadequate for the subjective, syllogistic syllogism, which lacks the objective intermediate determinations, so the syllogistic subsumption is forced and inadequate for the objective syllogism, specially grounded in objective elements.

If the objective syllogism is conceived not from the contemplating but from the producing subjectivity's point of view, then its premises become antilogical judgments. The gypsum, as anticipated concept *the universal*, is then determined by the peculiar combination of the sulphur, the oxygen and the calcium metal, *the particular*; this combination is in turn determined by its actualization into *the singular*, the existing gypsum. Yet in this respect too there is no lack of analogy with the subjective syllogism. The subjective syllogism is, namely, as we have seen, conditioned not merely by the subsumption, but also by the disjunction. *A*, the universal, is either *B* or *C*, the particular — for the particularity lies in the still undecided reciprocal determination; by negative determination, i.e. by excluding the one term: *A* is not *D*, the particularity

becomes restricted and thus individualized into the singular: thus A, the universal, is C, the singular in its existing.

[400] If the antilogical movement could not be reproduced logically, there could be no objective syllogism; the objective syllogism-act must necessarily reflect itself subjectively in the producing subjectivity, but the subjective reflection hovering over the production is logical. If the logical movement could not be reproduced antilogically, the transition from the theoretical to the practical functions, from functions of knowledge to functions of power, would be impossible. In the anticipation everything is logical, and yet all logical determinations are so antilogically turned that what is really antilogical in the execution is, as regards movements and transitions, preformed in the logical. Here, in the master-workman's knowledge, there is not a series of merely logical judgments beside or running parallel with a series of antilogical ones; here there is besides a system of judgments, namely logical-antilogical judgments, which furnishes a connecting link for the extremes. To the system of the logical-antilogical judgments there now corresponds a system of *logical-antilogical syllogisms*, an intermediate system in which the subjective and objective syllogisms are unceasingly converted into one another.

What this conversion signifies can be elucidated by a closer consideration of the relation between extremes and middle term. Is it necessary that extremes and middle term must in every syllogism, objective as well as subjective, constitute three totalities? It seems at first glance as though the question must be answered with no. Manifold premises of subjective syllogisms are indeed judgments with one-sided predicates, pure property-predicates, as e.g. all men are mortal. Likewise the terms in many of the premises holding for objective syllogisms are so elementary and one-sided that they cannot at all present themselves as totalities. If the concept of the gypsum is set over against the existing gypsum, one may indeed say that the extremes are totalities; but how can the middle term, falling into two elements, be said to constitute a totality? The difficulty becomes no less if we, after Hegel's example, set the sulphuric acid as the one extreme, the lime as the other, the affinity as middle, and the gypsum as the actual syllogism.

[401] As regards the simultaneous and the successive too, misgivings arise. Inasmuch as

the subjective syllogism is conceived as a syllogism, the premises are formed successively, the conclusion with its consequent proposition follows after: the succession is unmistakable. If the subjective syllogism is on the contrary transformed into an immanence-syllogism, then the succession disappears; the movement becomes rest, and the terms of the syllogism simultaneous. Something similar is seen in the objective syllogism. If we choose the formation of gypsum for an example, the terms are successive; if we choose equilibrium, they are simultaneous.

By closer investigation of these doubtful operation-phenomena the conversion of the logical into the antilogical and of the latter into the former will gradually be exhibited. As regards now the relation between the simultaneity and succession of the terms, to begin with this, it will soon appear that the opposition of subjective and objective syllogism is grounded in identity. The succession in the subjective, the ideal, presupposes its simultaneous; for that which gradually becomes evident becomes evident as that which already was; the becoming of truth, i.e. its successive coming to consciousness, reflects itself in its eternal being. What subjectivity gradually comes to know, it comes to know *a priori* as something that beforehand *has been* and therefore is in eternal knowledge. The succession in the objective, the real, is indeed so finitized that it even becomes temporal; but precisely because the successive is parcelled out in the schema of temporality, simultaneity is outwardly realized in the schema of space. Whether, then, we consider the syllogism from the subjective or the objective, from the logical or the antilogical point of view, we see in both cases a reciprocal determination of the simultaneous and the successive.

That the reciprocal determination in the logical is the opposite of the reciprocal determination in the antilogical goes without saying; but it lies in the essence of the syllogism that the identity is mediated by the opposition. The total movement in the logical goes from the ideal through the real back to the ideal; here there are, in other words, two ideal extremes with a real middle term: *the anticipation is in this light more than a judgment, it is a syllogism.* [402]

The first extreme of the anticipation-syllogism consists in the totality of logical determinations which originally determine the anticipated concept. But since the anticipation is itself determined by objective considerations, the totality of the ele-

ments objective for these considerations will furnish the syllogism's real middle. The real middle is seen at first glance not as middle, but as extreme. From each of the objective elements there goes out an antilogical reflex which from the objective side is just as determining for the anticipating judgment as the logical moments are from the subjective side. Notwithstanding, it is not, for the objective view, reality in its immediacy as reality in which one here acquiesces. The regard for reality is only a vehicle for the development of the concept: the antilogical determinations are only reflexes, gleams and color-tones in the logical. The movement thus goes through the real back to the ideal; the last extreme, the concept articulated by the antilogical moments, is now, by virtue of the real middle, different from and yet one with its ideal beginning: the anticipation-syllogism is completed.

That the fully developed anticipation must absolutely end as syllogism could already be foreseen in the doctrine of judgment. In the reciprocal determination of the disjunctive and the hypothetical judgment, decisive for the anticipation, particular weight was laid not merely on the choice of objectively determined elements, but, what is here from this point of view decisive, on the influence which the choice of the objective elements had to exert, not on the actualization of the concept, for that goes without saying, but on the anticipation-concept's own anticipated determinateness. In the real middle of the anticipation-syllogism there thus goes a stream of movements [403] from the ideal toward the real, from the real toward the ideal with overreaching ideality, thus a movement from the logical toward the antilogical, and conversely, with an overreaching of the logical. The anticipation-syllogism is thus, when it is seen in its middle, a complete expression of the subjectivity-movement in which the logical unceasingly turns in order to reproduce the antilogical, and thereby to close itself together with itself.

If we fix our gaze on the actualization, is it not then striking that *the realization of the concept is more than a judgment, that from its objective side it is a complete syllogism?* That the anticipated concept, fully developed in the anticipation, however forms not, as it might seem at first glance, the syllogism's first extreme, but its middle, must in the present connection be expressly emphasized. So long as we still considered the actualization of the concept, in unity with its anticipation, only as one single objective

syllogism, the anticipation-concept, i.e. the anticipated concept, naturally had to become the syllogism's first extreme. Now, on the contrary, after the anticipation has been determined as a syllogism by itself, the actualization as a syllogism of its own must necessarily go out from actuality and return to actuality; the realization-syllogism must, in other words, have two real extremes with an ideal middle.

The ideal middle is precisely the anticipated concept. For what indeed is, in an objective sense, the first and most important thing for him who has a concept, a plan, that he will realize? Surely never to sit and stare at the plan and rehearse which and how many demands it really was that lay in the concept; by incessant repetition of such considerations the producing subjectivity gets nowhere with the objective. If the producer is not to remain hanging in anticipating reflections like the fly in the web, then he must, as he proceeds to the execution, instantly and immediately lay hold of the objective elements, choose his material; here, then, is the first extreme. In its [404] outward objective existence the material is not merely wholly foreign to, but, as it seems, even wholly heterogeneous with, the concept that is to be realized in it; now the movement begins from the material toward the concept, from the first extreme toward the middle.

Let us consider this movement somewhat more closely. The extreme is real, the middle is ideal; if it is to be possible to reach from extreme to middle, it must then be possible to convert the extreme's reality into ideal reflexes, i.e. to dissolve its antilogical determinateness into logical determinations. Inasmuch as a beginning is here made with immediate reality, a beginning is here made precisely with a system of logical judgments. The material consists, e.g., of iron, stone and wood; how is it now possible for the producer to make anything out of such a material if he does not from his point of view know its constitution; for upon the constitution the usability precisely depends. But an exhaustive cognition of the material's constitution presupposes a system of logical judgments. Every constituent, every one of the particular substances furnishes here the subject for a multitude of predicates to which the producer must necessarily have regard in the execution of his plan.

The system of predicates in which the material's concept is developed now meets with the system of predicates by which the anticipated concept is determined; upon this

meeting depends the validity of the ideal middle. Through the logical essentiality of the predicates the purpose-concept goes into its objective elements, becomes determining for their treatment; the movement thus goes from the ideal toward the real, from the logical toward the antilogical. That reality of the elements which in the form of material furnished the syllogism's first extreme now corresponds to the reality, the actualized concept, which forms the last extreme. By virtue of the ideal middle the last extreme is identical both with the concept itself and with the first extreme, is, in [405] other words, the first extreme's identity with the actualized concept. The doubling of movement in the ideal middle is again an example of this, that the antilogical in every objective syllogism reproduces the logical, in order that the logical may reproduce the antilogical.

It began with the realization of the concept showing itself as one syllogism; the one syllogism has now by immanent doubling become two syllogisms; what is thereby gained? The objective syllogism has developed its subjective moment! The contradiction, that the objective syllogism as function of the syllogism-act must necessarily be subjective, is dissolved in the doubling: the anticipation-syllogism has shown how the objective as moment is taken up into the subjective; the actualization-syllogism has shown how the subjective becomes a moment for the objective. But the subjective can — in the syllogism — become a moment for the objective only on the express condition that the objective has become a moment for the subjective. The two syllogisms, the anticipation and the actualization, cannot then be set over against one another as mutually independent; the anticipation has significance only as presupposition for the actualization, and the latter significance only as consequent proposition of the former: the *two syllogisms thus form extremes for a third*, which maintains the validity of both by taking both up as moments.

The third syllogism, enclosing the two particular syllogisms, must again have its middle and be recognized by the middle. If now the anticipation-syllogism with its real middle is the subjective extreme, the actualization-syllogism with its ideal middle the objective, then it lies in the nature of the matter that the middle corresponding to the syllogism of these syllogisms must be the concrete unity of the two particular middles. But each of the two particular middles is as middle itself the whole particular syllogism,

the real middle the whole anticipation-syllogism, the ideal the whole actualization-syllogism; the two middles form by their *difference* the extremes of the third syllogism. But from this follows again that the two middles must by their *identity* at the same [406] time form the middle of the third syllogism.

And what, then, is all this to say? It is to say that the objective syllogism is a system of three syllogisms, that the motion in this system is infinite rest. The motion goes from extreme to extreme; seen finitely, the rest passes over into motion. But every extreme is itself the whole syllogism: seen infinitely, the motion passes over into rest. The subjective goes from extreme to extreme through the real middle, the objective from extreme to extreme through the ideal middle: the subjective and the objective go in opposite directions. But the ideal middle is real, the real is ideal: the subjective and the objective, with opposite direction, nevertheless go in the same direction. *Immediately* this is a contradiction; but in the objective syllogism everything is *infinitely mediate*, and the contradiction removed.

Inasmuch as the logical in an infinite manner reproduces the antilogical, the thought-act has from all sides gone together with the power-act; knowledge has according to its reality become identical with power. Inasmuch as the antilogical in an infinite manner reproduces the logical, the power-act has at all points gone together with the thought-act; power has according to its ideality become identical with knowledge. The teleological identity of thought-act and power-act is clarified through.

If now the form-development thus carried through is applied to the determination of the finite extremes, however these may be placed in relation to the respective middle, then the totality in all three terms is easy to discover. As regards the example of the gypsum, there can here of course be no doubt that the real concept gypsum is a totality, and the actual gypsum likewise. The doubt falls upon the middle alone. But now consider the following: “The concept gypsum is a — by combination of sulphuric acid and lime — peculiarly determined real concept”; here we have the anticipation-syllogism with the two ideal extremes and the real middle. “The elements: [407] sulphur, oxygen and calcium metal unite — in accordance with the demand of the gypsum-concept — into actual gypsum”; here we have the actualization-syllogism

with the two real extremes and the ideal middle. If we now, in immanent reflection of the syllogism's essence, let the ideal and the real middle with their mutual opposition form extremes, and by their identity again the middle for a new syllogism, then the totalization of the syllogism's terms is carried through on all sides. The same result comes out when we apprehend the gypsum-syllogism in such a way that the sulphuric acid becomes the one extreme, the lime the other, and their affinity the essential middle.

From a chemical standpoint it would, to put it plainly, be galimatias if anyone asserted that either the sulphuric acid by itself or the lime by itself was at bottom gypsum; but from a logical point of view there is here, as regards the gypsum-syllogism, something else to take into account. Not the sulphuric acid by itself as existing acid, but the sulphuric acid as an extreme of the gypsum-syllogism is what here in a one-sided manner represents the concept's totality. Only in relation to the whole syllogism can the single term become an extreme. Inasmuch as the sulphuric acid is posited as extreme for the gypsum, its corresponding extreme, the lime, is expressly presupposed. The system of properties holding for each extreme acquires significance solely thereby, that both systems of properties are reflected in one system, thus thereby, that two one-sided totalities are reflected in one all-sided totality; thus thereby, that this one all-sided totality is particularly reflected in two one-sided totalities determined not merely *by* one another, but also *for* one another. This way of viewing then serves at the same time as confirmation that the objective syllogism is essentially teleological. As extreme in the gypsum-syllogism the sulphuric acid has not merely certain properties, *so that* it in combination with the lime *can*, but also expressly, *in order that* it under certain conditions *shall* be able to form gypsum. Where such a teleology neither holds [408] nor can hold, there it has (as e.g. in chemistry) no significance either to speak of objective syllogisms; where teleology on the other hand holds, there the objective syllogism holds too.

ββ) The Word of Power in the objective Syllogism. What the word of power signifies, both according to its ideality and according to its reality; in what relation the anticipating, executive and explicative functions must be thought to stand to the power-word's utterance in judgment and object; in what manner the ideal power-functions as imper-

ative, indicative and interpreting enter into the determination of the idea of judgment and object; how the anticipating judgment develops itself into anticipating syllogism: these and similar principal points have in our foregoing already been treated and illuminated from so many sides that a further working-out in the same direction would only look like unfruitful and wearisome repetitions.

The development of the objective syllogism has already been brought to the turning point where the logical functions now meet with the logic of the functions. In the logic of the functions the objective syllogism acquired particular significance thereby, that “the system of the totalities”¹⁴⁹ had to be particularly determined by systematic alterations in the energy of the corresponding functions. By the essential alteration in the energy of the functions the objective difference between the mechanical, the mechanically-dynamical and the organic syllogism then became recognizable in such a way that the objective in the transition from the one of these syllogisms to the other thereby at the same time let itself be seen. Here, under the point of view of logical functions, the objective syllogism in its relation to the power-word must be apprehended and determined in such a way that it can be discerned what difference there is between referring the objectified concepts, realized in the objectification, to the psychological and to the ontological subjectivity.

So long as the objectified concepts, actualized in the objects, are, as regards the comprehending, referred exclusively to the psychological subjectivity, the finite separation between concepts and objects, between a priori and empirical concepts, between thinking and being will never be able to be removed. At this standpoint the one who cognizes can indeed, by subjective syllogisms supported upon facts, work his way forward to objective results; but in the objective results finite knowledge can never reach the objective syllogisms. In order to clarify the reality of the objective syllogisms and thereby sublate the finite parcelling-out of a priori and empirical cognitions, logic must refer the objectified concepts, realized in the objectification, not to the psychological, but to the ontological subjectivity, overreaching in knowledge and power. An illumination of the reality of the objective syllogisms then serves at the same time to clear up the logical element in the difference between the real cognition of philosophy

¹⁴⁹Cf. Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 434 ff.

and that of the special sciences. What this signifies we shall in what follows strive to show; we choose as examples *gravity*, *affinity* and *the organic process*.

1) *In the Word of Power Gravity is an objective Syllogism*. Both in logic and in the experience-science an express difference must be made between the concept of gravity and actual gravity; but in the experience-science the difference is determined from a quite other point of view than in logic. What does physics teach about gravity? “Every body which is supported by another”, says physics,¹⁵⁰ “exercises a pressure upon the same, but when it is not supported it falls perpendicularly down toward the earth’s surface. This property of bodies is called gravity”. Gravity is thus according to this [410] explanation a *property*. Immediately after it reads¹⁵¹ “Gravity is not a force peculiar to the earth, but the consequence of a general attraction which takes place between all bodies”. From this point of view gravity thus becomes determined by two new categories, the category *force* and the category *consequence*, a consequence whose effective ground is a *general attraction*. When here in conclusion it is added “that the force which on the earth we call gravity is the general force-bond by which the great universe is held together”,¹⁵² then by this “general force-bond” the category gravity glides imperceptibly over into the category power; gravity is thus a *power*.

That gravity really lets itself be apprehended from all three sides, as *property*, as *force* and as *power*, without the one of these apprehensions at the standpoint of the special science coming into conflict with the other, shall willingly be conceded. But the formation of the real concept in the special science is one thing, its development in logic another. When logic sets about investigating how the empirical in the natural-scientific concept of gravity stands related to the a priori, difficulties present themselves which at the stage of finite knowledge it is impossible to remove.

In order to explain the universal, the necessary and to that extent a priori in gravity, one subsumes the gravity-phenomena occurring on the earth under “the general attraction”; in order to explain the general attraction, one appeals to the force of attraction inherent in all material parts; in order to explain the general force of attraction, one refers to the property common to all bodies; but in order to explain

¹⁵⁰Naturlærens mekaniske Deel af H. C. Ørsted. Tredie Udgave ved Holten. Kjøbenhavn 1859. p. 154.

¹⁵¹Anfr. Skr. p. 155.

¹⁵²Anfr. Skr. p. 174.

this property, what does one then do? The judgment about the common property of bodies, the judgment that all bodies are heavy belongs, according to what we have at [411] an earlier stage¹⁵³ set forth, among the antilogical-apodictic judgments.

How the empirical and to that extent contingent in the antilogical-apodictic judgments conflicts with the necessary and to that extent *a priori* is then recognizable enough in mechanical physics' explanation of gravity. If a property common to all bodies were really to let itself be apprehended as the ground-cause of the gravity-phenomena, then this property would have to let itself be derived *a priori* from the concept of matter. But to the concept of matter as matter there belongs, according to the doctrine of experience, only this, to fill space. "The space-filling in bodies we call *matter*, the bounded filled space a *body*". But from the mere concept of space-filling a general force of attraction will never let itself be derived with logical necessity. If it were to be possible to derive the general attraction from the concept of matter, then it would surely also have to be possible to derive the law of attraction from the concept of matter. But how precarious it is at the standpoint of finite knowledge to want to determine the law of gravity *a priori* is then seen clearly enough, among several examples, from the well-known dispute between Buffon and Clairaut. Buffon is right in setting out from the assumption that the law of gravity must correspond to a concept of reason holding with objective necessity, thus to a concept whose validity is *a priori*. But the untenability of his logical and metaphysical as well as mathematical arguments shows that he is wrong in wanting to construe nature's *a priori* concepts of reason *a priori*.¹⁵⁴

A real concept like gravity cannot be pieced together out of heterogeneous constituents, so that an objective presupposition and a subjective thought, an empirical element and an *a priori* category, a contingent content and a necessary form should [412] by ingenious combinations be able to satisfy the highest demand of knowledge and of science. At all points thought demands the *a priori*, at all points intuition stops at the empirical. The heterogeneous constituents out of which a concept of experience at first glance seems to be composed must in the comprehending itself be transformed into

¹⁵³See above p. 264–75.

¹⁵⁴On the dispute's logical moments cf. Forelæsn. over "Phil. Propæd." fra Universitetsaaret 1861–62. p. 116–118.

homogeneous moments: in the concept of experience as concept all determinations are *a priori*; in the concept as object, the existence of the concept of experience, all determinations are empirical¹⁵⁵.

The unity of actual gravity and the concept of gravity is a syllogism-unity, a unity of extremes which are themselves syllogisms. But it is, be it noted, the ontological, not the psychological, the divine, not the human subjectivity that masters such a syllogism. The subjective extreme is the power-word's ideality; in this extreme all gravity-determinations are anticipated knowledge-determinations: the real concept with terms and relation is borne *a priori* by imperative functions. The objective extreme is the power-word's reality; in this extreme all gravity-determinations are realized existence-determinations: the concept is empirical, and the empirical an objectification by indicative functions.

[413] From the standpoint of finite knowledge the syllogistic union of the extremes cannot, as has been said, be cognized; but precisely in the manner in which they are set over against one another, human reason shows its natural urge to maintain them both.

If thought directs its gaze toward the subjective extreme, then the explanation runs thus: "Whether we consider gravity in its simplest utterance as attraction between two bodies separated in space, or from a higher point of view as the force-bond that holds the world-systems together, it is to us equally unthinkable that gravity should rest upon an objective property contingently inherent in matter. But if gravity in its objective determinate being is not to rest upon a merely factual property, contingent in its facticity, then it is surely incontrovertible that an almighty reason, a divine wisdom, must have implanted this property in matter. Since it is now further altogether unthinkable that a fundamental property should be able to be implanted in a matter

¹⁵⁵If one overlooks this, one will hardly be able to escape the consequence of the following discussion: "A. You will then surely grant me that the *a posteriori* on the whole stands related to the *a priori* as sense-perception to thinking? B. Of course. A. The more of the sensible there is in a concept, the more it contains of an *a posteriori*. B. That is understood. A. But the sensible is, as we have seen, an unthinkable, something that is not there for thought, that does not let itself be thought? B. That must be granted. A. The more of the *a posteriori* a concept contains, the more of the unthinkable must it thus contain; that is to say: a concept is unthinkable in the same degree as it is a *a posteriori*; that is to say: *a posteriori* concepts are unthinkable". Forelæsn. over phil. Propæd. fra Universitetsaaret 1861–62. p. 107–108.

already existent beforehand, it follows from this at the same time with necessity that the same divine reason which has determined matter's fundamental property must have brought forth matter itself. Matter is thus created together with gravity. The general attraction is the phenomenal expression for the thinking-together of the parts in the divine knowledge. The "general force-bond" is an almighty thought-bond. We cannot comprehend it, but our reason is compelled to assume it".

If thought on the contrary fixes its gaze upon the objective extreme, then the explanation goes in the opposite direction: "However we may apprehend the concept of gravity in and for itself, so much is certain, that gravity is a fact. As fact the actuality of gravity, its objectivity, is indisputable. But if gravity really is objective, the mutual attraction of the material parts cannot possibly be explained by a reason hovering above thinking the parts together, bringing them together by subjective acts of thinking. It lies in the nature of matter, it lies in the parts themselves, that they mutually attract one another. As fact gravity has its ground solely and alone in [414] matter's actual existence. In the actual existence the ground is one with the objective necessity. Against an objective necessity there is no ratiocinating; in the objective necessity lies precisely the ground why gravity as a property common to all bodies does not let itself be grounded: the concept of gravity is and remains a posteriori".

This antinomy, insoluble as it might seem to a critical philosophy, finds in a simple and natural manner its solution in the objective syllogism, a solution conditioned by the psychological point of view being exchanged for the ontological. For the ontological subjectivity each of the extremes has the same original validity. The a priori does not in time precede the empirical; the imperative functions do not come to operate for themselves alongside the indicative; the middle of the extremes is not brought about by finite combinations of subjective and objective elements; no, the middle is itself the articulated identity of the extremes: all the terms of the syllogism are simultaneous. The syllogistic union is an infinite reciprocal determination of the extremes' peculiarity, thus of the a priori with the empirical, of the subjective with the objective, of freedom with necessity, of the power-word's ideality with its reality, a reciprocal determination which is grounded precisely upon the doubling that both extremes of the syllogism are themselves syllogisms.

2) *In the Word of Power Affinity is an objective Syllogism.* In the general gravity-syllogism all finite succession is excluded: extremes and middle come forth as at one stroke. Precisely because gravity as property is a general property inherent in matter as matter, there can here, as regards the realization of the concept of gravity, be no thought of finite succession. But how does it now stand with the concept of affinity? If it is established that the ontologically powerful subjectivity cannot by [415] any whatever of its imperative functions force upon the objectively existent matter a single property, but must indicatively apprehend and determine each single property as objective expression for matter's own objective essence: then it follows of itself that the properties corresponding to affinity can as little have been arbitrarily impressed upon matter as gravity.

None the less the realization of the concept of affinity presents peculiar principal aspects characteristic of the objective syllogism. Gravity is in its essence uniform; affinity, on the contrary, multiform. So far is it from being the case that the actual difference between the weight and specific gravity of bodies of different kinds should mark an essential difference in their gravity, that it, according to physics, on the contrary serves as proof that all bodies are equally heavy. It is otherwise with affinity. Though hydrogen and iridium are equally heavy, notwithstanding that their specific gravity is so different (hydrogen's 0.06, iridium's about 23.0), one nevertheless cannot say that their affinity is the same, seeing that they enter into very different combinations. From one and the same general gravity the particular weight-relations can, under given conditions, be derived; but from the general affinity the particular affinities can, however much weight one might otherwise attach to the conditions, in no way be derived.

In the doctrine of "the logic of the functions", in particular of "functions of the mixed ground",¹⁵⁶ it has already been shown how impossible it is, under the functions' concrete-physical reciprocal relation, to derive the particular affinities from the fundamental essence of a general affinity. One can indeed set up a theory which teaches that the affinity in every substance must always at the same temperature have the same intensity; but what intensity the affinity in the given substance, at the given

¹⁵⁶Grundideernes Logik. I. p. 316–329.

temperature, actually has is an empirical determination which as little lets itself be [416]
derived from the general concept of affinity as from the general concept of substance.

The empirical in the concept of affinity points, however, in a quite peculiar manner to the *a priori*. Just as, namely, the property of the one thing in general first comes into view thereby, that it, under the reciprocal action of things, reflects itself in the property of another thing, so it holds in a peculiar sense that a substance's peculiar affinity can be seen only insofar as it, in the combination, renders recognizable the corresponding affinity in another substance. The different relations in which carbon unites with hydrogen show us at the same time the different relations in which the hydrogen unites with the carbon: the affinity of the carbon becomes manifest by that of the hydrogen, inasmuch as that of the hydrogen becomes manifest by that of the carbon. The facts belonging hereunder exhibit a remarkable reciprocal determination of contingent and necessary, of possibility and disposition.

Apprehended according to their phenomenon, the chemical substances of different kinds, metals and metalloids, are surely quite independent of one another. Or how should it be able to be shown that the existence of the one substance, if it is true that it really is an elementary substance, should with necessity presuppose the existence of the other? Oxygen could after all very well be thought to be there without hydrogen, hydrogen without nitrogen, etc. Insofar now as the oxygen existing for itself is independent of the hydrogen existing for itself, the properties of the oxygen and of the hydrogen fall quite outside one another: the properties of the oxygen do not concern the hydrogen at all, those of the hydrogen not the oxygen; the two systems of properties are thus contingent for one another. If we next consider affinity, in that we seek to penetrate into the substances' "nature and essence", what do we then discover? Why, then we discover that the chemical properties of the substances, far from being indifferent and contingent to one another, are on the contrary determined by one another and for one another, and thus stand in a mutually necessary reciprocal relation. What the oxygen in its combination with the hydrogen signifies rests upon [417]
the hydrogen; what the hydrogen signifies is again determined by the oxygen: if oxygen and hydrogen were not originally determined for one another, water would never have come to be.

What the reciprocal determination of contingent and necessary (actual necessity is here thought of) is with respect to the phenomenon, the reciprocal determination of *possibility* and *disposition* is again with respect to the essence. Referred to its possibility the peculiar product is a contingent or, more exactly, contingently-necessary result; referred to its disposition the product is a realized purpose. For the objectively rational consideration the chemical products will on the whole appear now as contingently-necessary results, now as realized purposes. That the observer can give up neither the one nor the other of these ways of viewing, and yet cannot point out their mutual boundary either, shows again how the psychological subjectivity oscillates between the extremes of the objective syllogism, without mastering the syllogism itself.

If we let the so-called sound human understanding (or “sound reason”) choose the starting point of its reflections first in the subjective, next in the objective extreme, then the conflicting ways of viewing indicated in the discussion of the *a priori* and the empirical in the concept of gravity will develop themselves into further-reaching consequences answering in particular to the concept of affinity. If the gaze is thus fixed one-sidedly upon the subjective extreme, the consideration will go in the following direction: “No doubt it can for our limited knowledge in manifold cases appear as if the chemical products were only contingently-necessary results of affinity-forces taking place and determined by the constitution of the substances and the conditions of the surrounding world; but if we look more closely, then we cannot possibly withdraw ourselves from the impression that what in the fact looks like the product of a possibility conditioned from without shows itself on closer reflection to be an actual utterance of divine plan and disposition. The possibility of the oxygen’s combination [418] with the hydrogen is only thinkable under the presupposition that the same divine wisdom which has *a priori* determined the chemical constitution of the oxygen has also determined that of the hydrogen. But if the chemical properties of the named substances are determined by a reason exalted above both, if, in other words, the peculiarity of the oxygen is fixed, not merely so that it really *can*, which only hints at *possibility*, but also, which plainly testifies to *disposition*, so that it under given conditions expressly *shall* unite with the hydrogen: who will then be able to deny that the same divine understanding which has determined the oxygen for combination

with the hydrogen has by this combination at the same time predetermined, and thus intended, the formation of water. How characteristic every disposition to chemical combination must be utters itself plainly in the manifoldly varying opposition of acid and base: these combinations are acids, because those are bases. By the antecedently fixed separation of acids and bases not merely the possibility of a great number of salt-formations is given; but by the separation of acids and bases predetermined in the disposition it is expressly laid out for the formation of determinate salts.” It is Leibnitz’s doctrine of possibilities, dispositions and predetermined harmonies which by reflections upon the subjective extreme of the objective syllogism will again and again find confirmation.

If the gaze is fixed just as one-sidedly upon the objective extreme, the consideration goes of course in the opposite direction: “As unthinkable as it is that gravity by a divine choice, an almighty arbitrariness, can be forced upon matter, just as unthinkable is it that such a thing should be able to happen with any other property. Not in accordance with divine deliberation, calculation and predetermination can now these, now those more or less purpose-serving properties be grafted into matter; for matter with its actual and possible properties is at one stroke what it is and as it is: here neither purpose nor choice nor arbitrariness holds. The difference between possibility and [419] disposition is a difference of reflection in the observing subjectivity, and has nothing to do with the objective. No doubt the opposition of acids and bases plays an important role in nature’s “economy”, and to that extent belongs essentially in the order of things. But what has the objective order of things to do with such categories of subjectivity as anticipation, preformation, disposition and mechanically arbitrary predetermination? There is in nature an order of things, not because there is a particular ordering principle, but because a disorder of things is impossible. Nature is an infinite whole which subsists in its parts. As the parts are, so must the whole also be, and conversely: as the whole is, so must the parts be. Had we another whole of nature, then we should also have other parts: nature’s order rests precisely upon this, that the parts cannot do otherwise than correspond to the whole, and the whole to the parts.”¹⁵⁷ It is empiricism with its facts and its factual necessity that will again and again seek

¹⁵⁷Cf. *Phil. Propæd.* p. 189.

its point of support in the objective extreme of the objective syllogism. But neither abstract idealism with its *a priori* nor abstract realism with its empirical will be in a position to master the syllogism itself.

For insight into the relation between the power-word and the objective syllogism, on the other hand, everything in the foregoing has been prepared. With the word of power in its ideality all the specific determinations of affinity are *a priori* posited and presupposed; with the word of power in its reality the same determinations are empirically realized. The misunderstanding of the predetermined harmony in the subjective extreme is removed in the doctrine of the anticipating and preforming functions. The misunderstanding of the empirical determinateness in the objective extreme is removed in the doctrine of the objective possibilities and their dependence [420] upon subjectively determining functions. The middle of the syllogism is thus just as original as its extremes, and the extremes just as original as the middle: the *a priori* and the empirical interpenetrate one another at all points.

3) *In the Word of Power the organic Process is an objective Syllogism.* For the ratiocinating observer the two extremes of the objective syllogism fall apart from one another like two separated hemispheres; if the one is above, then the other is below the horizon of cognition.

Absorbed in the subjective extreme, finite knowledge does indeed demand the objective; but since objectivity is not permitted to strike out into its extreme, its essential validity, its relative independence, will never be able to be maintained. Instead of having its thing-causes, its grounds and possibilities in itself, everything objective on the contrary gets its last cause and therewith its original ground and possibility outside itself, namely in subjectivity.

Impressed by the objective extreme, even to such a degree that it cannot so much as notice it as extreme, finite knowledge is of course so taken up with facts, sense-perceptions and empirical presuppositions that it has not a glance to spare for the originally subjective. If the objective world with its facts is not itself an extreme, but something absolute in itself: how then should it be able to tolerate, let alone demand, subjectivity as a corresponding extreme? A subjectivity is indeed required in order to consider the objective and form for itself a concept of the actual; but in actuality the

objective is itself just as indifferent toward the observer as toward the consideration and the concept won by the consideration.

From neither of the extreme points of view is it possible to solve the problem of objectification. In the subjective extreme the objectifying subjectivity is intuited; but the objectification lacks its objective. In the objective extreme objectivity is intuited, that which is objectified in actuality, but the objectifying subjectivity is only a shadow. Only in the objective syllogism's all-sided development can the problem of [421] objectification find its solution.

Gravity and *affinity* have, as shown above, this characteristic about them, that, insofar as they fall under the horizon of finite knowledge, they each in its own way categorically hold the syllogism's extremes so separated that the empirical investigator must direct his gaze exclusively toward the objective, and let the speculative thinker grope after the subjective. With the organic process the phenomenon has become another. The fact now itself gives an equal mirroring of both extremes: the organic process is in its phenomenon an objective syllogism. As objective syllogism the organic process is nevertheless manifestly misinterpreted both by empirical physiology and by immanent speculation.

As a special science physiology holds to the objective extreme, naturally not as extreme, but as plain and simple objectivity; it compares the organism and its single parts with a machine: "The heart resembles a pumping-apparatus furnished with suitable valves, the arteries elastic pipelines" etc. The organic process is explained by mechanical and chemical functions: the consideration is altogether objective. If now the activity of the organs is determined exclusively by their "anatomical, physical, chemical and thence derived or co-operating properties," then it is indeed a matter of course that "the special anatomy," the doctrine of the structure of the tissues, "physics" and "chemistry" must furnish the foundation for physiology. But now, as has already been shown in "the Logic of the Functions," an organic function can in no way be derived or directly explained from merely mechanical and chemical activities. Physiology's explanations then also run out at last upon this, that science can at bottom explain nothing. "We do not know," says the physiologist, "what life is." But if it really stands thus, that physiology cannot lead to insight into what life is, then

[422] neither can it lead to insight into what an organism is, and then neither to insight into what an organic process is.¹⁵⁸

The organic process is not clarified in immanent speculation either. Speculation is indeed in the right when, against the doctrine of experience, it maintains that the concept as concept is precisely realized in the organism; but it is in the wrong in behaving as though it could really prove that the concept realizing itself in the organism was the same as the concept which, at the stages of mechanism and chemism, struggles with the conditions and works itself up through lower presuppositions. By this misinterpretation, pointed out in the foregoing from several sides, the speculative philosophy of “the concept” comes into just as skewed a position toward the organic process as physiology.

Physiology’s misdirection is, as far as the concept is concerned, this: that the organic process should be merely a result of the co-operation of mechanical and chemical functions. Speculation’s misdirection is, as far as the fact is concerned, this: that the organic process should with irrefutable consequence let itself be developed and determined in logic as a naturally necessary expression of the concept identical with its content.¹⁵⁹

[423] The organic process is indeed in Hegel’s logic apprehended and determined as objective syllogism. But the apprehension is so one-sided that what is here posited as a system of objective syllogisms, namely the system of the organic processes in the organism, on closer inspection lacks completeness and falls one-sidedly under the

¹⁵⁸“Life,” says the physiologist, “must be constituted as the organization is. A single cell’s life is *the sum of this cell’s activity* and is simple in the same proportion as the organization is simple. The life of an animal with a highly developed organization is the sum of all the forces that stir within it, and is complicated in the same proportion as the organism is complicated.” The one-sidedness shows itself in this, that the physiologist, who in this manner makes life into “*a consequence of the organism*,” forgets that the ideality appealed to is grounded in an essential difference, that life is a consequence of the organism only insofar as the organism itself is a *consequence of life*. Forelæsn. ov. “Phil. Propæd.” fra Universitetsaar 1860–61. p. 223.

¹⁵⁹“Daß das lebendige Individuum sich in sich selbst gestaltet, damit spannt es sich gegen sein ursprüngliches Voraussetzen, und stellt sich als an und für sich seyendes Subjekt der vorausgesetzten objektiven Welt gegenüber. Das Subjekt ist der Selbstzweck, der Begriff, welcher an der ihm unterworfenen Objektivität sein Mittel und subjektive Realität hat; hierdurch ist es als die an und für sich seyende Idee und als das wesentliche Selbstständige konstituiert, gegen welches die vorausgesetzte äußerliche Welt nur den Werth eines Negativen und Unselbständigen hat. Sein Trieb ist das Bedürfniß, dieß Andersseyn aufzuheben, und sich die Wahrheit jener Gewißheit zu geben”. Hegel. Die subjective Logik. p. 255–56.

objective syllogism's objective extreme. How matters stand with this we can easily elucidate somewhat more closely.

Already in the Logic of the Functions¹⁶⁰ the organism is, as "the third fundamental totality of objectification," determined by an objective syllogism: $S - A_o - O_o$ is the syllogism's schema. If we consider this schema somewhat more closely, then it is clear that the organic process takes place in O_o and is referred to A_o only insofar as O_o itself proceeds from A_o . Since now O_o in the system of all its syllogisms expressly designates the objective syllogism's objective extreme, it follows from this that the organic process is indeed an objective syllogism, but a partial syllogism which is taken up as a moment in the objective extreme's total syllogism.

This illumination now has a force that reacts back upon the gravity- and affinity-syllogism. For just as the gravity-syllogism in its separate phenomena goes in under the system of the abstract-mechanical functions, and thus in under "the first fundamental totality of objectification," so does the affinity-syllogism, specified in its chemical [424] appearances, go in under the system of the mechanical-dynamical functions, and thus in under "the second fundamental totality of objectification."

And what then do we learn from this? We learn from this that the objective syllogism is just as much to be developed in systems of total and partial syllogisms as the subjective-immanent one, that the functions of power are to that extent just as dialectical as the functions of knowledge. The dialectic of the power-functions can then be developed by a closer determination of

γγ) The objective Syllogism and the categorical Power-Language. — The objective syllogism is a teleological act, an actual utterance of the comprehending subjectivity that presents its concept in the object, an utterance which, when it has been determined by interpreting functions, can rightly be said to give the object its proper significance, and to that extent to establish that there really is meaning in the thing, since originally something was meant by the thing.

The error, however, lies near at hand, that the subjective regard should now all at once acquire an illogical, arbitrary preponderance over the objective. One could indeed reason thus: "If every thing is a realized concept, every realized concept determined

¹⁶⁰Grundideernes Logik I. p. 434–446.

by an objective syllogism, and every objective syllogism an utterance of the divine reason's aim, its meaning about the thing and with the thing: what a swarm of aims, subjective intimations and divine meanings must there not then be found in the world of things! If it is now to be the highest goal of human knowledge to trace out, discover and determine these meanings, then there is surely no doubt that we must soon come back to a teleology, a teleology in truth theological, which is just as profound and in its kind just as meaningless as that which put an Athanasius Kircher in a position — in the age of "lithotheology," "petinotheology," "grasshopper-theology" — to discover 6561 proofs of God's existence."

[425] That this reasoning rests upon a misunderstanding is easy to demonstrate. In the first place, a separation has indeed been made at an earlier stage, an essential, categorically determined separation between the divine meaning with things and men's opinions about things. In the second place, what holds at a lower stage of the essential and the necessary holds at a higher stage of the teleological. That the essence of things pervades things, that everything which happens in the world of things happens with a certain necessity, can neither exclude the determination of anything unessential nor sublate the significance of anything contingent. In a corresponding manner it stands with the teleological. Because everything in the world of things is subordinated to teleology, since everything in the world of things is subordinated to the objective syllogism, it does not follow from this that every single thing in all immediacy should, as a specially attained aim, have a special teleological significance.

What therefore the difference between necessity and contingency is for reflection, that the opposition between end and means is for the objective syllogism. In systems of objective syllogisms the all-capable subjectivity has uttered its knowledge's content in the word of power: a rich content, a manifold word! But for the understanding of this word of power it is above all necessary to make a difference between *main-thoughts*, *middle-thoughts* and *side-thoughts*.

In each of "the fundamental totalities of objectification" a divine *main-thought* utters itself; such a main-thought is, with respect to form, objectively expressed in the total syllogism's objective extreme. Each main-thought is, as far as the singular and the particular are concerned, developed in a sum of characteristic *middle-thoughts*:

the determinate total syllogism consists in a system of peculiar particular syllogisms necessary for the totality. Finally, in that the particular syllogisms enter into finitude, take up the contingent and are altered in the external, these alterations, at once [426] essential and yet unessential, may well be said to express the system's *side-thoughts*.

"But," one will perhaps ask, "is this explanation really more than an ingenious application of interpreting functions; will the doctrine of the categorical power-language really be able to exercise any fruitful influence upon science?" We answer: Yes! The doctrine of the categorical power-language is of decisive significance in the determination both of philosophy's goal and of its relation to the special sciences. We shall at once test its significance upon the three fundamental totalities of objectification, the mechanical, the mechanical-dynamical and the organic.

1) *The mechanical Totality in categorical Meaning*. In a totality such as our planetary system a concept complete in itself has been realized. Herein lies this, that this concept must present itself as a system of facts, and that the system of facts must conversely let itself be explained in a concept. From the standpoint of physics the facts must be seen as the original, the concept as the derived. The functions, which here are referred to the psychological subjectivity, are indicative and explicative, but not interpreting: physics' apprehension of the power-concept is and must be unteleological. From the standpoint of the philosophy of nature, on the contrary, the concept as concept must be the original in the divine sense, the system of facts the derived; the functions, which here are referred to the ontologically powerful subjectivity, are not merely indicative, but also imperative, not merely explicative, but also interpreting: the apprehension of the power-concept in the philosophy of nature is and must be teleological.

The strife between mathematical physics' mechanical and immanent speculation's teleological apprehension of the planetary system has come to utterance in a quite unreserved and striking manner in Hegel's philosophy of nature.

Hegel's speculative objections to Newton's *principia philosophiæ naturalis mathematica*¹⁶¹ run thus: *a*) that Newton's mathematical presentation of the Keplerian laws is a distortion of Kepler's theory built upon experience, *b*) that Newton's mathematical proofs at bottom prove nothing, and finally *c*) that the mathematicians' doctrine of [427]

¹⁶¹Vorlesungen über die Naturphilosophie. Werke 7ter Band. 1. Abtheil. Berlin 1842. p. 98. Cf. Forelæsn. ov. "Phil. Propæd. Universitetsaar 1861-62." p. 57-66.

the parallelogram of forces, introduced by Newton, and what hangs together with it, is without application to the motion of the heavenly bodies and their mutual relation. And what then will Hegel put in place of the mathematical analysis of the mechanical forces? Syllogisms, a system of objective, teleological syllogisms!

The colossal blunders of which Hegel on this occasion has made himself guilty allow themselves to be explained solely by this, that the relation between the objective syllogism and the categorical power-language has been altogether unclear to him.

Hegel has a sharp eye for the three-sided form of the objective total syllogism, but when he has got the total syllogism's threefold schema set up and, on the occasion of each figure, has brought forward some general remarks, then he is finished. Upon physics' observations and calculations he can in no way enter; the mathematical determinations of concepts are to such a degree incompatible with his absolute concept that he plainly combats them, and that even, which has in no way been to philosophy's advantage, without having understood them.

Mathematical physics is for its part consistent; it considers the whole planetary system, not as a system of objective syllogisms, but as a result proceeding from given presuppositions and conditions; it is then in good agreement with itself when it [428] apprehends the system's single parts from the same standpoint. Hegel on the contrary is in the highest degree inconsistent. He sees the system in its totality under the standpoint of objective syllogisms; but, remarkably enough, he does not see that what holds of the total must also hold of the particular; he does not see that the total syllogism can consist only in a system of particular syllogisms.

If the motion of the planets, of the secondary planets and of the comets about the sun as central body utters a main-thought realized in the objective syllogism's objective extreme, then there is nothing either in the way of the earth's motion about the sun being interpreted as a middle-thought corresponding to the main-thought, and the moon's motion about the earth as a side-thought corresponding to the middle-thought. That the categories main-thought, middle-thought and side-thought must however be infinitely relative is unmistakably seen from this, that each of the middle-thoughts can in turn be posited as a main-thought with corresponding middle-thoughts and side-thoughts.

This way of seeing yields a consequence very important for the philosophical development of the real concept. The consequence is that the analyses of the particular syllogisms in the philosophy of nature can go into detail just as well as mathematical physics' analyses of the hypothetically necessary results. Indeed, what is more, by this and only by this way of seeing does the philosophy of nature become able to appropriate the yield of the mathematical-physical analyses, a yield essential and indispensable for idea-cognition.

The dialectical reciprocal determination of main-thoughts, middle-thoughts and side-thoughts is namely not to be settled according to a speculative estimate; such an estimate is too indeterminate and subjective to make decisions in science. The dialectical must here necessarily have the exact as its foundation. The task of the philosophy of nature will thus consist in showing how mathematical physics' hypothetically necessary results let themselves in detail be transformed into significant particular syllogisms, in that these particular syllogisms in turn show themselves to be moments in a corresponding total syllogism.¹⁶² [429]

Physics' logical functions are essentially explicative, those of the philosophy of nature interpreting: the categorical power-language, which has transformed the concepts into facts and precisely thereby assigned physics its task, has at the same time laid a divine meaning in the facts, and thereby set a task for philosophy.

2) *The second Fundamental Totality of Objectification is determined by the categorical Power-Language.* "In that geology presupposes geognosy, it must necessarily take its

¹⁶²What is meant by this can provisionally be elucidated by a couple of examples. "If a material point is acted upon by an accelerating force directed toward one and the same fixed centre, and is imparted an initial velocity, then the areas described by the radius vector in equal times will be equal." If this judgment is made the major premise in a formal subjective syllogism with a categorical minor premise, we obtain a *hypothetically necessary result*. When on the other hand this result, in its connection with the main-thought uttered in the totality, shows itself as a realized middle-thought, it is transformed into an objective particular syllogism, takes on a teleological stamp, and thus yields a proposition belonging to the categorical power-language. The same transformation can naturally be undertaken with all similar results. "If the attraction takes place according to Newton's law, the orbit must become a conic section;" "if the initial velocity is small in proportion to the force of attraction, the conic section must become an ellipse". "If different material points move in ellipses about the same centre, then, since $\frac{T^2}{a^3}$ is constant, the squares of the periods of revolution will be related as the cubes of the semi-major axes." In that these hypothetically necessary results are transformed into objective particular syllogisms, each of them is seen to be a special disposition belonging under the total disposition A_z , an intimated aim, a proposition of its own with its meaning determined by the power-language.

[430] beginning in the finite, in actuality's piecework. To collect and examine minerals, to characterize rock-types, to point out the relation between loose blocks, intrusive masses, Neptunian, Plutonic and volcanic formations etc. belongs to such a degree under the category of piecework that on a preliminary consideration one would hardly suppose that such heterogeneous constituents could be worked together into a scientific whole, still less that their constituents should lead to a cognition of the idea. Nevertheless geognosy has become a science; the more this science masters the facts, the more thoroughly it works up the elements of finitude, the more it points beyond itself, for its content is of the idea ... Seen from geognosy's standpoint the earth is only a pieced-together whole; from geology's standpoint the earth-body is on the contrary to be apprehended as an elementary organism, an essential whole whose parts have gradually developed out of an inner disposition. In the originality of the disposition we then have again the principal, in the parts' separation and the whole's planned articulation the typically teleological, i.e. we have, if only the cognition of the infinite mediation were complete, the idea realizing itself in the formation of the earth".¹⁶³

The reciprocal determination of geognosy and geology shows, when the categories are taken in the sense given above, how natural science's all-sided working-up of an elementary organism must with inner necessity lead from the abstractly objective, non-teleological way of seeing over into teleology. For it is not possible for the geologist to judge the relation between the conditions in the different periods of the earth and to characterize these as a series of lower and higher stages of development, unless he presupposes a kind of final end, a state of maturity toward which the whole development strives as toward a conclusion. But the fundamental relation between
[431] the physically objective and the teleological the geologist will never be able to see through: that which dazzles him is again the categorical power-language.

In virtue of the categorical power-language geology's concept is realized in actual facts; in the system of facts thing-causes are seen everywhere; but the ground-cause identical with the purpose-cause is lost. How hollow and fantastic the philosophy of nature must become when, in order to remedy empiricism's one-sidedness, it springs

¹⁶³Phil. Propæd. p. 186.

off from the thing-causes (*causæ efficientes*) and stares exclusively at the ground-cause (*causa finalis*), can be seen from Hegel's explanation. "Wie die Luft sich als allgemeines Element ihre Spannung aus der Erde nimmt, so das Meer seine Neutralität. Die Erde dünstet gegen die Luft aus, als Meer; gegen das Meer aber ist die Erde der Krystall, der das überflüssige Wasser aus sich abscheidet, in Quellen, die sich zu Flüssen sammeln. Aber dieß ist, als süßes Wasser, nur die abstracte Neutralität, das Meer dagegen die physische, in die der Krystall der Erde übergeht. Der Ursprung der unversiegbaren Quellen darf also nicht auf mechanische und ganz oberflächliche Weise als ein Durchsickern dargestellt werden, so wenig als nach der andern Seite das Entstehen der Vulkane und heißen Quellen; sondern wie die Quellen die Lungen und Absonderungsgefäße für die Ausdünstung der Erde sind, so sind die Vulkane ihre *Leber*, indem sie dieß Sich an ihnen selbst Erhitzen darstellen." That which dazzles the speculative philosopher of nature is again the categorical power-language. He sees in the totality of facts not merely a concept, but in the concept a meaning. The meaning he quite rightly seeks in the aim; thus in his eyes the earth's springs and volcanoes get their existence from their significance and their significance from the service they render the earth-body: they stand to the earth-body as organs to organism. But in the determination of the single thing the speculative philosopher forgets that the word in which the concept's meaning is objectively uttered is a word of power, and that the word of power is proclaimed in actual facts, reciprocal actions of efficient causes. [432]

It is "the household of nature" upon whose interpretation both the natural scientist and the speculative philosopher of nature, each from his side, are bent. But from both sides the interpretation will miscarry so long as the relation between hypothetically necessary results and objective particular syllogisms is not clarified.¹⁶⁴ Only in the reciprocal action of particular and total syllogisms does the power-language become intelligible, and the expression "the household of nature" come to be apprehended, not as a figurative turn of phrase, but as a natural-scientific concept.

3) *The third Fundamental Totality of Objectification is determined by the categorical Power-Language.* That the living organism must be apprehended as much under the standpoint of purpose-causes as under that of thing-causes is generally acknowledged.

¹⁶⁴How geognosy's hypothetically necessary results let themselves in cognition be transformed into particular syllogisms has been shown above by examples from chemistry.

Leibnitz's words: *finalem causam non tantum prodesse ad virtutem et pietatem, in Ethica et Theologia naturali, sed etiam in ipsa Physica ad inveniendum et detegendum abditas veritates*, will surely, if not the physicists proper, then at least botanists and zoologists willingly endorse. In the interpretation of a vertebrate's bone-structure, of its teeth, claws etc. the zoologist must necessarily support himself upon teleological presuppositions. By this interpretation the special science and philosophy thus seem to approach each other, each from its own point of departure. That the approach cannot lead to a fusion is however settled by this, that the special science, which apprehends the a priori through the empirical, can never reach the ground-cause through the thing-causes, while philosophy, which according to its method must begin [433] with the ground-cause determined by facts, never by any conceptual development whatever will be able to make the relation between the ground-cause and the actual thing-causes *in concreto* transparent.

What then in this connection is philosophy's significance? That with a clear cognition of the limits of human knowledge it at the same time knows and cognizes a divine knowledge, a knowledge which, in its unity with power, utters its content in the word of power, in a categorical power-language. That philosophy really does know and cognize a divine knowledge can naturally not be seen from its immediately presupposing, and by supposing functions appealing to, the unity of God's omniscience and omnipotence; but it is seen from this, that philosophy, after many groping attempts, has at last become conscious of its method, in that it has become conscious of how it, without mistaking the limit of human knowledge, will be able to develop and make clear the concept of a divine knowledge¹⁶⁵.

The organism, the living organism, is of all forms of existence that in which the reality of the categorical power-language is most clearly uttered. Human knowledge is able to understand this language only insofar as philosophy, under advancing conceptual development, is able ever more deeply, more thoroughly, more all-sidedly to give an account of knowledge and power in their pervading opposition and yet original unity. With the general unity as foundation the opposition of knowledge and power is developed in the doctrine of *judgment and object*; with the developed

¹⁶⁵Cf. Grundideernes Logik I. p. 230 ff.

opposition as foundation the unity-in-opposition in the form of power is developed and, by the categorical power-language, articulated in *the objective syllogism*. But with this the objective syllogism is at the same time developed into a syllogistic union with the subjective.

γ) Idea-Syllogism: Modal Functions of Truth.

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That the expression: functions of truth, cannot in the present connection be specially determined by the contradictory opposition to functions of untruth, but by the ontological opposition to functions of knowledge and functions of power, is surely understood of itself. As form for the absolute subjectivity with its content and free necessity the subjective immanence-syllogism is an absolute form for the absolute itself, an adequate idea-form, and to that extent an idea-syllogism. Knowledge's content is from this standpoint identical with the power-word's ideality, and the idea-syllogism's subjective functions are modal functions of knowledge. As form for the power-word's reality in actual facts the objective syllogism is an adequate form for the development of existence's absolute, and for its part likewise an idea-syllogism. The syllogism's content is knowledge's object; knowledge's object is objectified in a categorical power-language; the syllogism's functions are with respect to this determined as modal functions of power.

During the development both of the subjective and of the objective syllogism there showed itself, however, the remarkable doubling, that each of the extremes itself became a syllogism. This doubling repeats itself, and the integrating of one-sidednesses in every direction, conditioned by the doubling, is now a distinguishing mark for modal functions of truth. Thus in this connection subjectivity's all-sidedly developed immanence-syllogism is expressly posited as the idea-syllogism's subjective extreme, while the objectivity-syllogism with real concepts, imperative, executive and interpreting functions etc. for its part yields the idea-syllogism's objective extreme. Since both syllogism-extremes are idea-syllogisms, the concrete idea must necessarily itself yield the middle in which they are syllogistically united. Only by this syllogistic union is the concept *idea-syllogism* all-sidedly apprehended and determined.

But the concept is as yet determined only in general; the concept fixed in its generality demands a determinate development going through the particular and [435]

the singular. Under this development the doubling will then consist in this: that the whole subjective-objective idea-syllogism is posited in its subjective extreme and characterized as *ideality-syllogism*; that next the whole, objective-subjective idea-syllogism is posited in its objective extreme and characterized as *reality-syllogism*; that finally the ideality-syllogism's subjective and the reality-syllogism's objective extreme are syllogistically united in an all-explaining middle, which thus forms a *conclusion*.

αα) Ideality-Syllogism: the Pre-existence of the Ideas. If in logic the question is raised, which of the two categories: *being* or *existing*, is in the stricter sense to be posited as the original one for the idea, the answer may well demand a closer consideration. Insofar as the idea as idea is the universal, being seems undeniably to have to be preferred to existing; for being expresses the general. One would then have to say: the idea is, but it does not *exist*; for the general is, but it does not exist. But now the idea as idea is not merely the absolutely universal; it is, according to what we have in the foregoing elucidated from so many sides, just as much the absolutely particular and the absolutely singular. Insofar then as the idea is determined as the absolutely singular, there is every reason to lay emphasis upon the idea's existence: the idea is, because it *exists*.

And yet, immediately regarded, the category existence is just as inadequate for the absolute idea as the category being. Being is ambiguous, because it runs just as much upon the abstract as upon the concrete, just as much upon the non-self-subsistent as upon the self-subsistent, just as much upon the unessential as upon the essential: being is indifferent to the difference between abstract and concrete, essential and unessential, self-subsistent and non-self-subsistent. This indifference [436] stands in decisive conflict with the idea's demand; for the idea is and wills to be, not the abstract, but the absolutely concrete, not the unessential, but the absolutely essential, not the non-self-subsistent, but the absolutely self-subsistent: being is inadequate for the idea. What being lacks, existence possesses. By the category existence there is expressly aimed at a subsistence for itself, a particular, self-subsistent determinate being: that which exists is not merely something existent, but a concrete singular essence subsisting for itself. And yet the category of existence has, immediately understood, side-determinations that do not let themselves be united with the idea

as idea. A thing exists just because it is a thing: the thing and that which exists are identical expressions. To make the idea into something that exists is, in other words, to make it into a thing; but the idea is just as little a thing as the thing is an idea.

So long as being and existing fall apart from one another in a finite manner, neither of these categories will satisfy the idea's claim to all-sided determinateness; in order to become adequate, they must become identical; in order to become identical, they must surrender side-determinations for a higher category. The higher category, enclosing being as existing and existing as being, can be designated by an *absolutely reflected subsistence*.

In the absolutely reflected subsistence being is present; for that which subsists is something that is. In the absolutely reflected subsistence existence is likewise present; for that which subsists is something self-subsistent, and the self-subsistent is something existing in and for itself. The formerly inadequate being has now, by being taken up into an absolute subsistence, become adequate, for it has come to run upon decisive self-subsistence; the formerly inadequate existence has likewise, after having given up its immediacy and been transformed into absolutely reflected subsistence, become adequate, for the idea has its subsistence, its absolute self-subsistence, in absolute reflecting.

But how are we now to determine the absolute reflecting? According to our foregoing, as an infinite energy! The idea *is*, that is to say: it *subsists* in infinite energy; [437] the idea *exists*, that is to say: its infinite energy is one with *its absolute self-subsistence*. The infinite energy is, subjectively seen, an infinite *comprehending, judging, syllogizing*. In the infinite comprehending, judging, syllogizing the idea is at one and the same time both the comprehending, judging, syllogizing subjectivity and also the content of the concept, of the judgment, of the syllogism: the energy is that the idea's self-separation rests upon its absolute self-unity, and this again upon the former.

Subjectivity has in its threefold being, as thinking, intuiting, willing, a threefold existence: the absolute subjectivity exists in three existences. That the three existences are in the matter itself more than three modifications of one and the same existing can be seen from subjectivity's threefold content. The threefold content is expressly determined by the three absolute ideas: the true, the beautiful, the good. The thinking

subjectivity exists with the energy of the universal in eternal truth, the intuiting subjectivity with the energy of the particular in eternal beauty, the willing subjectivity with the energy of individuality in the eternal good. Here there are in the idea three centers, three regions: the ideal world (*κόσμος νοητός*) is originally divided into three realms. But the threefold existence is, in the syllogism-unity of subjectivity and the ideas, nonetheless one subsistence reflected into itself, one energetic being, one single infinitely concrete existing.

The ideal world with its infinite system of ideas and idea-syllogisms is in its reflected subsistence a relative-absolute existence; it is by the energy of objectification determined as the idea of objectivity, the idea of the ideas in objective form, that is to say as *world-idea*. As the word of the Godhead the world-idea is one with and yet different from the Godhead itself. It is one with the Godhead, for in all objectification of another subjectivity originally objectifies itself. It is different from the Godhead, [438] indeed opposed to the Godhead, as otherness in its absolutely pervasive relativity can be opposed to the original selfhood that determines itself in all and all in itself.

As the idea of objectivity the world-idea has its selfless selfhood in the principle of relativity: the objectivity-idea is in its objective essence the idea of otherness. Herein lies it, that the one original world-idea must have its reflected subsistence in systems of relative ideas. According to the ideality of the power-word the systematic unity of the relative ideas constitutes *the ideal system*; according to the reality of the power-word it constitutes *the real system*. The ideal system now furnishes the idea-syllogism's subjective extreme, the real system its objective extreme. Since, however, the idea-syllogism's subjective extreme is itself a syllogism, an *ideality-syllogism*, it follows from this that the whole real system with its power-determinations and antilogical moments must already, in an ideal-concrete manner, be anticipated in the ideal idea-syllogism.¹⁶⁶

For the all-sided determination of the ideality-syllogism, the ideal idea-syllogism, it is thus necessary that the totalities in the objective extreme be transparent in the subjective: the objective extreme's real totalities are anticipated and, by the anticipation, co-determining for the idea-syllogism's subjectively absolute content. If

¹⁶⁶On the original opposition and teleological unity of the ideal and the real systems cf. Grundideernes Logik I. p. 216–229.

the real system's co-determining reflexes are thought away, the ideal system is only an empty abstraction. The ideality-syllogism is at one and the same time extreme and syllogism. As syllogism it has, by integrations from reality, the whole world-idea for its a priori content; as extreme it has the infinite richness of its content in absolutely reflected subsistence, in a being identical with eternal working. The anticipated real system is by the ideality-syllogism determined at one and the same time both as *possibility* and as *outer actuality*, as possibility by virtue of the anticipation, as outer actuality in the character of objective extreme. [439]

By the objective extreme's syllogistic conjunction with the subjective the world-idea, the world of the ideas, is infinitely concrete, an actual world *ad intra*. But since the anticipation of the objective extreme has validity only by virtue of the extreme's own objective reality, the world of the ideas can have subsistence in energetically reflected existence only under the inviolable presupposition that the real world of things has an outward immediate and material existence. In the inward-going, reflected existence all becoming in all activities, formations and movements bears the stamp of *unalterable being*: the ideal existence expresses the eternal. In the outward-going, immediate and material existence, on the contrary, all being and determinate being takes on the stamp of finitude, parcelling-out, outward alteration, *unceasing becoming*: the real existence expresses the temporal.

As necessary as it now is that a syllogism's extremes — far from being indifferent to one another — must as extremes have their subsistence in mutual opposition and reciprocal tension, just as necessary is it then also that the ideal and the real existence must assert their validity by opposition and tension.

But how is the ideal existence now to be determined by its decisive opposition to the real existence? As eternity-existence, thus as pre-existence! In opposition to the ideal existence the real existence in temporality and becoming is then to be apprehended as a derived existence, an existence in which every existing term has its finite beginning. In the tension between the ideality-syllogism's two extremes lies "the birth of time".¹⁶⁷

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¹⁶⁷On the theologians' quackeries in determining the beginning of time and of the world cf. D. Strauß. Den christelige Troeslære. Oversat af H. Brøchner. Første Bind 1842. p. 557–71.

Every real existence begins in time; but time itself does not begin. If the real existence presupposes a disposition, then the disposition again presupposes a pre-existing idea. *The pre-existence is partly absolute, partly relative.*

In opposition to the real existence's manifold worlds and edifices of the world the eternal world-idea has *an absolute pre-existence*. But the edifices of the world that are in actuality different could nevertheless impossibly, if it is true that each singular one is to develop out of its principle according to its type, proceed from the absolutely pre-existing world-idea, if particular ideas, answering to particular worlds, did not by a principal disjunction develop out of the fundamental idea itself: the ideas so developed have in relation to the particular worlds of the real development not an absolute but *a relative pre-existence*.

How it must originally stand with the relativity of the pre-existence and with the principal disjunction is seen clearly enough from the relation between *idea and disposition*. That an edifice of the world develops out of a disposition, that a terrestrial globe develops out of a disposition, that an organism develops out of a disposition, means, according to our foregoing, that the edifice of the world, the terrestrial globe and the organism each in its own way actualize an idea. What the disposition is in objective being, that the idea is in subjective reflecting; the idea is thus one with and yet different from the disposition. The unity-in-difference is determined by this, that the disposition is the idea dwelling in the real beginning, the idea the disposition completed by preformation and pre-existing in the anticipation. The identity of disposition and pre-existing idea is, when it is more closely determined, a categorical expression for the ideality-syllogism's original middle. In the present connection it is especially a matter of making clear what essentially lies in this middle.

In the first place, then, the middle expresses that the extremes must hold good by their mutual opposition, for if the opposition were not, then the middle would surely
 [441] be superfluous. In the second place the middle expresses that the mutually opposed extremes must be identical; for if the identity were not, then the middle would be without significance. We will now begin by reflecting upon the opposition by itself and seeing what follows from it. The subjective extreme will then, by its opposition to the objective, present freedom in a one-sided manner, while the objective from its

side will in a just as one-sided manner present necessity.

According to the freedom-extreme the real system's principal totalities with their dispositions would then have to be immediately referred to relatively pre-existing ideas, and each singular one of these ideas be straightway determined by imperative functions of the divine subjectivity. Thus, as regards e.g. the organism and its types, not only the emergence of organic life upon the terrestrial globe, not only the typical fundamental difference between plant- and animal-organism, but also every one of the typical forms within the plant- and the animal-kingdom would have to be referred singly and immediately to a divine act of will. This is the extreme in the subjective. Whether one otherwise prefers to represent the matter to oneself in such a way that the divine subjectivity finds the pre-existing types already present in its realm of ideas and then, with these in view, forms the different dispositions of real existence, or prefers to hold that the divine will first brings forth the paradigms and thereafter the corresponding dispositions, is wholly indifferent to science; for thought fails: the concept has gone out, the objective extreme is violated.

According to the necessity-extreme not only would the pre-existing ideas fall away as idle, deuteroscopic fantasies, but even the dispositions characteristic of the real system would necessarily have to give up their principal significance and transform themselves into bare possibilities; thus a world of possibilities without disposition! It is incredible what exertions the science of experience, indeed even philosophy, has made in order to come to terms with such a world of possibilities without disposition. Where [442] the disposition is lacking, there must naturally be peculiar circumstances and favorable conditions to cover the lack. Thus organic life upon the earth is by no means to have its origin from a divine disposition, but solely from a possibility that supervenes under peculiar circumstances and favorable, especially favorable, conditions. Since now no possibility can be actualized without sufficient conditions, while every sufficiently conditioned possibility is always actualized with necessity, necessity reigns. This is the extreme in the objective. How one otherwise will picture to oneself the peculiar circumstances and favorable conditions, whether one will grant the divine knowledge a contemplative role restricted to indicative functions alone, or straightway reject every representation of a divine knowledge, is indifferent, wholly indifferent; for the

concept has gone out, the subjective extreme is violated.

By their mutual opposition the extremes are thus posited as one-sided freedom against one-sided necessity. Hereby the middle, the totalized identity, is expressly determined. That freedom in the abstractly subjective is one-sided means, in other words, that it must have its real possibility in the objective necessity; that necessity in the abstractly objective is one-sided means that it must have its essential ground in the subjective freedom. Freedom in the ideal system is thus to be integrated by necessity in the real system, and conversely: here is the middle. Reality weighs with necessity's pressure upon freedom; but by self-determining reaction freedom gets the better of necessity. It is necessity's pressure and subjectivity's reaction that give the syllogism's middle its peculiar tension. Upon this tension rests the teleological unity of the real and the ideal system; upon this unity rests the reciprocal relation between real and ideal disjunction; upon this reciprocal relation rests the idea's divine productivity.

[443] In a real world with possibilities without disposition nature is without productivity. As little as the "harvestless" sea can be said to have productivity because, on condition of wind and storm, it can bring forth high waves, just as little will a real world with possibilities without disposition be able to be said to have productivity because, on condition of substances with determinate melting-points and a changing temperature, it can bring forth solid, fluid and gaseous masses. Only with the principal disposition does productivity come. Water's transition from the drop-fluid state to ice cannot in the categorical sense be called productive bringing-forth; in the emergence of organic life, in the coming-to-be of every new organic type, nature on the contrary displays an essential productivity. Every productive form is determined by its peculiar disposition; every peculiar disposition is again determined by a real disjunction: either plant or animal, either mollusc or articulate etc. The productive transitions rest upon sheer totality-separations, sheer principal disjunctions. In such disjunctions nature utters itself productively.

And yet productive nature does not, properly speaking, speak out of itself, as little as any language either speaks out of itself or itself speaks. No, it is subjectivity that speaks in and by language, in that it speaks out of itself: the divine subjectivity

speaks in and by nature, in that it speaks from itself. The real system's productivity is at all stages of the formations an utterance of the word of power, a categorical power-language in disjunctive judgments and disjunctive syllogisms: the principal disjunction is real.

But the principal disjunction could impossibly be real if it were not originally ideal; it could impossibly take place in the real system if it did not originally take place in the ideal system; it could impossibly enter into necessity if it did not originally spring from freedom. Were the divine selfhood not infinitely productive, it would be weighed down by otherness and stifled by objectivity.

It lies in selfhood's essence that it can be determined by another only in that [444] it determines itself; it lies in the word of power that it could impossibly be real if it were not originally ideal; it lies in the disjunction that it cannot have reality in a disposition if it does not have ideality in a pre-existing idea. Upon the relation between the determined disposition and the determining idea rests the relation between the ideal or inward-going and the real or outward-going productivity. The pre-existing idea, the particular word of the power-ideality, is not idle: it bears the objective totality's disposition, in that it is itself borne by subjectivity; it effects the disposition's real development in the objective and determines the word in the categorical power-language of bringing-forth, in that it receives from subjectivity its content-moments, answering to the antilogical power-determinations of the real development, developed in reflected subsistence.

The outward-going productivity answers to necessity, the inward-going to freedom; but in the middle of the extremes — and the middle is here the decisive thing — the ideal productivity is necessary by virtue of the real, and the latter free by virtue of the former. But all productivity expresses, according to its concept, that subjectivity at one and the same time both acknowledges and masters its objective. In productivity freedom is necessary, and necessity free; but since the real productivity depends upon the ideal as the determined disposition upon the determining idea, freedom has in the free necessity necessity itself under it.

That the earth's development, geologically seen, points to a disposition means then, logically understood, that it takes place in consequence of a pre-existing idea; here

one may thus with full right speak of *the earth-body* itself as elementary organism, of *the earth-body's disposition* and of *the earth-body's idea*. The development's beginning is preformed by this, that the disposition in the totality of the objective elements is all-sidedly determined by the idea reflected in subjectivity's productive energy.

[445] If the disposition were not borne by the idea, it would vanish as a pure contradiction; for what a wonderful demand is there not laid in a disposition! In the disposition the whole is, essentially seen, to be finished from the beginning, and yet the disposition requires precisely that an actual development must take place: in the earth's original disposition there lies at one and the same time everything earthly, and yet this earthly all is first to come forth successively, and to that extent to come to be *by degrees* in the course of the development. This contradiction can be resolved only by this, that the same content is at one and the same time both *outwardly*, thus in the reality of the power-word as disposition, and *inwardly*, thus in the ideality of the power-word as pre-existing idea.

"But," someone might ask, "does not the same contradiction now arise in the idea as in the disposition? What is gained, after all, by moving the contradictory demand out of the disposition and into the idea?" We must on this occasion impress it that the pre-existence is categorically determined as subsistence in energetic reflecting, as reflected subsistence: in reflected subsistence the idea has all the moments of the content at one and the same time; the energetic reflection is in this subsistence anticipation, and in the anticipation that which is actually to come must surely be essentially present. What the anticipation is in the idea, that *the drive* now is in the disposition. The outward-going productivity, the actual development of the earth, shows us only the drive, not the anticipation; and yet all formative drive in the objective is only a word of power that confirms the energy of anticipating in the subjective.

From the energy of anticipating it is then further seen that the development of totality in the outward-going productivity must point for point answer to the idea-development itself in the inward-going. The pre-existing earth-idea has indeed from the beginning all the moments of development in reflected unity, and the real development can to that extent not enrich the idea with anything whatever; but since the idea-moments are themselves anticipated, the real development in the outer

totality, in the earth-body itself, must necessarily be the condition for a corresponding [446] ideal development in the earth-body's idea: the executive functions reflect themselves in the anticipating ones. That the earth at a certain stage of development attains, as it is said, a certain maturity means then, logically speaking, that the pre-existing earth-idea has attained a certain determinate energy.

Whence then, at the terrestrial globe's relative stage of maturity, do the new dispositions come, the dispositions namely to plants and animals? Naturally from a preceding idea-development. In relation to the paradigms for organic life the earth-idea is pre-existing; in relation to the organic individuals the life-ideas are pre-existing. The free necessity with which the typically different life-ideas step forth out of the earth-idea has in the foregoing already been determined by the doctrine of the immanent subsumption- and disjunction-syllogisms and the individuations answering to them. We have still to consider the reciprocal relation between the individuations and the fundamental idea's infinite pregnancy.

It lies in the nature of the matter that the world-idea, the absolute idea of otherness, of objectivity and of relativity, must be infinitely pregnant. The otherness-form is finite; the content infinite: in every one of the finitely determined forms the content thus yields an infinite surplus. This disproportion persists at all the intermediate stages of formation, until the otherness-form can again be taken up into the selfhood-form. In the first syllogism, the syllogism fundamental for the edifice of the world, which according to the ideality of the power-word has the fundamental idea itself for its ideal, and according to the reality of the power-word this determinate actual world for its material extreme, there lies the first intermediate idea in the form of particularity, the idea of *this kind of* edifice of the world. This intermediate idea, derived from the fundamental idea but determining for the actual world's disposition, an anticipation-idea which over against its own determinate real world has relative pre-existence, now assumes the determinate form of particularity, thus a form with determinate limitation, determinate boundary; it is then with this form to be an individuation [447] of the fundamental idea, is to hold its whole content, thus an infinite content in a finite form: here there must come to be an infinite surplus, the particular idea must be infinitely pregnant.

With the fundamental syllogism the form of productivity is peculiarly bounded. However often the same kind of syllogism be repeated, however many finite edifices of the world be added to those already given: the productivity in the mechanical form will constantly suffer from the one-sidedness that the idea, as well after its ideal as after its real development, remains in otherness and, by virtue of otherness, in finite opposition to subjectivity.

That the subjectivity which is master of its content masters otherness precisely thereby, that otherness is driven to an extreme, rests in selfhood's deep upon productivity's inexhaustibility. But the inexhaustible productivity rests again upon this, that a higher form constantly relieves a lower, until the otherness-form at last is resolved into selfhood's adequate form. In the real system every new form of productivity is determined by a new disposition, thus in the ideal system by a new idea. The new idea, decisive for the new disposition, is not created out of nothing, nor does it rest upon a divine whim, but proceeds by ideal disjunction out of an already given foundation-idea.

The foundation-idea can expressly be determined as the immediately preceding syllogism's *terminus medius*. If we consider the syllogism: A (the world-idea in its generality) — S (the particular world-idea) — E (this actual, determinate solar system), then the particular world-idea, which furnishes the syllogism's middle, is precisely that foundation-idea out of whose deep the idea for the new productivity, the planet-idea answering to the system, proceeds. The new productivity beginning with the planet-idea now forms the extreme for the new syllogism: A_2 (the planet-idea in generality) — S_2 (the particular planet-idea, the earth's idea e.g.) — E_2 (this actual determinate earth). By this syllogism productivity already makes an essential advance, for otherness now begins to enter into selfhood: as an idea realizing itself the actual earth is an elementary selfhood.

That the form of productivity, however, cannot be brought to a close with the syllogism $A_2-S_2-E_2$, that S_2 must, so to speak, teem with surplus, is a straightforward consequence of the selfhood-drive lying in otherness. For the selfhood-drive in the new form S_2 must then again become foundation-idea; in other words: the new disposition in the earth-body, the disposition to organic life, must presuppose a pre-existing

life-idea developing itself out of the earth-idea. With the syllogism: A_3 (the life-idea in earthly generality) — S_3 (the life-idea in earthly particularity, plant- and animal-life) — E_3 (the life-idea realizing itself in the individual), and the systems contained in this system, selfhood at last wins the victory over otherness, and productivity attains its completed form.

What otherness is in the outer infinity, that selfhood is in the inner; from this it is seen that the form of productivity can first be completed with the selfhood developed into a self-conscious self; only self-consciousness with its inner infinity can be the adequate form of the infinite productivity: the starry heaven is too small to hold what can dwell in a human soul.

How necessity in the infinite productivity unites itself with freedom, in what relation knowledge's indicative functions, which let everything rest upon objective power-consequences, originally stand to subjectivity's imperative functions, which let everything depend upon self-determination, now shines forth from our foregoing.

In stepping forth out of its ideal foundation the new idea steps forth according to a principal disjunction. By a principal disjunction the life-idea has proceeded from the pre-existing earth-idea, this again from the pre-existing planet-idea, etc. The principal disjunction is in its energy essentially conditioned by a corresponding subsumption. [449] Seen outwardly, the subsumption presupposes the already existing individual (this existing thing is a horse, this existing thing is an elephant); the subsumption goes from existence to category, from individual to idea.

It is otherwise when the ideality itself, the inward, is here looked at. That energy of the anticipation upon which the disjunction, the original separating-out of the new idea, each time rests cannot indeed posit the two terms of the syllogism without presupposing the third, cannot possibly posit the foundation-idea as the universal (the genus), and the new idea as the particular (the species), without presupposing the individual as individual; but the presupposition is here an anticipation. By the anticipation-energy it is thus just as much the species and the genus that become determined by the individual as conversely the individual that becomes determined by species and genus. If now individuation requires, as we have shown above, that the immanent syllogism's three terms must in the principle itself have the same originality:

then it follows with necessity from this that the individual in which the species is to be realized must by anticipating subsumption be an individual-idea co-determining for the species-idea: only in reflection of its individual-ideas is the species-idea a paradigm.

According to the subsumption the pre-existing idea becomes determined by objective considerations, that is to say: it becomes determined as disposition; here there is, e.g. at this stage of the terrestrial globe's development, a possibility of organic life, and thus this objective possibility is now in and by the life-idea to be transformed into a disposition. But life upon the earth is impossible without a living shape; the living shape must be an earthly-individual shape, according to the objective conditions, either this or this shape. Once the ideal disjunction has the possibility of several dis-
[450] positions, the energy of the anticipation posits this, precisely this shape in individual determinateness; the presupposed individual can now be subsumed under its species, and the species-idea pre-exist as paradigm.

Insofar, then, as it is the subsumption conditioned by the real system that motivates the ideal disjunction, the subsumption indeed points to necessity, the ideal disjunction to freedom; but since the subsumption is just as originally motivated by the disjunction as the latter by the former, freedom goes together with necessity: freedom posited in necessity's form is disposition; necessity posited in freedom's form is pre-existing idea. Unity of disposition and pre-existing idea is a syllogism-unity, that unity of the idea-syllogism which completes ideality.

ββ) Reality-Syllogism. The Real Existence of the Ideas. In the ideality-syllogism, the idea-syllogism's subjective extreme, otherness is a moment transparent in selfhood; reality is here a reflex in ideality; the word of power is transfigured in the form of knowledge; productivity *ad extra* is there only as presupposition for productivity *ad intra*. If we now attempted to hold fast the subjective extreme alone by itself, thus not as extreme, but as a syllogism self-subsistent for all eternity, then it would undeniably be an abstraction, and this abstraction would give us precisely that relation in God which Hegel¹⁶⁸ has designated as "a play of love with itself, in which it does not come to serious otherness, to separation and discord". If the subjective extreme is to have

¹⁶⁸Philosophie der Religion. Zweiter Theil. Berlin 1840. p. 248.

validity, it must originally have its objective extreme, precisely that extreme in which it does come to “serious otherness, to separation and discord”.

If speculative dogmatics knew the idea-syllogism, it would be able to spare itself all objective trouble over deriving nature’s corruptibility from the Devil’s principle and the Fall. Of course, the derivation is indeed of a piece with it. “It is”, it is said in the [451] objective treatment of “Death and the Corruptibility of the Whole Creation”, “difficult to deny that there are in nature phenomena which themselves raise the problem of the incursion of evil into nature. We shall not merely appeal to the fact that what stirs in the darkness of the human soul hisses through the foliage of the forest in the coiling of the serpent, and howls through the desert in the bloodthirst of wild beasts. But we shall point in particular to the fact that there is revealed in nature an enigmatic contradiction against nature’s own inner teleology, a contradiction against nature’s own inner purposiveness ... This disturbance of nature’s own ends we are unable to cognize as grounded in a true necessity; natural phenomena which in themselves bear a disturbing principle we are unable to acknowledge as normal”.

It does indeed look solemn at a distance when the theological inquirer takes the non-theological logician to task and submits it to him to consider whether he “is confident that he can show that the redemption of fallen human nature does not also comprise the redemption of thought, that this is not Christianity’s intention, to restore true humanity completely, but to let essential elements — and thought surely belongs among the essential elements — remain outside its sanctifying and perfecting activity”. Yes, in such language the talk of the redemption of thought even sounds edifying; but is it not strange all the same? Every time the “redeemed thought” really has to set about solving a problem, how very poorly the scientific redemption fares! When a Jacob Böhme, although he acknowledged “that a No was required if the Yes was to be able to reveal itself, and that opposition was necessary if life was to be felt”, nevertheless did not believe he could explain to himself “the wondrous regime of present nature, the palpability and obscurity of matter, the struggle and strife of all elements and [452] creatures against one another”, without the presupposition “that Lucifer’s arrogance had set fire to the pure etherial essence of the original creation, whose slag forms the

present world”:¹⁶⁹ then it is the task of science in such a mysticism to distinguish what belongs to imagination and what belongs to thought. But upon such a distinguishing the thought redeemed according to the direction of dogmatics will hardly enter. But where then is the sign of thought’s redemption? For that the dogmatician is unable to cognize the natural disturbance of nature’s own ends as “grounded in a true necessity” can surely not be set up as a proof of thought’s redemption.

If we regard the actual nature present to our senses as the objective extreme of the idea-syllogism, an extreme which is itself a syllogism, indeed, as has been shown in our foregoing, a system of syllogisms; if we, as regards this reality-syllogism with its systems, lay due weight both on *the natural otherness* and on *the natural selfhood*, then it may well succeed in cognizing the natural disturbance of nature’s own ends as grounded in true necessity, and in interpreting the aesthetic-ethical parallel between that “which stirs in the darkness of the human soul” and that which alarms us in the hissing of the serpent and the howling of the beast of prey.

As regards, then, in the first place, otherness, its elementary character can come into strife with selfhood and mark corruptibility only at the point where life begins, hence first in the plant organism. If the terrestrial globe is regarded by itself, even the greatest upheavals will mark no disturbance: for elementary selfhood, hurricanes and earthquakes are just as adequate as sunshine and dead calm. In relation to the organism, [453] by contrast, there begins the tension between principle and conditions, between idea and actuality. “In the plant’s natural shape the unity-in-difference of the whole and its parts, the inner and the outer, the total individual and its partial individuals ... is all-sidedly determined by the articulating opposition of selfhood and otherness ... If we ask which of the two powers is the stronger, selfhood or otherness, a dialectic of power and impotence will show itself on both sides. Essentially understood, selfhood, which in principle bears otherness within itself, is the original, the higher, and to that extent the more powerful; otherness, which has its integrating element outside itself, is by contrast the derived, the lower, and to that extent the impotent, the weaker. But if now the emphasis falls, as actuality likewise demands, on the phenomenon, the factual, the immediacy that strikes one in the fact, then the relation reverses itself, then

¹⁶⁹See D. F. Strauß. *Den christelige Troeslære*. Oversat af H. Bröchner. Kbhvn. 1843. p. 13.

otherness, which has its strength precisely in the outward immediate, must necessarily show itself as the original, the stronger, and that not merely *although* it is, but *just because* it is that which according to its essence is the derived, the weaker; likewise selfhood, whose validity rests on reflection-energy, must necessarily present itself as the derived, the abstracted, and that not merely *although* it is, but just *because* it is that which at bottom is itself the original, that which in objective reflection is eternal and incorruptible”.¹⁷⁰

Corruptibility, which shows itself in many ways in the plant world, is raised in the animal world to the higher power of suffering, pain and death. This happens not by any intervention of Lucifer, but by “a true necessity”. The ensouled individual is in its immediate self-sensation its own end; for this end the actual surrounding world must furnish means and conditions, and thus be determined as the subordinate. But the surrounding world, which itself lies subject to elementary otherness, resists [454] the self, and so the conflict begins. “Every animal species is, like every plant species, determined to live in its own way. But the ensouled lives on higher terms than the unensouled; the unensouled lives only insofar as it is, in all immediacy, a living thing; but the ensouled is a living thing which expressly lives its own life. To live one’s own life for oneself is to *try* life; to try life is, in the immediate sense, to *enjoy* and to *suffer* ... The goal is not enjoyment of life for itself, as little as it is suffering; for the same thing that makes it possible for the individual to enjoy also makes it possible for it to suffer; actual enjoyment presupposes the possibility of an actual suffering, just as conversely actual suffering presupposes the possibility of a corresponding enjoyment”.¹⁷¹

Already the struggle thus characterized between selfhood and elementary otherness will be sufficient to explain how it comes about that there can be revealed in nature “an enigmatic contradiction against nature’s own inner purposiveness.” “But”, the dogmatician with “the redeemed thought” continues: “natural phenomena which in themselves bear a disturbing principle we are unable to cognize as normal ... A theodicy which would here reassure us with the general representation of finitude and of life’s necessary development through oppositions would only evade the problem.

¹⁷⁰Forelæsninger over “Phil. Propæd.” fra Universitetsaaret 1860–61. p. 317–18.

¹⁷¹Anfr. Skr. p. 392.

For both true and false development moves through oppositions, and the question is precisely whether all the oppositions that natural life shows us are normal". We answer "the redeemed thought" that the objective extreme of the idea-syllogism naturally is and remains normal as extreme; but that it is a contradiction, indeed a gross contradiction, to demand of an extreme what can first be attained in a middle. Let "the redeemed thought" for once make a serious scientific attempt at throwing the real [455] extreme away, and it will soon see where, despite all declamations about the normal and the abnormal, the true and the false opposition, it finally ends up.

The strife between selfhood and otherness, growing in the animal world, reaches its maximum in human life. Inasmuch as consciousness, which in the animal is only immediate sense-consciousness, doubles itself in the human being into self-consciousness, by this doubling not only joy and enjoyment but also pain and suffering are infinitely doubled: death, which merely strikes the animal, comes to be for the human being. With the human being's awakening self-consciousness there awakens spirit, the idea of the will with freedom's demand in freedom's form. Natural selfhood is egoism; the strife between selfhood and otherness that runs through the whole of nature is then transformed in the human being into a struggle of freedom between egoism and spirit. For spirit, egoism is a guilt; the intimation of guilt is anxiety. Seen from this standpoint it must surely be evident, without Lucifer's help, to everyone whose thought is not so "redeemed" that it has become quite loose, how it can come about that something which hisses in the foliage and something which howls in the desert can be an alarming reminder of something "which stirs in the darkness of the human soul".

It is the attractive thing about original mysticism that it everywhere sees nature in the light of spirit and spirit in the light of nature; but when the reflection of the understanding begins, the ambiguity must go. What shines as in holy twilight with the metallic lustre of primitivity can neither be replaced nor reproduced by the aesthetic polish of a superficial "thought-redemption". That a Jacob Böhme, by one of spirit's strong flashes of lightning, can believe he sees the corruptibility of the whole creation explained in the red glow of Lucifer's flames, we can understand; we can be involuntarily gripped by what is profound in it. But how feeble and ambiguous

the explanation becomes when the “redeemed thought”, by objective grounds in an objective manner, seriously undertakes to furnish proof that world-egoism is the cosmic principle, and the cosmic principle the devil in becoming. [456]

Revelation and science have, with all their opposition, this in common, that both reject the ambiguous: an ambiguous revelation is just as great a *contradictio in adjecto* as an ambiguous science. In order to do away with the ambiguity, one must from both sides make a separation between nature and spirit. But when the separation has taken place, how deep is the gulf that divides faith from knowledge! For it stands fast, provided only one will not let science’s “redemption” play conjuring tricks with faith, that pain and death have been in existence for millions of years before the human being appeared on earth. And it stands fast, provided only one will not let faith’s “redemption” play conjuring tricks with knowledge, that death is the wages of sin, and nature’s corruptibility a guilt of spirit.

That the reality-syllogism is an extreme has beguiled believing speculation, which in consequences of the immediate power of otherness has thought to trace the works of the devil; that the reality-extreme is itself a syllogism consisting in systems of syllogisms has beguiled immanence-philosophy, which by letting the ideal be absorbed in the real has taken a syllogism-extreme for the completed syllogism.

yy) Closure: The Completion of Idea-Existence. With the fully developed middle of the ideality- and the reality-syllogism, and with the two extremes’ syllogistic union as determined by the middle, the idea-syllogism itself at last reaches its closure. The succession hereby indicated is, however, grounded in a corresponding simultaneity; the idea-movement is rest, rest itself a movement. For the case is not that the perfect middle should now abolish the two imperfect extremes, that totalized one-sidedness of ideality and of reality on which dualism originally rests; no, on the contrary! as true and perfect middle it must precisely let the extremes stand in force in all their one-sidedness. Another matter is that the middle, which is itself a syllogism, a system of syllogisms, indeed a system of syllogism-systems, can again unfold extremes which in their perfection are themselves middle terms, inasmuch as the perfect middle terms are themselves extremes. [457]

It is *otherness* (the limit, the real negation, the difference) which hereby presents

itself in a new light. In the ideal system otherness is ideal, and the negation immanent; the differences are formed by the reciprocal determinations which the word originally carries with it in the infinite thinking, intuiting and willing of ontological subjectivity. In the real system otherness is real, by the immediate manifestation of power even sensuous and material. The differences lose themselves in superficial diversities, temporal parcellings-out, outward and contingent relations.

If now it really were impossible, as has so often been asserted in “the philosophy of the concept”, that real otherness could be raised to a higher level than that which characterizes this actuality present to us, then the ideals could indeed, as it is said, never be attained, then idea and existence would have to find themselves in eternal discord. But a transformation of otherness, and therewith a sublation of corruptibility, is, logically seen, so far from being an impossibility that it is on the contrary an inescapable necessity. The discord between ideal and actuality which is so characteristic of the objective real extreme is by no means a sign of the idea’s relative impotence; it is much rather a proof of the absolutely overreaching power of idea-filled subjectivity.

A feeble idea naturally has feeble extremes with a weak middle and a feeble syllogistic union; hence immanent speculation is always so anxious about whatever might resemble “a dualism”. The powerful idea, divine in essence, by contrast has powerful extremes; its manifestation in a vigorous dualism is only the presupposition of the infinite superiority with which it carries the syllogism through; the completion [458] of idea-existence in concrete closure must necessarily have an all-explaining middle, a last *terminus medius* that masters all extremes. Since now the all-explaining middle must be a realm of ideas just as much as each of the extremes, the three *termini* of the idea-syllogism have thus with inner consistency transformed themselves into three distinct worlds: an ideal world, a real world and an ideal real world.

“But” — sober criticism asks — “where are we getting to now? If logic is really to occupy itself with illuminating the ideal real world, that supernatural kingdom where the ideals are actual only because actuality itself is ideal, then the closure of the syllogism-systems must indeed end in a formal eschatology. But then an encroachment is after all being made upon theology’s well-earned rights; then the logician does after all come at last to institute such considerations in the upper world as only a speculative

dogmatician, a mystically profound genius who in an otherworldly “cloister life” had devoted himself solely and alone to “eschatological considerations”, would be able to carry through in the underworld!”

In this respect we can at once reassure criticism by referring to the problem: “Two Worlds”.¹⁷² The discussion of this problem ends precisely with an entirely negative result. “If we hold fast”, it is said, “to the likeness between Here and Yonder, then we are surprised by the unlikeness; if we hold fast to the unlikeness, then the likeness again forces itself upon us. If we keep to actuality, then it comes into conflict with the ideal; if the ideal is itself to be actual, then we get two kinds of ideals: ideals which we know, but which never become actual; ideals which we do not know, and of whose actuality we can form no representation, let alone any clear concept. But when I am not in a position to see into an ideal’s possibility, how should I then be able to assume [459] its actuality? *A non posse esse ad non esse valet consequentia*”.

What a precarious undertaking it is in science to have to depict for oneself, by analogies from this present world, the condition in the life to come, can be seen from many examples; the theologians’ attempts with the objective doctrine of the resurrection are instructive in particular, also in a logical respect. The thought objectively “redeemed” in dogmatics has, namely, in union with the equally objectively “redeemed” imagination, taken many and various and characteristic runs at a scientific explanation of the nature transfigured in the resurrection. The attempts, carried out now with scholastic boldness, now with the smoothing-over caution of a modern consciousness, now inaesthetically and tastelessly, now again with tact and taste, all move on the basis of one and the same contradiction, the contradiction of *a natureless nature*.

That philosophical criticism, every time it has occupied itself with exposing what is insipid, flat and self-contradictory in the dogmaticians’ attempts, has been able not only to render *præstanda* but to celebrate triumphs, is understandable. But neither ought it to be passed over in silence that criticism, dazzled by sundry cheap triumphs, has not seldom criticized itself so far into finite contradictions of the understanding that it has *eo ipso* criticized itself out of the idea. By proving the impossibility of making the condition in the world to come intuitable, negative criticism has, in accordance

¹⁷²Forelæsninger over “Phil. Propæd.” fra Universitetsaar 1861–62. p. 123–137.

with an easily explicable self-deception, been brought to assume that it thereby proved the impossibility of a world to come. But this is a precipitancy.

If the world to come is posited as identical with the ideal real world and this as identical with the middle of the idea-syllogism, then no doubt can any longer be raised about its validity; its necessity is given. Insofar as what is at stake is then not to make its actuality intuitable in the form of a condition — for this is, as has been said, [460] impossible — but to determine its concept as the necessary form for the completion of the idea-syllogism, reflection can in this case rest precisely on the familiar proposition of formal logic: *a necesse esse ad posse esse valet consequentia*.

There can as little be talk of any leap or outward transition from this world to that as there can be talk of a leap or outward transition from a syllogism's extreme to its middle. There is indeed a difference of sphere between Here and Yonder, but in the same way there is also a pervasive opposition and qualitative difference between middle and extreme. Just because the opposition of extreme and middle reaches its highest point in the idea-syllogism, the identity is all the stronger. It can be seen at all principal points in the extreme that the one-sidedness, albeit in a one-sided manner, is integrated from the middle: through the middle there runs a continued movement from extreme to extreme.

If we now regard the three regions, the ideal and the real system as extremes and the ideal real system as middle, then it is at bottom the idea, the one and the same idea, which with all particular ideas runs through all three regions. In the ideal system the idea has as idea its pre-existence, in the real system its immediate real existence; but each of these forms of existence is one-sided and in its one-sidedness unsatisfying. Pre-existence lacks reality, real existence lacks ideality; if these lacks could not be remedied, the idea would have to remain in eternal strife with itself: strife and contradiction would then, in meaningless meaning, be the principle of existence (πόλεμος πάντων πατήρ).

But in each of the extremes the middle is itself preformed. The ideal disjunction by which the particular idea obtains its pre-existence coincides precisely, as has been shown above, with the real disjunction by which real existence obtains its disposition. The real originally works upon the ideal in order that the ideal may work upon the

real; there is in the idea nothing so ideal that there must not be in its energy a moment, [461] a reflex of real immediacy, and there is in the idea nothing so real that it does not have an ideality in its possibility. By the doubling that in this way obtains in each of the extremes, the middle can gain power; for what now is the middle? The all-sidedly determined existence of the idea, that completion of existence which alone can give the extremes their significance. The middle is goal, the goal is closure, closure is the truth of all syllogisms; from this standpoint it can then be seen that the functions of the idea-syllogism are essentially modal functions of truth.

The middle is truth. The extremes indeed also have their truth, but only in union with the middle. If the middle is thought away, then otherness is on both sides inadequate, and the thought-syllogism E–A–S (as movement A–(E, S)–A) is not in a position to satisfy the idea. In the ideal extreme otherness is abstractly ideal, the concretion in E and S lacks reality; but to lack reality is to lack truth. In the real system otherness is one-sidedly elementary, the concretion in E and S lacks ideality; but to lack ideality is to lack truth. In the middle, by contrast, otherness is adequate, and the idea of truth satisfied.

The middle is beauty; for beauty is the intuitable harmony of the ideal and the real. In the ideal system, as regards the intuition-syllogism E–S–A (as movement S–(E, A)–S), E is with all its transparency so feeble that S precisely thereby comes to lack the striking immediacy which the beautiful may never be without. In the real extreme E has immediacy enough; but since otherness is elementary and, by its elementary immediacy, contingent, it is in rupture with A and non-transparent for S. From the intuitable disproportion between E, S and A there arises the unbeautiful. In the middle, by contrast, otherness is adequate; E has transparency enough to make A intuitable and immediacy enough to take up, individualizingly, the shape S: the idea of beauty is [462] satisfied.

The middle is the good. In the ideal extreme the will lacks its necessary barrier, the actual opposition by whose sublation it proves its energy. The will-syllogism S–E–A (as movement E–(S, A)–E) is empty, for E is a shadow, otherness is only a reflex of selfhood. In the real system otherness is strong enough to offer the will resistance; but now the resistance is so elementary that the will and the barrier find themselves in

unceasing struggle. In unity with the middle, by contrast, both extremes are good; the all-sided energy with which the will works in and by the equilibrium of ideal and real otherness that characterizes the middle is precisely conditioned by the one-sidedness with which it works in the extremes.

What holds of the ideal ideas, the true, the beautiful, the good, in all generality, holds naturally in a peculiar sense of the real ideas, the foundation-ideas and the selfhood-ideas ascending from them. For the individual existence of these ideas elementary otherness acquires a double significance: first, in general, through the real extreme to which it belongs; next, in particular, through the substrate it furnishes for the individual idea's own real development. Thus e.g. the idea of the world-structure has not merely a subsistence reflected in the subjective extreme, a pre-existence belonging under the ideal system, but in the real extreme, the objective extreme, it has at the same time a material and immediate subsistence as this determinate world-structure (this solar system). What now does the middle signify? The world-structure developed and transfigured into all-sided existence! Here it is a matter of attending to the double-sided role of the real extreme.

If the real extreme is apprehended individually in individual opposition to the ideal, hence this existing world-structure in individual opposition to its pre-existing [463] idea, then the middle's significance is unmistakable. If the middle were not, the idea in its pre-existence would lack reality, and immediate real existence would lack ideality; between such extremes no reciprocal relation could then be thought: both extremes would be without truth. That the middle is the truth of the extremes thus means that the world-structure can have an immediate and material existence only on the presupposition that it at the same time has a real existence reflected in its closure and idealized by the reflection. There can thus, to put it plainly, exist a sensuous world-structure only on the presupposition that a supersensuous one at the same time comes into existence.

But as pre-existing idea the world-structure has a beginning in eternity, as real existence it has a beginning in time; the ideal extreme bears the stamp of eternity, the real extreme that of temporality: how does the eternal stand, in the closure, the middle of the syllogism, to the temporal? If the beginning in eternity did not originally reflect

a determination of time, there could here be no talk of relative pre-existence. Relative pre-existence indicates precisely a becoming of the idea out of its ideal foundation, a coming-to-be marked by the disjunction's *punctum saliens*, a development of reflection ascending in the principle, hence a succession within the eternal. Conversely, real existence beginning in time could not possibly begin as an actual disposition if there were not something eternal in the temporal beginning. In the middle itself, ideal real existence, the temporal will thus in an infinite manner convert itself into the eternal, and the latter into the former.

But at this point an ambiguity enters. That the middle subsists as long as the extremes subsist is a matter of course; but if now one of the extremes perishes, what then becomes of the middle? That a supersensuous world exists as long as this material world-structure exists must, if it is true that by the supersensuous there is [464] here thought not a new outward and immediate, but an essential, inwardly reflected existence, indeed be conceded; but everything that arises in time must perish with time; when, then, this sensuous world-structure one day perishes: what then becomes of the supersensuous one? For the answering of such questions it is necessary to set clearly before one's eye the relation between selfhood and otherness that is decisive for the idea's pregnancy and for infinite productivity.

In all regions, under all shapes, *otherness has the double-sided significance: to be at once both coordinated with and subordinated to selfhood*. That otherness is *coordinated* with selfhood, that there could be no subjectivity if the objective were lacking; that the knowing self could have no energy either in thinking, intuiting or willing if that manifestation of power which gives otherness its reality were thought away — all this has been set forth in our foregoing. But that otherness with all this is nonetheless, and must be, *subordinated* to selfhood; that subjectivity, which through its real opposition always relates itself to itself, expresses its acknowledgment of the objective precisely by impressing its seal upon it in infinite productivity, and thus sealing its objectivity — this too must then be assumed to have been sufficiently set forth.

The contradiction concealed in otherness, that it is at once both coordinated with and subordinated to selfhood, is resolved only by the double role which the otherness-elements evidently play in the real extreme.

That a real extreme is in all generality necessary in order to form an opposition to the ideal extreme means that the ideal world would have to vanish if this actual, [465] material world-order could vanish as a whole; in this respect the immediately real stands on a par with the ideal: otherness is coordinated with selfhood. But as regards the individual real existence corresponding to the determinate idea, elementary otherness is, despite all its apparent independence, essentially subordinated to selfhood and subjectivity.

Every idea, even the foundation-idea most deeply sunk in otherness, is nevertheless according to its original essence a selfhood. No world-idea could thus come to actual existence in the actual world-structure if the idea in its real self-development were not in a position to master the elements of otherness.

In the real extreme the elements of otherness can never — this expressly conflicts with the character of the real extreme — be transformed into real idea-moments. But without developing an indwelling system of real idea-moments the idea could not possibly develop itself as idea. Since now the real idea-moments, although from the beginning they must be articulated by the material elements of otherness, are by no means one with these: the otherness-elements can fall back again to the universal real system, and the existing idea nevertheless preserve the ideal-real result of the development and with this result be absorbed into the closing middle. In this middle real otherness — even if its reality is otherwise ever so great, even if in the new system it should be able to be released anew into elementary extremes, indeed, though it should thunder in the midst of “eternity’s summer” — is nevertheless in every way so merged with the ideal, so absolutely subjected to selfhood in every respect, that idea-existence must with full right be said to be satisfied: the supersensuous world is incorruptible.